

Medicare Shoppers (AEP) — Deep Buyer Research

Health Insurance Ecosystem · the person turning 65 or already on Medicare choosing a plan (and the family helping) ·

Researched 2026-09-25 · refresh due 2027-03-25 · Live page: <https://vincestars-cloud.github.io/campaign-previews/medicare-shoppers/research/>

104,229 documents in the shared corpus · 10,534 buyer documents in this page's voice · 1,126 ads to this audience of 4,366 read.

TLDR

- Who: 10,534 first-person Medicare shoppers (10,327 turning 65 or on Medicare, 207 family members helping), mostly comment threads under 90 Medicare explainer videos plus r/medicare. Agents, SHIP counselors, former brokers and commenters posting links are excluded.
- The decision is Original Medicare + Medigap versus Medicare Advantage, and the fear is on the Advantage side: networks, prior authorization and denials (65 fear documents; 481 complaint documents), a big illness and its bills (65), and being stuck after failing underwriting (35; 213 in the complaints ledger).
- The frustration is the system itself: too confusing to compare (456), premiums that keep going up (162), Part D changes (70) and doctors or hospitals dropping Advantage plans (45).
- What they did: 1,180 documents hold or held an Advantage plan and 704 a Plan G or N; 166 went through an agent or broker; 57 got out of Advantage onto a supplement. Both sides have satisfied voices: 319 say Advantage works for them, 190 describe peace of mind with a supplement.
- Who sells to them: 1,126 active Meta ads to Medicare shoppers, 356 from lead funnels and third-party marketers. The 'Turning 65?' qualifier and benefit bait (giveback, flex card, grocery money, \$0) lead the hooks.
- The silent layer: 'how to stop Medicare calls' and its variants are typed 84 ways and watched 1,381,158 times, yet only 24 shoppers mention the calls in their own posts. They put up with the calls quietly; those calls are what the lead industry sells.
- The read for Vince (hypothesis): the Medicare lead an agent will pay for is a shopper who asked for help, chose one agent and was told the truth about Medigap underwriting. The market around them is bait ads and calls they are trying to block, so the ad that names the rule and names the agent is the different one.

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Tab 1 — Fears

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Networks, prior authorization and being denied care · 65 documents

"Retirement and Dealing with Cancer Costs It is not a pleasant subject, but it is important to talk about it. According to WebMD, 30% of seniors aged 65-74, 19% of 75-84, and 8% over 85 get cancer. Within the last 2.5 years, I've had three different cancers, and I retired at the same time. It can be expensive. I thought I would share my experience dealing with the costs. The three cancers I've had to contend with are Mantle Cell Lymphoma (blood cancer), Squamous Cell Carcinoma (skin cancer), and prostate cancer. Mantle Cell Lymphoma is incurable. In my case, my oncologist advised me to delay treatment as long as possible since it always comes back and is harder to treat each subsequent relapse. I was on a "Wait and Watch" monitoring program for over two years with blood tests every 3-months and a scan every 6-months. The monitoring showed it had progressed and required treatment, which I started earlier this month. I'll have 6-months of chemotherapy / immunotherapy followed by 2-years of less intensive "maintenance" therapy. Over the last couple of years, in addition to the chemo treatment, I've had numerous blood tests, PET scans, CT scans, biopsies, and doctor appointments. For the skin cancer, I had a blob of Squamous Cell Carcinoma cut off my face using the "Mohs" procedure, and another much smaller spot shaved off the tip of my nose. I've had multiple visits with the surgeon and other specialists, and I will require skin checks every 6-months because of all of the per-cancerous lesions that keep popping up. The prostate cancer was detected during a PET scan for the lymphoma. However, after a follow-up MRI and biopsy (lot of fun), it was determined that I have the least aggressive form of prostate cancer which does not need immediate treatment and can be managed with "Active Surveillance". I am told it is slow growing and I have about a 50% chance of needing treatment in the next 10 years. I will be monitored with blood tests, MRI scans, and possibly additional biopsies in the years to come. As you can imagine, all of these tests, procedures, and treatments are very expensive. I had always planned on retiring the day I turned 65. However, I was diagnosed with the lymphoma when I was 64 and I decided to work an extra 10 months after I turned 65 (until the end of the year) because: 1) I had already met the out-of-pocket maximum for the year for my work health insurance; 2) my job was very supportive and allowed me to take time off as needed; and 3) my wife would be in a better position financially if things didn't go well for me. I had plenty of time to learn about Medicare, which I started in January 2024 when I officially retired. There are two ways to get Medicare: Original Medicare or a Part C Advantage Plan. With Original Medicare, you really need to also have a Medigap Supplemental Plan and a Part D prescription drug plan. There are several options for a Supplemental Plan. I chose Plan G, which covers everything except an annual deductible. For 2025, the annual deductible was only \$257, which I probably hit within the first 15-minutes of my first appointment in January. Everything else is free for the rest of the year. I should point out that, if I had been on my work group health insurance plan, I would have incurred several thousands of dollars of costs each year until I hit my out-of-pocket maximum. Compared to an Advantage Plan, the premiums are higher with Original Medicare and a Supplemental Plan G, but you don't have any restrictions of which doctors are in your network, and you don't have to worry about insurance company pre-approval. In addition to lower premiums, Advantage plans also include perks such as dental, vision, and maybe even a gym membership. Many people are very happy with their Advantage plan, and may save money with the lower premiums. However, based on my experience, I think Original Medicare with a Supplemental Plan G is preferred if you have a serious illness such as cancer, and you can afford the higher premiums. I pay \$185 for Medicare Part B, \$209 for my Supplemental Plan G, and \$17.50 for my Part D prescription plan. Dental and vision I pay out of pocket. The main benefit of Original Medicare with a Supplemental plan is I've never had to worry about insurance company pre-approvals, or whether my doctor accepted it. In general, I think it is wise to get the best insurance that you can afford."

— r/retirement · 161 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/retirement/comments/1liorgh/>

↳ (0): "Plan N offers the same coverage as plan G except excess charges (which aren't allowed in my state anyway) and there is a \$20 co-pay for an office visit and \$50 co-pay for an emergency room visit. The savings with N will cover over 20 co-pays per year based on the rates I was quoted. It is also expected that premium increases with N will be less than G since plan G is the guaranteed issue plan."

↳ (0): "Good point. Even with all of my appointments, I don't think I ever went over 20 in a single year. If I did, it wasn't by much. Plan N is a good option for those just starting Medicare. Unfortunately, I'm in Massachusetts and this plan is not available."

↳ (0): "Agree whole heartedly on the Medicare supplement plan. My husband is currently undergoing cancer treatment at MD Anderson. He has tonsil cancer, which is an uncommon type of cancer. We came to Houston from Oregon because MD Anderson is an NCI cancer center that treats thousands more cases of tonsil cancer than the one NCI hospital we have in

Oregon. We wouldn't have been able to do that with an Advantage plan. It may be that our local hospital would have been fine managing his care, but we're much more confident in the care plan and speed of treatment he's been getting at MD Anderson."

"Our Medicare Advantage Experience I have no affiliation with any health insurance companies and no particular ax to grind. I just want to share our experience because I see a lot of scary information out there about Medicare Advantage. We live in Florida and my wife has been on Medicare for 11 years and 9 years for me. The first few years we were on traditional Medicare with a Plan F HD supplement, then we switched to MA, first with Aetna and now Humana. We travel a lot so we needed PPO plans for all this time. We signed up for MA because it seemed like such a better deal than Medicare plus a supplement, and that has worked out well for us. We paid no premiums (other than the Medicare B premiums everyone pays) on Aetna and on Humana we actually get a \$175/month rebate towards the B premium. We have watched the co-pays for specialists go up frequently and now pay \$50 per specialist visit. Primary care visits have always been free. In spite of the bad reports on MA, we were very healthy and thought it would be a risk we could take. Five years ago my wife was diagnosed with a faulty mitral valve in her heart. The cardiologist checked it every year and this year he decided it was severe enough to require fixing. Fast forward several months and my wife is now recovering from open heart surgery, which was successful. She spent six days in the hospital and is getting twice a week home care from a nurse, a physical therapist and an occupational therapist. There were two tests that required procedures in an outpatient heart center at the hospital before her surgery. The total out of pocket for all this was about \$3,000. The hospital and physician charges billed to Humana were in the neighborhood of \$300K. We never had to deal with any refusals of coverage, balance billing or any other surprises. So our experience with a major medical issue was outstanding. For the 8 years we have been on MA, we've paid no premiums, had reimbursements for dental work and eyewear of at least \$20K and had no issues with finding good doctors and facilities in-network. Bottom line, who knows what surprises might await us as we get older and less healthy, but I have no complaints about our experience with MA so far. UPDATE: Thanks to everyone who contributed to this thread! It's clear that MA can be anywhere from great to awful, depending on the plans in your area and your individual health situation. I think the comments brought up great issues to explore before choosing MA or traditional Medicare with a supplement. I know we are risking challenges in MA if we move or networks change for the worse. But I calculate that we've saved roughly \$57k in supplement premiums (for 2 people) and received roughly \$20k in dental benefits over 8 years, so the risk was certainly worth it so far."

— r/medicare · 139 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1tp8qt5/>

↳ (0): "I've had the same positive experience with my MA plan for 10 years. I'll go ahead and upvote you in preparation for the Reddit MA-Hating Mafia that will surely show up and tell you why we are stupid and shower us both with down votes."

↳ (0): "I had no opinion about this until I began taking my mother to medical appointments in NYC. It was astonishing to me how often the medical personnel would tell me it's a good thing my mom has original Medicare because they were able to refer us immediately to superior facilities for treatment. When she had to go to rehab, they took both of us for free (not a small thing in NY) directly from the hospital in a hospital car to a beautiful place that gave her great care (and fantastic meals I got to share). So now I am definitely biased. My mother would've had to wait a long time in pain and then accept lower quality care inside bargain basement places. For me, it made a huge impression to keep getting unsolicited opinions from hospital and medical office personnel that it was great my mom had original Medicare because the Medicare advantage plans had much tighter restrictions on referrals and many times we would've been sol. I trust the people who have to deal with getting patients treatment. We are Americans so we are being screwed either way, but a bit less screwed without for profit insurance companies. Good luck to us all who aren't emigrating for better health care."

↳ (0): "If you are in an area with a lot of providers and all your doctors are in network, MA can be fine. But now ask most folks in rural areas about their experience. Also, in many places you can't get a MA PPO, which can be a dealbreaker. Everyone needs to do their own homework, of course."

"This video was so informative. My late husband was blessed to have a Supplement Plan G. Prior to beginning Medicare he began having neurological problems and was diagnosed with ALS. Thankfully we were able to receive the treatments he needed without the stress of co-pays, referrals, or pre authorizations. Instead of the healthcare process being a bear to deal with, it seemed more like leading a lamb."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 98 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgxnPLA_JdSH8Od-IRF4AaABAg

↳ @debbycoffey4788 (7): "You never mentioned underwriting, questions about your health, in order to switch from a MA to Original Medicare if you aren't happy with the Advantage plan you chose. I understand it can be very hard to switch if you have an underlying condition. What are some questions they might ask to deny you from switching?"

↳ @Theretirementnerds (6): "So sorry to hear about your husband. Yes, the ease of use is quite different between the two plans. I like your animal analogy 😊 "

↳ @Theretirementnerds (6): "@debbycoffey4788 we have a video that goes over switching. And, we just finished filming an update to this video where we go through the medical questions in more detail that we hope to release next week. Hopefully you are subscribed and can see that when it comes out. Here is the existing video: <https://youtu.be/djuGel829M4>";

A big illness and the bills that follow · 65 documents

"My husband was given the sales pitch about how great an advantage plan was. So he switched to Humana and the first two years were good. He was never sick. Then Covid came and he was diagnosed with cancer. We live in NH and the ER put him in an ambulance to go to Dana Farber in Boston (an hour away). Well guess what, the ambulance and hospital was out of network. Ambulance was \$5000. After he was diagnosed he passed away 72 days later. He was laying in the hospital bed stressed out about how I was going to pay all the medical bills when he dies. Sucks pretty bad when you're on your death bed and the only thing you think about is how your surviving spouse is going to pay the medical bills! Needless to say, when I signed up for Medicare I took a supplement plan."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 92 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgztwkgUWWxR35VyLN4AaABAg>

↳ @rshoe1023 (14): "Sorry for your lose! It really shouldn't be this way for seniors! The whole health care system here in the states is entirely broken!"

↳ @truthhearit1471 (7): "YOU LEGALLY DO NOT HAVE TO PAY HIS MEDICAL BILLS"

↳ @johndoe-ss9bz (1): "Capitalist - Medicine 101.. "Profits First"..."

"Pretty much have decided on original Medicare (A&B) plus N and Part D, whenever I decide to retire. The cost and "perks" of an Advantage plan sound appealing, but not worth the risk of possible out of pocket expenses compared to original Medicare with a supplement plan. Health conditions can change quickly and with us in the over 65 crowd, that's a huge consideration at least in my opinion. And i want my medical decisions to be made between me and my doctor, not an insurance company."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement I Most Get This Wrong · 21 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4xXIJZes9o&lc=UgzloIQWLpLnagmlgkF4AaABAg>

↳ @MedigapSeminars (8): "One point I cut out of this video to keep it from being too long is that a recent study by Medicare showed that about 90% of Advantage plan companies advertise their plans by drawing attention to the extra benefits (I call shiny objects). They do so to take the focus off the healthcare benefits so people assume they are as good as Original Medicare."

"I have plan G and I have never paid a dime other than my Medicare deductible, and I've had to go to the hospital/ER 3 times. Frankly I hate the fact I'm forced to pay for Medicare. I used to have Obama care and paid \$1 a month. Now I'm forced to pay what \$170 a month? Then I pay for Medicare Advantage. When I quit working I won't be able to afford anything, even Medicare. I will refuse to go to the hospital because I don't want the gov taking my last dime. I'll just die at home. After working at least 50 yrs, paying taxes, this is how the US treats us? It's disgusting!"

— YouTube · 2 New Devastating Medicare Advantage Stories · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Plzy4A7HxHg&lc=UgwMTriMytjoFMpaT6J4AaABAg>

↳ @Reed-2big (1): "If you had a reduced premium under the ACA there is probably a program that I'll reduce your Medicare cost. Please, please seek out help to find that reduced cost plan."

Drug costs and Part D · 47 documents

"The Medicare Plan Shuffle: Why NOT Shopping Part D Annually Could Cost Thousands Let's face it—when it comes to Medicare Part D drug plans, there are two types of people: those who compare their options each year... and those who don't. The first group might sleep easy knowing they're not overpaying for their medications. The second? Well, they could be unknowingly flushing hundreds—or even thousands—down the drain every year. We're not trying to scare you... Okay, maybe we are. A little. # The \$0 Trap: It Sounds Good, But... A \$0 monthly premium sounds amazing, right? Like free pie. But what they don't tell you is that the crust costs extra, and the whipped cream? Outrageously priced. That "free" drug plan might not cover your medications—or might do so at sky-high copays. Drugs like **Eliquis**, **Zepbound**, **Wegovy**, **Ozempic**, and **Mounjaro** aren't just pricey—they're plan landmines. Some plans cover them. Some don't. Some charge you your left arm, others your right. We've even seen plans list one of these drugs at over \$1,000 a month while another plan had it at just \$35. Same drug. Different nightmare. # The Annual Game of "Gotcha" Here's the kicker: every year, plans change. They change their premiums. They change their copays. They change what drugs they cover and what tier they're on. That \$10-a-month generic from last year? Surprise! It's now \$85 and mysteriously moved up a tier. Imagine showing up at the pharmacy in January thinking your plan still loves you, only to find out it ghosted your medications over the holidays. # Why This Year is Different (And Maybe Worse) Whispers from Washington are raising eyebrows. With big changes coming to how Medicare negotiates drug prices and funds subsidies starting in 2026, we could be on the edge of a "musical chairs" situation—except instead of chairs, it's coverage for your heart medication, and when the music stops... well, you get the picture. If you're banking on "the government will fix it," remember: these are the same folks who brought you the DMV experience. # The True Villains? The Middlemen & the Markups Let's not forget the real fun part: drug manufacturers and pharmacy benefit managers (PBMs)—the shadowy middlemen who get rich while seniors juggle pills and price tags. They're the ones who make your life-saving medication more expensive in the U.S. than a luxury vacation in Mexico (where, ironically, the same drugs often cost 80% less). So yes, it's not just about "shopping" your plan. It's about taking a stand against a broken system. One click, one form, one chat with your agent could save you thousands. # Moral of the Story? Don't Be That Guy. Every year, we talk to someone who didn't bother to compare plans. They "liked what they had" and "didn't want to mess with it." By February, they're calling us in a panic because their meds are costing more than their rent. Don't be that guy. Reprinted from Lisaknowsmedicare.com. blog posts"

— r/medicare · 27 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1kyujg6/>

↳ (0): "Basically what I tell all my clients every year. Read your ANOC (Annual Notice of Change) carefully for changes to how your prescriptions are covered, copay changes, etc. Part D plans are super easy to compare on Medicare.gov. Be aware that most PDPs no longer pay broker commissions, so a broker might not be eager to spend valuable time helping you shop around unless you are already a client."

↳ (0): "This right here. I still did reviews for all my existing clients, despite the fact that Aetna, Centene, Cigna, etc. all said no commissions for brokers. I love my clients but this year I'll probably be directing most of them to [Medicare.gov](<http://Medicare.gov>) for Part D reviews and changes."

↳ (0): "Keep in mind that as a broker, sending them to Medicare.gov to enroll proves the carriers point that brokers are not needed. Have them call the carrier to enroll in a plan. Make the carriers pay someone to do the work they won't pay brokers to do."

"@Wildflowerz57 good plan! My parents are both on med advantage and love it, same with my Medicare clients. Advantage isn't for everyone, and I have some clients on supplements because that is their preference and they can afford the premiums, but the vast majority are happily on advantage PPOs with huge networks & solid care. I have also seen older folks paying \$700 plus total monthly for part B, med supplement, and drug plan because they're stuck in an obsolete med supplement and can't qualify for another one, and are scared to move because of videos like this."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 13 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgyxwtlsnO3Manu9DFx4AaABA9.9Zo-abmMTzA9aY40j57arF>

"Dam right , I took it also at 65 . I couldn't wait , self employed , was paying over 1,200/month in NJ, no subsidies from Gov, during a pandemic scared to death I would get Covid and have complications or die, had a big deductible and I'm typical healthy on no meds . Medicare - Medigap plan G and a Part D RX plan was a bargain for me. Everyone does not have « employer sponsored health insurance » . Commercial Insurance plans stick it to you in terms of high premiums from age 60-65 until your Medicare eligible. Everyone's situation is different. Great video- you covered it well."

— YouTube · Reasons to DELAY Medicare Past 65 That Will Save You Thousands and Avoid ALL Penalties · 12 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=L2goGwp4Co8&lc=UgzdXYe0VCiC-Rf4IWN4AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (1): "Thank you for sharing your experience!"

↳ @HMC-p6p (0): "Same here ACA premiums 1295 a month for HMO"

Not being able to afford it on a fixed income · 43 documents

"Medigap Plan G High-Deductible I'm switching from Advantage to Medigap for 2025, but I'm on the fence about whether to go with Plan G or G-HD. Here's my thinking: **Medigap Premium** * Plan G-HD: \$564/year (United American) * Plan G: \$2,292/year (Cigna) * Plan G-HD is **\$1,728** less expensive **All-in cost (premiums plus deductibles)** * Plan G-HD: Part B premium (\$2,088) + Plan G-HD premium (\$564) + Plan G-HD deductible (\$2,800) = \$5,452 * Plan G: Part B premium (\$2,088) + Plan G premium (\$2,292) + Part B deductible (\$240) = \$4,620 * Plan G-HD is **\$823** more expensive However, G-HD costs will vary depending on actual medical expenses, which creates a big opportunity for savings. \$3,538 is effectively the worst case scenario because the Plan G-HD deductible is really an out-of-pocket maximum. Best case is that I don't incur any Part A or Part B costs and I pay as little as \$738 in total premiums, resulting in \$1,728 in relative savings. The spread between the best and worst case scenario is therefore \$2,251/year. Plan G is the clear winner if I'm ever hospitalized, because the \$1,632 Part A deductible, alone, would offset potential savings. G-HD is a clear winner if I stay relatively healthy and incur less than \$1,728/year in out-of-pocket costs. Due to the Part B 80/20 split, I'd need to rack up well over \$8,000 in Medicare-approved expenses before my 20% share is \$1,728, which is a lot of medical care. (In fact, it's more than 5 times this year's spending.) I used my 2024 claims history as a way to predict what I might expect going forward, assuming I stay relatively healthy. My current plan has paid out about \$1,500 in Medicare-approved costs so far this year. Assuming I had had G-HD this year, my Part B coinsurance would have been 20% of that, or \$300. If I assume this represents my ongoing average use of medical services, Plan G-HD will save me around \$1,500/year. The choice ultimately boils down to my risk tolerance and budget priorities, but here's what I'm thinking: * Plan G-HD is a very good bet if I assume I can stay healthy most years. Major risks are covered and I save a substantial amount of money. * With G-HD, the savings during one healthy year (\$1,500) offsets the extra cost of having two unhealthy years (\$800/year). In that case, I pretty much break even. * Therefore, it appears Plan G only makes sense if I assume I'm going to have consistently high medical expenses. Any thoughts? Am I missing anything?"

— r/medicare · 27 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1fxhqz9/>

↳ (0): "Husband and I did G-HD for many of the same reasons you listed. We visit the doctor twice a year for labs. Husband had a few other specialist visits but the total costs were much less than paying plan G premiums. We pay \$48/month each and are in WA. Husband switched from MA plan to this G-HD last year because he wanted more options for doctors and hospitals if things got bad. Medical underwriting was easy as they are looking at serious medical conditions."

↳ (0): "Don't you need to multiply your Part B premium by 12 to get an annual amount?"

↳ (0): "one thing to factor in: increase in Plan G vs G-HD on both the premium and deductible sides of things. even if the percentage increase on G and G-HD is the same, the premium dollars on regular G will be significantly higher than G-HD if you look at it 5 or 10 years down the line. At a 7% increase, in 10 years that regular G is 4213/yr and G-HD is 1037/yr."

"After a year of researching my Medicare options, I chose original Medicare with Plan N. Living in SW Florida, it was a close call between Plans N & High Deductible G, but because of underwriting requirements here, I had to pick the plan that would be best for the long-term. Initially, my HD-G's total costs would be cheaper (if I remain healthy). But after about 10 years, it's likely that my N's total costs would be cheaper as I need more medical services and HD-G's max out-of-pocket would keep getting higher. In the end my decision came down to my concern about HD-G's deductible increasing each year at an unpredictable rate of inflation versus the much more predictable & budgetable N monthly premiums."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement I Most Get This Wrong · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4xXIJZes9o&lc=UgyYhExgJdVDH1dnNpp4AaABAg>

↳ @MedigapSeminars (4): "You made a good choice. Pre- 2020 I would have chosen a G-HD myself. But now that inflation is back, it's not a risk I want to take."

↳ @ChrisSadowski10372 (3): "@robanmateja5000 HDG deductible has gone up 27 percent over 5 years. Having said that most people will not reach that deductible. Remember your paying only 20 percent of Medicare approved charges. Unless you have cancer you simply will not hit that deductible. NY you can switch back and forth so you can play that game. Of course that's why the regular G rates are so high."

↳ @ChrisSadowski10372 (0): "@MedigapSeminarschoose Plan N to avoid high rate increases of plan G, avoid HDG for inflation and EOB issues, avoid advantage plans and pay dental and vision with an HSA to avoid networks and denials."

"Thank you for what you shared here. I am 67 years old now. I was laid off earlier this year when I was 66 and received a severance package on my termination. I did not go onto Medicare until my full retirement age a few months after being laid off work. I did find contract work to help me, and it has been working out. When I learned about the IRMAA charges for my Parts B & D and how that works, I was really worried about what additional amount they would be charging me in 2028 as I know I could not afford that huge increase. My severance package is what would throw me into the 65% bracket, and I know I would not be able to afford that on what I expect my income to be in 2028. Your information here has help relieve some of the anxiety I have been feeling about dealing with 2028 Medicare payments. Thank you for all you shared with us here. Larry"

— YouTube · Why Medicare Will Cost DOUBLE for Over 3 Million People 🤔 · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=sCdAfk-zQFU&lc=UgyXZYhPsAL2hvMVIC94AaABAg>

Stuck: failing underwriting, no way back to a Medigap · 35 documents

"@Wildflowerz57 good plan! My parents are both on med advantage and love it, same with my Medicare clients. Advantage isn't for everyone, and I have some clients on supplements because that is their preference and they can afford the premiums, but the vast majority are happily on advantage PPOs with huge networks & solid care. I have also seen older folks paying \$700 plus total monthly for part B, med supplement, and drug plan because they're stuck in an obsolete med supplement and can't qualify for another one, and are scared to move because of videos like this."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 13 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgyxwtlsnO3Manu9DFx4AaABAg.9Zo-abmMTzA9aY40j57arF>

"I've thought along the same lines. But based on the meetings I've attended over the years with different insurance companies, I believe the future of Medicare Advantage is going to be heavily weighted toward HMO plans. Last year was a good example of that shift, with many PPO options being pulled from the marketplace. Because of this trend, I actually think it will cause more people to hang on to - and even purchase - Medicare supplements than we might expect, since many don't want to be locked into restrictive HMO networks."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 5 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SF_CZkg&lc=UgyNSEImQ0NTVmpgkcV4AaABAg.AMN6TrEcJsQAMNOraNjvCT

"My question that I can't ever find an answer to is what if you have one or more pre-existing conditions and want to get insurance? Is it possible to even get insurance for part G? All of the videos I find are for 'planning at 65 with minimal health issues'. How much does it cost for 'planning at 67 and I have several health issues that cost a lot every year.' Or are you just turned down? Is there some safety net insurance the government backs?"

— YouTube · Best Medicare Supplement Plans - What's Changed for 2026 · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qQtzKellvpk&lc=Ugzuk426mhTx694navd4AaABAg>

↳ @Inspector.ClueSo (1): "You get a g or n without underwriting no matter what your ailment the first time you sign up within 6 months of signing up for B"

↳ @sfree322 (0): "If you're 67 and already on a Medicare Advantage plan, in most states you'll need to go through medical underwriting (health screening) to switch to a Medicare supplement plan and they have the option to deny you or charge you a much higher premium. But if you sign up for traditional Medicare plus a Medigap supplement when you initially sign up at age 65 there is no health screening requirement. I think there's also a one year exception where you can switch from Advantage plan to a supplement plan without health screening in the first 12 months you're enrolled in Medicare."

Choosing wrong, missing a deadline, the penalty · 20 documents

"I've been researching Medicare for the past few months as I am getting ready to have to make some decisions.. I found this video very helpful and informative... I have been so stressed as I don't want to make the wrong decision. This was a great overview and just helped calm my mind a bit. Nothing is easy or straight forward for sure...Thank You!"

— YouTube · If I Were Turning 65...Here's EXACTLY What I'd Do · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2I1lpLq6moM&lc=UgzdEe01DRkZ7syX6od4AaABAg>

"I am concerned as those who chose advantage trying to switch back to regular medicare later would be given penalty additional monthly charges and sometimes be denied for pre existing health issues."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage Plans Leaving in 2026 - 2,600,000 Seniors Impacted · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8Pq6H7UZBbU&lc=Ugw8-92XixbSzt4mnV4AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (3): "This is not the case in the context of this video"

↳ @gramig0 (1): "Hasn't happened in my experience."

"Thank you so much. I turn 65 in December of this year and my open enrollment starts on September 1st. I will be honest. I have watched a lot of your videos and they are helpful, but I am now intimidated and pretty frozen with fear of making a mistake I will pay for for the rest of my life. You would think it would be easier on seniors. I hope you can help me."

— YouTube · When To NOT Call A Medicare Broker · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=zEYptYsaMGY&lc=Ugyof5Nv7Kmjv---GoB4AaABAg>

↳ @AbtInsuranceAgency (0): "We can help! Call us at 888-465-9728. We look forward to it."

Travel and care out of state · 13 documents

"There has to be a cost savings and/or risk reduction for the government to push advantage plans. Considering the restrictions involved with advantage (approvals for services, staying within networks, potential high deductible), I don't see the benefit for a relatively slight increase in cost contrasted with traditional Medicare and Medigap policy. Anyway I want to travel and if I need medical services on a trip I can't be worrying about staying within network and getting approval for services. -- Ms. Abt does a great job explaining this stuff."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage I Pros, Cons and Myths · 16 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ANL8Sji0S1o&lc=UgxVqA0ZppgheEgmBt4AaABAg.95PNrwgrN4I9Ftg4stkizC>

"Sunburn: I'm 77, I live in Florida, since starting Medicare (12 years ago!) I've tried many plans. At first while my husband was still working as CFO of the company he owned we just stayed on his company's employee plan. Then I did some calculations and it appeared that not only were WE paying more, but HIS COMPANY was paying more needlessly! HE was shocked. From there we went on plan N, later on G, then Advantage, then G. He passed. Now I'm on Advantage. Since I spend 4 mos/yr in another state, I feared that if I had medical needs there they would not be covered. I see a dermatologist in my other state and this year I only paid \$80 out of pocket for that visit. Until my health deteriorates I plan to stay on advantage. This was the best video on Medicare choices I have ever seen— nor has anyone ever carefully explained the cost differences among the plans. Bravo!"

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 9 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=UgwQ3lPiQ5wr80EKjrp4AaABAg>

↳ @DankFarrikMe (2): "Once your health deteriorates, you may be stuck in your Advantage plan. If you want to move up to a G or N plan....you will probably have to go through medical underwriting.....and they will likely deny you if you have bad health."

↳ @jamesmcconnell2131 (0): "@DankFarrikMe Yes, Always try to be so healthy you wouldn't need health insurance even though you actually have health insurance."

"My medicare advantage provider will, literally, not talk to me when I'm outside my home state. They won't talk on the phone or provide tele-health services. They also block access to their website when I'm outside the country. I can't review test results or make future appointments for when I get home. Considering that I have given up my original part A and B coverage it's gotten scary to travel. A lot of seniors want to travel. This should be a consideration when choosing an advantage plan."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage I Pros, Cons and Myths · 9 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ANL8Sji0S1o&lc=UgwyZtU41V3f3yXgAy94AaABAg>

↳ @AbtInsuranceAgency (2): "This is a very good point to consider - thank you for sharing!"

Medigap premiums rising until they are priced out · 12 documents

"Medigap getting too expensive When I was eligible for Medicare in 2019, I picked a plan G policy because at the time I was getting at least 4 MRI's a year, seeing my oncologist 4 times a year, and doing physical/occupational therapy. My premium was around \$180/month with a projected rate increase of about 6% a year. It was manageable until my premium shot up to \$327/month in 2024. Last year it jumped up to \$459/month. The cost increase I'm facing in August is terrifying. I'm not entirely sure what to do at this point. I just know I can't keep this up, I'm sure the next increase will take more than half my SSDI."

— r/medicare · 60 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1tbdbvh/>

↳ (0): "Unless you live in a birthday rule state that allows you to switch plans, or you can pass medical underwriting (which is unlikely given your health issues), you're stuck with your current Plan G. If you're stuck, see if your current Plan G insurer will allow you to switch to HD Plan G (high deductible) without medical underwriting. Premiums would be dramatically less. Another option is to move to a Medicare Advantage Plan. Even that may not guarantee any savings because while the premiums are likely to be \$0, there are copays and coinsurance and an out of pocket maximum of \$9250. Given that your current premiums for Plan G are \$5500/year, and that is likely your only out of pocket expense, it might not make sense to move to a \$0/month Medicare Advantage Plan if you end up spending the max out of pocket of \$9250. Even with copays and coinsurance, you'd likely not hit \$9250 (the max out of pocket), but the real question is how likely you are to hit \$5500 (the cost of Plan G premiums). You'd have to look closely at what the out of pocket costs would be for whatever Medicare Advantage Plans you were considering. If you think the cost of copays and coinsurance would be less for Medicare Advantage than the premiums for Plan G, then switch. Of course, if you are low income, then you should also investigate Medicaid options, but just know the income thresholds are pretty low."

↳ (0): "If you really want to go Med Adv, and duplicate the original Medicare as best as possible, gotta go PPO for out-of-network support, and the OOP for that is \$13,900. In 2027 it will be in the neighborhood of \$14,800. Otherwise, one is stuck on networks with HMO. For most stuff that is fine. But, if it's the big C? I had enough money to afford PPO to expand choice closer to original Medicare. It's not really Medigap or Med Adv. It's Medigap, or PPO, or HMO. But, PPO only makes sense if one can operate the plan fully, and that does require a spare \$13,900, although there are cheaper combined OOPs for are PPOs. I saw a \$7400 ppo last fall."

↳ (0): "I'm not a Medicare Advantage nay-sayer, but it's worth pointing out that even with a PPO you can't necessarily go to any provider you want to. Some places don't take PPOs."

"One week ago, I started with Part G, then (after some long thought) I changed four days later to Part N. In my state the price difference is \$106 per month more for Part G, which equates to 5 office visits a month. I usually see my doctor once a year for my yearly exam, so I couldn't see spending the extra money for something I won't use (for now anyway). Also, in my state excess fees are not allowed, and my Part N Plan covers out-of-state excess fees as well. And, I'm sure you know this (but for those who don't) the \$20 copay is for doctor's office visits, not for hospital stays, skilled nursing, or most other covered Medicare services (including Urgent care or out patient care). One other point, the rates for Part G increase faster than Part N. Of course, because of the lack of copays, but also because of "Federal Guaranteed Issue Rights". Most states require carriers to offer Plan G as a guaranteed issue option. Plan N is usually not required to be offered under FGI Rights. People with health issues who use FGI Rights usually go into Plan G, not Plan N. That concentrates sicker, higher-cost members in Plan G. And more claims means premiums rise faster. In contrast, Plan N doesn't absorb as many high-risk enrollees under FGI Rights, so its rate increases tend to be slower. I'm not knocking Part G, but there are just a lot of moving parts people should be aware of."

— YouTube · Should You Switch from Medicare Plan G to Plan N? Here's the Real Tradeoff · 31 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xsEZJVMwY8E&lc=UgxRpS3f2VEzwU7RufR4AaABAg>

↳ @ronaldelliott4373 (2): "Had you looked at Plan G-HD? That's Plan G with a high deductible. I'm just turning 65 and in the process of examining these supplement options. I'm leaning towards G, however yearly rate increases broken into monthly premiums in the recent past are unfavorable if this trend continues. I'm trying to get up to speed on Plans N and G-HD for specific differences among all three. As I'm new to the Medicare System, I'm wanting to make the best possible decision while I have the opportunity to choose, without being denied through underwriting qualifications that hit all of us later if wishing to change from one Plan to another."

↳ @nickt.2825 (0): "Agree and why I also chose plan N. Started Medicare this year and went to several specialists already. I can afford the co-pays and whatever fees I have to pay. I was leaning towards G but like you said premiums increase faster on G and N is still great coverage."

↳ @AndrewKline-v2d (0): "@ronaldelliott4373 I did look at a Part G-HD plan. For my situation the numbers didn't make it that favorable. Even after subtracting the standard Part B deductible (\$257), the high deductible of the G-HD almost equals two years the difference in price of my Part N plan. If I never use it, then the G-HD makes sense, but I know I'll use it (at least once a year). But if something medical does come up, I would be paying almost twice as much out-of-pocket (1 year deductible for Part G-HD vs 1 year of premiums for Part N). And, of course, that's what insurance is for—to cover those unexpected events. One thing about deductibles, you could end up paying it twice for the same event. Say, you have a situation in November. In November and December you are chipping away at the deductible. But January comes along, and for any additional services needed, the high deductible resets. Also, the deductible of the G-HD is for all services, the Part N \$20 copay is only for office visits. Go to urgent care on Part N, there's no copay, but the G-HD high deductible will still need to be satisfied. The final thought that made me consider my Part N plan over Part G-HD was that I am thinking long term. I had to pick a plan that I will be using 20-30 years down the road when I'm sure I'll be using insurance more. I felt that Part N was a good compromise. It's saving me money now (compared to the standard Part G) while I'm healthy, and in my later years, I avoid the high deductible of Part G-HD (which you know will be going up). Again, this is only for my situation, not yours. You have to do what's best for you."

"My Plan N with Mutual of Omaha went up 4%. What I'm really concerned about is the Plan D premium & Rx cost increases."
— YouTube · HUGE Medicare Supplement Rate Increases (and what to do about them) · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ah1bzQtPBRQ&lc=UgwGJkTLDOum38J5pfp4AaABAg>

↳ @AbtInsuranceAgency (3): "4% is good! And yes, big Part D changes coming for 2025."

↳ @BOND007-s6k (0): "@AbtInsuranceAgency Is mutual of Omaha pretty stable with their rate increases over time?"

↳ @jbrokay (0): "My Mutual of Omaha Medigap plan G increase this year (for 2025) is 20%! I sure wish I could change companies!"

Excess charges and doctors who won't accept Medicare (argued both ways) · 11 documents

"We picked plan N, to keep the premiums lower. A copay of (UP TO) \$20 for just doctor visits, wasn't a deal breaker for me. I was concerned about the excess charges. But after finding out they're very rare, and we can control that, by simply asking if they take Medicare Assignments."

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=Ugw2gW4LDQM9jtaWI7I4AaABAq.AOODtS76NJWAOv00hnMCmg>

"Plan N for me here in NC. Excess charges not a concern here. Premium substantially lower than plan G. Plan G is now the guaranteed issue policy. That will most likely keep plan G premium rates rising more than plan N in the future."

— YouTube · Medicare Plan G vs Plan N (New Info!) · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SP2JABN8RL8&lc=Ugx9K-c4jAv0WjHn6A54AaABAq>

↳ @allanc9472 (0): "What company did you go with?"

↳ @greyholcombjr.9623 (0): "@allanc9472 AARP UHC. I'll be 67 in November and my premium will increase to \$111 with annual increase."

"My wife and I had been on Plan F but several years ago we switched to Plan N with a different carrier resulting in significantly lower premiums. Switching normally involves medical underwriting but if you do not currently have an expensive condition it should not be hard to qualify. But this does underscore the need to pick a supplement plan for the long term. I'm glad you spoke about excess charges, I think often the risk is grossly overstated. We are both pretty healthy for geezers so don't go to the doctor very often. So even if our health deteriorates we are betting our lifetime supplement cost will be lower with Plan N, but YMMV."

— YouTube · Medicare Plan G vs Plan N (New Info!) · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SP2JABN8RL8&lc=Ugz2q-igaj1QqQtKpMd4AaABAq>

↳ @AbtInsuranceAgency (1): "Absolutely! Thanks for commenting 😊 "

↳ @Slo-ryde (1): "@tomschmidt381 I was referring to high deductible plan F (which is no longer available to new enrollees)... the whole selling point of F (both types) is that the premiums were lower than N, and if you are someone who does not utilize the healthcare system much, then it would make more sense to have taken F, as the savings are realized by the lower premiums (as is my understanding). But now plan F has been supplanted by plan G (high deductible version)."

↳ @Slo-ryde (0): "How could plan F, a high deductible plan.... Be more expensive than plan N?"

IRMAA and the income surcharge · 6 documents

"Thank you for what you shared here. I am 67 years old now. I was laid off earlier this year when I was 66 and received a severance package on my termination. I did not go onto Medicare until my full retirement age a few months after being laid off work. I did find contract work to help me, and it has been working out. When I learned about the IRMAA charges for my Parts B & D and how that works, I was really worried about what additional amount they would be charging me in 2028 as I know I could not afford that huge increase. My severance package is what would throw me into the 65% bracket, and I know I would not be able to afford that on what I expect my income to be in 2028. Your information here has help relieve some of the anxiety I have been feeling about dealing with 2028 Medicare payments. Thank you for all you shared with us here. Larry"

— YouTube · Why Medicare Will Cost DOUBLE for Over 3 Million People 😬 · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=sCdAfK-zQFU&lc=UgyXZYhPsAL2hvMVIC94AaABAq>

"I guess you gotta think about IRMAA as a a good thing that you have decent income, even though you don't want to pay the extra surcharges"

— YouTube · Medicare IRMAA: What Most Retirees Get Wrong About Their Premiums · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=w1PM7D2XD84&lc=UgyWwR1drH68EeaWZgF4AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "Things could be worse I guess... if you are running into IRMAA."

"With my Roth conversions, I've definitely been more concerned with the IRMAA thresholds than tax brackets. Not so much trying to minimize IRMAA while doing Roth conversions, but more ensuring that if I need to push into a higher bracket that I go ahead and do a bit more conversion to fill up the bracket. Also, I've found that while, for my family's circumstances with a disabled child and Social Security disability benefits, Boldin cannot be used to calculate exact Roth conversion numbers, because it cannot account for SSDI and therefor cannot calculate our true MAGI. I can fudge things; so that, it can get me in the ballpark, but I have to do manual calculations myself to generate the exact amount for each of my conversions and exactly how far into the IRMAA brackets I'm going."

— YouTube · IRMAA Explained: Why Your Medicare Premium Can Suddenly Explode · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=R1MRB2YjYDY&lc=UgxNMVajYKlwQif9lt54AaABAg>

Tab 2 — Hopes & Dreams

Theme	Documents
Their drugs covered at a price they can pay	40
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Any doctor, any hospital, no approvals	27
Staying healthy enough never to need it	16
Getting it right the first time	14
Dental, vision and hearing covered	13
Knowing exactly what it will cost, no surprise bills	10
Retiring, or finally stopping work	7

Their drugs covered at a price they can pay · 40 documents

"GLP-1 Bridge Program Info As someone that works in a doctors office and submits PAs, I want to clear up some confusion about the GLP-1 bridge program. I want to start by saying I appreciate that this program will get these meds to many people that need it, but it leaves a lot of Medicare beneficiaries behind. If you have type 2 diabetes, moderate to severe obstructive sleep apnea, or MASH you do NOT qualify to use the program. You have to get a GLP-1 medication approved for those conditions through your Part D plan. Even if the Part D copay is astronomical, you still can't use the bridge program if you have any of those 3 diagnoses. It doesn't matter if the provider doesn't even use those diagnoses and only submits the PA for obesity, you still don't qualify. When we submit the PA, the provider has to attest that you do NOT have those conditions. If the provider selects that you DO have any of them, the system automatically denies it and kicks it back saying it has to go through Part D. You can't get around this if you have these conditions because that would be committing Medicare fraud. I submitted multiple of these PAs today and confirmed this is exactly how it's being processed. You do still qualify if you have mild obstructive sleep apnea and meet the other criteria, because mild OSA isn't covered under Part D, only moderate to severe. This is directly from the CMS website info for prescribers and the PA form that I've linked below. I recommend looking over these because this is exactly the guideline providers are following when submitting these PAs. <https://www.cms.gov/glp-1-bridge.pdf> <https://www.cms.gov/files/document/glp-1-prescribers-c-1.pdf> I hope this information is helpful."

— r/medicare · 74 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1ulaona/>

↳ (0): "Super helpful - nice to hear from someone actually submitting the forms. People keep asking agents and that's useless :)"

↳ (0): "Great info & great explanation!"

↳ (0): "The pharmacy tech at the Walmart pharmacy i use, had no idea about the bridge program. Someone else tried to help her figure it out I sent a message to my doctor who responded the paperwork has been submitted and awaiting a response This whole thing feels like a mess. I hope it gets straightened out before the program ends Update: I just got notification from Walmart that my prescription is ready at the \$50 copay!"

"COST PLUS DRUGS (Mark Cuban's) I have insurance that I pay \$350. a month for and only one of my drugs is covered, the other three are relatively inexpensive and I pay 100% of the cost. For the other drug it costs me \$2000 a year, and then my insurance pays 100%. Now I signed up for Mark Cuban's Cost Plus drugs. I get the same 4 prescriptions for \$424. a year. I would like to cancel my drug plan, but I guess I have to wait until open enrollment."

— r/medicare · 58 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1qw7vli/>

↳ (0): "You don't want to cancel your Part D unless you are absolutely, totally sure you can use Mark Cuban OR afford to pay all your drug costs out of pocket for the rest of your life OR re-enroll later & pay a penalty for the rest of your life You can voluntarily disenroll or not enroll in a Part D plan during the Annual Enrollment Period (typically Oct 15 – Dec 7) or certain other enrollment periods. Can you try & find a zero or low cost plan next open enrollment? If you can, keep your D even if not actively using it and if you are off for 63 days and ever have to go back on it, then you will be charged a penalty which is: 1% of the national base beneficiary premium for each full month you went without creditable coverage.(\$38.99 in 2026) That amount is rounded to the nearest \$0.10. The penalty is added to your monthly Part D premium — so you pay it every month for as long as you have Part D coverage (even if you switch plans). The longer you go without coverage, the bigger the penalty. This is all up to you, but please think through the implications"

↳ (0): "I'm not sure if you have a Part D drug plan or not, but I have never seen one that costs hundreds of dollars per month. You do have to wait until the enrollment period later in the year to sign up for a different one. My opinion is that it's a good idea to buy the cheapest Part D plan if you are buying generic drugs "off plan" from places like Cost Plus. You can often get a plan for a very small amount. I have never paid more than \$1.40 a month for mine. It just serves as a backstop if I'm prescribed a more expensive drug later."

↳ (0): "Please get some expert advice. No drug Plan costs this much. Get an appointment with SHIP. It's free unbiased expert advice. If you do have a drug Plan and it's costly, if you drop it you'll have a penalty forever. I had a Wellcare drug Plan that had 0 premium and protected me against penalties. This year the premium is \$3.25 a month. Next year I might get a better more expensive plan. Maybe."

"I just want to say the "negotiated" prices Medicare received for the drugs is ridiculous. Canadian's pay way less for these drugs than we do. We need better negotiators."

— YouTube · Trump Administration Ends Medicare Part D Subsidies - Here's What It Means · 51 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=OGuOGZSI_fc&lc=UgxYuN2b6yzmZ7kxG7J4AaABAg

↳ @SquirrellySquirrel1 (9): "@kenny-tu2bu when you look at the total tax burden—federal, state, and local—the gap between the U.S. and Canada isn't as wide as many assume; for high earners, Canada's combined rates can exceed 50% compared to roughly 35-45% in the U.S., but for middle-income families making around \$60-80K, U.S. rates run 12-22% while Canada sits at about 20-25%, making the difference much smaller in practice—and here's the real issue: Canada uses that tax revenue to fund universal healthcare and robust social programs that simply don't exist in the U.S., meaning Americans often end up paying out-of-pocket for services Canadians get through their taxes, so while the U.S. tax rates might be a little lower on paper, when you factor in what you actually get for your money, we're paying close to what Canadians pay but receiving significantly less in public benefits, leaving more gaps that individuals have to fill themselves."

↳ @kenny-tu2bu (7): "Canada's income tax rate is 20.5% on income from \$58,523 to \$117,045. Why did you leave that part out?"

↳ @robertmeunier9915 (7): "@kenny-tu2bu Because it is irrelevant to the conversation. The conversation is about government negotiated rates. That is before government subsidies for consumers. The tax rate would be relevant to the subsidies the consumers receive from the government. But as you brought it up, US tax rates for a single filer is 22% for income from \$50,401 to \$105,700."

Switching to a supplement (or to a better plan) next year · 39 documents

"As someone who is about to enter the Medicare minefield I truly appreciate your honest evaluations of Medicare Supplement and Advantage plans. As a senior reaching 65 I have learned a lot and had my eyes opened by your informative videos. Keep up the good work. I hope others do their due diligence on their health care post 65. I wish other states other than the four allow seniors to switch back to original supplement plans. That would immensely help."

— YouTube · MASSIVE: Hospitals Are DROPPING Medicare Advantage Plans 🤖 · 46 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vn2k1W-JzB8&lc=Ugy6mXtwm4ahYY_KrNR4AaABAg

↳ @ckstaff (12): "Don't know the truth on it but in those states you can go back to original I have heard to do so you will be paying a hefty premium to do it. Just take the smart rout and do it right the first time. Don't gamble with your health with taking shortcuts."

↳ @ronbaker8007 (5): "Medicare limits the amount that can be charged; Supplements protect the patient from lack of permission from providers, Med ADV controls permissions and choice."

↳ @kathyd7284 (3): "It is so overwhelming and I was a paralegal for over 40 years. We asked older relatives and decided on regular Medicare Plan N through AARP United Healthcare with Part D through WellCare. We have been so happy with these plans. Hardly anything out of pocket after Medicare yearly deductible paid."

"anyone that is 65 and over must pay for medicare cost that is paid from social security, about \$175 a month. the 20% supplement can cost \$150 a month , plan G and goes up each year with United Health Care. So annually, one pays \$1800 plus the annual deductible of \$240, or \$2000 a year for health insurance. no co-pays and no other expenses to see the doctor or ER visits after the annual deductible is paid, \$240. the original medicare pays up to 60 days in the hospital. 60 days is a long time. In most cases, one will be discharged within 60 days. From age 65 to 75, most seniors would not be staying in the hospital for long periods of time. the goal is to make appointments to see the doctor and do preventive care. take advantage of the plans. the part that I have a problem with is, medicare advantage can change its policy and they are for profit. the medicare advantage tangle carrots like free stuff , some dental work, glasses, and partial payment for hearing aids. plus gym membership which are available on some supplements. some medicare advantage plans do not pay if you leave the network. when the original medicare, I can go to any ER and do not need to worry about a co-pay. with advantage plans, there are doctor visit co-pay and ER co-pays and drugs cost money, with kaiser advantage plans. if one starts with the original medicare, you are guaranteed , no need to qualify. if you start with an advantage medicare plan with zero to little monthly fee with some free stuff, if you wish to go back to the original medicare plan, you have to be screened and qualify. the questions, do you wish to pay \$2,000 a year that gradually increases with the annual \$240 deductible , then unlimited doctor visits and ER visits? or be nickled and dime with office visit cost, ER cost , and subject to having the advantage plan approving your bill with possible surprises? I have to make a choice soon, nothing is free in life. All I know, I am currently paying \$1000 a month with kaiser and it cost me \$\$\$ for office visit, lab work and if I need to go to the ER. if I have to have a test performed, I have to still pay. So the \$200 a month supplement is reasonable with the original medicare. Again, Nothing in life is FREE, especially when our congress is swayed by private insurance companies trying to get a larger piece of the business. I hear many horror stories with private advantage medicare plans. they surprise Americans with large bills since the coverage does not pay for certain treatments. IMO"

— YouTube · Original Medicare vs. Medicare Advantage: What's the Difference? · 30 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=weO1WkquA3s&lc=UgzaiX7JeWu8Hgkw-fB4AaABAg>

↳ @ESMEE_4EVERR (0): "Jvgknftiokfpmgibdhcujiqbjjg"

↳ @AIH-p2u (0): "I'm surprised you think it's okay to pay 2400\$ a year plus dental plus vision plus medication and think it's everyone's best option. Many ppl are healthy and can save 2400\$ etc for 5-10 yrs then go into a chronic plan with little max out of pocket saying you thousands but if you're ill and have my doctors then supp is the way to go UHC offers both mapd pdp and supp I am contracted with them"

↳ @bozomonster (0): "The math doesn't workout in your if your paying \$1,000 per month to Kaiser. The max out of pocket with a Medicare Advantage Plan is \$5,000."

"I HATE doctors. I HATE insurance and I avoid both at all costs. This all makes me cringe. Unfortunately I have to make a decision in a few months and I honestly don't know what to do. I want to choose Traditional Medicare, but with my rent jumping up every year, I'm going to be homeless next summer on Traditional Medicare. There is no way I can afford double digit increases on supplements. I don't like the Advantage plans at all either. What's a Senior supposed to do? Take what I can afford and just die when Advantage denies a procedure is what it's looking like. Great options 🙄 after working our whole lives. It's ALL a racket."

— YouTube · The REAL Cost of Medicare Supplement vs Advantage over 20 Years? I G vs N vs HD G vs Advan · 13 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Yf_LRloXmSo&lc=Ugwcgxlchxqa2pLRBYx4AaABAq

↳ @adoptacat2877 (3): "I'm in the same boat. I hate our healthcare system. As always you only survive if you have a high paying government job or a wealthy person the rest of us lose everything if we get sick and even if you don't get sick right away the copays on these advantage plans are not affordable. We are screwed and that's why so many millions of people die needlessly in our country."

↳ @Theretirementnerds (1): "A lot of moving parts for sure! Appreciate you watching and sharing. Highly recommend working with an agent familiar with your area. Takes a lot of the guesswork and fear out of the equation for you :) Thank you for making it to the end :)"

↳ @eduardooramaeddie4006 (1): "You could say i agree with this gentleman"

Paying less for the same care · 31 documents

"Excellent information. My suggestion, respectfully, when comparing prices, you did not clearly explain that Supplements "Do Not" include prescriptions and will require an additional PD plan. Which is not a big premium but it is additional monthly dollars. Supplemental plans are Superior if the Senior can handle the monthly premiums. I've worked with some seniors who live social security "paycheck to paycheck" and while there are government programs that help assist, they have to decide premiums or food/medication. I love Medicare. I love our country. I love our Seniors. I pray for affordable, excellent medical care plans for ALL. In the meantime, explaining the Medicare plans as you do, is exemplar!!!! You are my hero 🙌🙌🙌 "

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement Plans · 24 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xw7EiH-5iik&lc=UgyNdbQBZ9WoEBX6e5V4AaABAq>

↳ @MedigapSeminars (5): "The great advantage to having a Stand-Alone Part D plan, rather than bundled with an Advantage plan, is that the consumer can change Part D Plans annually without any impact on their healthcare. With an Advantage Plan, a person can be left having to choose between the healthcare they want, the doctors they want to see, and low Part D costs. Too often, the best of all three is not in one plan. By the way, when comparing PartD plans it's not the premium that is important, it's the total cost of premium plus prescriptions."

↳ @toriless (0): "Yeah, but do you get decent coverage under a PD plan. The regular one is as crappy as a MOA is for their services. I have lost count how many times I have to pay for a medication because it is not covered. I had a doctor write 3 different prescriptions just so I could test each one to see which gets denied. The one that was approved was one that was previously denied a year before. The difference was \$3 vs \$200 and they only paid another \$8 or something."

"My plan G with AARP in FL (90 miles north of Orlando) just went to \$252 from \$219 from \$194. Massive jumps each year. If it keeps going like this, in 10 years, when I'm 80, my premium could be over \$900. My entire Social Security check is only \$665. With the way the country is going, I'm hoping I check out long before, because the Cadillac won't be affordable by then."

— YouTube · Can We Talk Openly About Medicare Supplement Plan G? · 23 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=YbzNHT67jnc&lc=UgzGX4XNzdnypogFok94AaABAg>

↳ @belindapfaff8902 (5): "It is sad to get older and have to worry about these expensive Medicare plans. Big business wins again. Government wins again. 🙄 "

↳ @Nemo-yn1sp (3): "@belindapfaff8902 People have to start recognizing that government is the PEOPLE unless the people don't get off their asses and vote, speak, call, write,. You know, participate. Democracy is not a spectator sport, and the government is only what we make it. Are we Americans too lazy to both now, just bend the knee and blame?"

↳ @lizadivine3785 (2): "This is a huge sign on a dying empire and the elected don't care."

"Thanks for another great video! I recently switched to a High Deductible Medigap plan. Monthly premium is currently \$67 with an almost \$3,000 out-of-pocket maximum. I'm hoping that it provides the flexibility and predictability that I want with a lower premiums throughout my life. Not too many people choose the High Deductible Medigap plans, but it seems like a good compromise among all the available options."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 19 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgxQt-3YOkOpHjJyLt94AaABAg>

↳ @shirl5953 (6): "YES!!! You found the BONANZA of HDG! Erin did not talk to this but I am hoping she does in her follow up videos!!!"

↳ @stevevenn1 (0): "Thx I'm a fan of this kind of choice. A form of mini self insuring just the HD portion. I like that trade off for lower premium."

↳ @scottpearson5871 (0): "If a person has a decently sized (50-100k) HSA this seems to be the best option."

Any doctor, any hospital, no approvals · 27 documents

"Why does John Oliver hate Medicare Advantage so much? I'm huge fan of Last Week Tonight with John Oliver ([his show on MA.])(<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yfLVCc>) He is amazing at taking a topic, going in depth, and if need be, skewering it. But I think he was way off base on his Medicare Advantage rant. So, it costs the government--when has that ever bothered him (or me)? And yes, it's not the same as Original Medicare, but more like regular insurance. I know, I have it. Like all insurance are there instances of denial? Sure (although he was really reaching for it on some of his examples). But here's the thing. For me to switch to Part D and a Medigap plan it would cost me about \$3000 a year. I've had MA for 8 years, and I've never spent more than \$200 or \$300 in a given year on copays and coinsurance. And that's not counting the thousands I get in dental, eyewear, hearing, and OTC benefits (although granted some of those are being reduced or cut this year). And with my PPO plan, I can see any doctor or specialist I want without a referral, in or out of network (nearly every provider in my medium-size midwest city is in network). So, sure I could just go back to Original Medicare and pay the 20% it doesn't cover myself. Or I could get the drug and gap insurance (which you have to buy from private companies, by the way). But I can't afford either of those options. But I can afford my MA plan. And I wish rich people would stop telling me what to do with money I don't have."

— r/medicare · 88 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1op2r5b/>

↳ (0): "Bad insurance is great when you don't use it. Medicare Advantage plans work great when they aren't used."

↳ (0): "Exactly this. What happens when (not if) significant chronic conditions coupled with acute conditions accumulate? None of us is getting any younger. Once you're locked into MA, it can be *very* hard to get out, and once they start denying needed care, you will need to start fighting them for your life."

↳ (0): "Nope. Wife and I both have Advantage plans. Her's is used a lot. No problems. I wish people like you would stop making general statements you really know nothing about. It works well for half the Medicare recipients."

"My experience with UHC was that they initially gave me \$3000 for dental the first year, which basically covers cleanings, and filling cavities, then they dropped it by \$500 dollars for the next 2 years. I needed a bridge, which costs a lot more than \$2000, never mind that I would still need my routine care. I finally went back to regular Medicare last fall. My secondary insurance covers my routine dental care. Still no bridge, but at least I do not have to be manipulated by a for-profit advantage care corp. Oh! And I can see any doctor I want and go to any facility that takes Medicare."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · 37 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yfLVCc&lc=UgwjTPflbhOs9e-qKml4AaABAq>

↳ @elizabethconnolly3260 (0): "Exactly! Their "additional benefits" are subpar and have very limited providers."

"I want to choose my own doctor when I need him. I don't want to wait for a referral or a wait till my doctor thinks I need a specialist."

— YouTube · Top Disadvantages of Medicare Advantage Plans · 19 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BebQ04cKzJc&lc=UgzScyFbSRKvBEO7UwN4AaABAq>

Staying healthy enough never to need it · 16 documents

"Sunburn. Thank you for this. I would like to add that catastrophic diagnoses come out of nowhere very often and I know this from personal experience. The other big negative about advantage plans is that doctors can leave the network whenever they feel like it and then you're in a position of having to find someone new who is, in fact in the advantage network. Add to this the fact that many doctors are leaving the advantage network because of how it's structured, the fact that this is "Medicare for profit" and that the advantage plans have really erred on the side of denying claims. Traditional Medicare supplements allow you to see any physician you want who participates in Medicare. That is a much more vast choice for consumers than the narrow and narrowing availability of doctors who participate in advantage plans. I personally have invested in a costly but comprehensive Medicare supplement and I'm so glad that I did. We have to remember that we buy car insurance not hoping we have an accident and it pays for itself, but to take care of any financial obligations should we have that accident. This is not any different. You purchased the best coverage you can afford hoping you'll stay healthy, but knowing if you don't that you won't be wiped out financially as a result."

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=UgxUo0YS6DvcGfMLZyR4AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "Thank you for watching and adding your thoughts! 😊 "

"Great video with much information. I am on original medicare, supplement thru united health, humana for medicare D. Every year I have increase in premiums and only use my insurance for annual visit with pcp and gyn. On very little meds. For once, I would like to see an incentive for less premiums if you stay healthy and take care of yourself!"

— YouTube · The Medicare Math Nobody Shows You · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=LJ3P5gL1JFw&lc=UgxIkB P7f9rrukpTygR4AaABAg>

↳ @BruceLee-zw5ue (0): "You and I (the healthy ones) subsidizing the abusers."

"Today is my first day in Medicare plan G. I hope I never have to use it 😊 "

— YouTube · Medicare Broker Reveals 3 Reasons He Chose Supplemental Plan G · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=D-ub2E2kShQ&lc=UgyKZWki3bq7iqjx8lF4AaABAg>

Getting it right the first time · 14 documents

"I don't have an anecdote. I just want to learn as much as I can about Medicare before I turn 65. I've been learning about it for 2 years now and I still learn something new every time I watch a video. I'm pretty sure I will go with the supplement. I don't like networks. Plus doctors can leave a network at anytime leaving you to start over with a new doctor. Whoever says they want Medicare for all doesn't know Medicare at all."

— YouTube · Here's How Much We Paid With Medicare I Medicare Supplement vs Advantage · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ykvrdd8VxIY&lc=UgynpQyRNd5K2lg6N-Z4AaABAg>

"Just turned 65. My broker tried to present all options and easy to understand. Very confusing. I appreciate your videos especially when I just watched one of those portraying this business as a DOG eat dog world. Having said that I hope my agent and I made the best choice. I really hate the whole thing. But thnx again for your unbiased presentation"

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 5 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgycU_NhzSwAnS6aKMI4AaABAg

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "Thank you so much for watching! The analysis paralysis and all the marketing messaging creates quite the whirlwind. I'm glad your agent was able to help you! Given they presented all options, rely on them for future decisions. Sounds like they are doing a good job!"

"I agree completely! I'm so glad I requested a quote for my wife recently, and that you reached out to us personally and debunked some of the inaccurate info we had already received from a retiree trust that we were planning to use. I'm very happy with the supplement plan that you and your staff helped us choose, and I'm looking forward to doing it again when I turn 65 next year. Thanks Matthew!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement Plans · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xw7EiH-5iik&lc=Ugz0w8k5IZqJSnvv85d4AaABAg.9UjnTroRTKC9UkReofVKaZ>

Dental, vision and hearing covered · 13 documents

"When looking for supplemental policies I want it to cover everything Medicare doesn't. I want it to have the ability to pay providers directly. I don't want dental or vision discounts, I want coverage."

— YouTube · Top Medicare Supplement Companies Review - Winners and Losers! · 8 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HYfsEbghGR8&lc=UgxzaZRDLhsBRTomhbh4AaABAg>

↳ @Malteser00 (0): "No dental "coverage" from anyone. Someone I know has TRICARE just shelled out \$24000 for a set of dental plates."

↳ @annawarner1078 (0): "@Malteser00 Dental insurance (in my opinion) is the scam. Because of the dentists. I have dental as part of Medicare Advantage (up to \$1,500). I purchased by myself Delta Dental . That is nearly \$80 a month for Delta Dental. And still I pay for the dental services."

↳ @sct4040 (0): "Advantagecare pretends to cover everything until the denials stop your treatments. They are a scam. If you can afford it, Supplement plans gives you the most coverage (nationwide) without dealing with preapprovals, denials and appeals. There is a reason why Advantagecare is called Disadvantagecare."

"What if you don't want Medicare at all. I was forced to enroll it this scam. I don't do standard medicine. I want Vision Dental a naturopath and natural medicines. I was told I had to enroll in Medicare or I would be penalized. I think I should be entitled to a refund since they don't offer what I want. I am majorly pissed off. I have been paying into the Plan for 50 years..."

— YouTube · The \$600/Month Medicare Mistake Most 65-Year-Olds Make · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HsfNTRmt3Pw&lc=Ugx5OsbJ2vzX0jjoFzJ4AaABAg>

"Next video you make it should begin with a picture of a lie detector machine lol. I actually went with plan "N" because I can fortunately afford it, good health, and peace of mind. I have a separate dental plan, and part D plan. My wife still works and I am on her vision plan. As for hearing my wife says I need hearing aids but little does she know I only hear what I want to hear when she is talking so I do not need hearing insurance. Now since the percentage is so low on the providers who will bill me the 15% "EXCESS" charge I just thought plan "N" was the way to go for me. Great Video as usual!"

— YouTube · Can We Talk Openly About Medicare Supplement Plan N? · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Csmi1YgxGrY&lc=UgzkpN_uWGtbBrjLX9N4AaABAg

↳ @Theretirementnerds (1): "Well said! Excess charges are quite rare for sure! I appreciate you, my friend!"

Knowing exactly what it will cost, no surprise bills · 10 documents

"Glad I did my homework and chose traditional Medicare over Medicare Advantage. I read too many horror stories about people who became catastrophically ill, and had problems seeing specialists, or obtaining certain treatments. I would rather pay for the "peace of mind," and the CHOICE to go where I want, and see the doctor or specialist I need/want."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 264 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgxefqUbjQyLYRyCYv54AaABAg>

↳ @DankFarrikMe (10): "@LisaKnobel Medicare covers most everything, so unless you have a rare never heard of disease that has holistic/experimental treatment...Medicare/Medigap will cover it."

↳ @aregee7121 (10): "It's way more than just choice or peace of mind. Advantage plans, all insurance co. based, are more like socialized medicine, i.e. less spending per patient. You get restrictive networks, forced diagnosis first with G.P. or P.A! with delayed referral to a specialist, possibly not the one you want. The end result is a delay of the proper treatment. Do you want this as you get older?"

↳ @maryequilter31 (7): "The person at our local senior center who helped with info when we signed up for Medicare over 5 years ago warned us about not being guaranteed to move from an advantage to a Medigap/supplemental plan. So very glad we chose a supplemental plan. The advantage plans are a horror of denials, referrals etc."

"Thanks for another great video! I recently switched to a High Deductible Medigap plan. Monthly premium is currently \$67 with an almost \$3,000 out-of-pocket maximum. I'm hoping that it provides the flexibility and predictably that I want with a lower premiums throughout my life. Not too many people choose the High Deductible Medigap plans, but it seems like a good compromise among all the available options."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 19 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=Ugx Ct-3YOkOpHjJyLt94AaABAg>

↳ @shirl5953 (6): "YES!!! You found the BONANZA of HDG! Erin did not talk to this but I am hoping she does in her follow up videos!!"

↳ @stevevenn1 (0): "Thx I'm a fan of this kind of choice. A form of mini self insuring just the HD portion. I like that trade off for lower premium."

↳ @scottpearson5871 (0): "If a person has a decently sized (50-100k) HSA this seems to be the best option."

"Erik, first time Medicare 8/1/26 in PA. I have been educating myself for 6 months with your videos which are the CADILLAC of education! Your agent Kelli has been amazing and we are finalizing things next week. I fit Plan G perfectly except I am healthy and want Plan G because I know those big bills and sickness will come one day. I am willing to pay for peace of mind all day long! Thanks!! Keep up the great work and honesty!"

— YouTube · Can We Talk Openly About Medicare Supplement Plan G? · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=YbzNHT67jnc&lc=UgxjVUUJ6-aL8oMLjEN4AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "Thank you so much, Lisa! You are awesome and so glad you got to meet with Kelli! 😊 "

Retiring, or finally stopping work · 7 documents

"Thank you! I'm 64 and hoping to retire next year at 65 and am doing initial; research and this video was such a helpful resource!"

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 4 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SF_CZkg&lc=UgzQc52Xkxf8FWPyD-V4AaABAg

↳ @policyguides (0): "That's wonderful to hear — congratulations on getting close to retirement! I'm glad the video helped as you start planning for Medicare. Doing your research early is the best way to make sure everything goes smoothly when you turn 65."

"Wow... Great video! This has significant impact on my plans to start Roth Conversions in my 60's to move money out of my traditional 401K. I do feel a bit like I'm between a rock and a hard place though as I was "hoping" to retire early and qualify for Affordable Care Act subsidies until 65 (and then start Roth Conversions). Looks like that might not be the best strategy now."

— YouTube · IRMAA Explained: The Hidden Medicare Cost That Could Double Your Premiums in Retirement · 2 likes · http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=McRktcoWBG0&lc=UgxyzB_zz1JEI_5PW0d4AaABAg

"I waited till 67. But am still working. Thank God. But praying God lets me retire in a few years."

— YouTube · Working past 65? Avoid these HUGE Medicare mistakes. · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=evYI75xJnKg&lc=UgxxgYfD5xIVmYqfZndF4AaABAg>

↳ @maggiemay8622 (0): "I'll be working til I die"

Tab 3 — Relationship Fears

Medicare shoppers rarely write about relationships as feelings; what they write is what happened to a spouse, a parent or a friend, and that is what moves the decision.

Theme	Documents
Friends, siblings and neighbors as the warning (or the proof)	133
A parent's Medicare: Advantage, denials, rehab and bills	112
A spouse's illness or death, and what the plan did	90
A younger spouse without coverage until 65	57
Helping a parent or relative choose or fix a plan	27
Widowed: one check, the same premiums	22
A spouse on a different plan, or choosing together	21
Told what to choose by family, friends or a salesperson	11
Doctors who won't take their plan	11
Not wanting to burden the kids	9

Friends, siblings and neighbors as the warning (or the proof) · 133 documents

"Being a Utilization management RN for a Florida based hospital for over 15 years, I totally agree with you. So often patients experience medical emergencies while on vacation and are limited to choices for care while away from home and "out of network." I advise my friends and family to always invest in supplements and keep Medicare, steering them away from advantage or replacement plans. I think it's a crime when I have to argue with advantage plans to authorize physician directed care after the acute health emergency has been addressed. Most folks don't realize that once a patient is determined to be stable, their care is limited to what their advantage plan will allow, even while they remain hospitalized. Often their choices decrease significantly when they are discharged. Those who require home health or rehabilitation services post-hospitalization can be severely restricted and are usually required to return home to their local area for coverage. You are providing a great service with your videos. Keep it up!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 513 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgyQPwewvEHaPILi_Qd4AaABAg

↳ @TheCheryl57 (34): "Again, you have to consider your situation and many older people don't travel so this would not be a problem. There are many things to consider on a personal level, it's not one size fits all."

↳ @MedicareonVideo (31): "Sure wish everyone could read your comment!"

↳ @lindahidalgo1804 (15): "@TheCheryl57 I heard Advantage plans are more costly in the long run especially if you need a lot of medical care. Also, that those plans are more costly for the government, because those Advantage plans charge more for services because the middlemen/women and the in those companies need to make a profit."

"Exactly! I am 76. Have been on Original Medicare with a Supplement since turning 65. Was quite healthy at 65. Few health issues. At 63 I was remodeling a old house, doing almost all of the work myself. Tearing up old flooring. Refinishing wood floors. Tearing out old updates in the kitchen that were poor and putting in new cabinets. Did have my Son and Son-in-law help me with things I could do alone, like hanging upper kitchen cabinets, etc. At 67, my health suddenly began to fail. I have had numerous hospitalizations and surgeries since then. I have been able to go to specialist within a few days, without pre-approval. I have friends on "Advantage" plans that have had to deal with needing numerous referrals, waiting months for testing and surgeries, while I breeze through seeing specialist and getting surgeries within a few weeks. Do not expect that you will always remain healthy. Our bodies are great machines, but let's face it. As any machine ages, more and more issues evolve. Don't fall for the "Advantage" hype. It won't advantage you when you are truly in need of medical care."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 224 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1SFCZkg&lc=Ugx5CVy8MAo_bxfGmzd4AaABAg

↳ @policyguides (13): "Thank you for sharing your story — it's such an important reminder. Many people feel great when they first start Medicare, but as you've experienced, health can change quickly. Having a Supplement plan makes a huge difference when it comes to getting timely access to specialists and surgeries without the hurdles of referrals or pre-approvals. You make a great point: while Medicare Advantage can look attractive upfront, those restrictions can become very frustrating once serious health issues arise. Your experience really highlights why so many people value the freedom and flexibility of a Medigap plan. I'm truly sorry to hear about the health struggles you've faced, and I wish you continued strength and healing as you move forward."

↳ @franks4973 (6): "Sorry about your health but thank you for your response. HC is my big concern and ven though I am healthy at 62 and like you do a lot of my own work. It was nice hearing another voice of reason regarding Medicare. Thx"

↳ @reneeblack8940 (5): "Hello which supplement plan are you using"

"As always, extremely well-done. I am now 67 and have worked in finance most of my career. So many retiring friends asked for my "advice" and I explained why I absolutely, positively chose Medicare + Medigap for myself and my husband. Every single friend ignored my advice. So, once again, my husband and I are delighted with our choice and feel so darn validated by this video. It is a true public service!. Thank you!"

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 193 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=Ugzk9H-8V-DSIDWGiR4AaABAq>

↳ @billmulvihill8452 (8): "You can't talk sense to most people. They stubbornly don't want to hear it."

↳ @bourbontraveler (7): "Are you sure they're your "friends"?"

↳ @lauraberry6729 (5): "@TAM-bv2di I'll never ask...and I promise to 🙄 try not to gloat if it doesn't work out for my pals.😂"

A parent's Medicare: Advantage, denials, rehab and bills · 112 documents

"My mother is in her 90s and has dementia...along with many health issues.. my mother has a medical advantage plan with one of the largest insurance companies...I would never recommend it a Medicare advantage plan especially if you have a lot of medical issues.i have been taking care of my mother for the past 10 years.. the insurance companies fight you every step of the way..they send you used equipment... they limit you to 5 days of physical therapy ..2 of the 5 days are for evaluation purposes...so you only get 3 days of physical therapy.. you always get rejected if you appeal for more therapy..the doctors in network are very bad and very few choices... or they leave network because of low reimbursement . If you are a healthy person medical advantage plans are good...but if you need medical therapies such as PT.. forget it... I am 65 am based on my experience with my mother..I will never sign up for an advantage plan....its a bait and switch game that the insurance companies play... advantage plans are a scam!!"

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 90 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgzpRDIIAYWVYI35q2x4AaABAq>

↳ @johnphillips4342 (10): "All the celebrity promotional advertising is very misleading. These people, although they are over 65, probably are not on an MA plan. The money to promote the MA plans on TV and provide the higher compensation to agents to steer people to those plans comes out of the funds that Medicare pays the carrier to provide medical care. Thus, the networks, prior authorizations, referrals, and denials of care to compensate for the costs to promote the programs. Yes, it's a scam and one our wonderful Congress cooked up and keeps giving support for."

↳ @gordonallen9095 (6): "Agreed. Medicare Advantage = Death Panels."

↳ @ClintFletcher-eu8tn (4): "Medicare is no paradise either. My Mom fell at age 95 and needed physical therapy. The hospital discharged her because they did not want deal with the low Medicare payments. My mother was unable to walk, but they discharged her anyway. I had to carry her about the house until she was able to start walking some by herself."

"I'm 68 and going part time at work so I'm losing my insurance. When my parents needed ivermectin their advantage plan dr said he was not allowed to prescribe it. My friend who had a supplement went to her doctor and he gave her the rx. Based on this info I'm leaning toward a supplement to allow for my independent nature. I prefer freedom. Run wild horses, run! I make my own future decisions, not a 'plan' doctor. Granted, according to this situation I would save money with an advantage plan because I'm on zero meds, no medical problems and it would be cheaper. Nope. I'll take freedom and choice. I eat food I make from scratch, exercise, walk my dog everyday, not a TV watcher, and have self discipline. We should be the captains of our own physical destiny. I've started raising chickens for healthy eggs and found a lady that provides raw milk. Ok, done with my animal references and rant. God bless all of you."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 74 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=Ugw3cwYNdOVz-04Qf-l4AaABAg>

↳ @joyschlomer6866 (2): "You just don't know, you're healthy but things change quickly at times, out of no where. Run wild and confident you don't have to about that tricky policy of not being able to return to that medicare supplement plan 😊 "

↳ @giancolabird (1): "@ please see my response below. I think my response went to a general answer when I was attempting to respond to you. God bless."

↳ @beckyadams4161 (0): "What if I have partial medicade and Medicare 😊 "

"Very well done. You did your homework. I'm 66 this year. I had to do a LOT of research to decide what was best for me. I agree about choosing for my future me. That said: I have a high deductible G plan in place (55.00 mon) in case I get very sick or have an accident but I spend a couple hundred a month (about what I'd pay for regular G premium 210.00) to take care of my metabolic health the way i want to. I use functional medicine, naturopath, no conventional drugs, acupuncture, massage therapy and supplements that are not covered by Medicare on any level. My husband died at 58 from a liver disease and a transplant. We had an HMO. I refuse to do it that way for myself. It was a chaotic, frustrating and terrifying experience for both of us. I know that if I'm hit with a chronic disease or accident I'll be set. So I chose ease of mind over just dollars. Everyone does it different. My parents have always done an advantage plan"

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 24 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgwDoFtNU8GrgWx3-O94AaABAg>

A spouse's illness or death, and what the plan did · 90 documents

"For a lot of people Medicare at 65 is a blessing. We couldn't wait. My wife had been putting off hip replacement surgery for years due to high deductibles and copays with our employer's plan. On Medicare (and G Supplement) all we paid was the part B deductible of two hundred and some odd dollars! It was life changing for her."

— YouTube · Reasons to DELAY Medicare Past 65 That Will Save You Thousands and Avoid ALL Penalties · 315 likes · <http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=L2goGwp4Co8&lc=Ugw5192ygARS776lv554AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (25): "Agreed! We tried to show this in the middle section. For many, Medicare is better coverage at a lower cost than what they were experiencing before 65 😊 "

↳ @pgpc6448 (12): "So glad! Your wife deserves it!"

↳ @sfstucco (0): "I'm truly sorry to hear about your situation. No one should have to experience these dilemmas & delays. I'm curious — how many, here, in these unfortunate situations vote Red (Republican)? Not to start a fight or pretend to be superior, but I hope people realize that universal coverage/socialized medicine goes a long, long way to relieving these burdens, financially speaking and logistically speaking. It would cut costs SO, so much if we had a Medicare-for-all (i.e., for all who select it) scheme, from birth to death. There are variations that can include some copayments (or not), depending on how it's structured. But expense, experience, and health outcomes are greatly superior in countries with socialized medicine, in all its forms. Democrats want that."

"Sunburn. Thank you. During my working years I had a Co pay for my HMO high deductible insurance. When I retired I learned about plan G and found it less than what I paying at work. Since my retirement my wife had open heart surgery and knee replace to and a broken arm. I have prostate cancer and ulcerative colitis. If I would have had an advantage plan it would have financial devastated us. When I bought plan G I bought it not for how I felt at the time, but for when I was sick. Advantage plans come in my mail every day trying to switch me over. Never get mail for plan G. That should tell you something in itself."

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 249 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=UgyPSeGJnpazbrQ0VB94AaABAg>

↳ @RolandHolubec (0): "Nobody knows anything; You need to create your process, manage risk, and stick to the plan, through thick or thin, While also continuously learning from mistakes and improving..."

↳ @KristýnaKalová-t8q (0): "Appreciate that. I just looked her up and she seems highly regarded. I've been meaning to fine-tune my drawdown strategy, so this might be the right time. Thanks for pointing me in a solid direction!"

"Our Medicare Advantage Experience I have no affiliation with any health insurance companies and no particular ax to grind. I just want to share our experience because I see a lot of scary information out there about Medicare Advantage. We live in Florida and my wife has been on Medicare for 11 years and 9 years for me. The first few years we were on traditional Medicare with a Plan F HD supplement, then we switched to MA, first with Aetna and now Humana. We travel a lot so we needed PPO plans for all this time. We signed up for MA because it seemed like such a better deal than Medicare plus a supplement, and that has worked out well for us. We paid no premiums (other than the Medicare B premiums everyone pays) on Aetna and on Humana we actually get a \$175/month rebate towards the B premium. We have watched the co-pays for specialists go up frequently and now pay \$50 per specialist visit. Primary care visits have always been free. In spite of the bad reports on MA, we were very healthy and thought it would be a risk we could take. Five years ago my wife was diagnosed with a faulty mitral valve in her heart. The cardiologist checked it every year and this year he decided it was severe enough to require fixing. Fast forward several months and my wife is now recovering from open heart surgery, which was successful. She spent six days in the hospital and is getting twice a week home care from a nurse, a physical therapist and an occupational therapist. There were two tests that required procedures in an outpatient heart center at the hospital before her surgery. The total out of pocket for all this was about \$3,000. The hospital and physician charges billed to Humana were in the neighborhood of \$300K. We never had to deal with any refusals of coverage, balance billing or any other surprises. So our experience with a major medical issue was outstanding. For the 8 years we have been on MA, we've paid no premiums, had reimbursements for dental work and eyewear of at least \$20K and had no issues with finding good doctors and facilities in-network. Bottom line, who knows what surprises might await us as we get older and less healthy, but I have no complaints about our experience with MA so far. UPDATE: Thanks to everyone who contributed to this thread! It's clear that MA can be anywhere from great to awful, depending on the plans in your area and your individual health situation. I think the comments brought up great issues to explore before choosing MA or traditional Medicare with a supplement. I know we are risking challenges in MA if we move or networks change for the worse. But I calculate that we've saved roughly \$57k in supplement premiums (for 2 people) and received roughly \$20k in dental benefits over 8 years, so the risk was certainly worth it so far."

— r/medicare · 139 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1tp8qt5/>

↳ (0): "I've had the same positive experience with my MA plan for 10 years. I'll go ahead and upvote you in preparation for the Reddit MA-Hating Mafia that will surely show up and tell you why we are stupid and shower us both with down votes."

↳ (0): "I had no opinion about this until I began taking my mother to medical appointments in NYC. It was astonishing to me how often the medical personnel would tell me it's a good thing my mom has original Medicare because they were able to refer us immediately to superior facilities for treatment. When she had to go to rehab, they took both of us for free (not a small thing in NY) directly from the hospital in a hospital car to a beautiful place that gave her great care (and fantastic meals I got to share). So now I am definitely biased. My mother would've had to wait a long time in pain and then accept lower quality care inside bargain basement places. For me, it made a huge impression to keep getting unsolicited opinions from hospital and medical office personnel that it was great my mom had original Medicare because the Medicare advantage plans had much tighter restrictions on referrals and many times we would've been sol. I trust the people who have to deal with getting patients treatment. We are Americans so we are being screwed either way, but a bit less screwed without for profit insurance companies. Good luck to us all who aren't emigrating for better health care."

↳ (0): "If you are in an area with a lot of providers and all your doctors are in network, MA can be fine. But now ask most folks in rural areas about their experience. Also, in many places you can't get a MA PPO, which can be a dealbreaker. Everyone needs to do their own homework, of course."

A younger spouse without coverage until 65 · 57 documents

"Thanks for this! I'm 62 and my husband is 64. I think you have saved us from possibly making the wrong choice at 65. I will share this with my friends."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · 496 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yflVCc&lc=UgzKYiHkePnOIVl9aDN4AaABAq>

↳ @zachwalton5693 (24): "Hi, as a former insurance agent make sure you still enroll in Medicare part B then get your medigap plan/Medicare supplement. THEN make sure you get a prescription drug plan. Because if you dont theres a lifetime permanent 10% fee for each year you didnt enroll this same fee applies to your Part B as well. Now this doesn't cover dental or vision so youll need you pick a plan for that. They are pretty cheap."

↳ @rapacious_rapscallion (14): "Tell them to stop getting their information from Fox "News" while you're at it."

↳ @nalou6933 (10): "Right now, regular Medicare is very expensive, but still the best plan. This administration favors big business who gives it big campaign contributions, so it will force all new Medicare enrollees to the (dis)Advantage plans, and fatallly damage regular Medicare plans."

"I retired at 62 and my wife and I went on a bronze Obamacare plan. We didn't pay one penny for premiums for the three years we were on Obamacare. An advantage of the HSA plans is you can reduce the income that applies towards the subsidy calculation. You can also contribute to a traditional IRA to lower your income. I also stuffed my HSA before I retired so that I could cover an emergency."

— YouTube · The Pros and Cons of Obamacare · 53 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=-VR66gt_AqA&lc=Ugwo-Gz37UHV1h4cT0l4AaABAq

"I retired at 65 but my wife is also retired and not 65 yet. So we had to get an ACA plan for her. I followed this advice early. But I followed it too well during my first year and my income was so low that the exchange bumped her down to a Medicaid plan. Which sounds great because it had \$0 premiums. But the problem with Medicaid where I live is no doctors take it. Not great insurance for someone in their 60s. Ever since then, I have been careful in taking enough taxable income so that my income threshold is high enough to not qualify for Medicaid and low enough to optimize on ACA credits."

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65: The ACA Reality Nobody Tells You · 43 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=1Qz8CyPjA5s&lc=Ugz7JAf8GPGbn0Ae8ld4AaABAq>

↳ @mikeb8342 (4): "@mnnew6772 I think it's not about whether providers are available, but rather will a doctor accept a lower amount for a service (usually the case with medicaid)? Maybe Colorado medicaid has higher payouts for services? If so, you might be correct. 🙌"

↳ @RetireEarlyWithMelanieAndKeith (1): "Yes that is something to think about. Good thing you caught it and readjust."

↳ @polaridoo1 (1): "No, it is very hard to find Medicaid providers in Colorado. There's usually a very long wait to get in and not many providers accept it."

Helping a parent or relative choose or fix a plan · 27 documents

"My mother is in her 90s and has dementia...along with many health issues.. my mother has a medical advantage plan with one of the largest insurance companies...I would never recommend it a Medicare advantage plan especially if you have a lot of medical issues.i have been taking care of my mother for the past 10 years.. the insurance companies fight you every step of the way..they send you used equipment... they limit you to 5 days of physical therapy ..2 of the 5 days are for evaluation purposes...so you only get 3 days of physical therapy.. you always get rejected if you appeal for more therapy..the doctors in network are very bad and very few choices... or they leave network because of low reimbursement . If you are a healthy person medical advantage plans are good...but if you need medical therapies such as PT.. forget it... I am 65 am based on my experience with my mother..I will never sign up for an advantage plan....its a bait and switch game that the insurance companies play... advantage plans are a scam!!"

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 90 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgzpRDIIAYWVYI35q2x4AaABAg>

↳ @johnphillips4342 (10): "All the celebrity promotional advertising is very misleading. These people, although they are over 65, probably are not on an MA plan. The money to promote the MA plans on TV and provide the higher compensation to agents to steer people to those plans comes out of the funds that Medicare pays the carrier to provide medical care. Thus, the networks, prior authorizations, referrals, and denials of care to compensate for the costs to promote the programs. Yes, it's a scam and one our wonderful Congress cooked up and keeps giving support for."

↳ @gordonallen9095 (6): "Agreed. Medicare Advantage = Death Panels."

↳ @ClintFletcher-eu8tn (4): "Medicare is no paradise either. My Mom fell at age 95 and needed physical therapy. The hospital discharged her because they did not want deal with the low Medicare payments. My mother was unable to walk, but they discharged her anyway. I had to carry her about the house until she was able to start walking some by herself."

"I'm in the process of helping my father choose his coverage and he has always had a supplemental plan. We're a bit shellshocked at the increase in premiums and the premium free advantage plans are very tempting. But Dad has several health issues and sees a lot of doctors (afib, high blood pressure, sleep apnea, wet AMD). He has several ER visits in the past few years (and one overnight hospitalization when his blood pressure spiked). He's 81 years old and I know that the odds are that he's going to have more health issues as we move forward and that he's probably better served with staying on a supplemental plan, even if it costs us more up front. So we will tighten our belts and swallow the costs now because there is something reassuring that if he does have to go to the hospital that I won't be facing a big bill afterwards. Our cats want Dad to stick around a long time."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 51 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgyPVVWFFD9F_LY9wPh4AaABAg

↳ @Theretirementnerds (11): "Yeah... I don't know him or the family personally, nor the financial picture, but based on that health profile, a supplement plan definitely will keep healthcare costs at bay and flexibility when it comes to providers and treatment options. Appreciate you watching and sharing. Supplement premium increases are a big deal"

↳ @emilyc.2131 (0): "I just lost my father who had a supplement plan, which was Blue cross blue shield plan F, they don't even sell anymore because it covers so well. He had afib then became ill w sepsis landed in the hospital, then had to be trached because he needed more respiratory support as he recovered over the illness. He recovered with flying colors, and shocked everyone at age 82... however it was the poor care in the rehab facilities (long term acute rehab facilities) they force you to that we believe killed him, when he should have recovered and came home just fine. He was able to survive for about a year until medicare basically closed the book at us and denied him further treatment. What I can attest to you is it appears if he had had medicare advantage, he would have been given only 25 days in a rehab hospital they force elderly to, after they just recover from a medical illness. Whereas he was allowed up to a year with his supplement plan. What we heard from doctors and other patients families is they would have forced him to go home or skilled nursing which is even worse care than the rehab. Skilled nursing, only has one visit from a nurse once per day and basically just keeps your loved one comfortable until they succumb to their illnesses... They don't work with them to get them better.... Where my father was given all green lights to have the health and the strength to get off the vent, but if it was the poor care in the rehab facility, that allowed him to slip back get an infection, either from the trachea, or his feeding tube, and then ultimately got a bed sore because he was left to lay in his own bowel movement, (which is 100% diarrhea all the time with a feeding tube, 24/7) ..He would get off the vent, then get pneumonia, from their lack of care then back on the vent again... we were told that over 60% of these hospitals patients are medicare patients, where they're usually under staffed, with staff that doesn't have or barely has the credentials to be caring for these more critical, patients. Who thrive just fine in ICU,,, like my dad did but they force out to "make room" for younger patients. Because my dad had the supplement plan, he was allowed to come back to ICU and get treatment. The back out again to the rehab facilities. where he would get an infection and back again. I have a nurse client who confirmed that the rehab facilities is like third world country care. So whatever you do, have him avoid getting in there...However, if you do he seemed better off with the supplement... We learned also with my dad's afib, he wouldn't have been able to choose his cardiologist either, and if someone gets cancer, advantage won't pay either... It just seems that overall the hospitals aren't doing much to proactively to assist an elderly to get better and trying to waste no time coding your loved one as "not improving" when they are ... they just don't have the staff to take care of them. We found out my father was given more chances because of his supplement but if he has advantage they would have gotten rid of him long before. Where, it appears advantage just turns the light off much quicker...Sorry for writing a novel, but I hope this helps people understand how medicare and the hospitals look at everything...When you think the hospital or medicare sees you as a human being they don't... they only see you as a cost ...and trying to figure out how they can avoid "waste" and paying too much when, it's just time they believe to let your loved one go...Also, last thing...if your father gets into a hospital.. you need to be there or other family around the clock 24/7 staying after the doctors, because it's those we hear also get to get the better care than those who don't come around or are too busy, or ones who don't have any family at all. It's very sad.. but I hope this helps."

↳ @RosemaryLackey (0): "@Theretirementnerds yeah, I'm making those decisions now, and it's looking like those premium increases may well be a deal breaker for me. I see that the supplement path provides amazing coverage, but along with the increases, it looks like I'd have to get dental and vision insurance also - and also for meds? Too much for me. I guess I just

made up my mind. Thanks so much for your excellent presentation. I look forward to learning about social security from you too!"

"New to Medicare This Year - More Confusing Than I Thought! I had helped my mother and my mother-in-law with their Medicare in the past. I also had worked in Human Resources early in my career and learned a lot about insurance. So I thought that signing up for Medicare would be easy for me. But, not having looked at this stuff in at least 10 years, I found it a lot more confusing than I had expected! I'm turning 65 in a few months. I'm in SF Bay area of California. I already know that I want traditional Medicare and not Medicare Advantage. I started taking Social Security at the beginning of this year (2025) so I automatically got a Medicare number and automatically got enrolled into Parts A & B. Now I need to pick a Plan D for drugs and a Medigap plan, which I already know will be a Plan G. In that regard, perhaps I'm ahead of the game. But picking a Plan D and a Plan G is turning out to be much harder than I'd thought it would be. I was glad to have watched a few YouTube videos about the process for signing up for each of these things -- that helped a lot, as well as reading the Medicare website and some info from AARP, etc. I found out that some of the Part D plans I was considering have limits on how many pills can be filled in 30 days for some meds. An SSRI that I take requires 90 10mg pills each month, because I take 25 mg per day and there is no 25 mg pill (nor is there a 50 mg that can be cut in half). So the plans that limit me to 30 10mg pills per month are a non-starter. (Sure, I could probably have my doctor try to appeal and get the 90 pills per month covered, but there is no guarantee that the insurance company would agree....and then I'd be stuck! Not worth the hassle!) This information was kinda buried at the bottom of each Part D plan on the Medicare website. It would have been a "bad surprise" to learn this after the fact! Regarding Part G -- this really surprised me -- the only Part G plan for my area that shows the premium and extra perks upfront is the AARP United Healthcare plan. ALL of the others don't even have a special page (or set of pages) about their Medigap plans! How are you supposed to compare the plans if you can't even see what you're paying for? I understand that all of the plans cover the exact same things; that's not what I want to know. I want to see rate tables (because most of them are Attained Age plans. The AARP one is Community based rates, and one other that I'm considering, Transamerica, is age at issue based rate). I also want to see if there are any perks beyond the regular plan coverage (like gym membership or whatever). I don't want to have to go through an agent or get a broker involved. I've had bad experiences with them in the past. I want to do this myself and sign up directly with the insurance companies. I truly don't understand why NONE of the Medigap providers in my area have ANY information on their websites about Medicare or their Medicare plans. When you click on the "company website" link on the Medicare website, it takes you to a general home page about the insurance company. I have tried searching these websites for "Medicare" or "Medigap" or "Plan G" but the searches come up blank. Why even offer a Medigap plan if you're not going to show your benefits to your clients online???? I don't want to have to waste my time calling 3 or 4 insurance companies! Only AARP seems to be upfront with any of this stuff. It's so weird, and I truly don't understand it! Am I missing something or misunderstanding something? Are the insurance companies deliberately making it hard for people to understand exactly what they're buying??"

— r/medicare · 33 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1ls9lyr/>

↳ (0): "I agree you can't find true info without contacting companies individually. I found that there are some options that might make it difficult. Smoking makes a difference, paying yearly can make a difference. Someone else in the household with the same company can make a difference. Wearables can make a difference. Like you I spent hours on YouTube (glad I did), called a few companies directly then got retirement nerds involved after I had narrowed things down. They actually placed the policy for me after helping to answer a few questions. Figuring all of this out was like a job. It worked out well for me. Good luck."

↳ (0): "Don't go with UHP. Profiteers from the pain and suffering of humans. Major lawsuits and denials. It amazes me this country still has not gone to universal healthcare. I'm on the original Medicare ABG&D. G is with Anthem BC. No perks. Simple and easy with my Drs. No issues so far in 13 months. They are profiteers as well, but I think they are less evil than the rest. D plans are stupid. They all have their "formulary" lists and none are the same \$\$ for identical drugs. Tier 1/2/3/4 garbage. But it's better than nothing. I have Wellcare. Not great but cheap. I've heard from friends in the SF bay area that Kaiser advantage is excellent. Of course you have to use them. But they are well established there. I'm in an area where there are hardly any Kaiser facilities. The agents that "help" are paid to drive you to their plans. They make \$\$ on your payments. Agents should be eliminated. It's a parasite business."

↳ (0): "Untrue about agents that drive you to their plans. Most agents are pretty good folks doing a good job. Signed, a parasite. D plans aren't stupid. If you don't get one, you get a penalty. But go ahead and not get one... see how that works out. UHC is fine - no different than any other carrier that you are bashing. Thanks for your nice, helpful post, btw!"

Widowed: one check, the same premiums · 22 documents

"I turn 65 this year and I'm pretty pissed. I'm a military widow who's been covered by Tricare forever. NOW I have to pay over \$200/month for insurance!!! WTF??? When did Congress decide that my lifetime coverage is now going to cost me \$3000 a year???? (insert swear words here!!)"

— YouTube · The \$600/Month Medicare Mistake Most 65-Year-Olds Make · 265 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HsfNTRmt3Pw&lc=Ugxr50UOGSXgjzKZ-Ih4AaABAg>

↳ @MarieKayla00 (8): "Retirement costs are honestly scarier than market volatility sometimes. A \$600 monthly mistake at 65 can snowball into a huge problem later."

↳ @MichaelBrown00f (8): "Facts. A lot of people spend decades building savings but underestimate healthcare and tax planning completely."

↳ @AustinCole99 (5): "Working with a wealth advisor changed how I prepare for retirement. He helped me organize my withdrawal strategy, reduce unnecessary expenses, and I've added around \$87k in long-term growth while feeling much more secure."

"My brother-in-law jumped onto Medicare Advantage despite my advice against it. Early on he bragged about the "stuff" he was getting from his insurance plan. He eventually was diagnosed with fourth stage pancreatic cancer. He fought the cancer for two years and fought his Advantage insurance provider for those two years through waiting for authorizations and thousands in out-of-pocket expenses when he consulted an out of network renowned cancer center. He survived one week following that visit. His widow had to fork over the money to the cancer center. My wife and I are on original Medicare with a supplemental plan I carried with my employer at retirement. She was diagnosed with Breast cancer. Her surgery, radiation therapy and a year of chemo pulled her through it. We had no issues with approvals and not a penny of out-of-pocket expenses. The advice to stick to original Medicare came straight from Medicare representatives during a pre-retirement seminar I attended fifteen years ago."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement - NEW cost comparison · 68 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t7XBSZaPx5E&lc=Ugwz7ggeVWwtwy1nUs14AaABAg>

↳ @nsatutor635 (12): "I've heard that Advantage is a POS and as scammers, they shouldn't be in business. They're like the roach motel. Once you get in, you're not only stuck but will die. Sorry for your loss. These for profit companies don't give a F about anyone but their bottom line."

↳ @ZipaDeeDooDahDays (10): "This doesn't make sense to me honestly. I have gone through all of this and my understanding is you can SWITCH plans every year depending on your healthcare needs. You are NOT stuck in one plan or the other. You always look at your health situation each September and make the proper choice in October for what you will need Healthcare Advantage is EXCELLENT for people that doesn't have health issues and also are on a limited budget. I have the GIVEBACK program and get my monthly Part B paid back to me, this means I only pay \$17 moth for Plan B coverage through my Advantage plan. I also get \$100 every quarter in FREE OTC needs, which is awesome for hundreds. Of things I usually paid for myself, like compression socks, Ibuprofen, Band Aids, Crutches, Food supplements, Vitamins, and a ton of other high end expensive things I can't afford. That's \$400 a year in FREE OTC stuff. Also, I don't need approval from my PCP as I can go anywhere there is an in-network member. For Eye care I go to an Optometrist in the network who happens to also be the best in my area, so it works out. I'm also very healthy, have no health issues, no chronic disease, no prescriptions, and I love the getting the FREE silver sneakers FREE gym memberships and free recreation access for pickle ball and the pool and weight room stuff. 4th Stage Pancreatic Cancer is a result of a metabolic problem and is not genetic or something you can't control. Meaning, what you put into your body dictates if you get control if you get a diagnosis it can be reversed by immediately FASTING for 1 week, and changing your diet immediately, and exercise. You have to get radical to save your life. We all can prevent cancer easily by changing our diet. Stop drinking alcohol, beer and wine. Stop all seed oils, only eat Olive oil, coconut oil and avocado oil. Stop eating sugars and carbs, stop eating processed foods, start drinking only water, eat healthy salts like Arctic or Celtic salt with high minerals. Exercise every day, don't be sedentary, get moving, plenty of easy things we can do even seated that increase O2 intake and help blood flow. We all have been conned that we need to depend on Medicare and the medical profession and big pharma to keep us alive. This has killed many people for no reason at all. It's time we make America healthy again and stop listening to the quacks and start eating like our food is healthcare, then we don't need healthcare!"

↳ @AnthonyLindsay-c4m (2): "You are 100 right 👍 in what you wrote! The real truth about MA plan verses a supplement plan in real life. Supplement plans are better but you pay more per month but it's worth it in the longterm when you really need a lot of medical care down the road. I am going with a supplement plan G high deductible because I have VA , not going to use it much but I am locked in for life as long as I pay the premium every month."

"I'm a 70 year-old widower, just started taking SS, but have been taking Medicare since 67. I was recently offered a short-term software consulting job (a couple of years at the most). Since my retirement accounts are comfortable, I thought it would be nice to help my two granddaughters with their college expenses, so I took the job. My IRMAA surcharge more than triples my Part B payment, and also adds onto my Part D. I'm still going to continue working as long as the contract lasts to help them minimize post graduation debt, but, learning about IRMAA was a bit of a shock. I don't get any additional coverage for that surcharge; it's just an additional tax. It's like I am being penalized for saving all those years for my retirement and then getting extra penalties because I am still able to work. Oh well. Either way, I am still happy with my choices. Just have to have some grumbles to keep the grumpy old man image intact. 😊 Than you for the great videos, Erin!"

— YouTube · IRMAA Explained: The Hidden Medicare Cost That Could Double Your Premiums in Retirement · 48 likes · <http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=McRktcoWBG0&lc=UgwLy3jYkTiBDE5dLcR4AaABAg>

↳ @penelope5500 (20): "Yeah, well...that's kind of the way it works isn't it? People who save & do well always seem to get dinged to subsidize the slackers. What are you gonna do?"

↳ @cedarwaxwing3509 (8): "It's not an additional tax. It's simply a factor of progressive taxation: the more you make, the more you pay. Perhaps people who make enough to cross the IRMAA threshold should be grateful that they make more money than the vast majority of other Americans."

↳ @brucestiles6477 (3): "I hope you're able to keep those pesky kids off your lawn!"

A spouse on a different plan, or choosing together · 21 documents

"Thanks for the excellent video. I am on AARP Medicare Advantage UnitedHealthcare PPO. My wife was on the same plan, but we kept hearing bad things about Advantage and we both attempted to switch back to traditional medicare in 2023. She was accepted, I was not. I was told I could not because I had received a couple of steroid shots in my spine due to arthritis. We are both 71 and in good health for the most part. I have had cancer (16 years ago), but my wife is in excellent health and always has been. We also full time RV's. We winter in Tucson Nov-April and the rest of the year we migrate with the birds. I have just subscribed. I wish health care in America was not such a game show, but it is."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 25 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgxgkqFeVTXyGsSK5nV4AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (1): "Thank you so much for watching and subscribing! Check out our recent videos because we are mid-48 state road trip 😊 In A mini van though... not an RV"

"I really like the honesty of this agent. I have been studying medigap s and Medicare advantage plans plus G. And asking many questions whether to purchase G or N. No one even gives me an answer. it's always its your decision, but this agent was truthful. My husband and i are both on N because it's expensive, but it's true we never know what will happen, and we do have many friends going home to the Lord. We never go to the doctor but we dont know the future. I plan to switch next year to G"

— YouTube · Why I Would Never Choose Medigap Plan G? · 11 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=b1-xkGFxm_g&lc=UgxSgFnaJw69KePAqkt4AaABAg

↳ @MedicareonVideo (4): "Yes, exactly. Everyone coming into Medicare needs to understand that there are options aside from Plan G. Plan G is a fantastic plan, but it is not a one size fits all scenario. I have plenty of clients on Plan G, Plan N, and Plan GHD."

↳ @katherinebruno616 (2): "All I want to know is the monthly cost for Plan G in R.I ...What will it cost my boyfriend every month? I do know Part B comes out his check automatically so what else does he pay???"

↳ @katherinebruno616 (1): "What's the difference between reg G and a high deductible G plan???"

"Finally a video that explains a very complicated subject in a relatively easy to understand for Matt. My wife and I have two very different medical needs and two very different plans. I have an advantage plan and my wife has supplementary plan. Anyway, this is pretty easy to understand. For a very complicated subject. Thank you."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgzaWKyVAJJPSL5Zmt4AaABAq>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (1): "Thank you so much David! Appreciate you watching and sharing your experience!"

Told what to choose by family, friends or a salesperson · 11 documents

"My agent pushed an Advantage plan from the start, but I wanted to stick with original Medicare with a Supplemental policy. A couple of years ago, I relented and said okay, go ahead and put my wife and I on an Advantage plan since he said 95% of his clients were on the plan. It must be good, right? Having 43 years in the property & casualty insurance business before retiring, I actually read the 200+ pages of the contract. I immediately called my agent and told him to rescind the Advantage plan and get me back on what I had. I later learned that after 7 years he no longer gets a commission from Medicare but would have continued indefinitely to receive commissions from the Advantage plan. My 7 years was up last year, and guess what, I haven't heard from him since. I would recommend that everyone stay with original Medicare, unless there is some compelling reason not to do so."

— YouTube · MASSIVE: Hospitals Are DROPPING Medicare Advantage Plans 🤖 · 81 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vn2k1W-JzB8&lc=UgzHCpaN2Z99tywzREh4AaABAq>

↳ @greyholcombjr.9623 (9): "I recently started original Medicare with a supplement plan N. If the day were to come I could no longer afford supplement premiums, I could move over to a Disadvantage plan during open enrollment without being concerned about medical underwriting. I would probably take out a reverse mortgage on my home to continue affording supplement premiums before I would do that though. I would buy a HDG supplement plan before a Disadvantage plan. I do not want an insurance company having that much control of my healthcare decisions. I don't buy my health insurance for the shiny distracting objects of vision, dental, gym memberships and such either. @johnyracercat"

↳ @johnyracercat (8): "I'm an agent. I explain the options and yes, 95% choose an Advantage Plan because they cannot afford or do not want to pay the Supplement costs and PDP, plus dental, RX, etc. Most Supplement clients will need to reprice to a better rate sooner than 7 years anyways. Supplements will continue to raise their rates as well. It sounds real good at \$125mo. How will you feel when your Supplement is \$500mo and your drugs are \$400mo higher on the PDP? Suddenly, the Advantage Plan you hate will start looking very tempting. Plus it will cover your dentures? What? Sign me up. Unless you are wealthy, you will get priced out when you really need it."

↳ @mhlovelady (0): "I can understand perhaps 50% choosing the Advantage plan, but NOT 95% unless they are being steered to that. My experience with agents that just sell price is that they are not doing their customers a favor. I once heard a wise agent say that a doctor that makes a mistake may kill you quickly, but an agent that sells you the wrong coverage is like slow death financially. @johnyracercat"

"So glad I listened to friends who told me not to get an advantage plan when I turned 65. So glad."

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=Ugwsqy61flcc1W4xCgp4AaABAq>

↳ @nealkshah (0): "yes! I tell everyone i know the same thing!"

"Thank you Erin for so well explained these healthcare confusions! I wish this video would have came out a year ago. I'm 66 and I was confused by all these last year when I needed to enroll. My broker only pushed me to enroll in Medicare Advantage and it seems to be a better choice due to the lower cause. As you said, I'm lucky that I'm still healthy now but choosing Medigap may be a better choice down the road."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgwZrnBS3BHQIMpP7-x4AaABAg>

Doctors who won't take their plan · 11 documents

"My family doctor doesn't take Medicare. I pay him up front (he charges me the allowed Medicare rate for the visit) and his staff files for me with Medicare and Medicare sends me a check that covers the visit. I have supplement G. So even if the doctor doesn't participate, the cost can be covered."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 5 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgwK1gzzvwDmZ0n8K_V4AaABAg

↳ @EliseR-d1y (0): "It is so wonderful that your doctor's office does that. I am not certain many would."

↳ @MikeHammer1 (0): "@EliseR-d1y I suspect that you can submit the medical expense yourself using a copy of the actual visit paperwork with the coding for the treatment. Worth looking into. And yes, it is wonderful that they do this (not just for me), they are Christians and they also operate a free clinic to help those who lack the ability to pay. My son (an RN) worked at the clinic for several years (strictly voluntary, no compensation)."

"My local Dr here in Bartlett Tennessee doesn't take any advantage plans. I've been with him for 14 years, and he explained why he didn't take patients with these types of plans. I turned 65 several years ago, hence I was on Medicare A and B. I asked about supplemental coverage and he said in his opinion that would be the best for me. I chose a company and so far so good. It pays to have a good doctor, and his office is small, with himself and one other doctor and a FPN."

— YouTube · Top Disadvantages of Medicare Advantage Plans · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BebQ04cKzJc&lc=UgxY9CxTqO-n8hy5cUR4AaABAg>

"I would love to go back to supplement because of my hospital stay and I had full coverage at the time and always in my life I have higher level of Medicaid and my one hospital bill was 1,000,000 and I would of been responsible for 20 %and now I'm Medicare / Medicaid qmb and it paid all. With all these changes scares me now I V did not know the difference from supplement and advantage I just made sure I had a ppo and a private insurance company and they told me I would not lose anything. And this is my second year on advantage and now after watching for my health and quality of life may change for the rules that the agents never told . I even told them if it takes anything or decisions out of my hand I don't want it. Nothing or accesentives is worthwhile than my be health care. I feel I was lied to and till this year it came out and I found out for my copays are 47\$ if I don't go to a doctor that doesn't take Medicaid. Unless you're in the hospital doctors don't take Medicaid. my yearly coverage now is \$247 in January I don't know yet this year. Even though I'm undetectable I still have to"

— YouTube · Best Medicare Supplement Companies Review · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=DXrpiO_sGSc&lc=UgynA8kDxKYvvlAaJd4AaABAg_AM3rbFxx_jLANEHsoyZDJy

Not wanting to burden the kids · 9 documents

"I'm turning 65 in December. I am a single person and need to make sure I'm able to stay in my own home and not be a burden to family. I want a what is called "Cadillac Plan", I am considering regular Medicare plan and adding additional cover for any gaps in coverage for the rest of my life. I am not really thinking the Advantage plan works for me after hearing several Carriers are pulling out and it's harder to get approvals. I also have a Cancer Insurance and Heart Insurance I've had for years that pay a lump sum that I am keeping. I just want to be covered. I don't have much monthly income but I would rather be safe than sorry. I noticed Mutual of Omaha and Select Health offer supplements, I live in Utah. Any advise?"

— YouTube · Who REALLY Chooses Medicare Advantage vs Medigap (And Who Regrets It) · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=suy-7L-LYaM&lc=UgwH3al8qtp-kRd7Hx94AaABAq>

↳ @alansach8437 (2): "G. All you pay is the Part B deductible. With the D Plans look for one that covers any drugs you may be taking. If you are going to get screwed anywhere it's with the drug plan. None of them cover everything."

↳ @MedigapSeminars (0): "@alansach8437 All Part D plans must cover at least two drugs from every prescription category plus substantially all medications from 6 protected categories like cancer drugs and autoimmune drugs. If they do not have a specific drug available, they will have a competitor or generic. You also have the ability to appeal and have your specific drug added to the formulary just for you."

"I'm satisfied with Plan N- I spent a long time looking at them. I can't believe that so many go for Medicare Advantage. I like having some control and I don't want my children to have to pay for me."

— YouTube · Medigap Plan G vs Plan N Two Years Later · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=GRLgcxTEKs4&lc=Ugww3CgLvpuhi trRZ4AaABAq>

↳ @PJN61 (1): "I turn 65 in January and I chose plan N. I would never use a Medicare advantage plan."

"I'm in a battle with IRMAA because they just don't see my point. My income rose sharply in 2024 due to huge Capital Gain Distributions on a mutual fund I inherited in 2015. I have NOT sold the fund, so those CGDS effectively are NOT tangible income. In fact I plan on passing the fund to my daughter as an inheritance. This doesn't fall into any one of their SSA 44 Form categories to reduce my income. I wonder if joining the group mentioned will have some strategies to get my Social Security back where it belongs"

— YouTube · 8 Ways to Reduce Medicare IRMAA Payments · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Z6yhDpaSO9A&lc=Ugxf0sbNIT1PW6nT3d4AaABAq>

Tab 4 — Relationship Soundbites

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On Advantage: 'stay away' and the answers to it · 118 documents

"Being a Utilization management RN for a Florida based hospital for over 15 years, I totally agree with you. So often patients experience medical emergencies while on vacation and are limited to choices for care while away from home and "out of network." I advise my friends and family to always invest in supplements and keep Medicare, steering them away from advantage or replacement plans. I think it's a crime when I have to argue with advantage plans to authorize physician directed care after the acute health emergency has been addressed. Most folks don't realize that once a patient is determined to be stable, their care is limited to what their advantage plan will allow, even while they remain hospitalized. Often their choices decrease significantly when they are discharged. Those who require home health or rehabilitation services post-hospitalization can be severely restricted and are usually required to return home to their local area for coverage. You are providing a great service with your videos. Keep it up!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 513 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgyQPwewvEHaPILi_Qd4AaABAg

↳ @TheCheryl57 (34): "Again, you have to consider your situation and many older people don't travel so this would not be a problem. There are many things to consider on a personal level, it's not one size fits all."

↳ @MedicareonVideo (31): "Sure wish everyone could read your comment!"

↳ @lindahidalgo1804 (15): "@TheCheryl57 I heard Advantage plans are more costly in the long run especially if you need a lot of medical care. Also, that those plans are more costly for the government, because those Advantage plans charge more for services because the middlemen/women and the in those companies need to make a profit."

"Should we just not mention Medicare Advantage plans here? Do you all see this group as solely about Medicare, only? Because if I say anything positive about Advantage plans, or heck, even mention them, I get downvoted. If Medicare Advantage plan discussions aren't welcome here, that's fine. But some clarity on this would be welcome."

— r/medicare · 82 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1mckfap/>

↳ (0): "Medicare Advantage is a part of Medicare so of course it can be discussed here. There's a vocal portion of this group that doesn't like MA and that's fine. It's a discussion forum where people discuss things."

↳ (0): "I tried very hard not to sign up for MA, but because I'm relatively healthy the maths didn't math. I had help from a SHIBA volunteer when signing up. We determined it would cost me an extra \$6000 a year to go with original Medicare. What needs to happen is for Medicare to be allowed an even playing field compared to MA. Listen to Bernie!"

↳ (0): "I think your volunteer was math challenged. Depending on your age though. What I hate is to see people say "I'm relatively healthy". Do you expect to stay that way? Do you think you can change back to a Medicare supplement whenever you want? Chances are, you cannot. You are choosing a health plan that you will be using for a very long time, possibly forever. Yes during AEP you can change from one MAPD to another, but you cannot switch to a med sup unless you are healthy. You cannot switch be declined. And right now, medical underwriting is very strict. Possibly different in your state. I know a few, very few, have open enrollment for med sup, but the vast majority do not."

"My agent pushed an Advantage plan from the start, but I wanted to stick with original Medicare with a Supplemental policy. A couple of years ago, I relented and said okay, go ahead and put my wife and I on an Advantage plan since he said 95% of his clients were on the plan. It must be good, right? Having 43 years in the property & casualty insurance business before retiring, I actually read the 200+ pages of the contract. I immediately called my agent and told him to rescind the Advantage plan and get me back on what I had. I later learned that after 7 years he no longer gets a commission from Medicare but would have continued indefinitely to receive commissions from the Advantage plan. My 7 years was up last year, and guess what, I haven't heard from him since. I would recommend that everyone stay with original Medicare, unless there is some compelling reason not to do so."

— YouTube · MASSIVE: Hospitals Are DROPPING Medicare Advantage Plans 🤖 · 81 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vn2k1W-JzB8&lc=UgzHCpaN2Z99tywzREh4AaABAq>

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On supplements: what they were told and what they tell others · 111 documents

"Being a Utilization management RN for a Florida based hospital for over 15 years, I totally agree with you. So often patients experience medical emergencies while on vacation and are limited to choices for care while away from home and "out of network." I advise my friends and family to always invest in supplements and keep Medicare, steering them away from advantage or replacement plans. I think it's a crime when I have to argue with advantage plans to authorize physician directed care after the acute health emergency has been addressed. Most folks don't realize that once a patient is determined to be stable, their care is limited to what their advantage plan will allow, even while they remain hospitalized. Often their choices decrease significantly when they are discharged. Those who require home health or rehabilitation services post-hospitalization can be severely restricted and are usually required to return home to their local area for coverage. You are providing a great service with your videos. Keep it up!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 513 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgyQPwewvEHaPILi_Qd4AaABAg

↳ @TheCheryl57 (34): "Again, you have to consider your situation and many older people don't travel so this would not be a problem. There are many things to consider on a personal level, it's not one size fits all."

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↳ @lindahidalgo1804 (15): "@TheCheryl57 I heard Advantage plans are more costly in the long run especially if you need a lot of medical care. Also, that those plans are more costly for the government, because those Advantage plans charge more for services because the middlemen/women and the in those companies need to make a profit."

"One thing that stuck out big time was when he said when someone gets sick and others have to handle insurances issues Plan G takes all that away. My wife contracted Granulomatosis with PolyAngitis (GPA) a super rare autoimmune disease that killed her in 12weeks. Genetically she should have had 20 more years to live and was healthy before GPA hit her. Thankfully, we had Plan G. We didn't have to worry about all those pitfalls built into the healthcare system. So she got the best treatment and doctors available. I never saw a single bill only once in a while someone would ask about payment and when they heard Plan G there were no more questions. I never had to worry about that stuff during a horrible time when I was witnessing the disease destroy her from the inside. Medical system doesn't care what is happening to you or your spouse or family members they require payment and that's it. Her costs for that disease had to be millions of dollars and not one bill. There's so much to take care of after someone dies and not having to deal with medical bills and calls made it so much easier."

— YouTube · Can We Talk Openly About Medicare Supplement Plan G? · 45 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=YbzNHT67jnc&lc=UgzTcf9bSKj33LRsjex4AaABAg>

↳ @randybyrnepersonal (3): "@ChrisRI1000 - very sorry for your loss. I agree with you completely regarding the benefits of Plan G for someone with serious illness(es)."

↳ @nubiareymos3161 (0): "Christ I am sorry for your loss and also need your help with information. I will be 65 years old who two months ago contracted NMOSD which is a degenerative autoimmune disease. I don't have idea of what plan to buy. I was presented Medicare Advantage as the best option for my situation. Under your experience,"

"I was a Medicare sales agent with an FMO and I almost was brainwashed against Medicare Supplements. Thanks to your videos and others that tell the truth about medicare advantage plans, the damage done by that company was reversed. Before I left that company, we were told that they would no longer be offering supplements. That disturbed me but I was still under the spell of the lies, I eventually left the company due to health reasons and now I am glad that I did. The more that I learn the less I am willing to go back to companies that enforce advantage plans and leave out information about supplements. If I could find a company that tells the whole truth about Medicare plans, I would go back into the sales field. I live in Florida and so far I have not found such a creature. So, I have to rely on you for the "truth" because I will be going on Medicare in July. I will be getting a supplement!! Thank you for your honesty. I have learned so much."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement I Most Get This Wrong · 26 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4xXIjZes9o&lc=UgwKxBU32hb6xclBJR4AaABAq>

↳ @EXPLOREWITHME. (0): "If i give you my email. Could u tell me more info"

On doctors, drugs and networks: what the office and the plan said · 78 documents

"Being a Utilization management RN for a Florida based hospital for over 15 years, I totally agree with you. So often patients experience medical emergencies while on vacation and are limited to choices for care while away from home and "out of network." I advise my friends and family to always invest in supplements and keep Medicare, steering them away from advantage or replacement plans. I think it's a crime when I have to argue with advantage plans to authorize physician directed care after the acute health emergency has been addressed. Most folks don't realize that once a patient is determined to be stable, their care is limited to what their advantage plan will allow, even while they remain hospitalized. Often their choices decrease significantly when they are discharged. Those who require home health or rehabilitation services post-hospitalization can be severely restricted and are usually required to return home to their local area for coverage. You are providing a great service with your videos. Keep it up!"

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"GLP-1 Bridge Program Info As someone that works in a doctors office and submits PAs, I want to clear up some confusion about the GLP-1 bridge program. I want to start by saying I appreciate that this program will get these meds to many people that need it, but it leaves a lot of Medicare beneficiaries behind. If you have type 2 diabetes, moderate to severe obstructive sleep apnea, or MASH you do NOT qualify to use the program. You have to get a GLP-1 medication approved for those conditions through your Part D plan. Even if the Part D copay is astronomical, you still can't use the bridge program if you have any of those 3 diagnoses. It doesn't matter if the provider doesn't even use those diagnoses and only submits the PA for obesity, you still don't qualify. When we submit the PA, the provider has to attest that you do NOT have those conditions. If the provider selects that you DO have any of them, the system automatically denies it and kicks it back saying it has to go through Part D. You can't get around this if you have these conditions because that would be committing Medicare fraud. I submitted multiple of these PAs today and confirmed this is exactly how it's being processed. You do still qualify if you have mild obstructive sleep apnea and meet the other criteria, because mild OSA isn't covered under Part D, only moderate to severe. This is directly from the CMS website info for prescribers and the PA form that I've linked below. I recommend looking over these because this is exactly the guideline providers are following when submitting these PAs. <https://www.cms.gov/glp-1-bridge.pdf> <https://www.cms.gov/files/document/glp-1-prescribers-c-1.pdf> I hope this information is helpful."

— r/medicare · 74 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1ulaona/>

↳ (0): "Super helpful - nice to hear from someone actually submitting the forms. People keep asking agents and that's useless :)"

↳ (0): "Great info & great explanation!"

↳ (0): "The pharmacy tech at the Walmart pharmacy i use, had no idea about the bridge program. Someone else tried to help her figure it out I sent a message to my doctor who responded the paperwork has been submitted and awaiting a response This whole thing feels like a mess. I hope it gets straightened out before the program ends Update: I just got notification from Walmart that my prescription is ready at the \$50 copay!"

"Just about to turn 65, want medicare but it seems no doc wants to take it Im facing much anxiety about this coming decision. I would prefer traditional Medicare because I travel a lot. I asked my doctor if she would accept medicare and she said because I was an existing patient of hers, yes. But not for new patients. Is this common? Makes me wonder about going with medicare"

— r/medicare · 63 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1oe2z6j/>

↳ (0): "Doctors want more money than Medicare feels is reasonable. The source of the conflict may vary by who reads it. Do Doctors want too much? Does Medicare want to pay too little?"

↳ (0): "There are automatic cuts to Medicare reimbursement built in to the law every year to reduce costs. Now because the debt ceiling was raised to pass the BBB, sequestration will result in an ADDITIONAL 4% cut to reimbursement to Medicare providers. Imagine owning a business requiring a high degree of expertise, intensive staffing needs, high overhead, and costs rising higher than inflation while your revenue decreases every year. This is not about doctors wanting "more money". It's about all Medicare providers trying to afford to stay in business."

↳ (0): "In NJ, Medicare is my best payor. Medicare Advantage? My worst..."

'Do your own homework, read the fine print' · 52 documents

"LEAVE advantage plan OR RISK YOUR LIFE. WARNING: Medicare Advantage Plans Can Delay Care With No Consequences Please read this carefully—your health and your life could depend on it. I just found this out on Friday after speaking with an attorney. If you have a Medicare Advantage plan, you are NOT protected if your insurance company delays your care in bad faith—and right now, you have no legal recourse. I found this out the hard way. UnitedHealthcare's algorithm delayed my cancer treatment for five months. When I first found a lump in my neck, my cancer was stage one. By the time I was finally able to get treatment, it had progressed to stage three. Five months lost. Five months where the cancer spread. Now, I am left with irreversible side effects and a permanently diminished quality of life. These are facts. It's public knowledge if you do the research. I recently spoke with an attorney who confirmed my worst fear: Because of a 2023 Supreme Court upheld with the ruling listed bellow. You CANNOT sue a Medicare Advantage provider for delaying your care for BAD FAITH. The law was made in 2023. (The California Supreme Court's decision in Quishenberry v. UnitedHealthcare) -2022 Read that again. They can delay your treatment for as long as they want. They can deny and restrict access to life-saving care. And you have NO legal way to hold them accountable. If I had traditional Medicare or a standard insurance plan, I may have been protected. But under Medicare Advantage, patients have no rights when insurance companies prioritize profits over their lives. And if you think this is an accident, think again. These companies are making billions from Medicare Advantage while rationing care and exploiting legal loopholes that shield them from responsibility. Look up how much they've profited—while patients like me suffer the consequences. It's public record. You have until March 31st to switch back to straight Medicare if you are currently enrolled in an Advantage plan. Do your research before it's too late. I am looking into a class-action lawsuit, and I will be writing to my state senator—because this is criminal. No one should be forced to endure what I have. Please—share this information. Protect yourself. Protect your loved ones. The system is rigged, and right now, patients are paying the price!!!"

— r/medicare · 152 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1jcgwz2/>

↳ (0): "I have Stage IV cancer with Original Medicare and Medigap. Everything has been covered with no issues since my diagnosis. Your experience is a nightmare and echos what I've heard from other cancer patients. Some patients have no issue with Medicare Advantage but some experiences have put people's lives in jeopardy and I applaud you for telling your story."

↳ (0): "Are your bills higher? New to Medicare and need brain surgery. Soon. I was going to pick an advantage plan due to medical bills, seeming like they would be lower with advantage versus medigap. But now I'm thinking, after this post and your comment, for my current situation medigap would be smarter. This is all so confusing to me. Any advice I'd appreciate. Thank you."

↳ (0): "With our medigap G we only pay the \$257 deductible per year. Our monthly medigap plan cost my husband \$160 per month. He has lymphoma and gets ct scans 2x per year, pt scans, mri, specialists, all at no extra charge and no hassle. Unless you are healthy and don't need more than a physical once per year, I would recommend traditional Medicare and the medigap G."

"Medicare vs Medicare Advantage. My findings as I enter retirement. A few things I have found out since I have been researching the original Medicare vs. Medicare Advantage. I'm in no way saying that Medicare Advantage is bad. Some people prefer the Medicare Advantage plan over the original Medicare. 1. Medicare Advantage is a private insurance. When you sign up for Medicare Advantage, you are walking away from the original Medicare. 2. If you sign up for Medicare Advantage, and you are under 65, when you turn 65, you will be able to get back on the original Medicare with a medigap supplement. If you are 65 and older and you are on Medicare Advantage, that's when it gets difficult to enroll in a medigap supplement plan with the original Medicare. You will have to go through underwriting, and if you have anything preexisting, you more than likely won't be able to get that G supplement on the original Medicare. Plan G covers everything that Medicare Part A and B cover at 100% except for the Part B deductible of \$226. This means that you won't pay anything out of pocket for covered services and treatments after you pay the deductible. 3. When you enroll in a Medicare Advantage Plan you are essentially selling your traditional Medicare coverage to a private insurance company. 4. If someone tries to sell you "Medicare," ask them if it is Medicare Advantage Plan. 5. Insurance brokers make a commission of \$600. to enroll new members in the Advantage plan. They make \$300. To enroll you in the original Medicare. ** I was just informed that insurance brokers do not get commission when they enroll members in the original Medicare. 6. With an Advantage plan, you could have a yearly out of pocket as high as \$5,000 to \$10,000. With the original Medicare with a G supplement your out of pocket is \$226. a year, plus your monthly premium payment, depending on what plan you choose. 7. If you enroll in Medicare Advantage, you still pay the Part B premium amount, which is \$164.90. The \$164.9 is automatically taken out of your Social Security check. 8. If you are enrolling in Medicare Advantage, ask your agent/broker what happens if you travel out of state, and you need to seek medical attention outside of your network. With original Medicare, there is no network, and you have coverage in all 50 states. 9. With Medicare, you don't need prior authorization for a given service. Your doctor makes that decision. (I think you may need authorization with ambulance services though.) With Medicare Advantage, you need prior authorization to receive a service, and the insurance company makes the decision whether to approve or deny the service, not the doctor. 10. When you see a table set up at Walmart with a sign that says, "Sign up for Medicare here." That is Medicare Advantage. Medicare does not do that. The original Medicare will never call you to sell you anything and they will never visit you at your home. The calls and spam mail are from Medicare Advantage. TV ads with Joe Namath and J.J. Walker aren't from Medicare. That's a private insurance called Medicare Advantage. 11. If you see anything referring to a Medicare Part C plan, that is a Medicare Advantage Plan. That is not the original Medicare. 12. Read the fine print on Medicare Advantage's vision and dental plans. Vision and dental are not included in all Medicare Advantage Plans. 13. If you have the original Medicare, you don't need to renew it every year. Medicare Advantage will also renew automatically each year unless Medicare cancels its contract with the plan, or your insurance company stops offering the plan. On YouTube, subscribe to Medicare School, Christopher Westfall and Medicare on Video. Watch their Medicare vs Medicare Advantage videos. These videos are extremely informative to keep you informed while entering the retirement phase. Anyone, feel free to correct me if I've misstated anything or if you have anything to add to this post. I'm still learning and trying to gain knowledge to educate myself on this complicated subject."

— r/medicare · 81 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/141m9ym/>

↳ (0): "You need to consider the monthly insurance premium for the Medicare supplement, too. One reason many people sign up for MA is that they cannot afford the supplement premiums. Everyone pays the monthly Part B premiums, then on top of that, they may pay a monthly supplement premium, if they sign up for a supplement, and they will have drug insurance (Part D) premium, which they should sign up for even if they do not take medications now, to avoid paying a penalty later. If they sign up for MA, rather than a supplement, some MA plans, but not all, have a monthly premium. Drugs are included with MA plans."

↳ (0): "Thanks for the info. I'm making a file and adding new info as I go along. It's overwhelming!"

↳ (0): "5. The amount of commission an agent gets varies extremely from plan to plan, company to company, etc. Not set in stone at all like the numbers you have listed"

"My agent pushed an Advantage plan from the start, but I wanted to stick with original Medicare with a Supplemental policy. A couple of years ago, I relented and said okay, go ahead and put my wife and I on an Advantage plan since he said 95% of his clients were on the plan. It must be good, right? Having 43 years in the property & casualty insurance business before retiring, I actually read the 200+ pages of the contract. I immediately called my agent and told him to rescind the Advantage plan and get me back on what I had. I later learned that after 7 years he no longer gets a commission from Medicare but would have continued indefinitely to receive commissions from the Advantage plan. My 7 years was up last year, and guess what, I haven't heard from him since. I would recommend that everyone stay with original Medicare, unless there is some compelling reason not to do so."

— YouTube · MASSIVE: Hospitals Are DROPPING Medicare Advantage Plans 🤖 · 81 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vn2k1W-JzB8&lc=UgzHCpaN2Z99tywzREh4AaABAq>

↳ @greyholcombjr.9623 (9): "I recently started original Medicare with a supplement plan N. If the day were to come I could no longer afford supplement premiums, I could move over to a Disadvantage plan during open enrollment without being concerned about medical underwriting. I would probably take out a reverse mortgage on my home to continue affording supplement premiums before I would do that though. I would buy a HDG supplement plan before a Disadvantage plan. I do not want an insurance company having that much control of my healthcare decisions. I don't buy my health insurance for the shiny distracting objects of vision, dental, gym memberships and such either. @johnnyracercat"

↳ @johnnyracercat (8): "I'm an agent. I explain the options and yes, 95% choose an Advantage Plan because they cannot afford or do not want to pay the Supplement costs and PDP, plus dental, RX, etc. Most Supplement clients will need to reprice to a better rate sooner than 7 years anyways. Supplements will continue to raise their rates as well. It sounds real good at \$125mo. How will you feel when you're Supplement is \$500mo and your drugs are \$400mo higher on the PDP? Suddenly, the Advantage Plan you hate will start looking very tempting. Plus it will cover your dentures? What? Sign me up. Unless you are wealthy, you will get priced out when you really need it."

↳ @mhlovelady (0): "I can understand perhaps 50% choosing the Advantage plan, but NOT 95% unless they are being steered to that. My experience with agents that just sell price is that they are not doing their customers a favor. I once heard a wise agent say that a doctor that makes a mistake may kill you quickly, but an agent that sells you the wrong coverage is like slow death financially. @johnnyracercat"

What the agent or broker told them · 34 documents

"My agent pushed an Advantage plan from the start, but I wanted to stick with original Medicare with a Supplemental policy. A couple of years ago, I relented and said okay, go ahead and put my wife and I on an Advantage plan since he said 95% of his clients were on the plan. It must be good, right? Having 43 years in the property & casualty insurance business before retiring, I actually read the 200+ pages of the contract. I immediately called my agent and told him to rescind the Advantage plan and get me back on what I had. I later learned that after 7 years he no longer gets a commission from Medicare but would have continued indefinitely to receive commissions from the Advantage plan. My 7 years was up last year, and guess what, I haven't heard from him since. I would recommend that everyone stay with original Medicare, unless there is some compelling reason not to do so."

— YouTube · MASSIVE: Hospitals Are DROPPING Medicare Advantage Plans 🤖 · 81 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vn2k1W-JzB8&lc=UgzHCpaN2Z99tywzREh4AaABAq>

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"Anyone else not having fun anymore? I work at/partially own a smaller independent agency here in the Midwest with my dad and brother. I've been doing this for 14 years now and boy, the past 12 months has sucked. We only have 4 agents but I think the last time I checked our total written premium we were at \$9m so we're doing alright. We're pretty evenly split between personal and commercial and are really lucky to have a big selection of companies. * Travelers, Progressive, Nat Gen, Safeco, Hartford AARP, Auto Owners, Cincinnati, Philly, Nationwide, Openly, Stillwater, and probably a dozen specialty and mutual companies. I'm sure I'm forgetting a couple. I'm fully aware we got it better than most. Even still, this isn't really fun anymore. Especially on the personal side of things. I know we're not FL or TX but my god is it getting tough to shop people around. That's kinda our whole thing. We've always prided ourselves on being honest, upfront, actually answering the phones when folks call in, and trying to do what's best for the customer even if that means less commission. Us agents do all our own quoting and 90% of the servicing. I know we do it differently than most agencies. By doing that we've done pretty well for ourselves and really don't need to advertise or worry about finding leads. We run solely off referrals and call ins and are too busy to keep up. That's the good thing about right now. 10 years ago, we were desperate for business and would have to take anyone who walked in the door. Nowadays, I bet we have to turn away 30% of new customers for misc reasons. Oh your roof is 11 years old, tough. Your house is \$212k and 100 years old, sorry. A single water claim in the last 5 years, nope. You bought both of your daughters Kias?? I can't tell you how many call ins I've sent to Farm Bureau. 2-3 a week at least. We just had a big regional meeting with our parent company last week and boy it was grim. It was the most depressing company round up I've ever been to. Record losses, more companies tightening guidelines, don't expect profit payouts again anytime soon. I was sitting with some of our peer agency (comparable # of employees and companies) and man, they sure seemed like they were struggling. A couple of them said they were closing 3-4 customers a week and he seemed proud of it. Like for the whole agency. I didn't tell him that I myself did 6 that week. I'm not complaining about the money. I made \$25k more this past year than the year before it. I'll probably match that again this year given what renewals are rolling in at. I'm just getting real tired of quoting a perfectly normal 2,700 sqft 2 story with a perfectly fine 12 year old roof and not being able to do anything. I quote 9 different companies and only one offers me a price and it's \$1200 more than what they paid last year. There's a good chance I'll get that sale but the customer already doesn't like me. I'm tired of having to justify the 79% rate increase I saw this morning on a Nationwide home (no claim). I'm tired of every single elderly person telling me "I'm on a fixed income" whenever their policy goes up \$27. I'm tired of roofing companies rolling our customer's wind/hail deductible into the amount they're billing the insurance company to win over their business. And then I'm tired when that same customer bitches to me next Summer when their home goes up \$1800 on renewal. I'm tired of not being able to talk to an underwriter anymore without first going through India and having them pretend to know what's going on only to transfer me to a misc underwriter 10 minutes later. I'm not saying this job was all sunshine and daisy's but it's crazy how much less stressful it was just 2-3 years ago. My dad's been an agent for 40 years (25 with Farmers) and he said this is the worst market he's ever seen. He predominantly does commercial and habitational and that's become a nightmare as well. He's had to turn away \$250k premium accounts recently because there's literally not a single other market for it. Please tell me we're not alone. Please tell me this is temporary and it won't suck to come into work in 2 years. We've never ever listened to a single buyout offer but man, I get why some folks do it these days."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 51 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1cswcw9/anyone_else_not_having_fun_anymore/

↳ LifeVictor (26): "This may be the best post I have seen in a long time. I think it sums up what 90% of us are all dealing with in this unprecedented market. I'm captive and can you imagine all of the above with no other options to offer. It sucks! Hang in there. Be strong! 🍊"

↳ PromiseAdvanced1870 (9): "Here in KS and MO it's the same thing...I can't tell you how many times this month I've turned away new customers AND CURRENT cuz their roofs are over 10 years old. Just about 70% of our Nationwide book is calling in cussing us out for the MASSIVE rate hikes NW is taking. "Sorry Mr. Customer, NW is trying to figure things out just like the rest of the industry. Good thing is you're not the only customer to call in and we do have other options! Real quick, how old is the roof on your house? Oh it's the original from 1998??.....! [gif](emotefree_emotes_pack|facepalm)"

↳ Samwill226 (6): "I'm in Georgia....it hasn't been fun in two years. Had a 40% loss ration for oh I don't know....20 years? Had a 200% due to storms for a 6 month period and now its back to 50%. Travelers came in and shut down my ability to write new homeowners. I was also just notified that if I don't write enough policies I may drop a tier on commission.....but also

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 32 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=UgxdgBtHEeLV2ikHP-N4AaABAg>

↳ @sheila7814 (1): "Thank you. I have cancer and am just now making these decisions because I turn 65 soon."

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 33 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=UgxmT865uNNBDGTwxqV4AaABAq>

↳ @francesb6758 (7): "You made the right choice; don't listen to the others. MAdvantage might look tempting and cheaper, but wait until they're a bit older and their health deteriorates. If they need physical therapy, for example after a surgery, they'll be on the hook for a co-pay for EVERY PT visit. Or for repeated eye injections for retinal problems -- each repeat visit hits them with another co-pay. A friend used to work for a retinal specialist; she had to deliver the bad news about MA co-pays every day. Remember the old saying: Cheap is expensive in the long run."

↳ @sheila7814 (1): "Thank you. I have cancer and am just now making these decisions because I turn 65 soon."

"anyone that is 65 and over must pay for medicare cost that is paid from social security, about \$175 a month. the 20% supplement can cost \$150 a month , plan G and goes up each year with United Health Care. So annually, one pays \$1800 plus the annual deductible of \$240, or \$2000 a year for health insurance. no co-pays and no other expenses to see the doctor or ER visits after the annual deductible is paid, \$240. the original medicare pays up to 60 days in the hospital. 60 days is a long time. In most cases, one will be discharged within 60 days. From age 65 to 75, most seniors would not be staying in the hospital for long periods of time. the goal is to make appointments to see the doctor and do preventive care. take advantage of the plans. the part that I have a problem with is, medicare advantage can change its policy and they are for profit. the medicare advantage tangle carrots like free stuff , some dental work, glasses, and partial payment for hearing aids. plus gym membership which are available on some supplements. some medicare advantage plans do not pay if you leave the network. when the original medicare, I can go to any ER and do not need to worry about a co-pay. with advantage plans, there are doctor visit co-pay and ER co-pays and drugs cost money, with kaiser advantage plans. if one starts with the original medicare, you are guaranteed , no need to qualify. if you start with an advantage medicare plan with zero to little monthly fee with some free stuff, if you wish to go back to the original medicare plan, you have to be screened and qualify. the questions, do you wish to pay \$2,000 a year that gradually increases with the annual \$240 deductible , then unlimited doctor visits and ER visits? or be nickled and dime with office visit cost, ER cost , and subject to having the advantage plan approving your bill with possible surprises? I have to make a choice soon, nothing is free in life. All I know, I am currently paying \$1000 a month with kaiser and it cost me \$\$\$ for office visit, lab work and if I need to go to the ER. if I have to have a test performed, I have to still pay. So the \$200 a month supplement is reasonable with the original medicare. Again, Nothing in life is FREE, especially when our congress is swayed by private insurance companies trying to get a larger piece of the business. I hear many horror stories with private advantage medicare plans. they surprise Americans with large bills since the coverage does not pay for certain treatments. IMO"

— YouTube · Original Medicare vs. Medicare Advantage: What's the Difference? · 30 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=weO1WkquA3s&lc=Ugzax7JeWu8Hgkw-fB4AaABAg>

↳ @ESMEE_4EVERR (0): "Jvgknftiokfpmgibdhcujjgbbjg"

↳ @AIH-p2u (0): "I'm surprised you think it's okay to pay 2400\$ a year plus dental plus vision plus medication and think it's everyone's best option. Many ppl are healthy and can save 2400\$ etc for 5-10 yrs then go into a chronic plan with little max out of pocket saying you thousands but if you're ill and have my doctors then supp is the way to go UHC offers both mapd pdp and supp I am contracted with them"

↳ @bozomonster (0): "The math doesn't workout in your if your paying \$1,000 per month to Kaiser. The max out of pocket with a Medicare Advantage Plan is \$5,000."

'I love my Advantage plan' · 20 documents

"I love my medicare advantage, especially because I can be treated at Mount Sinai Medical Center and my copayment is 0"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage Plans Leaving in 2026 - 2,600,000 Seniors Impacted · 17 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8Pg6H7UZBbU&lc=UgznrQ3AeIMxl7_LZt4AaABAg.AMa0mE2CuSIAMcZKnj4rwD

"I love my advantage plan, i have not had anything denied, I've had two knee replacements, 3 back surgeries, trigger finger fixed all fingers on both hands and i have a monthly infusion that is 20,000 every 4 weeks. Absolutely nothing has been denied. MA for the win. Also i use the hell out of dental and vision i also love the 70.00 A month spending card."

— YouTube · MORE Medicare Advantage Plans CUT: Millions Will Face Forced Dis-enrollment ❌ · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CPLaLyfDZxY&lc=UgwRfwxGoyyoZ6A7iHJ4AaABAg>

↳ @MedicareSchool (3): "That's fantastic to hear, especially with a treatment history like that — a plan that's handled everything from major surgeries to a \$20,000 monthly infusion without denials is genuinely a strong track record, not something everyone experiences. And getting real use out of the dental, vision, and spending card on top of that is exactly how those extra perks are supposed to work. MAPD plans tend to work especially well for people who also have Medicaid or other government benefits layered on top, since that combination often minimizes the cost side of the equation. It's worth noting MAPD plans are still required to cover everything Original Medicare covers — the prior authorization process some people run into is real and does trip some people up, but clearly hasn't been the case for you. Thanks for sharing your experience — it's a good reminder there are real success stories alongside the more difficult ones people sometimes hear about."

↳ @ikestevers (2): "I'm curious, if you wouldn't mind, to know what plan you're on.. ? Thx :)"

↳ @matthewtaylor6564 (0): "What kind of plan are you on in Massachusetts?"

"I love my Medicare Advantage plan."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgzhmKFiqCpry0QwWM94AaABAg>

↳ @mmb9775 (2): "As a cancer survivor I love my Medicare Supplement plan."

↳ @AbtInsuranceAgency (0): "That's great! Many people do."

'They told me it was covered' · 18 documents

"I am 66 and when I first retired I went with an Advantage plan and was happy with it until I needed it. I needed a Cat Scan for lung issues I was having and needed prior approval for the Cat Scan. The Advantage plan denied it and I spent three days on the phone back and forth talking to numerous people each day and never talking to the same person twice. After three days they said ok and I asked why they approved the Cat Scan and the person said they didn't know why but it was approved. The next renewal period I went with regular Medicare and Plan G. This year I was in the hospital intensive care for four days and needed no approvals and my only cost was my \$240. Deductible. My cost for the Plan G supplemental plan is \$158. a month and boy is it worth it for the peace of mind of not worrying about a big medical bill and pre approvals."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 65 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgxdvpDxXszYorK4pCx4AaABAg>

↳ @logicalblueberry (3): "That's awesome. \$158 per month seems very affordable. I was worried that it would cost several hundred per month. Seems like an easier choice than I was expecting then."

↳ @maido9434 (2): "Totally agreed with you . We had same problem. My husband has Parkinson's and had to pay a lot out of pockets after his 2 hospitalization . He had to pay \$250/ day for 7 days first and other co insurance fees . I luckily was able to change to Medicare supplement thus year after underwent medical underwriting process . I was very happy to be able to switch . However , I heard that Dr Oz will make Medicare advantage mandatory because the insurance can make more money . I hope this wasn't true . This video is on you tube ffrom one of the Dr !"

↳ @maido9434 (0): "Will you share with me what company did you go with for dental / drugs/ eyes insurances ! I do not like Cigna and United healthcare that I currently have now . Thanks in advance"

"I got tricked and switched to a Medicare advantage when they told me over the phone that all my medication's were covered they lied. Multiple weren't a year later. I switched back to regular Medicare. Good job that you didn't try it out."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · 31 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yflVCc&lc=UgzHq6cK4tHUxOcEFjt4AaABAg.AOmGYDg472zAOmUZITAtAk>

"I switched to Medicare advantage when they lied to me on the phone and told me all the medications I was taking were covered. MULTIPLE WERE NOT! A year later I switched back to regular Medicare never looking back."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · 12 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yflVCc&lc=UgyqXuqZdiY16Hpur3J4AaABAg>

↳ @mscoyote50 (1): "You're lucky. Once you're padt a year, you really can't switch back without underwriting and most of us older people have underlying "conditions"..."

'Don't answer, don't give them your number' · 18 documents

"I always say " here in the United States Medicare does not call people on the phone they just hang up."

— YouTube · Medicare Scam Call AGAIN! This is how I handle them. · 16 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hIDJ4XfKHJE&lc=UgzZ0Mq8BzLgQQ3bJPI4AaABAg>

↳ @michaelquigley7927 (1): "Good Advice Brian!!!"

"@71suns that is all I have. Plan A and plan B which I pay for plan B. Plan A is regular Medicare that covers hospital stays. I get bombarded with phone calls and text from insurance companies wanting me to get an advantage plan. I block them because I do not trust them. I am 75 years old and I am scared of the medical system. I don't trust hospitals or doctors. They're only there for the money these days."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage Plans Leaving in 2026 - 2,600,000 Seniors Impacted · 7 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8Pq6H7UZBbU&lc=UgxrrFVha096OaNtoNd4AaABAg.AMUWC5cfeMZAMXWPB_jarG

"Lmaoo I'm in health insurance (Medicare) as well so I have a ton of people asking me find in network providers. Yesterday I had 70 year old (non dementia/no POA) tell me that her bank isn't answering the phone and for me to give her her routing and account number or call her bank. She had never given me her bank information prior as that is not needed for Medicare applications, I told her that her best bet would be to "keep calling the bank"😂 "

— r/InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1txwn8g/insureds_are_grown_adults/oq0hj8m/

What they were told about penalties and signing up · 6 documents

"Soda Family! Nice video, since about 4 or so years ago when a family member who was disable needed a medicare plan I have been watching. At the time it was plan F through United healthcare (they claimed we could not get G), there is a penalty (complicated) received and the premium just went to \$520 per month. In the beginning I thought you were peddling advantage plans with all the comments on what supplements doesn't give you, thought it was an angle to upsell advantage plans, glad I watched. I have heard many advantage plans can and have dropped perks after a few years, put shiny object out there for people to bite then once you are unable to go on a supplemental no need to offer any longer. I'll take a look the SS, interesting. Note I know others that call themselves to insurance companies and are given incomplete (rather than lied too) and make bad choices as well, if you don't already probably not a bad video to put together. Thanks,"

— YouTube · Medicare Supplement Plan (Medigap) Premium Hikes and What You Can Do · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=7rHuyAmCtHY&lc=Ugz2elDZLXipkrpHiqF4AaABAg>

"I never signed up for Part D when I first signed up for SS and Medicare 17 years ago. I looked into adding it this year, and was told I would have to pay a penalty for 17 years, plus a penalty for each year going forward because I didn't sign up originally! That is crazy! Can you explain why? Luckily I'm 82 with only one prescription needed for high blood pressure. But I'm appalled."

— YouTube · Medicare 2027 WARNING: What's Changing With Part D Costs · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=VL9ka29qz8Y&lc=Ugzj1GZF7J6Y-TgcgG14AaABAg>

"Yes true. Now I told my wife she will need to wait until she is 65 in 2025 before she retires now that I know this penalty. But I wouldn't mind the higher premiums if I could make 2022 income every year 😊 Thanks for making the video and explaining. It was a helpful video!"

— YouTube · Medicare IRMAA (Everything You Need To Know) · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=WUaV8Eh6pKQ&lc=Ugx3XyFTARSz6OFj-Yt4AaABAg.9yLmxMxinME9yMKwfaSNz6>

Tab 5 — Frustrations

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Prior authorization and insurers second-guessing doctors · 481 documents

"Physical Therapist here. Absolutely keep your traditional Medicare with Plan N/G while you can. Medicare with a plan G is a Golden plan. Dr.'s and hospital love traditional Medicare. They won't be denied and you won't be denied care. Plus you can choose any specialist/provider you want and also go to the top notch hospitals in the whole country including Mayo, Johns Hopkins, Cleveland Clinic etc, etc, etc. In the end if you get really sick it's well worth it. I pay around \$450 a month including Part A and B premium. I worked all my life in healthcare to afford to access the best healthcare in our country."

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 595 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgxcFFuqvyczX0JtB0J4AaABAg>

↳ @ChrisRI1000 (135): "Plan G was a life saver. My wife contracted a rare autoimmune disease. The disease affected almost every single organ in her body requiring uncountable numbers of specialists. She has numerous expensive treatments and procedures, was intubated in a ICU for 12 weeks, etc. The hospital bill was way past the million dollar mark. I saw not one single bill from all that. When she died it threw me into this awful whirlwind having to deal with the loss, making arrangements, contacting numerous businesses, and all the fallout of her death. I can't imagine what it would have been like adding in every single bill to deal with, refuting charges, calling the insurance company due to denials (and the sick games they play), etc."

↳ @2BeeMe (66): "I had an advantage plan for 8 years. It worked great for the first 6 years until 2 of my doctors quit taking my insurance. My premiums were \$0 and I had gym and vision benefits. Things got tricky when I had an emergency and the closest hospital didn't take my insurance. I was in ICU for 5 days. Follow up visits with specialists and physical therapy were now a regular thing. Lots of copays. The next year I was diagnosed with cancer. I needed an oncologist for my type of cancer. I didn't get a choice of doctors. I went to the only one in my network. Again, lots of scans and copays. Last fall my insurance company notified me they weren't staying in business for 2025. It was a blessing! I was now guaranteed acceptance to get original Medicare with supplemental plan F (because of the date of part B start) without underwriting. Getting medical care this year is so much easier without networks, prior approvals and copays. You can go where you want to whatever doctor. If you can afford the premiums I recommend it. I've had both and there is no hassle anymore."

↳ @jenniferperry-pk5zt (32): "@ChrisRI1000sorry for your loss 🥹"

"Almost fell into that trap until I was warned by a person who's family member eventually died because of care that was denied to them because Medicare Advantage declined to pay for treatment because it was too expensive despite the recommendation of a specialist. While in the appeals process, the family member passed away. After doing some research on my own, I found that this had occurred multiple times with people on Medicare Advantage. Also, that many healthcare providers were now refusing to accept Medicare Advantage. Needless to say, I chose traditional Medicare. The gap premiums aren't cheap, but I have the "peace of mind" of knowing that I can receive the care/treatment recommended by my doctor. This shouldn't be happening to seniors who PAID into Medicare their entire working lives."

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 270 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9Id0w9OA&lc=UgwTr1OgGdvCFu3U5Fp4AaABAg>

↳ @CB-vg1wq (17): "@miriamlandau1207 You pay into both. On a W-2 social security withhold is in box 4. Medicare tax is Box 5."

↳ @ighdesigns (14): "The insurance companies are always just trying to outlast the patients."

↳ @miriamlandau1207 (3): "You are paying into Social Security not into Medicare."

"I spent the last half of my career working in the billing office for a medical specialist group. I dealt with everything from private insurance, worker's compensation, medicare, medicaid, etc. By a large margin, the problems I encountered with payment denials came from Medicare Advantage plans. And most of those happened because people did not understand the rules of their plans. Thanks for the informative video."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 232 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgwMop0zRDK1CKkLhJ14AaABAg>

↳ @pacmanc8103 (7): "Although, it would seem as though a lot of the issue is with provider groups not confirming Advantage plan coverage prior to treatment. It seems like pre-auths are needed - I'm not sure how most patients would even know how to communicate with insurance carrier or have the relevant information. Stuff only the provider could know."

↳ @Melanie-ix4nq (2): "I'm seeing the payment denials because of in proper billing to the insurance company (using the wrong code) I'm showing that on one of my claims in my portal."

↳ @SipLeila (1): "@Melanie-ix4nq That is common but it is often the nurse's fault."

Too confusing to compare · 456 documents

"I like the elephant. :) I had no idea how complicated and layered the system is. I've checked books out at my library on Medicare, researched online, talked to friends, and I recently discovered your channel. Your presentations are concise and logically structured. I was dumbfounded when I first started researching Medicare, I'm turning 65 in May, This is a great channel and comments are informative too."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement Plans (2026 Update) – Full Comparison · 240 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cxhlXrMrc5s&lc=UgzZx9D3ilHuxXtdoPR4AaABAg>

↳ @michaelparadis5483 (1): "Nothing was mentioned about high deductible plans for G and N. Also are there additional plans? L , M , others?"

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "Glad you found me! Thank you so much for watching and your kind words! 🐘 "

↳ @hoosier_daddy65 (0): "So Beth, what did you go with?"

"Erin, this is your best video ever! I'm coming up on age 65 and until now, I was feeling overwhelmed. Thank you, thank you, thank you 🙏 "

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 234 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=Ugz25KzjRIqEu63hww4AaABAg>

↳ @BirdandDiz1957 (13): "My wife and I chose a Medigap Plan N plan four years ago. Literally 2 months after beginning my Medicare journey I had a really bad accident that required the trauma unit, two surgeries and a blood clot issue. My total bill for all that and two weeks in hospital was \$86 after meeting the Part B deductible. I could have argued \$50 off that amount because they charged me that amount for the ambulance even though I was admitted. It wasn't worth going through the hassle. My wife is a cancer survivor so our broker strongly advised her to stay away from an Advantage plan. If you do go that route and then have medical issues and expenses get out of hand then you will have to go through medical underwriting and probably will not be able to switch to Medigap. Keep that in mind."

↳ @geraldarcuri9307 (11): "So, you're NOT going to sign up for an Advantage plan, right? A waste of money, and no choice of physicians or hospitals."

↳ @trackguy4038 (9): "I agree!!! Best video ever!!!!"

"As someone turning 65 next month this type of information is very helpful. The way they have set everything up could not be more confusing and inefficient."

— YouTube · Working past 65? Avoid these HUGE Medicare mistakes. · 129 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=evYI75xJnKg&lc=UgwddBLZOMhdw-fYFsl4AaABAg>

↳ @kimdagnillo8246 (9): "They do that on purpose, that's how they use their excuses on how you get penalized later on."

↳ @AbtInsuranceAgency (6): "Agreed! Glad this was helpful."

↳ @irenegriego2446 (5): "That's cause there forcing people on this cause they want your money"

Premiums that keep going up · 162 documents

"I work with Medicare plans, C, D and medigap. Advantage plans are very similar to employer coverage, but the population is much more vulnerable. Medigap plan premiums increase every year, some people pay \$800 a month for them. Plus you pay \$200 a month just to have part B. Also Medicare penalizes you if you go without drug coverage, which some people do if they don't take prescriptions. None of these plans in general are the problem, greed is. The government needs to regulate what these companies do if they have a contract with CMS. It doesn't matter what the options are if both the government and private sector use it to squeeze every last penny out of people. The government needs to do its job and serve the people. I look forward to the day I have to go back to being a CNA because healthcare is treated as a right, not a privilege. Until then, I will continue to try my best helping people navigate through a broken system."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · 68 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yfLVCc&lc=Ugxmge1MtXC6NQ_2EUN4AaABAg

↳ @Is-aka-Pari (2): "What do you do if you really can't afford any extra payment, say if your SSI is very low?"

↳ @cristianbaluta1232 (1): "The government is composed of a bunch of careless irresponsible incompetent people who are there for one goal only - to get all the money from those outside the government. To expect these people to do their "job" is naive bordering stupidity."

↳ @rachelisnosy (1): "@Is-aka-Pari Definitely apply for Medicaid. Some people only get their part B premium paid for, but that's still \$200 that you don't have to spend each month. Regardless of what type of plan you have, you can apply for a social security program called Extra Help. It will cap your drug copays at \$12.65, even if the drug costs \$2000 normally. I would recommend anyone without Medicaid, to apply for it. Don't talk to any of those people who cold call you. I would ask your doctor's office who they work with, they'll know which companies work with them the best."

"Medigap getting too expensive When I was eligible for Medicare in 2019, I picked a plan G policy because at the time I was getting at least 4 MRI's a year, seeing my oncologist 4 times a year, and doing physical/occupational therapy. My premium was around \$180/month with a projected rate increase of about 6% a year. It was manageable until my premium shot up to \$327/month in 2024. Last year it jumped up to \$459/month. The cost increase I'm facing in August is terrifying. I'm not entirely sure what to do at this point. I just know I can't keep this up, I'm sure the next increase will take more than half my SSDI."

— r/medicare · 60 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1tbdbvh/>

↳ (0): "Unless you live in a birthday rule state that allows you to switch plans, or you can pass medical underwriting (which is unlikely given your health issues), you're stuck with your current Plan G. If you're stuck, see if your current Plan G insurer will allow you to switch to HD Plan G (high deductible) without medical underwriting. Premiums would be dramatically less. Another option is to move to a Medicare Advantage Plan. Even that may not guarantee any savings because while the premiums are likely to be \$0, there are copays and coinsurance and an out of pocket maximum of \$9250. Given that your current premiums for Plan G are \$5500/year, and that is likely your only out of pocket expense, it might not make sense to move to a \$0/month Medicare Advantage Plan if you end up spending the max out of pocket of \$9250. Even with copays and coinsurance, you'd likely not hit \$9250 (the max out of pocket), but the real question is how likely you are to hit \$5500 (the cost of Plan G premiums). You'd have to look closely at what the out of pocket costs would be for whatever Medicare Advantage Plans you were considering. If you think the cost of copays and coinsurance would be less for Medicare Advantage than the premiums for Plan G, then switch. Of course, if you are low income, then you should also investigate Medicaid options, but just know the income thresholds are pretty low."

↳ (0): "If you really want to go Med Adv, and duplicate the original Medicare as best as possible, gotta go PPO for out-of-network support, and the OOP for that is \$13,900. In 2027 it will be in the neighborhood of \$14,800. Otherwise, one is stuck on networks with HMO. For most stuff that is fine. But, if it's the big C? I had enough money to afford PPO to expand choice closer to original Medicare. It's not really Medigap or Med Adv. It's Medigap, or PPO, or HMO. But, PPO only makes sense if one can operate the plan fully, and that does require a spare \$13,900, although there are cheaper combined OOPs for are PPOs. I saw a \$7400 ppo last fall."

↳ (0): "I'm not a Medicare Advantage nay-sayer, but it's worth pointing out that even with a PPO you can't necessarily go to any provider you want to. Some places don't take PPOs."

"The more my Plan N increases annually, the more I'm inclined (against my better judgement) to start looking at a Part C Advantage Plan instead. I went with Plan N because I believed in the idea of "Pay me now or pay me later", where I protected myself against high deductibles and annual outlays by paying a (reasonable) monthly premium. Sadly, "Pay me now" is becoming "Pay me a LOT more now, and every year until you die." Also, we need better oversight of these insurers. Offering low costs for a year and then inflating prices once you have attracted a bunch of subscribers should be illegal. Or at least a Medicare plan cost should be guaranteed for a reasonable amount of time. I would be much happier paying more when I sign up, knowing that my premium won't increase to shocking levels for years."

— YouTube · Your Medicare Supplement Premium Just Went Up... Here's What to Do. · 57 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CDMzMoErP-w&lc=UgxVyp4MBD-dEhPeZlh4AaABAg>

↳ @chevelleflorida (8): "To me, if one can afford a medigap/supplemental plan, that is the best option. The biggest issue with Advantage plans is the level of care that you will receive. For example, I know someone who had a heart attack and stroke last year and was referred to a SNF/rehab center. The MA plan was calling within 3 days talking about discharging the patient even though they were not ready to go back home. With traditional Medicare, that person likely would have received 100 days. Fortunately, moving to a SNF, creates a qualifying event to change insurance and we were able to move the patient back to traditional Medicare with a supplemental plan that they already had (Tricare for life.) In truth, the broker who signed them up for a MA plan did them a huge disservice. No one with a Supplemental plan should move to a MA plan."

↳ @Farrodee (5): "In two years my plan G went from 1500 to over 1800 per year. I don't even take any meds and rarely see dr!"

↳ @vanguy9780 (0): "@jaygrenham education is a wonderful thing. You should try it"

Part D: drugs dropped from the formulary, prices that jump · 70 documents

"People on Medicare advantage plans, what is your experience? So, I am planning for retirement and by FAR the largest line item in our future budget is healthcare, especially after Medicare kicks in. So I am just wondering...is medicare advantage adequate for you? Is there a lot of services/medications not covered at all that you need? Did you keep some of your same doctors or lose a lot of them? I have a pacemaker and a replaced heart valve (mechanical). I am on warfarin, atorvastatin (cholesterol med), and metoprolol satrite (blood pressure meds)....any one have issues with those on medicare advantage? Also, take sertraline (generic zoloft). Just weighing my options. Last questions....if you had to work an extra year or two in your early 60's to be able to afford medigap insurance (plan G)would you...or would you retire earlier? Why / why not? Thanks for your time and considerations. ,"

— r/retirement · 95 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/retirement/comments/1jddz0q/>

↳ (0): "Hey folks do note that we are conversational, not confrontational, here. Also - In order for us to read your comment- you need to be a member , Hit the JOiN button. These guidelines for our supportive and respectful community , can be see in the rules. Unfortunately, you have to dig a little for them via the landing page of our subreddit. Thanks and have a good day, MAM"

↳ (0): "I worked in Medicare insurance for years and still do so take my opinion with a grain of salt. There are benefits to both medigap and Medicare advantage, but overall medigap (also called Medicare supplement plans) have more benefits for most people. The biggest benefit of advantage plans being that a lot have a \$0 premium and include some dental and vision benefits and other benefits so I've seen very healthy people just turning 65 start with an advantage plan for the first few years and "roll the dice" so to speak on their health while paying \$0 monthly premium. The only issue is we don't know when our health will turn and like some comments, to switch to a supplement plan later, there is health underwriting that could disqualify you at that time. Advantage plans also have yearly out of pocket maximums that range anywhere from \$3000-\$8000 for anything not routine. Hence the "rolling the dice" comment. When first starting Medicare, you have an open enrollment period where you can qualify for any supplement plan with any company regardless of health, and a plan G for example will cover 100% of your medical costs after the Medicare part B deductible. (\$257 in 2025 but typically increases a bit each year) the monthly premium varies by state but for someone starting Medicare at 65 years old, you're probably looking at \$90-\$120/month. Also no networks, accepted in all 50 states the same."

↳ (0): "Don't go with an Advantage plan. Use straight Medicare and get a Medigap supplemental. Work as long as you can."

"Part D 2027 Increases Mine is going up 72%. Just a little bit more?? Are we winning yet? I have a semi-rare disease that requires specialty medications and already pay more than the average boomer."

— r/medicare · 87 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1wkq5nz/>

↳ (0): "**Thank you Mr. TV Doctor Sir! May I have some more please????**"

↳ (0): "My Wellcare Value Plan is going down to \$5.27/month, down from \$6.00."

↳ (0): "My wife is on that but it won't cover my specialty meds."

"The thing that gets me is after you chose a Part D plan and start using it the following January, the insurer mails you a report of what you have been buying and spending. The report mentions they can drop the drugs you are taking at any time. Which leaves the patient at the mercy of a Part D insurance plan dropping your drugs from their formulary any time they want. So what is the point of picking a plan based on their formulary when they can change it during the year?"

— YouTube · The \$9.8 Billion Medicare Subsidy Just Ended — Here's What Really Happens to Part D · 35 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=pfLyIplem30&lc=UgzhuPCRU98hddyASlx4AaABAg>

↳ @ggjr61 (10): "Unfortunately all insurance companies do this. I don't understand why this is allowed. I totally understand being able to change the formulary before open enrollment but I don't think they should be able to change it mid stream."

↳ @alansach8437 (4): "Yeah. You are stuck for a year. They are not."

↳ @youngtimer964 (0): "While this is technically true, it has never happened to us in 7 years of having Part D plans."

Doctors and hospitals dropping Advantage plans · 45 documents

"Almost fell into that trap until I was warned by a person who's family member eventually died because of care that was denied to them because Medicare Advantage declined to pay for treatment because it was too expensive despite the recommendation of a specialist. While in the appeals process, the family member passed away. After doing some research on my own, I found that this had occurred multiple times with people on Medicare Advantage. Also, that many healthcare providers were now refusing to accept Medicare Advantage. Needless to say, I chose traditional Medicare. The gap premiums aren't cheap, but I have the "peace of mind" of knowing that I can receive the care/treatment recommended by my doctor. This shouldn't be happening to seniors who PAID into Medicare their entire working lives."

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 270 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9Id0w9OA&lc=UgwTr1OgGdvCFu3U5Fp4AaABAg>

↳ @CB-vg1wq (17): "@miriamlandau1207 You pay into both. On a W-2 social security withhold is in box 4. Medicare tax is Box 5."

↳ @ighdesigns (14): "The insurance companies are always just trying to outlast the patients."

↳ @miriamlandau1207 (3): "You are paying into Social Security not into Medicare."

"You are definitely speaking the truth. I used to have Humana advantage program all of my doctors and all of my hospitals where I lived sent me letters telling they no longer accepted it. That was actually a blessing in disguise because I went ahead and went with original Medicare and then I got AARP United Healthcare is my supplement to my medicare. Everything has been covered 100% I haven't had to pay anything except the course the deductible at the beginning of the year which continually goes up higher and higher. My social security check what little bit you do get doesn't even cover how much it goes up. The price of the United Healthcare continues to go higher every year also. So yeah America is really screwing people big time but what do you expect for 40 trillion dollars in debt and nobody even gives a crap anymore"

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 210 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9Id0w9OA&lc=UgycBY5V27_Utvq5bkd4AaABAg

↳ @sct4040 (24): "I too, am on AARP UHC and will be paying \$333/month in 2027. That is so much money."

↳ @nealkshah (18): "Sounds like that "blessing in disguise" really did work out. Thanks for sharing the whole story."

↳ @edwinrodeo (15): "@sct4040... me 2 🤔. I'm in CT though.. open enrollment yr round. No underwriting required. Only 4 states has it."

"Another negative for Advantage plans is that hospitals in my area are refusing to accept certain Advantage plans. So if you have a doctor you like and he works out of a certain hospital you could find yourself looking for another doctor and hospital. I was on an Advantage plan but was able to get on Plan G because the hospital I use stopped accepting the Advantage plan I was on. I didn't have to get approved or pass any medical tests to go on Plan G since it wasn't my fault that my Advantage plan was no longer valid. Best thing that could have happened to me."

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 32 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=Ugx4MOWZuO_w_2-SLoV4AaABAg

↳ @tracyjohnson5023 (1): "Same here. The hospital still accepts advantage, but many doctors do not"

Under 65 and disabled: no Medigap, or an unaffordable one · 43 documents

"Medicare vs Medicare Advantage. My findings as I enter retirement. A few things I have found out since I have been researching the original Medicare vs. Medicare Advantage. I'm in no way saying that Medicare Advantage is bad. Some people prefer the Medicare Advantage plan over the original Medicare. 1. Medicare Advantage is a private insurance. When you sign up for Medicare Advantage, you are walking away from the original Medicare. 2. If you sign up for Medicare Advantage, and you are under 65, when you turn 65, you will be able to get back on the original Medicare with a medigap supplement. If you are 65 and older and you are on Medicare Advantage, that's when it gets difficult to enroll in a medigap supplement plan with the original Medicare. You will have to go through underwriting, and if you have anything preexisting, you more than likely won't be able to get that G supplement on the original Medicare. Plan G covers everything that Medicare Part A and B cover at 100% except for the Part B deductible of \$226. This means that you won't pay anything out of pocket for covered services and treatments after you pay the deductible. 3. When you enroll in a Medicare Advantage Plan you are essentially selling your traditional Medicare coverage to a private insurance company. 4. If someone tries to sell you "Medicare," ask them if it is Medicare Advantage Plan. 5. Insurance brokers make a commission of \$600. to enroll new members in the Advantage plan. They make \$300. To enroll you in the original Medicare. ** I was just informed that insurance brokers do not get commission when they enroll members in the original Medicare. 6. With an Advantage plan, you could have a yearly out of pocket as high as \$5,000 to \$10,000. With the original Medicare with a G supplement your out of pocket is \$226. a year, plus your monthly premium payment, depending on what plan you choose. 7. If you enroll in Medicare Advantage, you still pay the Part B premium amount, which is \$164.90. The \$164.9 is automatically taken out of your Social Security check. 8. If you are enrolling in Medicare Advantage, ask your agent/broker what happens if you travel out of state, and you need to seek medical attention outside of your network. With original Medicare, there is no network, and you have coverage in all 50 states. 9. With Medicare, you don't need prior authorization for a given service. Your doctor makes that decision. (I think you may need authorization with ambulance services though.) With Medicare Advantage, you need prior authorization to receive a service, and the insurance company makes the decision whether to approve or deny the service, not the doctor. 10. When you see a table set up at Walmart with a sign that says, "Sign up for Medicare here." That is Medicare Advantage. Medicare does not do that. The original Medicare will never call you to sell you anything and they will never visit you at your home. The calls and spam mail are from Medicare Advantage. TV ads with Joe Namath and J.J. Walker aren't from Medicare. That's a private insurance called Medicare Advantage. 11. If you see anything referring to a Medicare Part C plan, that is a Medicare Advantage Plan. That is not the original Medicare. 12. Read the fine print on Medicare Advantage's vision and dental plans. Vision and dental are not included in all Medicare Advantage Plans. 13. If you have the original Medicare, you don't need to renew it every year. Medicare Advantage will also renew automatically each year unless Medicare cancels its contract with the plan, or your insurance company stops offering the plan. On YouTube, subscribe to Medicare School, Christopher Westfall and Medicare on Video. Watch their Medicare vs Medicare Advantage videos. These videos are extremely informative to keep you informed while entering the retirement phase. Anyone, feel free to correct me if I've misstated anything or if you have anything to add to this post. I'm still learning and trying to gain knowledge to educate myself on this complicated subject."

— r/medicare · 81 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/141m9ym/>

↳ (0): "You need to consider the monthly insurance premium for the Medicare supplement, too. One reason many people sign up for MA is that they cannot afford the supplement premiums. Everyone pays the monthly Part B premiums, then on top of that, they may pay a monthly supplement premium, if they sign up for a supplement, and they will have drug insurance (Part D) premium, which they should sign up for even if they do not take medications now, to avoid paying a penalty later. If they sign up for MA, rather than a supplement, some MA plans, but not all, have a monthly premium. Drugs are included with MA plans."

↳ (0): "Thanks for the info. I'm making a file and adding new info as I go along. It's overwhelming!"

↳ (0): "5. The amount of commission an agent gets varies extremely from plan to plan, company to company, etc. Not set in stone at all like the numbers you have listed"

"I was on Medicare advantage for 15 years because I'm disabled and I was too young to get a supplement plan. I turned 65 last year and switched to original Medicare with a Humana plan G supplement plan. I'm thrilled with this. I did have to buy a separate dental plan. But I know I can travel anywhere in the United States and I have the same coverage. And I don't get nickel and dimed to death. And I don't have to get approval for tests and surgeries. And I'm not going to be dumped. FYI, it doesn't matter what insurance company you choose for your supplement plan. They pay exactly the same. So don't spend a lot of money getting a Blue Cross plan when you can get a Humana plan that pays exactly the same and is a lot less expensive. But I do recommend plan G."

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 60 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=UgyaUtMfHKYB03d_PGZ4AaABAg

↳ @pursuehealth940 (15): "@georgebranson9486 they can't cancel plan G. They can stop accepting all insurance from one company, or all Advantage plans from all companies, but they can't stop accepting Medicare insurance or supplements. It's federally mandated."

↳ @georgebranson9486 (4): "How do you know hospitals won't start cancelling plan G? And then what?"

↳ @sarahdee374 (3): "could you share appr what your supp plan monthly premiums are? I've been on an Advantage plan for years, and happy with it, and pretty healthy too. But now I'm scared, but also don't want a high premium to pay ongoing. Thank you for sharing your experience."

"Something you may wish to address is that in many states (including mine), if you're under 65 and qualify for Medicare through being on SSDI, you *can't* sign up for a Medigap plan. I was fully convinced Medigap was the right thing for me--until I found out that only plan A is available in my state if you're under 65, and its premium would be nearly \$1000/month. It's hard not to panic when your only option is the one that's being taken away."

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 11 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=UgzD2U3nrXQh12oLeV94AaABAg>

↳ @gurnblanston5000 (1): "That is high, like 4x more."

↳ @Dbb27 (1): "I'm paying \$1,200 a month for a family member that has medicare. He could get on Medicaid but none of his doctors take it. He does qualify for a Medigap but we are afraid to switch as his insurance has been very good. It's becoming unaffordable."

↳ @gurnblanston5000 (1): "@Dbb27Is that a Medicare C plan, as you mention switching?"

Agents and callers who push or mislead · 31 documents

"My agent pushed an Advantage plan from the start, but I wanted to stick with original Medicare with a Supplemental policy. A couple of years ago, I relented and said okay, go ahead and put my wife and I on an Advantage plan since he said 95% of his clients were on the plan. It must be good, right? Having 43 years in the property & casualty insurance business before retiring, I actually read the 200+ pages of the contract. I immediately called my agent and told him to rescind the Advantage plan and get me back on what I had. I later learned that after 7 years he no longer gets a commission from Medicare but would have continued indefinitely to receive commissions from the Advantage plan. My 7 years was up last year, and guess what, I haven't heard from him since. I would recommend that everyone stay with original Medicare, unless there is some compelling reason not to do so."

— YouTube · MASSIVE: Hospitals Are DROPPING Medicare Advantage Plans 🤖 · 81 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vn2k1W-JzB8&lc=UgzHCpaN2Z99tywzREh4AaABAq>

↳ @greyholcombjr.9623 (9): "I recently started original Medicare with a supplement plan N. If the day were to come I could no longer afford supplement premiums, I could move over to a Disadvantage plan during open enrollment without being concerned about medical underwriting. I would probably take out a reverse mortgage on my home to continue affording supplement premiums before I would do that though. I would buy a HDG supplement plan before a Disadvantage plan. I do not want a insurance company having that much control of my healthcare decisions. I don't buy my health insurance for the shiny distracting objects of vision, dental, gym memberships and such either. @johnyracercat"

↳ @johnyracercat (8): "I'm an agent. I explain the options and yes, 95% choose an Advantage Plan because they cannot afford or do not want to pay the Supplement costs and PDP, plus dental, RX, etc. Most Supplement clients will need to reprice to a better rate sooner than 7 years anyways. Supplements will continue to raise their rates as well. It sounds real good at \$125mo. How will you feel when you're Supplement is \$500mo and your drugs are \$400mo higher on the PDP? Suddenly, the Advantage Plan you hate will start looking very tempting. Plus it will cover your dentures? What? Sign me up. Unless you are wealthy, you will get priced out when you really need it."

↳ @mhlovelady (0): "I can understand perhaps 50% choosing the Advantage plan, but NOT 95% unless they are being steered to that. My experience with agents that just sell price is that they are not doing their customers a favor. I once heard a wise agent say that a doctor that makes a mistake may kill you quickly, but an agent that sells you the wrong coverage is like slow death financially. @johnyracercat"

"One of the better explanations of the difference. I noticed several agents here push Plan G very heavily. My wife and I see a doctor twice a year, so co-pays don't bother us. We would have to have three doctor appointments a month to make up the difference in plan prices. Good job."

— YouTube · Medicare Plan G vs Plan N (New Info!) · 19 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SP2JABN8RL8&lc=UgwpXUF5t2zyH94bLlx4AaABAq>

↳ @gianmatt1930 (10): "Don't the brokers make more money on the more expensive plans? Of course they do. That is why they are all pushing plan G. This nice person on the video is honest. It's appreciated."

↳ @AbtInsuranceAgency (4): "Thank you! And yes, some brokers right here on YouTube won't even sell or discuss other options besides Plan G."

↳ @AbtInsuranceAgency (3): "@gianmatt1930 thank you! 😊 "

"IMO - I feel that insurance Medicare agents/brokers who push this scam on clients should be investigated. It's my understanding that the agents are compensated for at a higher rate for enrolling seniors on the Advantage Plan. At the very least customers who enrolled in the Advantage option should be allowed to change back to the traditional one at no penalty to them."

— YouTube · HUGE Medicare Supplement Rate Increases (and what to do about them) · 4 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ah1bzQtPBRQ&lc=UgzcjY71Bi2WAeUiyGt4AaABAq.A7yD_2SFDkoA8AiNVaa-oS

Calls, mail and TV ads that never stop · 23 documents

"Medicare vs Medicare Advantage. My findings as I enter retirement. A few things I have found out since I have been researching the original Medicare vs. Medicare Advantage. I'm in no way saying that Medicare Advantage is bad. Some people prefer the Medicare Advantage plan over the original Medicare. 1. Medicare Advantage is a private insurance. When you sign up for Medicare Advantage, you are walking away from the original Medicare. 2. If you sign up for Medicare Advantage, and you are under 65, when you turn 65, you will be able to get back on the original Medicare with a medigap supplement. If you are 65 and older and you are on Medicare Advantage, that's when it gets difficult to enroll in a medigap supplement plan with the original Medicare. You will have to go through underwriting, and if you have anything preexisting, you more than likely won't be able to get that G supplement on the original Medicare. Plan G covers everything that Medicare Part A and B cover at 100% except for the Part B deductible of \$226. This means that you won't pay anything out of pocket for covered services and treatments after you pay the deductible. 3. When you enroll in a Medicare Advantage Plan you are essentially selling your traditional Medicare coverage to a private insurance company. 4. If someone tries to sell you "Medicare," ask them if it is Medicare Advantage Plan. 5. Insurance brokers make a commission of \$600. to enroll new members in the Advantage plan. They make \$300. To enroll you in the original Medicare. ** I was just informed that insurance brokers do not get commission when they enroll members in the original Medicare. 6. With an Advantage plan, you could have a yearly out of pocket as high as \$5,000 to \$10,000. With the original Medicare with a G supplement your out of pocket is \$226. a year, plus your monthly premium payment, depending on what plan you choose. 7. If you enroll in Medicare Advantage, you still pay the Part B premium amount, which is \$164.90. The \$164.9 is automatically taken out of your Social Security check. 8. If you are enrolling in Medicare Advantage, ask your agent/broker what happens if you travel out of state, and you need to seek medical attention outside of your network. With original Medicare, there is no network, and you have coverage in all 50 states. 9. With Medicare, you don't need prior authorization for a given service. Your doctor makes that decision. (I think you may need authorization with ambulance services though.) With Medicare Advantage, you need prior authorization to receive a service, and the insurance company makes the decision whether to approve or deny the service, not the doctor. 10. When you see a table set up at Walmart with a sign that says, "Sign up for Medicare here." That is Medicare Advantage. Medicare does not do that. The original Medicare will never call you to sell you anything and they will never visit you at your home. The calls and spam mail are from Medicare Advantage. TV ads with Joe Namath and J.J. Walker aren't from Medicare. That's a private insurance called Medicare Advantage. 11. If you see anything referring to a Medicare Part C plan, that is a Medicare Advantage Plan. That is not the original Medicare. 12. Read the fine print on Medicare Advantage's vision and dental plans. Vision and dental are not included in all Medicare Advantage Plans. 13. If you have the original Medicare, you don't need to renew it every year. Medicare Advantage will also renew automatically each year unless Medicare cancels its contract with the plan, or your insurance company stops offering the plan. On YouTube, subscribe to Medicare School, Christopher Westfall and Medicare on Video. Watch their Medicare vs Medicare Advantage videos. These videos are extremely informative to keep you informed while entering the retirement phase. Anyone, feel free to correct me if I've misstated anything or if you have anything to add to this post. I'm still learning and trying to gain knowledge to educate myself on this complicated subject."

— r/medicare · 81 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/141m9ym/>

↳ (0): "You need to consider the monthly insurance premium for the Medicare supplement, too. One reason many people sign up for MA is that they cannot afford the supplement premiums. Everyone pays the monthly Part B premiums, then on top of that, they may pay a monthly supplement premium, if they sign up for a supplement, and they will have drug insurance (Part D) premium, which they should sign up for even if they do not take medications now, to avoid paying a penalty later. If they sign up for MA, rather than a supplement, some MA plans, but not all, have a monthly premium. Drugs are included with MA plans."

↳ (0): "Thanks for the info. I'm making a file and adding new info as I go along. It's overwhelming!"

↳ (0): "5. The amount of commission an agent gets varies extremely from plan to plan, company to company, etc. Not set in stone at all like the numbers you have listed"

"I see the Medicare advantage commercials on TV everyday and how they are misrepresented. They only point out the pros and never explain the cons. Being a past Chartered Life Underwriter, I am surprised the Insurance commissioner lets this slide."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 27 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=UgxYsyXZ2F7QRC7SUXB4AaABAq.9ZDCYdipbst9ZH9zAtTFD2>

"I won't ever enroll in a Medicare Advantage plan just for those annoying commercials they bombard us with every year"

— YouTube · Why Medicare Advantage Plans are Bad (or Are They?) · 27 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SM3ypQamgls&lc=UgwdnumgTKxINNtbPp14AaABAq>

↳ @stephenlan5450 (2): "And people from India call too"

↳ @BoomerBenefits (2): "Those commercials can be frustrating!"

↳ @ahbeemarie7451 (1): "Commercials??? I turned 65 april1st. I HAD to pick a plan. I did. I STILL receive unsolicited phone calls from insurance companies....at LEAST 25 a day. I have to keep my ringer off at all times and every day block and delete these calls."

Dental, vision and hearing 'coverage' that pays little · 19 documents

"One more thing, folks.... yes, Medicare is supposed to cover dental now, I think. But if they see the prefix "perio" on anything, you are NOT covered. As our gums deteriorate over the years, treatment for them in any way is not covered by anyone. I don't think there is such a thing as dental insurance anymore, and if there is, it is a pure ripoff because it will be capped at around \$2,000. Anything after that is all yours and it will be a lot. What they do have now are "dental discount plans." But no coverage for any periodontal work. If a dentist even LOOKS at your gums, be ready to cough up some major bucks. And even with a dental plan you will pay big, big bucks if you need any kind of major work, like a bridge or an extraction "by a specialist." You bet I'm angry. After working since 1971 full time in IT (information technology) and made good money, and maxed out my 401k contributions - guess what, after the big recession, what is left is not enough to live on. I am very surprised that our president, with all the tariffs, and everything else, has not done much for the everyday people. Along with huge rent and utility payments, with electricity and water going sky high for AI data centers, more people than ever will never be able to afford a good Medicare plan."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 16 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFZkg&lc=Ugy4dlmjy8eYocHABU14AaABAq

↳ @bellaclyde (2): "Trump has trumped us all"

↳ @namllenum00 (1): "@bellaclyde better than Biden, just care to put money in his pocket and cover for his family. leave politic out please"

↳ @raulhodge3314 (0): "Quit watching the 6:00 news propaganda"

"My Blue Cross Blue Shield, Medicare advantage plan that had good coverage and dental was good too for 2025 now it's gonna cost more for crappy coverage in 2026. It upsets me"

— YouTube · Big Medicare Advantage changes for 2026. · 11 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=73mR9YGZHS&lc=UgzXkzmRgEgwGwnMzn14AaABAq>

↳ @toecutter7683 (0): "PPO in 2025 was good. HMO in 2026 not as good"

"As a licensed agent, I absolutely agree. I understand why mapds exist, because not everyone can afford a supplement, let alone part b premium. I will also like to point out however, that sometimes, especially in areas of Florida, there are great mapd plans out there. The fact of the matter is, most people don't venture out seeking multiple doctors, and rarely seek routine service out of their service area. Heck, most people wouldn't even know what to do if they are diagnosed with chronic condition. I am slowly warming up to mapds because those who live in hardships, and have health conditions have no other choice. Original Medicare needs to be increased because besides that part d and part b premium, never mind the ancillary "not covered" services like vision, hearing or dental (what a joke)"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 8 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=UgwIBspUINt_ZTfu8bN4AaABAq

↳ @akita96th (0): "You haven't had to shell out the \$7500 out of pocket expenses yet....That will wake you up."

↳ @stuntmasta305 (0): "@akita96th this is pretty much the norm for most private healthcare coverage under 65. Not including Aca, or Medicaid. For those on OM, it goes on forever, unless you have a supplement that you pay anywhere between 100-300 a month, plus a separate part D with no dental, vision or hearing in consideration. There are plans with considerable less MOOPs, not uncommon in populated areas to have moops as low as 800. The ugly side of mapds isn't always the cost, but the utilization management."

↳ @akita96th (0): "Like I said its all fun and games until you really get sick then they put the screw on you. All I am saying is those who say they can't afford a supplement will realize when they get sick that maybe they could have afforded it after all once those out of pocket bills start piling up. It is a shame seniors have to live like that in this rich country thanks to the republican party. Any senior citizen on a fixed income who votes republican deserves all the misery old age can muster. MAGA does not love you back."

'Free' benefits that are a rip-off · 14 documents

"My mother is in her 90s and has dementia...along with many health issues.. my mother has a medical advantage plan with one of the largest insurance companies...I would never recommend it a Medicare advantage plan especially if you have a lot of medical issues.i have been taking care of my mother for the past 10 years.. the insurance companies fight you every step of the way..they send you used equipment... they limit you to 5 days of physical therapy ..2 of the 5 days are for evaluation purposes...so you only get 3 days of physical therapy.. you always get rejected if you appeal for more therapy..the doctors in network are very bad and very few choices... or they leave network because of low reimbursement . If you are a healthy person medical advantage plans are good...but if you need medical therapies such as PT.. forget it... I am 65 am based on my experience with my mother..I will never sign up for an advantage plan....its a bait and switch game that the insurance companies play... advantage plans are a scam!!"

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 90 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgzpRDIIAYWVYI35q2x4AaABAq>

↳ @johnphillips4342 (10): "All the celebrity promotional advertising is very misleading. These people, although they are over 65, probably are not on an MA plan. The money to promote the MA plans on TV and provide the higher compensation to agents to steer people to those plans comes out of the funds that Medicare pays the carrier to provide medical care. Thus, the networks, prior authorizations, referrals, and denials of care to compensate for the costs to promote the programs. Yes, it's a scam and one our wonderful Congress cooked up and keeps giving support for."

↳ @gordonallen9095 (6): "Agreed. Medicare Advantage = Death Panels."

↳ @ClintFletcher-eu8tn (4): "Medicare is no paradise either. My Mom fell at age 95 and needed physical therapy. The hospital discharged her because they did not want deal with the low Medicare payments. My mother was unable to walk, but they discharged her anyway. I had to carry her about the house until she was able to start walking some by herself."

"anyone that is 65 and over must pay for medicare cost that is paid from social security, about \$175 a month. the 20% supplement can cost \$150 a month , plan G and goes up each year with United Health Care. So annually, one pays \$1800 plus the annual deductible of \$240, or \$2000 a year for health insurance. no co-pays and no other expenses to see the doctor or ER visits after the annual deductible is paid, \$240. the original medicare pays up to 60 days in the hospital. 60 days is a long time. In most cases, one will be discharged within 60 days. From age 65 to 75, most seniors would not be staying in the hospital for long periods of time. the goal is to make appointments to see the doctor and do preventive care. take advantage of the plans. the part that I have a problem with is, medicare advantage can change its policy and they are for profit. the medicare advantage tangle carrots like free stuff , some dental work, glasses, and partial payment for hearing aids. plus gym membership which are available on some supplements. some medicare advantage plans do not pay if you leave the network. when the original medicare, I can go to any ER and do not need to worry about a co-pay. with advantage plans, there are doctor visit co-pay and ER co-pays and drugs cost money, with kaiser advantage plans. if one starts with the original medicare, you are guaranteed , no need to qualify. if you start with an advantage medicare plan with zero to little monthly fee with some free stuff, if you wish to go back to the original medicare plan, you have to be screened and qualify. the questions, do you wish to pay \$2,000 a year that gradually increases with the annual \$240 deductible , then unlimited doctor visits and ER visits? or be nickled and dime with office visit cost, ER cost , and subject to having the advantage plan approving your bill with possible surprises? I have to make a choice soon, nothing is free in life. All I know, I am currently paying \$1000 a month with kaiser and it cost me \$\$\$ for office visit, lab work and if I need to go to the ER. if I have to have a test performed, I have to still pay. So the \$200 a month supplement is reasonable with the original medicare. Again, Nothing in life is FREE, especially when our congress is swayed by private insurance companies trying to get a larger piece of the business. I hear many horror stories with private advantage medicare plans. they surprise Americans with large bills since the coverage does not pay for certain treatments. IMO"

— YouTube · Original Medicare vs. Medicare Advantage: What's the Difference? · 30 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=weO1WkquA3s&lc=Ugzaix7JeWu8Hgkw-fB4AaABAq>

↳ @ESMEE_4EVERR (0): "Jvgknftiokfpmgibdhcujjgbjgg"

↳ @AIH-p2u (0): "I'm surprised you think it's okay to pay 2400\$ a year plus dental plus vision plus medication and think it's everyone's best option. Many ppl are healthy and can save 2400\$ etc for 5-10 yrs then go into a chronic plan with little max out of pocket saying you thousands but if you're ill and have my doctors then supp is the way to go UHC offers both mapd pdp and supp I am contracted with them"

↳ @bozomonster (0): "The math doesn't workout in your if your paying \$1,000 per month to Kaiser. The max out of pocket with a Medicare Advantage Plan is \$5,000."

"Great explanation of the two options. I wanted to add my experience. I started with original Medicare. I was then attracted by the extra benefits of the Advantage plans like dental and vision, so I switched. About 11 months in, my cardiologist wanted to perform a diagnostic procedure, but the pre-authorization was denied. I decided to switch back to original Medicare, and in my state, I was fortunate that my original Medigap insurer would accept me back without medical underwriting. As soon as I was covered by my Medigap plan, I had the diagnostic procedure done. It revealed that two heart arteries were 100% blocked, and a third was 80% blocked! The cardiologist and heart surgeon both said I was lucky I did not have a heart attack. Those extra benefits in the Advantage Plans are not worth my life. I never would have imagined an insurance company denying a cardiologist's request. I am curious how many patients have suffered and/or gone broke under an Advantage plan." — YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medigap at 65: The Real Costs Most People Don't Understand (Clip) · 9 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=M9hEKbgJg2w&lc=UgzatdULLbThq980Ddl4AaABAg>

↳ @stargazer-c5v (0): "Nope you won't go broke with an advantage but you will with the medigap. I guess you had the money to pay an extra \$500 plus copays. Well bully for you. What we need is government medicare for all not a for profit medical system. Imagine if firemen came to your house looked at your fire insurance and said oh your policy doesn't cover your house just the property so we have to let it burn. You Americans are so blinded by greed and me bot attitude that you let the rich eat you"

↳ @gerryglauser2394 (0): "Alternately, I've had an Advantage plan for well over a decade. Before choosing a plan, however, I looked into their record. A year ago my cardiologist wanted multiple heart diagnostic procedures, which were done. In addition to AAA scans and others, I never had anything denied."

The government's part in it: rules, cuts and mandates · 14 documents

"Don't just verify your doctors are in network. Check with each doctor to make sure they will accept your new advantage insurance. Two dentists in my network refused to accept my new insurance when I turned 65 and switched from AARP dental insurance to Medicare advantage. Turns out they don't have to take your insurance, even though they're "in network". Also, if you get a part d after turning 65 you'll get hit with a penalty premium based on age that never ends. What the government is doing to Medicare is horrible. The people who have worked all their adult lives and now need it the most are the ones suffering."

— YouTube · Big Medicare Advantage changes for 2026. · 573 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=73mR9YGZHS&lc=UgyHNddHO9eG9zZ5XTh4AaABAg>

"LEAVE advantage plan OR RISK YOUR LIFE. WARNING: Medicare Advantage Plans Can Delay Care With No Consequences Please read this carefully—your health and your life could depend on it. I just found this out on Friday after speaking with an attorney. If you have a Medicare Advantage plan, you are NOT protected if your insurance company delays your care in bad faith—and right now, you have no legal recourse. I found this out the hard way. UnitedHealthcare's algorithm delayed my cancer treatment for five months. When I first found a lump in my neck, my cancer was stage one. By the time I was finally able to get treatment, it had progressed to stage three. Five months lost. Five months where the cancer spread. Now, I am left with irreversible side effects and a permanently diminished quality of life. These are facts. It's public knowledge if you do the research. I recently spoke with an attorney who confirmed my worst fear: Because of a 2023 Supreme Court upheld with the ruling listed bellow. You CANNOT sue a Medicare Advantage provider for delaying your care for BAD FAITH. The law was made in 2023. (The California Supreme Court's decision in Quishenberry v. UnitedHealthcare) -2022 Read that again. They can delay your treatment for as long as they want. They can deny and restrict access to life-saving care. And you have NO legal way to hold them accountable. If I had traditional Medicare or a standard insurance plan, I may have been protected. But under Medicare Advantage, patients have no rights when insurance companies prioritize profits over their lives. And if you think this is an accident, think again. These companies are making billions from Medicare Advantage while rationing care and exploiting legal loopholes that shield them from responsibility. Look up how much they've profited—while patients like me suffer the consequences. It's public record. You have until March 31st to switch back to straight Medicare if you are currently enrolled in an Advantage plan. Do your research before it's too late. I am looking into a class-action lawsuit, and I will be writing to my state senator—because this is criminal. No one should be forced to endure what I have. Please—share this information. Protect yourself. Protect your loved ones. The system is rigged, and right now, patients are paying the price!!!"

— r/medicare · 152 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1jcgwz2/>

↳ (0): "I have Stage IV cancer with Original Medicare and Medigap. Everything has been covered with no issues since my diagnosis. Your experience is a nightmare and echos what I've heard from other cancer patients. Some patients have no issue with Medicare Advantage but some experiences have put people's lives in jeopardy and I applaud you for telling your story."

↳ (0): "Are your bills higher? New to Medicare and need brain surgery. Soon. I was going to pick an advantage plan due to medical bills, seeming like they would be lower with advantage versus medigap. But now I'm thinking, after this post and your comment, for my current situation medigap would be smarter. This is all so confusing to me. Any advice I'd appreciate. Thank you."

↳ (0): "With our medigap G we only pay the \$257 deductible per year. Our monthly medigap plan cost my husband \$160 per month. He has lymphoma and gets ct scans 2x per year, pt scans, mri, specialists, all at no extra charge and no hassle. Unless you are healthy and don't need more than a physical once per year, I would recommend traditional Medicare and the medigap G."

"Nope. I'm not willing to pay 50 or 60 % in taxes, plus if you think the government can run the Healthcare system completely without terrible consequences it is delusional. Medicare is bad enough no need to destroy what we have with communism."

— YouTube · BIG Medicare Changes Coming in 2027 — What You Need to Know · 13 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nXXywC4myaw&lc=UgynxtJNTyb5jbGSrtl4AaABAg.AaWwDvQmkg7AaX3q99wjlu>

IRMAA and the Part B premium · 11 documents

"As a licensed agent, I absolutely agree. I understand why mapds exist, because not everyone can afford a supplement, let alone part b premium. I will also like to point out however, that sometimes, especially in areas of Florida, there are great mapd plans out there. The fact of the matter is, most people don't venture out seeking multiple doctors, and rarely seek routine service out of their service area. Heck, most people wouldn't even know what to do if they are diagnosed with chronic condition. I am slowly warming up to mapds because those who live in hardships, and have health conditions have no other choice. Original Medicare needs to be increased because besides that part d and part b premium, never mind the ancillary "not covered" services like vision, hearing or dental (what a joke)"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 8 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=UgwIBspUINt_ZTfu8bN4AaABAg

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"CLIFF. I know someone who has been paying IRMAA from day one, he is far from being angry. His Medicare premium is still MUCH CHEAPER than his individual health premium before 65. As far as he's concerned he's laughing all the way to the bank."

— YouTube · Medicare IRMAA: What Most Retirees Get Wrong About Their Premiums · 4 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=w1PM7D2XD84&lc=UgxD49_MZE_85aUXK_F4AaABAg

"My wife will turn 65 in November of this year (2024), she just received (today 10/10/24) the letter from Social Security tell her that she will be getting charged for Part B next month in Nov. and if she wants to appeal it she has 60 days from the date on the letter to do so. In the meantime they will be deducting approximately \$174 which she will not get back after she cancels, how can they get away with that when she never consented to be covered by Part B, THIS IS SO INFURIATING. And to top it off the letter says she has to contact them by writing a letter, I can cus but I will refrain from doing so. Oh yeah, did I mention that she is on Social Security Disability, how does that work."

— YouTube · Medicare Part A B C D Explained (and made simple!) · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=sshK1P7qko&lc=UgxVLeGAKK5z5D3r5x14AaABAg>

Insurers' profits, CEOs and Advantage overpayments · 7 documents

"Thank you for this video. I worked for a medical billing company as a surgery medical coder, assigning procedure and diagnosis "codes" for insurance claims. Patients would tell us their stories as they tried to maneuver through the paperwork to try and get their insurance to authorize the surgeries their doctors said they needed to have. My own PCP had worked for an insurance company reviewing claims for medical necessity. When she was hired, they told her she literally had to deny a certain percentage of claims to keep her job. She said she couldn't do it, the claims all met their medical necessity guidelines so she quit in disgust. When it was time for me to go on Medicare I went with a Plan G. Does it cost me more in premiums than an Advantage Plan? Yes, but it is worth it. I know it is the best choice in the long run and I never need to stress over the shameful process of pre-authorization, knowing if the insurance company had a choice between their profit and my life, they'd let me die without so much as a thought. I've even heard of cases where the patient was told to wait until the next "quarter" of the year to ask for authorization and of one patient whose pre-authorization was put off until the following calendar year. It all affects the profit they show to investors, after all, health insurance is BIG business. Personally, I will find a part time job if money to pay the premiums (currently \$129 month not including the \$\$ withheld from my SS check) for my Plan G ever becomes an issue. Piece of mind is priceless."

— YouTube · 2 New Devastating Medicare Advantage Stories · 26 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Plzy4A7HxHg&lc=UgxlzKqLKsUUTpu94IR4AaABAg>

↳ @threefr3349 (6): "An amazing story, thank you for sharing that. I am not of age yet for Medicare. When I worked for an imaging company, I briefly sat by the authorization dept. I was shocked of some of the conversation my co-workers had with elderly patients. The shocker, a person trying to explain, why their insurance company denied their Pet scan, and they had a history of cancer. That test was medically necessary, to determine continue course of treatment for their cancer. Doctors don't have the staff or time to fight these lengthy denials, so it's left for the patient to fight. Unfortunately it's a steep almost impossible hill to conquer"

↳ @MedicareSchool (0): "So thrilled to hear that we can be so helpful. Thank you for sharing this we appreciate it so much! Happy to hear that you are getting the coverage and treatment you deserve!"

↳ @Itsgettingcrazy. (0): "@MedicareSchoolWould you recommend a person who is retired and turning 65 stay on their private insurance or get on Medicare part A and B? One person told me if I wasn't working, I had to go on Medicare? I'm happy with my plan. My husband passed 18 years ago and I was able to stay on his insurance."

"Healthcare for profit is a joke. The majority of people that go bankrupt from medical bills have insurance - so it's a worthless joke. The ACA are taxpayer funds funneled to wall-street. Tying health insurance to work is a joke. McDonalds doesn't provide insurance and tax payers have to subsidize these monopolies. Let GOP policies play out and run on healthcare for all 2028. I haven't had health insurance through work since the early 1990s. Paid in for almost 1/4 century and went to the doctors once. Should have gone without. I was paying over \$1,000 per month a decade ago for worthless insurance. So I went the last 10 years without any health insurance, saved over \$120,000 and retired early (58). I'm 66, have Medicare, went to the docs and all is fine."

— YouTube · Expiration of ACA subsidies will have 'ripple effects' in health care and economy · 11 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xOrWISxntkQ&lc=UgxxkDNx8AImb_D8Novh4AaABAg

↳ @bobbear4437 (0): "The insurance you talk about isn't the ACA, it was bankruptcy care that is where we're headed again, you get sick, you go bankrupt, you'll never have anything to leave to your children!"

"Plan G is costing me over 440\$ + drug coverage separate another 125\$ + Medicare monthly fee - ridiculous - half of my ss is going to greedy insurance companies that have record profits, while the undocumented illegal aliens that never worked a day in their life in USA get this for free from our overtaxed system - what i also find ridiculous is that plan g changes rates depending on your zipcode - if you live in a more colorful community the rates are significant lower verses a white one - many years i've been hearing about white privilege and systemic racism -but never imagined i'd be a victim of racist system with no special civil rights to protect my whiteness."

— YouTube · High Deductible Medicare Plan G: The "Secret" They Don't Tell You About! · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=YFEb0FiEpB4&lc=UgwwpYDKQJoJuIBDSbB4AaABAg>

↳ @MedicarePlanFit (2): "I'm not sure how to respond to this comment, but Medicare supplements can get expensive."

↳ @janc8199 (0): "It sucks, I'm praying this administration means what it says getting cost down, but we wont see it until 2027. Crossing fingers, because it's so damn expensive and confusing."

On hold, transferred, given wrong answers · 6 documents

"They not only change tears of the medication they also change the price of the medication at their whim. One month you could pay \$9.00 and next month it cost you \$30.00 for the medication. When you call for explanation you don't get any answers from customer service or they provide you with phone number that is not in the service any longer. They are all thieves, liars and crooks. They will bleed us every year more and more. They are in business for only their own profits. \$600.00 out of my SS goes to cover all the mandatory Medicare programs to be just covered not including copays and cost of the medications. I am managing three different autoimmune diseases, SLE Lupus, Sjogren's syndrome and Thyroid disease."

— YouTube · UPDATE: Medicare Part D Subsidy Program ENDS - What Happens Next? · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t7l_bhhxH9w&lc=Ugza8BzMqSbV0DL-SUp4AaABAg

"I started doing research on Medicare during my first week and knew them and there I was a scammer I only worked for 3 days and pulled off one scam which I didn't know at the time what I was doing fully and I seek forgiveness everyday because of the guilt but you know what at least now I work at a restaurant I make an honest living even if it ain't much. They paid people ~500 Egyptian pounds per scam which is like \$10 now but it's still heavy money over here and basically they just hire you to get social security numbers so that the people who are running the call centres and take all your money it's disgusting yet so common"

— YouTube · IT'S A SCAM! A DAY IN THE LIFE! How Many Medicare Scam Calls Can I Get In One Day... HA! · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=32GR2F0y4IY&lc=UgwcfdKR976zRjaE-IR4AaABAg.AB6DntD4cXuABoHmVwgGd9>

"But the thing is they're old people on the phone who simply can't understand what's happening because of how ridiculously complicated Medicare is to begin with. I started training with them stupidly thinking we were customer service for Medicare since I haven't been to america and didn't know Medicare isn't a private company then I actually started working there still not understanding 100% if this is a scam but then being on the floor there with everyone working it just felt really really odd"

— YouTube · IT'S A SCAM! A DAY IN THE LIFE! How Many Medicare Scam Calls Can I Get In One Day... HA! · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=32GR2F0y4IY&lc=UgwcfdKR976zRjaE-IR4AaABAg.AB6DntD4cXuABoHObw-bM6>

Tab 6 — Previous Solutions

Theme	Documents
Chose an Advantage plan	1,180
Chose Plan G or Plan N	704
Part D plans, GoodRx, Cost Plus and Canada	279
Stayed on an employer, union or retiree plan past 65	217
AARP / UnitedHealthcare	176
Agents and brokers (and the commission question)	166

YouTube channels, seminars and their own research	158
VA, TRICARE and federal retiree coverage	156
High-deductible Plan G	102
Kaiser and staying inside one health system	102
Medicaid, Extra Help and Medicare Savings Programs	89
Changed Medigap carriers to escape a rate increase	51
Medicare.gov, SHIP counselors and Social Security	32
Appealed a denial or filed a complaint	32
Switched from Advantage back to Original Medicare + Medigap	24
Called a number from TV, the mail or a cold call	22
Self-insured: Original Medicare with no supplement	17
Switched from a supplement to Advantage (usually for the premium)	9

Chose an Advantage plan · 1,180 documents

"Thank you. I turned 65 this summer and I was inundated with Medicare Advantage paperwork. Intuitively after doing more research I decided to stick with regular Medicare and I'm so glad you covered this. I was led to believe I had to enroll in a Medicare Advantage plan and I'm soooo glad I didn't. The program is designed to deceive you into signing up with zero understanding of what the risks are especially since I'm disabled with a rare spinal cord disease. I feel like I dodged a bullet and I'm going to share this information everywhere. I believe you saved people's lives with this piece."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · 895 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yflVCc&lc=UgzhQ6cK4tHUxOcEFjt4AaABAg>

↳ @sunflower9611 (31): "I got tricked and switched to a Medicare advantage when they told me over the phone that all my medication's were covered they lied. Multiple weren't a year later. I switched back to regular Medicare. Good job that you didn't try it out."

↳ @ammalestie509 (31): "THANK YOU JOHN OLIVER! Medicare Advantage is a scam. Stick to traditional Medicare (with an extra Medigap program) if you can! At this time of year, watching "old people TV", every other commercial is about switching to Medicare Advantage, and some of these commercials are two minutes long, which seems like an eternity."

↳ @edg3048 (24): "Stay out of the Advantage stuff. BCBS has always been good as a supplement. Insurance in this country sucks."

"I came off a supplement to an advantage plan about 5 years ago for two reasons affordability and our good health. We enrolled into a HMO-POS plan for 2026. Of course before the switch we verified all of our providers were still in the plan. Zero premium and \$4800.00 MOP. Which is thousands less than the previous plan. I've saved in premiums over the 5 years over 18K. And wer still healthy."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage Plans Leaving in 2026 - 2,600,000 Seniors Impacted · 888 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8Pq6H7UZBbU&lc=UgyH9WhhAjCLI7lrkMt4AaABAg>

↳ @Johnsonadam_6652 (1): "Exactly.It's a calculated risk. I did the same, but a major health event last year showed me the holes in my "cheap" plan. The out-of-pocket max became a real number fast. That \$18k in savings vanished in medical bills."

↳ @AmirKazan-n2l (1): "What professional looks at healthcare and investments together?Most treat them separately."

↳ @ReeceCook-r7o (0): "Smart move saving on premiums.That \$18k can compound. The risk is the plan's network stability. A provider leaving or a new diagnosis can change the math overnight. You're betting on continued health."

"I am 64 and received my medicare card. As a senior citizen trying to go through the maze of medicare plans is enough stress to kill anyone. One must ask themselves why is medicare so hard to navigate that private insurers send out their so called medicare advisors to steal our money? I have decided to decline Part B and I will definitely not sign up for the Advantage Plan that I know all too well it will kill you in the end. I will cancel my Federal blue Cross Blue Shield insurance that is almost \$400 a month now that I have only used on four occasions in 21 years. I'd rather die than give one more cent to a broken health care system. When property insurance, health care insurance and auto insurance takes over 50% of a retired citizen income, I call that a crime. The only reason we are the wealthiest country in the world is due to the fact that private companies have been stealing money from the hard working middle class folks and became richer with the money they stole from us because the law makers got their kick back money and we got kicked in the back."

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 811 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9Id0w9OA&lc=UgwoFkaXMEaOiRM1oYh4AaABAg>

↳ @mlyt3153 (24): "I agree that it's incredibly confusing to understand all of the implications when choosing a plan."

↳ @christinereich6050 (16): "Don't give up the Fed blue cross and blue shield! Just don't take Medicare Part B"

↳ @fnhc2023 (16): "Well said, doctors over order and duplicate tests ALL the time.....private advantage tries to prevent waste cuz they have money but not unlimited like the government. Make sure u know when buying Gap how much they increase each year. God help us all"

Chose Plan G or Plan N · 704 documents

"I had switched from Advantage to Plan G because I'm totally risk-averse. Good thing I did. Out of the blue, I got neurological symptoms that made it impossible to type, write, knit, hike, or even walk my dog. (Fast forward several months--turns out they were caused by the neurosurgeon who treated me 15 years ago). Because I live in a part of the country with very poor medical coverage, my PCP referred me to a university medical center in another state. I got first class care--surgery, hospitalization, home health all were billed to Medicare at over \$350K. I paid nothing. If I had been on Advantage, I most likely would have been limited to the surgeon who caused my problem in the first place. And next week I'll go hiking with my dog for the first time in over a year."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 270 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgxCXf6P2_bAdYu1Q_l4AaABAg

↳ @Theretirementnerds (9): "Thank you for sharing your experience 🙏 Glad to hear you'll be able to walk your dog again soon! Hope recovery is going okay!"

↳ @elizabethb.1693 (4): "That's awesome! 🙌👏"

↳ @clairemckayhart1109 (3): "Thank you for the elephant advice, coming up on 65 and retirement."

"Sunburn. Thank you. During my working years I had a Co pay for my HMO high deductible insurance. When I retired I learned about plan G and found it less than what I paying at work. Since my retirement my wife had open heart surgery and knee replace to and a broken arm. I have prostate cancer and ulcerative colitis. If I would have had an advantage plan it would have financial devastated us. When I bought plan G I bought it not for how I felt at the time, but for when I was sick. Advantage plans come in my mail every day trying to switch me over. Never get mail for plan G. That should tell you something in itself."

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 249 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=UgyPSeGJnpazbrQ0VB94AaABAg>

↳ @RolandHolubec (0): "Nobody knows anything; You need to create your process, manage risk, and stick to the plan, through thick or thin, While also continuously learning from mistakes and improving..."

↳ @KristýnaKalová-t8q (0): "Appreciate that. I just looked her up and she seems highly regarded. I've been meaning to fine-tune my drawdown strategy, so this might be the right time. Thanks for pointing me in a solid direction!"

"My wife had been complaining of shortness of breath for about six months before finally talking to her doctor in late August. The doctor had an EKG done, which was normal, and then ordered a CT scan of her heart. In September she was diagnosed with severe aortic stenosis, (bad aortic valve), which has a 50% mortality rate within two years. She then had a cardiac catheterization done to see if her heart was healthy or if she needed bypass surgery. Her arteries were clear and an appointment was made for an open heart valve replacement. The open heart surgery with valve replacement was done in the first week of November. The total cost of everything was \$207,000. Our out-of-pocket cost was \$280, part of which was the part B deductible. We have original Medicare with Plan N and a Part D prescription plan. I believe if we had an MA plan we would still be waiting on prior authorization if she survived long enough."

— YouTube · MASSIVE: Hospitals Are DROPPING Medicare Advantage Plans 🤖 · 212 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vn2k1W-JzB8&lc=UgzevbXaSuoWX4WCW814AaABAg>

↳ @RonMac08 (18): "@nealjones84 She's doing well, recovering quickly."

↳ @nealjones84 (13): "Congratulations 🎉 how is she doing now after major surgery"

↳ @ckstaff (13): "Sooner or later you get to realize and feel how smart you were in choosing right. If you did have advantage, she may have died waiting or you would now be bankrupt paying a huge out of pocket. I witnessed first hand a friends husband die in bed with Leukemia when he was sent home after 1 day in hospital because the advantage company had their loophole as to why they would not pay. He spent the next 3 weeks fighting denials and appeals in his soon to be deathbed. He died before he ever got approved."

Part D plans, GoodRx, Cost Plus and Canada · 279 documents

"What pisses me off is... I did not sign up for prescription drug plan when I signed up for Medicare at age 65 because I wasn't taking any drugs. Later I was convinced to take the part D coverage. Then I find out I will have to pay a monthly penalty amount of \$18.00 for the rest of my life to the drug companies because I did not enroll in part D when I signed up for Medicare. (I am now 82 years old, in good health, and still do not take prescription drugs). It's a rip-off."

— YouTube · Working past 65? Avoid these HUGE Medicare mistakes. · 312 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=evYI75xJnKg&lc=UgwYnNkAm7dPfm_ViEZ4AaABAg

↳ @OLDGUY7301 (25): "People go talk to a medicare agent. ITS FREE."

↳ @flufwix (21): "I agree, the penalty is a rip off"

↳ @jimroscovius (13): "Why didn't you know that? You've got to research and find out those things. That was in the first mailing I got about Medicare. Also, if you're in good health, you should take Medicare Advantage, which includes a drug plan."

"My wife had been complaining of shortness of breath for about six months before finally talking to her doctor in late August. The doctor had an EKG done, which was normal, and then ordered a CT scan of her heart. In September she was diagnosed with severe aortic stenosis, (bad aortic valve), which has a 50% mortality rate within two years. She then had a cardiac catheterization done to see if her heart was healthy or if she needed bypass surgery. Her arteries were clear and an appointment was made for an open heart valve replacement. The open heart surgery with valve replacement was done in the first week of November. The total cost of everything was \$207,000. Our out-of-pocket cost was \$280, part of which was the part B deductible. We have original Medicare with Plan N and a Part D prescription plan. I believe if we had an MA plan we would still be waiting on prior authorization if she survived long enough."

— YouTube · MASSIVE: Hospitals Are DROPPING Medicare Advantage Plans 🤖 · 212 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vn2k1W-JzB8&lc=UgzevbXaSuoWX4WCW814AaABAg>

↳ @RonMac08 (18): "@nealjones84 She's doing well, recovering quickly."

↳ @nealjones84 (13): "Congratulations 🎉 how is she doing now after major surgery"

↳ @ckstaff (13): "Sooner or later you get to realize and feel how smart you were in choosing right. If you did have advantage, she may have died waiting or you would now be bankrupt paying a huge out of pocket. I witnessed first hand a friends husband die in bed with Leukemia when he was sent home after 1 day in hospital because the advantage company had their loophole as to why they would not pay. He spent the next 3 weeks fighting denials and appeals in his soon to be deathbed. He died before he ever got approved."

"Retirement and Dealing with Cancer Costs It is not a pleasant subject, but it is important to talk about it. According to WebMD, 30% of seniors aged 65-74, 19% of 75-84, and 8% over 85 get cancer. Within the last 2.5 years, I've had three different cancers, and I retired at the same time. It can be expensive. I thought I would share my experience dealing with the costs. The three cancers I've had to contend with are Mantle Cell Lymphoma (blood cancer), Squamous Cell Carcinoma (skin cancer), and prostate cancer. Mantle Cell Lymphoma is incurable. In my case, my oncologist advised me to delay treatment as long as possible since it always comes back and is harder to treat each subsequent relapse. I was on a "Wait and Watch" monitoring program for over two years with blood tests every 3-months and a scan every 6-months. The monitoring showed it had progressed and required treatment, which I started earlier this month. I'll have 6-months of chemotherapy / immunotherapy followed by 2-years of less intensive "maintenance" therapy. Over the last couple of years, in addition to the chemo treatment, I've had numerous blood tests, PET scans, CT scans, biopsies, and doctor appointments. For the skin cancer, I had a blob of Squamous Cell Carcinoma cut off my face using the "Mohs" procedure, and another much smaller spot shaved off the tip of my nose. I've had multiple visits with the surgeon and other specialists, and I will require skin checks every 6-months because of all of the per-cancerous lesions that keep popping up. The prostate cancer was detected during a PET scan for the lymphoma. However, after a follow-up MRI and biopsy (lot of fun), it was determined that I have the least aggressive form of prostate cancer which does not need immediate treatment and can be managed with "Active Surveillance". I am told it is slow growing and I have about a 50% chance of needing treatment in the next 10 years. I will be monitored with blood tests, MRI scans, and possibly additional biopsies in the years to come. As you can imagine, all of these tests, procedures, and treatments are very expensive. I had always planned on retiring the day I turned 65. However, I was diagnosed with the lymphoma when I was 64 and I decided to work an extra 10 months after I turned 65 (until the end of the year) because: 1) I had already met the out-of-pocket maximum for the year for my work health insurance; 2) my job was very supportive and allowed me to take time off as needed; and 3) my wife would be in a better position financially if things didn't go well for me. I had plenty of time to learn about Medicare, which I started in January 2024 when I officially retired. There are two ways to get Medicare: Original Medicare or a Part C Advantage Plan. With Original Medicare, you really need to also have a Medigap Supplemental Plan and a Part D prescription drug plan. There are several options for a Supplemental Plan. I chose Plan G, which covers everything except an annual deductible. For 2025, the annual deductible was only \$257, which I probably hit within the first 15-minutes of my first appointment in January. Everything else is free for the rest of the year. I should point out that, if I had been on my work group health insurance plan, I would have incurred several thousands of dollars of costs each year until I hit my out-of-pocket maximum. Compared to an Advantage Plan, the premiums are higher with Original Medicare and a Supplemental Plan G, but you don't have any restrictions of which doctors are in your network, and you don't have to worry about insurance company pre-approval. In addition to lower premiums, Advantage plans also include perks such as dental, vision, and maybe even a gym membership. Many people are very happy with their Advantage plan, and may save money with the lower premiums. However, based on my experience, I think Original Medicare with a Supplemental Plan G is preferred if you have a serious illness such as cancer, and you can afford the higher premiums. I pay \$185 for Medicare Part B, \$209 for my Supplemental Plan G, and \$17.50 for my Part D prescription plan. Dental and vision I pay out of pocket. The main benefit of Original Medicare with a Supplemental plan is I've never had to worry about insurance company pre-approvals, or whether my doctor accepted it. In general, I think it is wise to get the best insurance that you can afford."

— r/retirement · 161 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/retirement/comments/1liorgh/>

↳ (0): "Plan N offers the same coverage as plan G except excess charges (which aren't allowed in my state anyway) and there is a \$20 co-pay for an office visit and \$50 co-pay for an emergency room visit. The savings with N will cover over 20 co-pays per year based on the rates I was quoted. It is also expected that premium increases with N will be less than G since plan G is the guaranteed issue plan."

↳ (0): "Good point. Even with all of my appointments, I don't think I ever went over 20 in a single year. If I did, it wasn't by much. Plan N is a good option for those just starting Medicare. Unfortunately, I'm in Massachusetts and this plan is not available."

↳ (0): "Agree whole heartedly on the Medicare supplement plan. My husband is currently undergoing cancer treatment at MD Anderson. He has tonsil cancer, which is an uncommon type of cancer. We came to Houston from Oregon because MD Anderson is an NCI cancer center that treats thousands more cases of tonsil cancer than the one NCI hospital we have in

Oregon. We wouldn't have been able to do that with an Advantage plan. It may be that our local hospital would have been fine managing his care, but we're much more confident in the care plan and speed of treatment he's been getting at MD Anderson."

Stayed on an employer, union or retiree plan past 65 · 217 documents

"For a lot of people Medicare at 65 is a blessing. We couldn't wait. My wife had been putting off hip replacement surgery for years due to high deductibles and copays with our employer's plan. On Medicare (and G Supplement) all we paid was the part B deductible of two hundred and some odd dollars! It was life changing for her."

— YouTube · Reasons to DELAY Medicare Past 65 That Will Save You Thousands and Avoid ALL Penalties · 315 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=L2goGwp4Co8&lc=Ugw5192ygARS776lv554AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (25): "Agreed! We tried to show this in the middle section. For many, Medicare is better coverage at a lower cost than what they were experiencing before 65 😊 "

↳ @pgpc6448 (12): "So glad! Your wife deserves it!"

↳ @sfstucco (0): "I'm truly sorry to hear about your situation. No one should have to experience these dilemmas & delays. I'm curious — how many, here, in these unfortunate situations vote Red (Republican)? Not to start a fight or pretend to be superior, but I hope people realize that universal coverage/socialized medicine goes a long, long way to relieving these burdens, financially speaking and logistically speaking. It would cut costs SO, so much if we had a Medicare-for-all (i.e., for all who select it) scheme, from birth to death. There are variations that can include some copayments (or not), depending on how it's structured. But expense, experience, and health outcomes are greatly superior in countries with socialized medicine, in all its forms. Democrats want that."

"Being able to enroll in traditional Medicare (A,B,D,G) and to start collecting Social Security allowed me to walk away at age 65 from my shitty employer and company health insurance to change focus from an unfulfilling career to pickup the creative arts I had to put on a back burner to make a living has been truly liberating."

— YouTube · Reasons to DELAY Medicare Past 65 That Will Save You Thousands and Avoid ALL Penalties · 155 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=L2goGwp4Co8&lc=UgxhLZ_kuIW3Z9_7ZN4AaABAg

↳ @Pelican5077 (10): "Great post. Knowing we had SS and Medicare on the horizon allowed us to quit working full time at age 55, sell our house (at a loss), take the wife's pension early (at a discount), and move onto our gracefully aging 35 ft sailboat with a 5 year plan to see the world. 13 years later we are still in the boat. We supplemented our small income stream along the way by doing all sorts of different jobs which was a fantastic experience. We don't do that anymore but (until the inflation debacle) we were able to save about 25k per year over those 13 years. It's been a blast and although we are approaching 70, our goal now is to continue our nomad lifestyle for another decade if we can. I get not taking Medicare if you are still working and have employer coverage. Or if you're a 1%er. Otherwise it's a no brainer IMO."

↳ @dgc590 (2): "So you worked for a shitty employer? That's your own fault. You chose to stay."

↳ @NuggetMaven (1): "Hope this new chapter in your life is transformative! 🍷 🍷 🍷 "

"OK. Now I am just turning 65 and I have some things to add. My wife was 71 when I had to retire to take care of her. When I did so, I lost my health insurance. I enrolled in COBRA and it was damned expensive. Had I known then what I know now, I may have chose differently. Both insurances together were 1600 a month, which is a horrible price to pay, but it was an approved plan so she slid onto part B with no problem. Here's the thing. She went to the hospital and the finance people were telling me that BCBS was the primary and Medicare was the secondary, this is just information. COBRA through your former employer is the secondary payer and Medicare is primary payer. Hope this helps when choosing what to do. It doesn't matter now. RIP Linda B. 07/16/23 I miss ya baby. Thanks for 45 years. It was worth everything we went through. (I made a couple of edits because I made some mistakes on the post. Thanks to youtube for allowing me to edit. 🙏 "

— YouTube · Working Past 65? Medicare Mistakes You Can't Afford To Make! 🙏 · 59 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4GtRppYTHho&lc=UgzLz7ljSVYL8z78XYJ4AaABAq>

↳ @zebragiraffe1 (10): "You must have been a great husband. Sorry for your loss."

↳ @MedicareSchool (2): "My team would be happy to assist you. Give us a call at 800-864-8890 or schedule an appointment at www.medicareschool.com"

↳ @djmydlack (1): "Hi. Thanks so much for posting. Could you say what you'd done differently? My wife is dying of ALS and I may be forced to retire to care for her. Thank you."

AARP / UnitedHealthcare · 176 documents

"Medicare Advantage is a Scam: My experience almost a decade in the Healthcare industry I was inspired to go into some detail after an AskReddit post about dirty insider truth that most people won't know. I replied that, as a person who who's worked in the medical field for a little over 9 years, saying that Medicare is leagues better than Medicare Advantage and Medicare Advantage is a scam. I've worked in a Home Health Agency, an inpatient rehab (SNF), a doctor's office, and am currently an RN working inpatient rehab. Hopefully, people will find this interesting or helpful \- Admissions for SNF: First medical jobs was admissions primarily to fill short term rehab beds. I had a website of all the people discharging from local hospitals who needed inpatient therapy, I would reach out to the hospitals, say we had a bed available, they would confirm with me, I would get the paperwork, get insurance authorization if needed, and greet the patient once they arrived and sign papers Medicare patients: I was told to try and get as many traditional Medicare patients as possible. I asked my boss why and she said that they pay the most and they always pay. I never once had to get insurance authorizations for traditional Medicare. The people could just come in! It covered the most therapy per day vs any other insurance(an hour a day vs. 30 minutes a day usually), including every Medicare Advantage. It automatically covered the first 20 days, then the next 80 days after that, I think it was like 60%. But if they had a secondary insurance, it would cover 100 days at 100%. Medicare Advantage: First off, once you get a Medicare Advantage plan, it's not traditional Medicare anymore, it's the insurance company now. Of you want to come to our facility, you don't get the grace of just walking in. I'm sure they've streamlined everything now, but we had to call a number, present the diagnosis in certain code numbers, wait for an authorization number, and then we could let you in. From there, you'd maybe get 20 days at 100% with half the daily rehab, then after 20 days, they were done. it covered nothing. Patient was 100% responsible for all costs. \- Home Health Scheduler My 2nd job was scheduling a team of Therapists and Nurses to different homes in my city who needed home health. I'd get a stack of referral papers every morning and was told to get them scheduled. For example, a referral would say "Medicare A: Needs RN and PT services", and then I'd contact my staff and arrange a schedule. I would also work with my staff and the patients that needed anything rescheduled. I was essentially the Guy in the Chair Medicare: Let's say that of my 3 referrals I had that morning 1 was traditional Medicare A, once was a UHC Medicare Advantage, and the other a Humana Medicare Advantage. Once again, I was told, "Staff the Medicare patients first!" And once again, I asked why and was told that Medicare always pays, and it always pays the most. I wasn't working directly with insurance at that job, so I can't comment on authorizations or cost. But Medicare patients generally had more RN and PT visits per week than any Medicare Advantage. Usually 3 days per week for each with Medicare, and 2 days a week for any Medicare Advantage. Also, there are longer sessions with Medicare. usually an hour vs 30 minutes Medicare Advantage: Just less care. Less staffing days and shorter sessions. \- Doctor's office: Next job I had before my RN was in a primary care physicians office. I only worked the front desk, but I worked right next to the referral coordinator, so I knew everything that was happening about that Medicare: From a cashiers perspective, Medicare never had a copay while many Medicare Advantage plan did. From a referral perspective, Medicare was so much easier. I don't think I ever saw Medicare rejected a referral claim. It was always quick, and as long as we filled the paperwork out properly, it was approved. Also, most specialists took Medicare, so usually patients could go where they wanted. Medicare Advantage: There was always an authorization process. it often involved scanning and sending documents, then waiting for approval. Generally it was a longer process that resulted in much more rejections than traditional Medicare. Also, one again, because Medicare Advantage isn't Medicare anymore, it's whatever insurance company has it now, the patients were stuck with whatever doctors they had plans with, and it was always a much smaller list than Tradition Medicare. I've been an RN for about 4 years now, so I am very separated from the insurance side, thank God! DISCLAIMER: Some Medicare Advantage plans are competitive with the benefits of traditional Medicare, but they are often very expensive. Some people are very happy with their Medicare Advantage plans, but I wanted to share my perspective, and my experience. But, this is also why I am greatly in support of expanding Medicare to cover all People in the US. We have the means to give the people proper Healthcare, we just need to do it"

— r/HealthInsurance · 472 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1sl2x0z/>

↳ (0): "Reminder to get a supplemental plan with your traditional Medicare. A medigap plan. Also reminder to get your part D plan. Everything you said is spot on but leaves out those couple things that are very important. Everyone I know turning 65 I tell them get your traditional Medicare A and B and then get your D and Medigap. But that sounds really confusing to people which seems to be why they think it'd be 'easier' to just get a Medicare advantage plan to 'do it all'."

↳ (0): "I did research for 2 month on my spare time when I chose my mom's plan last year. And this sub was so beneficial because of so many people sharing their experiences. I chose her A,B,D an G Extra. I feel really bad they make it sooo

complicated. I can't imagine being 65 and having to deal with this nonsense."

↳ (0): "The current administration is pushing MA plans; they want to get out of the Medicare business and just pay the \$\$ to the private insurers instead. I think more people need to be aware of this & put a stop to it. As an elderly person, you don't want a for-profit company making care decisions for you."

"You are definitely speaking the truth. I used to have Humana advantage program all of my doctors and all of my hospitals where I lived sent me letters telling they no longer accepted it. That was actually a blessing in disguise because I went ahead and went with original Medicare and then I got AARP United Healthcare is my supplement to my medicare. Everything has been covered 100% I haven't had to pay anything except the course the deductible at the beginning of the year which continually goes up higher and higher. My social security check what little bit you do get doesn't even cover how much it goes up. The price of the United Healthcare continues to go higher every year also. So yeah America is really screwing people big time but what do you expect for 40 trillion dollars in debt and nobody even gives a crap anymore"

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 210 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9Id0w9OA&lc=UgycBY5V27_Utvq5bkd4AaABAq

↳ @sct4040 (24): "I too, am on AARP UHC and will be paying \$333/month in 2027. That is so much money."

↳ @nealkshah (18): "Sounds like that "blessing in disguise" really did work out. Thanks for sharing the whole story."

↳ @edwinrodeo (15): "@sct4040... me 2 🤔. I'm in CT though.. open enrollment yr round. No underwriting required. Only 4 states has it."

"I have the AARP UHC Supplemental Plan plus a Prescription Plan. I pay just over \$100 a month for my prescription plan. Purely by accident I discovered I pay double for my prescriptions using my insurance vs being uninsured. My CVS charge for my 90 day prescriptions was about \$45 but using a Good Rx card which I pay just over \$20 for the same prescription."

— YouTube · Medicare Supplement Plan (Medigap) Premium Hikes and What You Can Do · 120 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=7rHuyAmCtHY&lc=UgwIJVVWWtbq6iZbBBJ4AaABAq>

↳ @juanestopin3250 (16): "I live in a State where you can switch annually with a different carrier for your plan as long as it's the same letter, without underwriting..but because of this the premium is higher"

↳ @gdpoppe52 (10): "I just shopped plans on the government website. Put in your current meds and review plans that take those medicines. I pay \$17.50 and have very small out of pocket expenses. Also i do not have any major health problems."

↳ @ssa8479 (5): "Then the time comes to sign up I'll have to look for the cheapest Part D plan. For now my one generic prescription costs \$10 for a 90-day supply. The good thing would be that one can pick a different plan every year."

Agents and brokers (and the commission question) · 166 documents

"I have been a Medicare insurance agent for over 40 years I am 68 and now on Medicare... I chose a Medicare Supplement"
— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 290 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgyTKgkxTkTMhUiMNFN4AaABAq>

↳ @lindadavidson7328 (60): "@mont5584because the advantage plan is shit unless you're healthy till death"

↳ @lindadavidson7328 (44): "Me too , I was an agent too and I pick the supplement plan"

↳ @constancerobinson1377 (21): "I spent three weeks in the hospital with nursing home offered afterwards I had another ct scan after I got home along with two MRIs. I have not been turned down for any procedures and I'm very happy with getting extra money for over the counter drugs, 48 one way transportation to and from medical appointments and hospitals, dental work, eye exams and glasses and even gym membership. My friend has Medicare w a supplement and doesn't get any of the above and pays co-pays. I also don't have co pays Needless to say, I'm very happy with Medicare Advantage Dual healthcare with United."

"As a 79 years old person, I have worked with my Medicare Broker 10 years. I cherish and trust him as much as my Tax accountant, Investment Broker, Insurance agent, Veterinarian, Physician, car repairman, Apple Help line. How could I survive if not for their guidance? Yes, they make money off of me, but the mistakes I have made in the past were disasters. No more stressful nights nearly in tears because I did not understand the ins and outs of this complex world."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage Plans Leaving in 2026 - 2,600,000 Seniors Impacted · 120 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8Pq6H7UZBbU&lc=Ugw3E0Y7_DI2bpu859V4AaABAq

↳ @incorrigiblycuriousD61 (10): "@sandrashort1221 How did you find a trustworthy Medicare broker? I have no idea."

↳ @Floridabruce1960 (6): "@sandrashort1221 Where do you find a medicare broker?"

↳ @brucewilson6694 (5): "@sandrashort1221 I'd like to know too! This is the first time I've heard of a Medicare Broker."

"My agent pushed an Advantage plan from the start, but I wanted to stick with original Medicare with a Supplemental policy. A couple of years ago, I relented and said okay, go ahead and put my wife and I on an Advantage plan since he said 95% of his clients were on the plan. It must be good, right? Having 43 years in the property & casualty insurance business before retiring, I actually read the 200+ pages of the contract. I immediately called my agent and told him to rescind the Advantage plan and get me back on what I had. I later learned that after 7 years he no longer gets a commission from Medicare but would have continued indefinitely to receive commissions from the Advantage plan. My 7 years was up last year, and guess what, I haven't heard from him since. I would recommend that everyone stay with original Medicare, unless there is some compelling reason not to do so."

— YouTube · MASSIVE: Hospitals Are DROPPING Medicare Advantage Plans 🤖 · 81 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vn2k1W-JzB8&lc=UgzHCpaN2Z99tywzREh4AaABAq>

↳ @greyholcombjr.9623 (9): "I recently started original Medicare with a supplement plan N. If the day were to come I could no longer afford supplement premiums, I could move over to a Disadvantage plan during open enrollment without being concerned about medical underwriting. I would probably take out a reverse mortgage on my home to continue affording supplement premiums before I would do that though. I would buy a HDG supplement plan before a Disadvantage plan. I do not want an insurance company having that much control of my healthcare decisions. I don't buy my health insurance for the shiny distracting objects of vision, dental, gym memberships and such either. @johnyracercat"

↳ @johnyracercat (8): "I'm an agent. I explain the options and yes, 95% choose an Advantage Plan because they cannot afford or do not want to pay the Supplement costs and PDP, plus dental, RX, etc. Most Supplement clients will need to reprice to a better rate sooner than 7 years anyways. Supplements will continue to raise their rates as well. It sounds real good at \$125mo. How will you feel when you're Supplement is \$500mo and your drugs are \$400mo higher on the PDP? Suddenly, the Advantage Plan you hate will start looking very tempting. Plus it will cover your dentures? What? Sign me up. Unless you are wealthy, you will get priced out when you really need it."

↳ @mhlovelady (0): "I can understand perhaps 50% choosing the Advantage plan, but NOT 95% unless they are being steered to that. My experience with agents that just sell price is that they are not doing their customers a favor. I once heard a wise agent say that a doctor that makes a mistake may kill you quickly, but an agent that sells you the wrong coverage is like slow death financially. @johnyracercat"

YouTube channels, seminars and their own research · 158 documents

"I won't be 65 until June 2024, but have been doing a lot of research about this topic. I have watched several videos by others that explained the difference between the 2 ways to go, but had yet to find one that I felt comfortable passing on to my other 64 year old friends. My search has ended. Yours is the most even-handed, non-emotional one out there. You aren't just parroting the biased views of others."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 485 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgzEumJESs7gZho7ZUR4AaABAq>

↳ @JohnJohn-wr1jo (51): ""Better than nothing" until you develop a serious medical issue and start racking up denial of service for treatments that your doctor orders. A lot of health groups are no longer taking "Disadvantage Plans" for this reason. Their liabilities increase exponentially due to the sub par treatment they are limited by MA plans. It's becoming a huge issue in many areas. Seniors are dying prematurely every day because of these plans. Medicare Advantage isn't medicare.... It's privatized insurance that the companies are making double the profits vs Medigap plans. It's by far the biggest scam of all. The government is paying between \$1200 to \$1800 monthly per person on these plans. Guess whos supplementing this waste. Those of us on regular Medicare."

↳ @Theretirementnerds (22): "This means a lot! Thank you so much for taking the time to watch and share! 🐦 "

↳ @robertporter6659 (6): "Spike has given you 2 barks out of 3 , for your good work. 🐶 "

"My brother-in-law jumped onto Medicare Advantage despite my advice against it. Early on he bragged about the "stuff" he was getting from his insurance plan. He eventually was diagnosed with fourth stage pancreatic cancer. He fought the cancer for two years and fought his Advantage insurance provider for those two years through waiting for authorizations and thousands in out-of-pocket expenses when he consulted an out of network renowned cancer center. He survived one week following that visit. His widow had to fork over the money to the cancer center. My wife and I are on original Medicare with a supplemental plan I carried with my employer at retirement. She was diagnosed with Breast cancer. Her surgery, radiation therapy and a year of chemo pulled her through it. We had no issues with approvals and not a penny of out-of-pocket expenses. The advice to stick to original Medicare came straight from Medicare representatives during a pre-retirement seminar I attended fifteen years ago."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement - NEW cost comparison · 68 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t7XBSZaPx5E&lc=Ugwz7ggeVWwtwy1nUs14AaABAg>

↳ @nsatutor635 (12): "I've heard that Advantage is a POS and as scammers, they shouldn't be in business. They're like the roach motel. Once you get in, you're not only stuck but will die. Sorry for your loss. These for profit companies don't give a F about anyone but their bottom line."

↳ @ZipaDeeDooDahDays (10): "This doesn't make sense to me honestly. I have gone through all of this and my understanding is you can SWITCH plans every year depending on your healthcare needs. You are NOT stuck in one plan or the other. You always look at your health situation each September and make the proper choice in October for what you will need Healthcare Advantage is EXCELLENT for people that doesn't have health issues and also are on a limited budget. I have the GIVEBACK program and get my monthly Part B paid back to me, this means I only pay \$17 moth for Plan B coverage through my Advantage plan. I also get \$100 every quarter in FREE OTC needs, which is awesome for hundreds. Of things I usually paid for myself, like compression socks, Ibuprofen, Band Aids, Crutches, Food supplements, Vitamins, and a ton of other high end expensive things I can't afford. That's \$400 a year in FREE OTC stuff. Also, I don't need approval from my PCP as I can go anywhere there is an in-network member. For Eye care I go to an Optometrist in the network who happens to also be the best in my area, so it works out. I'm also very healthy, have no health issues, no chronic disease, no prescriptions, and I love the getting the FREE silver sneakers FREE gym memberships and free recreation access for pickle ball and the pool and weight room stuff. 4th Stage Pancreatic Cancer is a result of a metabolic problem and is not genetic or something you can't control. Meaning, what you put into your body dictates if you get control if you get a diagnosis it can be reversed by immediately FASTING for 1 week, and changing your diet immediately, and exercise. You have to get radical to save your life. We all can prevent cancer easily by changing our diet. Stop drinking alcohol, beer and wine. Stop all seed oils, only eat Olive oil, coconut oil and avocado oil. Stop eating sugars and carbs, stop eating processed foods, start drinking only water, eat healthy salts like Arctic or Celtic salt with high minerals. Exercise every day, don't be sedentary, get moving, plenty of easy things we can do even seated that increase O2 intake and help blood flow. We all have been conned that we need to depend on Medicare and the medical profession and big pharma to keep us alive. This has killed many people for no reason at all. It's time we make America healthy again and stop listening to the quacks and start eating like our food is healthcare, then we don't need healthcare!"

↳ @AnthonyLindsay-c4m (2): "You are 100 right 👍 in what you wrote! The real truth about MA plan verses a supplement plan in real life. Supplement plans are better but you pay more per month but it's worth it in the longterm when you really need a lot of medical care down the road. I am going with a supplement plan G high deductible because I have VA , not going to use it much but I am locked in for life as long as I pay the premium every month."

"Do I really need an agent to buy a medigap plan? Im a little confused. I will be moving to Original Medicare during open enrollment. Using the Medicare website it was easy to create a list of plans available to me. Then I contacted each company to get a quote for both Part G and Part N, which i am considering. Now my phone is blowing up with agents who leave me messages all day long. I guess I just dont understand. Why do I need agent? The process seems very straightforward. I was on the ACA for a couple of years before I went on Medicare and I managed to navigate the ACA without a "navigator". And when i sighed up for a MAP,i picked the plan and signed up on my own.Why would I suddenly need to turn to an agent for a medigap plan? What am I missing? ETA: I think it need to clarify the question, because im getting a bit of snark. My question is an i REQUIRED to use an agent to purchase a medigap policy, because the messages im getting in my voicemail are quite pushy about me needing one. I use an agent for my homeowners and car insurance, not even sure if i could buy without. Just wondering if its the same way. ETA: Well this has been interesting. I asked a question about medigap without an agent and while I got many helpful responses, I also got people thinking I advocate for practicing law without a license to replacing a car engine by watching YouTube videos. And being told that because I have decided to move off MA because my late husband got cancer and we were faced with max out of pocket abd high co-pays and I didnt want to deal with that in my life ever again, that I must have huge financial problems caused by not adequately funding my retirement. OK then. Its the internet, hopefully others have found some of the responses useful. I really dont understand the hostility. Whatever."

— r/medicare · 60 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1o4myrw/>

↳ (0): "Counterpoint: if you are a literate adult that knows how to use a plan compare tool, you don't need an agent"

↳ (0): "The medicare.gov search tool actually does give the pricing model used for each result."

↳ (0): "If you're a literal adult and can read a law book, you don't need a lawyer and can do it yourself."

VA, TRICARE and federal retiree coverage · 156 documents

"Great video! I retired from the civilian sector at 62. We have Tricare from when I retired from the military at age 42, this covers my family as well, so I never had to have any other health insurance while I worked. I also have VA disability, so I use a combination of both. I turned 65 this year so I have Medicare and Tricare for Life now, but my wife is younger than me and is still on Tricare Prime."

— YouTube · 8 Health Insurance Options For Early Retirement - All You Need To Know · 221 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=QiX777fTzzU&lc=Ugy_GwUf1EpCVF7geHF4AaABAg

↳ @TheUnRetired (0): "That's great! thanks for sharing"

"I'm retired military. In order to keep my Tricare insurance, I have to get Medicare at 65."

— YouTube · Reasons to DELAY Medicare Past 65 That Will Save You Thousands and Avoid ALL Penalties · 69 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=L2goGwp4Co8&lc=UgyPk4LJ0FVOrAlkurl4AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (16): "Correct! Don't let anyone talk you into dropping Tricare. It is amazing."

↳ @saraw8503 (13): "Same. I pay for Medicare, but Tricare for life is free. Hooray!"

↳ @clwest3538 (5): "Tricare told my dad that as long as he was working and covered by insurance he didn't need to sign up for Medicare at 65 - he worked until 70. Then when he signed up for Medicare, Medicare penalized him for not getting it early - even though he had full company insurance (large company). Left hand doesn't know what the right hand is doing or what is the law/regulations which cause 'normal' people to have to overpay."

"I turn 65 in January 2026 and I chose plan N and I live in a very expensive area (Northern Va.) and will only pay \$87 and the Part B so about total \$294 a month so I'm pretty happy. And I also purchased a zero payment part D premium. I don't go to the doctor much so not worried about \$20 copay visit."

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 28 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgxcFFuqvyczX0JtB0J4AaABAg.AODI8bYIzmOAOE-L9QNWYq>

High-deductible Plan G · 102 documents

"For a lot of people Medicare at 65 is a blessing. We couldn't wait. My wife had been putting off hip replacement surgery for years due to high deductibles and copays with our employer's plan. On Medicare (and G Supplement) all we paid was the part B deductible of two hundred and some odd dollars! It was life changing for her."

— YouTube · Reasons to DELAY Medicare Past 65 That Will Save You Thousands and Avoid ALL Penalties · 315 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=L2goGwp4Co8&lc=Ugw5192ygARS776lv554AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (25): "Agreed! We tried to show this in the middle section. For many, Medicare is better coverage at a lower cost than what they were experiencing before 65 😊 "

↳ @pgpc6448 (12): "So glad! Your wife deserves it!"

↳ @sfstucco (0): "I'm truly sorry to hear about your situation. No one should have to experience these dilemmas & delays. I'm curious — how many, here, in these unfortunate situations vote Red (Republican)? Not to start a fight or pretend to be superior, but I hope people realize that universal coverage/socialized medicine goes a long, long way to relieving these burdens, financially speaking and logistically speaking. It would cut costs SO, so much if we had a Medicare-for-all (i.e., for all who select it) scheme, from birth to death. There are variations that can include some copayments (or not), depending on how it's structured. But expense, experience, and health outcomes are greatly superior in countries with socialized medicine, in all its forms. Democrats want that."

"Sunburn. Thank you. During my working years I had a Co pay for my HMO high deductible insurance. When I retired I learned about plan G and found it less than what I paying at work. Since my retirement my wife had open heart surgery and knee replace to and a broken arm. I have prostate cancer and ulcerative colitis. If I would have had an advantage plan it would have financial devastated us. When I bought plan G I bought it not for how I felt at the time, but for when I was sick. Advantage plans come in my mail every day trying to switch me over. Never get mail for plan G. That should tell you something in itself."

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 249 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=UgyPSeGJnpazbrQ0VB94AaABAg>

↳ @RolandHolubec (0): "Nobody knows anything; You need to create your process, manage risk, and stick to the plan, through thick or thin, While also continuously learning from mistakes and improving..."

↳ @KristýnaKalová-t8q (0): "Appreciate that. I just looked her up and she seems highly regarded. I've been meaning to fine-tune my drawdown strategy, so this might be the right time. Thanks for pointing me in a solid direction!"

"My Medigap High-Deductible Plan G Analysis *[Edit: The official 2026 HD deductible is* **\$2,950. That's a 2.8% annual increase, which seems pretty much in line with inflation.]*** In case this is useful to others... I ran the numbers on switching to Medigap High-Deductible G (HD-G) for 2026, assuming the HD-G deductible will increase to \$3,000. The numbers would vary by age and ZIP code, but here's a way to run the math: 1. Premiums for my available Plans * **Plan G: \$250/month * HD-G: \$50/month** 2. Maximum Savings (Best Case Scenario) **If I have a healthy year and don't need care beyond what Medicare Part B already covers at no cost: * Plan G annual premium: $250 \times 12 = \$3,000$ * HD-G annual premium: $50 \times 12 = \$600$ * Savings = \$2,400/year** This is my "very healthy year" scenario. 3. Maximum Extra Cost (Worst Case Scenario) **If I have a major medical year and hit the full HD-G deductible: * Out-of-pocket under HD-G = \$3,000 * Minus the \$2,400 in premium savings * Net worst-case cost = \$600 more than if I'd had Plan G** So the most I can lose relative to Plan G is \$600/year. 4. Net Risk This is what makes HD-G attractive to me: * **One healthy year (+\$2,400) * Pays for up to four worst-case years (-\$600 each)** I obviously can't predict my future medical needs, but on average my net cost will fall somewhere between +\$2,400 and -\$600. With two people in our household: * **Max savings: \$4,800/year * Max risk: \$1,200/year** The odds of both of us consistently having worst-case years feels pretty low, so that's a very asymmetric risk profile where the upside heavily outweighs the downside. 5. How HD-G actually works **Many people misunderstand how the HD-G deductible actually works: * After you meet the Part B deductible, Medicare starts paying 80%, just like it normally does. * Because you're only paying 20%, you don't actually hit the HD deductible until and unless you require roughly \$13,000 in total Medicare-approved charges for your annual medical care. One way to look at it: * The HD-G "deductible" is actually a maximum out-of-pocket (MOOP) for Part A + B services. Another way to look at it: * HD-G = You have Original Medicare (A + B) and your premium buys you a \$3,000 MOOP * Plan G = Same coverage but your higher premium buys you a lower MOOP, equal to the Part B deductible (There is no official MOOP for Plan N because you can't accurately predict copays, but it's probably not a big issue for most.)** 6. Bottom Line** For me — with a \$200/month premium difference — HD-G is a no-brainer."

— r/medicare · 87 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1owx5kn/>

↳ (0): "Yeah, this is an excellent analysis. I came to the same conclusion but didn't go through as much mathematics. The bit of cash saved monthly could also possibly be invested. Anyway you slice it, GHD is also better than any employer plan I've had"

↳ (0): "**Because you're only paying 20%, you don't actually hit the HD deductible until and unless you require roughly \$13,000 in total Medicare-approved charges for your annual medical care.**" The other thing to emphasize here is that \$13k is *Medicare approved* charges. I had a procedure recently that was billed at \$1124. But the Medicare approved amount was \$43. Some eye tests by a specialist? Billed at \$763 but Medicare rate? \$197. The point is that \$13,000 in Medicare approved charges is a LOT of care"

↳ (0): "Plus when you pay for services (doctors etc) as part of your deductible, you can pay with your HSA account if you have one. The G plan with no deductible at \$250 per month can't be paid with an HSA. Only medical services, not insurance premiums."

Kaiser and staying inside one health system · 102 documents

"I came off a supplement to an advantage plan about 5 years ago for two reasons affordability and our good health. We enrolled into a HMO-POS plan for 2026. Of course before the switch we verified all of our providers were still in the plan. Zero premium and \$4800.00 MOP. Which is thousands less than the previous plan. I've saved in premiums over the 5 years over 18K. And wer still healthy."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage Plans Leaving in 2026 - 2,600,000 Seniors Impacted · 888 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8Pq6H7UZBbU&lc=UgyH9WWhhAjCLi7lrkMt4AaABAg>

↳ @Johnsonadam_6652 (1): "Exactly.It's a calculated risk. I did the same, but a major health event last year showed me the holes in my "cheap" plan. The out-of-pocket max became a real number fast. That \$18k in savings vanished in medical bills."

↳ @AmirKazan-n2l (1): "What professional looks at healthcare and investments together?Most treat them separately."

↳ @ReeceCook-r7o (0): "Smart move saving on premiums.That \$18k can compound. The risk is the plan's network stability. A provider leaving or a new diagnosis can change the math overnight. You're betting on continued health."

"Sunburn. Thank you. During my working years I had a Co pay for my HMO high deductible insurance. When I retired I learned about plan G and found it less than what I paying at work. Since my retirement my wife had open heart surgery and knee replace to and a broken arm. I have prostate cancer and ulcerative colitis. If I would have had an advantage plan it would have financial devastated us. When I bought plan G I bought it not for how I felt at the time, but for when I was sick. Advantage plans come in my mail every day trying to switch me over. Never get mail for plan G. That should tell you something in itself."

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 249 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=UgyPSeGJnpazbrQ0VB94AaABAg>

↳ @RolandHolubec (0): "Nobody knows anything; You need to create your process, manage risk, and stick to the plan, through thick or thin, While also continuously learning from mistakes and improving..."

↳ @KristýnaKalová-t8q (0): "Appreciate that. I just looked her up and she seems highly regarded. I've been meaning to fine-tune my drawdown strategy, so this might be the right time. Thanks for pointing me in a solid direction!"

"Anyone else receive their 2025 Annual Notice of Change from Aetna today? I have the HMO plan, and the biggest shock is the maximum out of pocket will go from \$4800 in 2024 to \$9350 in 2025. All the 'extra benefits' are getting reduced as well."

— r/medicare · 27 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1f93bec/>

↳ (0): "It's a regressive year for sure.. the 2k cap for pdp is a big reason for it."

↳ (0): "I have united healthcare advantage dual plan, my plan decreased in 2025, dental, vision, OTC, looks like my going have to visit dental regardless once a year, on my vision, hell where to go to get yearly vision testing, and new glasses that's not going to go over 350, that's going to be impossible, the OTC amount from 187, to160 for food, hope snap program increases , but I doubt it, that's government, well what can u do, can't fight the government"

↳ (0): "Some big factors for these changes are the Medicare reimbursement rates are lowering slightly, the \$2000 cap on Part D medications and insurance companies being more responsible for the costs versus the big pharma companies, and since COVID, insurance utilization has been at record highs. You're going to see every part of Medicare affected. Med Supp rates are already going up like crazy, premiums for Part D plans will be much higher, with higher copays on meds and Medicare Advantage plans will have less "extra benefits" like dental, vision, hearing, and for more you will probably need to pay an added premium. All in all it's adjustment. In my opinion, insurance companies were giving way too much on those MAPD plans and weren't making enough on the back in due to utilization being so high, it was bound to break somewhere"

Medicaid, Extra Help and Medicare Savings Programs · 89 documents

"There's no way I could describe how the cost of Medicare infuriates me... I worked from age 15 (part time/went to school) until I retired at 66..51 years!!! I had a stellar job and outstanding benefits.. when I retired, the amount I pay, the co pays, the deductibles are infuriating... people who receive Medicaid get almost better care and FREE for never working... make it make sense to someone who has common sense...can you ???"

— YouTube · Why Medicare Will Cost DOUBLE for Over 3 Million People 🤔 · 69 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=sCdAfk-zQFU&lc=UgykUrRns1xbaJTY2S54AaABAg>

↳ @coachop94 (3): "@Jaded57your attitude toward others is why we can't have nice things like Universal Health care"

↳ @Shars43 (3): "Madicaid get better care. after 75 on medicare, all you get is a wellness check. but we're still paying for full medicare."

↳ @Lifeworthliving425 (1): "Those on Medicare with Medicare worked all of their lives they just were paid lower wages."

"I retired at 65 but my wife is also retired and not 65 yet. So we had to get an ACA plan for her. I followed this advice early. But I followed it too well during my first year and my income was so low that the exchange bumped her down to a Medicaid plan. Which sounds great because it had \$0 premiums. But the problem with Medicaid where I live is no doctors take it. Not great insurance for someone in their 60s. Ever since then, I have been careful in taking enough taxable income so that my income threshold is high enough to not qualify for Medicaid and low enough to optimize on ACA credits."

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65: The ACA Reality Nobody Tells You · 43 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=1Qz8CyPjA5s&lc=Ugz7JAf8GPGbn0Ae8Id4AaABAg>

↳ @mikeb8342 (4): "@mnnew6772 I think it's not about whether providers are available, but rather will a doctor accept a lower amount for a service (usually the case with medicaid)? Maybe Colorado medicaid has higher payouts for services? If so, you might be correct. 🤔"

↳ @RetireEarlyWithMelanieAndKeith (1): "Yes that is something to think about. Good thing you caught it and readjust."

↳ @polaridoo1 (1): "No, it is very hard to find Medicaid providers in Colorado. There's usually a very long wait to get in and not many providers accept it."

"Worked in the healthcare industry my entire career. I found that most people do not have any knowledge of the Medicare and/or Medicaid even with a "pocket computer" today. Very good presentation! I hope people will see it and learn. 🤔 🙌 🍷"

— YouTube · Why Medicare Will Cost DOUBLE for Over 3 Million People 🤔 · 39 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=sCdAfk-zQFU&lc=Ugy4I3pgsk6qRHMD0t4AaABAg>

Changed Medigap carriers to escape a rate increase · 51 documents

"I started on Medicare with a supplement plan G in 2018. I switched insurers three times due to never ending and very high-rate increases. Each time I switched I had to do medical underwriting. In 2024 my AARP United G plan went way up, and I switched to plan N and saved myself \$99 alone in monthly premiums. If I had to go back, I would have just opted for plan N from the start."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 119 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1SFCZkg&lc=UgxHddWf7qxfUU5hD94AaABAg>

↳ @policyguides (19): "Thanks for sharing your experience. You're not alone — I've seen a lot of people face those same big increases on Plan G. Plan N usually ends up being the smarter long-term choice because of the lower premiums, and for most people the extra cost-sharing is pretty minimal compared to what they save each year. With how fast rates are climbing, especially going into 2026, your switch makes a lot of sense."

↳ @christinestephenson1742 (11): "I have Mutual of Omaha supplement since 2019. It's maybe 130 a month and has just gone up a bit each year."

↳ @jayes8191 (6): "@policyguides Could Plan N's extra cost sharing increase significantly if Medicare reimbursements decrease in 2026?"

"I turned 65 while employed, and my company switched me to the "Medicare Version" of the standard employee plan. I then retired with an early retirement package covering my medical insurance at employee rates for three years. Guess what. I had been put on an Advantage version plan. Ugh. I decided to jump to a Medigap plan as soon as the employee rate ended and was fortunately able to still pass underwriting. Two years later, I got diagnosed with a chronic heart condition. I am so grateful to have been able to move to a Medigap plan when I did!!!"

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 74 likes · <http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=Ugz3XghK1-XGwM55ivZ4AaABAg>

↳ @grenloopy2969 (2): "Lucky you were able to afford the supplement plan because they're very expensive in many areas versus Medicare Advantage."

↳ @JohnJohn-wr1jo (1): "Your decision likely saved your life and a whole lot of money. Advantage Plans likely kill thousands of seniors prematurely every week in this country."

"I started Medicare in 2018 at age 65. Every single year I have had rate increases that far exceeded 5-8%. I left United plan G in 2024 as their rate increase jumped drastically and sent my premium well above \$200 a month. I switched to plan N through, you guessed it, Ace. The rate started at \$113 a month and in 2025 increased to \$126 and for 2026 just went up this month to \$154. These high percentage rate increases are wearing thin. Texas resident."

— YouTube · Top Medicare Supplement Companies Review - Winners and Losers! · 52 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HYfsEbghGR8&lc=UgyL5MEueBzKhmgghJ94AaABAg>

↳ @Merzui-kg8ds (17): "The US is a FOR PROFIT medical care nation. As long as we treat healthcare as a for profit industry, costs will be manipulated to increase profits."

↳ @myvenusheeler (12): "@Merzui-kg8ds Well, the flip side to that is socialized medicine has plenty of issues too."

↳ @bobbo11357 (12): "@m@myvenusheeler Socialized Medicine aka the rest of the world. Germany, Sweden, Japan, Argentina. Every country has problems but do those countries health systems bankrupt their citizens?"

Medicare.gov, SHIP counselors and Social Security · 32 documents

"That's just what things cost..." Usually, I get my EOB (explanation of benefits), do a quick review that I actually received the service and thank Medicare and my Part G for saving me the bill. However, yesterday I got an EOB that really ticked me off. After hip surgery, I was prescribed "cryo therapy" (for the uninitiated, it's known as an ice pack.) What arrived at my door in April was a piece of padded fabric with some Velcro attachments - 1) to fit the wrap to my waist and hip and 2) to attach a frozen gel pack. In my wildest imagination, I couldn't see this thing being worth more than \$100. And here's where the insanity begins. The vendor charged Medicare **\$3417.96** 🤔 Of that amount, Medicare paid **\$1095.74**. Nearly \$1100 for padded fabric and an ice pack. Nice work if you can get it. Some of you may say, "That's the system" and that's basically what 2 Medicare reps told me when I called to tell them they were ripped off. "Nothing we can do, that's just what things cost." And we wonder why healthcare is in its current state. Apparently, the same people who value screwdrivers at \$1500 for the defense dept. are doing double duty. I know I shouldn't be amazed but color me gobsmacked. Now if you'll excuse me, I'm off to find a glass and some scotch aka "aroma therapy."

— r/medicare · 109 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1v3wccf/>

↳ (0): "Can you return it? If not can you report it to Medicare's Senior Medicare Patrol or ask SHIP for a resource. When you get a prescription it is out of your hands. You HAVE to take it?! Can you show it to your prescribing physician otter the PT company you used? That is utterly ridiculous. Send it to your US Congress person and ask what should /could be done to recover these funds. There must have been an error coding that tag instead of a cryo machine. Can you look at MSN and get the code to see what they billed for? Now I'm needing some aroma therapy just reading about it."

↳ (0): "It was coded as a miscellaneous brace which clearly it was not. The vendor was chosen for me so... The attitude at Medicare of "Ho hum, oh well, stuff happens" was beyond frustrating. My doctor will probably throw up his hands and try to sympathize. I guess I can always escalate with a tersely worded missive to Dr. Oz..."

↳ (0): "I invite you to write a letter to your 2 Senators and your 2 Representatives in Congress. When the debate over single payer healthcare begins again, and it surely will, they will remember your \$1,000 ice pack. "If you see something, say something." To members of Congress. Do not imagine they know the details of \$1,000 ice packs. They do not."

"My brother-in-law jumped onto Medicare Advantage despite my advice against it. Early on he bragged about the "stuff" he was getting from his insurance plan. He eventually was diagnosed with fourth stage pancreatic cancer. He fought the cancer for two years and fought his Advantage insurance provider for those two years through waiting for authorizations and thousands in out-of-pocket expenses when he consulted an out of network renowned cancer center. He survived one week following that visit. His widow had to fork over the money to the cancer center. My wife and I are on original Medicare with a supplemental plan I carried with my employer at retirement. She was diagnosed with Breast cancer. Her surgery, radiation therapy and a year of chemo pulled her through it. We had no issues with approvals and not a penny of out-of-pocket expenses. The advice to stick to original Medicare came straight from Medicare representatives during a pre-retirement seminar I attended fifteen years ago."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement - NEW cost comparison · 68 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t7XBSZaPx5E&lc=Ugwz7ggeVWwtwy1nUs14AaABAg>

↳ @nsatutor635 (12): "I've heard that Advantage is a POS and as scammers, they shouldn't be in business. They're like the roach motel. Once you get in, you're not only stuck but will die. Sorry for your loss. These for profit companies don't give a F about anyone but their bottom line."

↳ @ZipaDeeDooDahDays (10): "This doesn't make sense to me honestly. I have gone through all of this and my understanding is you can SWITCH plans every year depending on your healthcare needs. You are NOT stuck in one plan or the other. You always look at your health situation each September and make the proper choice in October for what you will need Healthcare Advantage is EXCELLENT for people that doesn't have health issues and also are on a limited budget. I have the GIVEBACK program and get my monthly Part B paid back to me, this means I only pay \$17 moth for Plan B coverage through my Advantage plan. I also get \$100 every quarter in FREE OTC needs, which is awesome for hundreds. Of things I usually paid for myself, like compression socks, Ibuprofen, Band Aids, Crutches, Food supplements, Vitamins, and a ton of other high end expensive things I can't afford. That's \$400 a year in FREE OTC stuff. Also, I don't need approval from my PCP as I can go anywhere there is an in-network member. For Eye care I go to an Optometrist in the network who happens to also be the best in my area, so it works out. I'm also very healthy, have no health issues, no chronic disease, no prescriptions, and I love the getting the FREE silver sneakers FREE gym memberships and free recreation access for pickle ball and the pool and weight room stuff. 4th Stage Pancreatic Cancer is a result of a metabolic problem and is not genetic or something you can't control. Meaning, what you put into your body dictates if you get control if you get a diagnosis it can be reversed by immediately FASTING for 1 week, and changing your diet immediately, and exercise. You have to get radical to save your life. We all can prevent cancer easily by changing our diet. Stop drinking alcohol, beer and wine. Stop all seed oils, only eat Olive oil, coconut oil and avocado oil. Stop eating sugars and carbs, stop eating processed foods, start drinking only water, eat healthy salts like Arctic or Celtic salt with high minerals. Exercise every day, don't be sedentary, get moving, plenty of easy things we can do even seated that increase O2 intake and help blood flow. We all have been conned that we need to depend on Medicare and the medical profession and big pharma to keep us alive. This has killed many people for no reason at all. It's time we make America healthy again and stop listening to the quacks and start eating like our food is healthcare, then we don't need healthcare!"

↳ @AnthonyLindsay-c4m (2): "You are 100 right 👍 in what you wrote! The real truth about MA plan verses a supplement plan in real life. Supplement plans are better but you pay more per month but it's worth it in the longterm when you really need a lot of medical care down the road. I am going with a supplement plan G high deductible because I have VA , not going to use it much but I am locked in for life as long as I pay the premium every month."

"My Experience With Medicare So Far Hi, I started Medicare in November 2024 and I just wanted to share my initial experience so far. A little background: I visited this forum many times and posted many questions in the six months or so before my 65th bday. I found out about ship help early on and enlisted their support by talking with a counselor online (who spent at least 30 minutes with me and was very knowledgeable), plus I signed up for a "Roadmap to Medicare" group meeting that they offered to the community (I live in Orange County, California). It certainly helped me to invest all of the time that I did because it helped me to really narrow down the path I elected to take. For anyone approaching this transition to Medicare I can only say that both Medicare.gov and places like ship help and this forum are invaluable. YouTube videos are plentiful and it is also a resource. I also enlisted a broker who I trusted and she proved invaluable in getting prepared as well as helping me with the application and follow-up questions. For me, I decided to go with traditional Medicare and a medigap supplement "G" and part D for prescriptions initially. My choice was primarily driven by the experience I had through my employer's insurance (I'm retired). They put me through hell for anything I needed. To be fair, my partner chose SCAN and been super happy with it. I'll say that I've been impressed with how quickly SCAN has been with appointments and referrals for their healthcare needs. I chose United Healthcare/AARP for both my medigap and part D portions. Their part G rates seemed reasonable for my zip code (with the discount), and the prescription plan covers all of my meds, which is a big plus. I have been able to get my meds delivered by mail (yes!!) and going to the doctor now is sooo easy. They get my Medicare info and the rest is taken care of. I check both Medicare.gov as well as UHC websites very regularly and I have to say that navigating both is a breeze for someone technologically inept like myself (lol). In summary, I would advise those approaching enrollment in Medicare to learn as much as possible as early as possible. For most people, I don't think there is any reason to not invest in this significant milestone. There is no shortage of resources to assist with this, in my opinion. Ship help, this forum, videos, and a broker will prove invaluable. Again, I am so happy with my experience so far, and part of that I'll concede is how miserable I was with my employer provided health insurance. FWIW I worked in healthcare for forty years and the coverage just got worse and worse. Plus, I have peace of mind for the first time since starting adulthood, in that I know that I will have health insurance and not be dependent upon my employer providing it. This has been my experience so far and I hope that it continues. Thank you to everyone who has answered my questions here in the past, you've been a part of helping me to make these choices. Take care of yourself and choose a good plan, no one else will do it for you !! (I tried to break my post into paragraphs and I apologize for not understanding how to do it, I know it would have been easier to read. I'm not good with technology, or much of anything anymore.)"

— r/medicare · 48 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1iten4m/>

↳ (0): "I have also found the Medicare experience like a breath of fresh air. It is so nice not having to worry about it."

↳ (0): "I feel the same way. I am a somewhat insecure person (lol), and probably some of my fears of not having health insurance go back to growing up and watching my father lose his job at 58 years old. He worked for his company for over 35 years and they cut him loose when his health began deteriorating. (He was a commercial artist and his hand wore out from repetitive stress injury. I remember his fear that he would lose the house and everything else.) Plus, a few surgeries that I had and the astronomical bills didn't help to put my mind to rest regarding the loss of insurance. Plus, my employer was not hesitant in eliminating people/departments at a moments notice. In short, Medicare has given me great peace of mind. It's not perfect and I know others may have completely opposite opinions, but I am so grateful to have it, I've seen what happens when you don't. Take care. :)"

↳ (0): "Thanks, OP. My spouse is turning 65 in April, and we really need to get on this. You mentioned YouTube videos. Do you have any particular channel that you found most helpful?"

Appealed a denial or filed a complaint · 32 documents

"My late mother who died just less than a year ago had UHC-MA as her insurance and she needed physical therapy to help make her well enough for ovarian cancer treatment. After a few weeks she received NOMNC (notice of Medicare non-coverage) notices, which I appealed and won for her ten times over the span of just over a month (basically had to appeal 2-3 times a week). She lost a second level appeal, and with the assistance of a law school clinic, she won her ALJ (administrative law judge) appeal. Unfortunately, the win was two months after she died from the cancer. The system was designed to slow down her progress and see her die before they really had to pay out (the actual chemotherapy and additional services). I'm not a violent person, but what happened to the CEO of UHC did not have me shedding any tears."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · 4,193 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yfLVCc&lc=UgyLL0RuYD8EU19OYq14AaABAg>

↳ @randyhowey7414 (264): "The UHC guys death didn't bother me either, sorry about your mom, fortunately? my mom was able to die at home like she wanted, I took care of her best I could but she wouldn't go to the Dr. She made it to 91 yrs old."

↳ @StrikeWarlock (160): "In this house, Mangione is a hero."

↳ @P.M.B99 (80): "@randyhowey7414Yessa rest her soul I know she had great memories and a wonderful life and she obviously left a wonderful legacy(you).¹⁰⁰ "

"I was hospitalized with a heart issue. I spent a week in hospital I had an advantage plan. I live 1 1/2 blocks from a hospital but they didn't participate in my plan (1) I went to a hospital 1/2 hour away that did. I was sent to a rehab facility after the week in the hospital. 2 days after arrival I was informed I contracted COVID. I was isolated for 2more weeks total of three weeks on my back in bed. When rehab began I couldn't even stand. After 1week of intense pain and effort I was able to stand. I then received a call stating that my insurance had ended coverage and that I would be sent home I would require home care at my expense. I appealed and was granted a few more days. It was long enough to switch to plan g just in time. My cat was my inspiration. Everything is fine, I am walking and able to function at home now."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 83 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgxtFiT9QsmW9PgyxKN4AaABAg>

↳ @donmoore7785 (2): "It is surprising that you were able to switch from MA to Plan G, especially since you had an existing condition."

↳ @Joecrow-waytogo (1): "Thank God and thank you for sharing this valuable information."

↳ @loriar1027 (1): "That plan G must have been expensive, though. It usually is if you go from MA to regular M with a supplement."

"Can't afford Medicare premium This. Went on Medicare when I turned 65. Everything was fine and then Medicare reassessed salary based on some taxable pension that I took out of my retirement account. I used all that money for my house and , my premium went up by a few hundred dollars between Medicare premium and my part C it's about \$800 a month that I cannot afford as a single person on a teachers salary. I appealed appeal was denied so I'm going back on my employers insurance as soon as I can! what a mess I wish somebody at my work had told me about IRMAA when I applied for Medicare. I wonder if anybody else has been in the situation?"

— r/medicare · 51 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1tm895k/>

↳ (0): "It should automatically go down in January, if your income goes back down. We won appeal in 2024 and again in 2026 based on retirement events."

↳ (0): "I just asked Google this question "can you go off medicare to avoid irmaa" You should do the same and read the full reply. (It basically says don't do it and gives options to reduce IRMAA which I am including below.) # Here is what it says about dropping Medicare: **No**, dropping your Medicare coverage to avoid IRMAA (Income-Related Monthly Adjustment Amount) is rarely a good idea. \[1](https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1jlerg5/disenrolling_from_part_b_and_reenolling_later_on/)\] If you voluntarily disenroll from Part B and Part D, your IRMAA surcharges may temporarily stop, but you will face severe consequences: \[1](<https://www.ssa.gov/medicare/lower-irmaa/>)\] **Gaps in Coverage:** You will be left without coverage for basic outpatient care, doctor visits, or prescription drugs. **Permanent Late Enrollment Penalties:** When you try to re-enroll in Medicare later, you will face hefty, permanent late enrollment penalties. **Lack of Guarantee:** You may not be able to simply re-enroll whenever you want; you will have to wait for the General Enrollment Period (January 1–March 31) with coverage beginning the following July. \[1](<https://www.ssa.gov/medicare/lower-irmaa/>), [2](<https://www.investmentnews.com/retirement-planning/what-happens-to-medicare-when-you-suspend-social-security-bennies/48121>), [3](<https://thebig65.com/medigap-plans-guide/>), [4](<https://boomerbenefits.com/medicare-enrollment-period/>), [5](<https://www.leonardfinancialsolutions.com/transition-from-employer-insurance-to-medicare/>)\] # These are the ways it suggests for reducing IRMAA: **Better Ways to Reduce or Avoid IRMAA** Instead of dropping your Medicare coverage, consider these legally recognized strategies to lower your MAGI or appeal the surcharge: \[1](<https://www.schwab.com/learn/story/how-higher-income-can-affect-medicare-premiums>), [2](<https://www.medicareresources.org/blog/four-ways-to-avoid-income-related-medicare-surcharges/>), [3](<https://decimawealth.com/planning/avoid-irmaa-surcharges/>)\] **File an Appeal for Life-Changing Events:** If your income dropped due to a qualifying life event (like retirement, work reduction, divorce, or the death of a spouse), you can appeal to the Social Security Administration using [Form SSA-44](<https://www.ssa.gov/forms/ssa-44.pdf>). **Reduce Taxable Income Pre-Retirement:** Maximize pre-tax contributions to employer-sponsored retirement plans (like a 401(k) or 403(b)) before you hit age 65. **Make Qualified Charitable Distributions (QCDs):** If you are 70½ or older, you can donate up to \\\\$111,000\\ per year directly from your IRA to a charity. This money is not counted as taxable income, thereby lowering your MAGI. **Roth Conversions Early On:** Strategically converting traditional retirement accounts to Roth IRAs *before* you reach Medicare age can reduce your future taxable RMDs (Required Minimum Distributions).\[1](<https://youstaywealthy.com/how-to-avoid-irmaa/>), [2](<https://www.ssa.gov/medicare/lower-irmaa/>), [3](<https://www.kiplinger.com/retirement/medicare/avoid-the-irmaa-with-a-roth-conversion>), [4](https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1jlerg5/disenrolling_from_part_b_and_reenolling_later_on/), [5](<https://medicareagentshub.com/questions/how-can-i-avoid-or-reduce-irmaa-charges-on-my-medicare-premiums/>)\] — — Hope this helps. I do Roth conversions which increase my income. IRMAA is triggered. (There is a 2 year look back so the impact of this years conversions cause IRMA 2 years later). If I stopped conversions, iRMAA would stop 2 years later. But I could use some the money I converted to pay the IRMAA if I had to. I don't fully understand your issue, but hopefully this helps you with some options. 🙏 "

↳ (0): "I dropped my part b due to an Irmay spike and stayed on my wife's insurance for three years, as long as you have creditable coverage it's not issue, you just have to reapply."

Switched from Advantage back to Original Medicare + Medigap · 24 documents

"I had switched from Advantage to Plan G because I'm totally risk-averse. Good thing I did. Out of the blue, I got neurological symptoms that made it impossible to type, write, knit, hike, or even walk my dog. (Fast forward several months--turns out they were caused by the neurosurgeon who treated me 15 years ago). Because I live in a part of the country with very poor medical coverage, my PCP referred me to a university medical center in another state. I got first class care--surgery, hospitalization, home health all were billed to Medicare at over \$350K. I paid nothing. If I had been on Advantage, I most likely would have been limited to the surgeon who caused my problem in the first place. And next week I'll go hiking with my dog for the first time in over a year."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 270 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgxCXf6P2_bAdYu1Q_I4AaABAg

↳ @Theretirementnerds (9): "Thank you for sharing your experience 🧐 Glad to hear you'll be able to walk your dog again soon! Hope recovery is going okay!"

↳ @elizabethb.1693 (4): "That's awesome! 🙌 🍷 "

↳ @clairemckayhart1109 (3): "Thank you for the elephant advice, coming up on 65 and retirement."

"Thanks for the excellent video. I am on AARP Medicare Advantage UnitedHealthcare PPO. My wife was on the same plan, but we kept hearing bad things about Advantage and we both attempted to switch back to traditional medicare in 2023. She was accepted, I was not. I was told I could not because I had received a couple of steroid shots in my spine due to arthritis. We are both 71 and in good health for the most part. I have had cancer (16 years ago), but my wife is in excellent health and always has been. We also full time RV's. We winter in Tucson Nov-April and the rest of the year we migrate with the birds. I have just subscribed. I wish health care in America was not such a game show, but it is."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 25 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgxgkqFeVTXyGsSK5nV4AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (1): "Thank you so much for watching and subscribing! Check out our recent videos because we are mid-48 state road trip 😊 In A mini van though... not an RV"

"I have continued feeling a great deal of relief that I wormed my way out of a mistaken choice to get an Advantage plan. I was hooked by the offer of a vision plan. But then I learned all the shady stuff various Advantage plans can do, and because I am in NC and on Medicaid, I had a 6 month period to change my mind,. I switched back to original Medicare the minute I got my new pair of glasses. And I learned about how messed up Advantage plans can be thanks to YouTube. Thank you for making this video!"

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 23 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=UgwiVOAo3PYIG4-Wj54AaABAg>

↳ @ragtop326 (0): "My vision plan only covered \$100 towards glasses, and I had to pay for my own exam \$89. In Viet Nam, RX glasses only cost \$14. What's wrong with our country. They're money hungry, that's all."

Called a number from TV, the mail or a cold call · 22 documents

"I'm in Florida too and in my early years I didn't have health insurance. I had to go to the hospital for surgery and the bill came to nearly 100k. When I was being discharged, they were wheeling me towards the front door and suddenly veered off and went to the business office. They were demanding some sort of payment and also wanted me to sign papers saying I would pay the entire bill. I told them that I was still medicated and under doctors orders so I couldn't legally sign anything. My wife came in , very pissed off, and took me out of there. When they called a few days later I told them that I wanted an itemized bill. They argued with me and I told them that I knew that hospital bills are works of fiction and that I wanted the same discount that the insurance companies get. They knocked the bill down to \$6,000 and I told them I would send \$100 a month. After paying for 6 months I called them back and asked what it would take to pay it off. They agreed on \$1,500 and I sent them a check and they marked it paid in full. Of course now I'm on Medicare and have a supplement plan but anyone who's younger should remember that you can always negotiate."

— YouTube · Here's How Much We Paid With Medicare I Medicare Supplement vs Advantage · 16 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ykvrdd8VxIY&lc=UgyplzdYHmZ7b1sgQJ4AaABAg.A8bQ-ZobSDuA8cVBGRqKWQ>

"My husband and I are only on social security have the same bills as everyone else we choose to pay for supplement husband had prostate cancer and broken leg had physical therapy I had two total knee replacement and other very expensive test throughout the 5 years on g husband 1800 a month and I make 1500 a month"

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 6 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SF_CZkg&lc=Ugy_Z4G4woonmXVcBW54AaABAg.AM45Z_Lbz2bAMXKXjGn5pl

"Since all or almost all of the TV commercials about Medicare promote the advantage plans, not the supplement plans, I've come to the conclusion that the insurance companies make more money from the advantage plans in the long run. In fact, I have never heard a Medicare TV commercial explicitly promote supplement plans. The fact that you have to be underwritten to be able to buy a new supplement plan (unless you're new to Medicare), but NOT so with new advantage plans AT ANY TIME, is further proof that insurance companies make more money with advantage plans, even if it means being less profitable in the short run, while seniors are younger and healthier. This is so that as they become older and sicker, they will not be able to go to a supplement plan that will cover them better, because they flunked the underwriting process, and therefore could not get supplementary insurance."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage I Pros, Cons and Myths · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ANL8SjiOS1o&lc=UgwdXSuTBRa6oArUP8x4AaABAg>

Self-insured: Original Medicare with no supplement · 17 documents

"We choose MA over Medigap. May not work out well, but for the first years we have been keeping a lot of dollars in our self-insurance fund that would have been going out to pay Medigap premiums. The old equation of Pay Now (A Growing Cost each year) and Pay Less (Maybe) vs. Don't pay now and Pay More Latter. Which to choose? Personal decision."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 20 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=Ugx5Wu3cl7paCtPKNVZ4AaABAg>

↳ @tomm.8892 (1): "@douglashughes2331 I've not had a problem with a lack of choice. I'm in an urban area. I think that is more of an issue in rural America ... but then healthcare in rural America is just plainly more of a problem."

↳ @douglashughes2331 (0): "But you ignore the lack of choice and the ability of your MA plan to deny coverage or delay it so long as to ruin your health."

↳ @JohnJohn-wr1jo (0): "MA is a "cakewalk" and percieved money saver until you develop chronic issues or worse a catastrophic illness. Sister in law found out 5 years into her Advantage Plan. No doubt it killed her prematurely and financially wiped out most of her estate. Delays and denials were an everyday occurrence."

"I am taking the risk. I self insure the 20%. As I see it: the potential, high cost illness is variable. It may happen, it may not. The Plan G Monthly Premium is fixed. It will rise over time. I may use it, I may not. But I will pay for it. Here is a much better idea: At age 65, rather than Plan G supplement, budget \$150 per month for Medical Risk, assume that number rises 6% per year. Put that money into a personal investment account, a safe one but growing too. I will use those funds as protection against the 20% self insurance risk. If I stay healthy, the incentive is a load of money that I own v. the insurance company."

— YouTube · The REAL Cost of Medicare Supplement vs Advantage over 20 Years? I G vs N vs HD G vs Advan · 7 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Yf_LRloXmSo&lc=Ugxt5VAFWFpm7mvH00B4AaABAg

↳ @aa-dz6cr (1): "Self funding is ridiculous if you have assets."

↳ @fl3609 (0): "I think it's a good idea if you are healthy now and can pass underwriting if you need it later."

↳ @jenniferpark2706 (0): "I pay less than \$40 per month for HDG to avoid that risk. I can afford this premium, but I cannot afford the risk for unknown MOOP."

"I lived in 8 different countries, aall had universal healthcare, and I was 100% satisfied with my medical care overseas I do not use the USA medical system if I can help it I have Medicare A and B only and feel like a pauper when I'm in the United states We are a failed country"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage Plans Leaving in 2026 - 2,600,000 Seniors Impacted · 6 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8Pg6H7UzBbU&lc=Ugzvmlw0X3ThDvC44yp4AaABAg>

↳ @ScottsdaleSushi (1): "Not in my opinion. If my twin granddaughters had lived in a different country they would not be alive today. My daughter was flown to another state to have the number one doctor in the world operate on them in utero & save their lives. My daughter's insurance paid for that. Would not have been possible - at least unless she wanted to pay the almost 4 million dollars it all cost out of pocket. Universal healthcare isn't going to allow that but my daughter & son-in-law's health insurance did."

↳ @dianah.9718 (0): "What insurance do they have? How much of the 4 mil did they have to pay?"

Switched from a supplement to Advantage (usually for the premium) · 9 documents

"My situation exactly. I switched from a medigap plan to an advantage plan. I was spending \$4,500 for the medigap plan and prescription drug plan plus a \$480 deductible on the drug plan. My advantage plan capped my max out-of-pocket at \$5,100. I got prescription drugs and \$1,000 dental in the MA plan at no extra cost. MA has been perfect for me."

— YouTube · Top Disadvantages of Medicare Advantage Plans · 7 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BebQ04cKzJc&lc=Ugz57a5HtSvqIR5fU8l4AaABAg.9SjvKJxeBpO9UKMbF_TFcO

"I love this type of video and you did a great job as usual. As an anecdote, this year (2024) I switched from a supplemental plan F to a MA plan and I couldn't be happier. I retired in 2015. Now, gone is my \$240 per month premium for supplement plan F, gone is my \$110 per month part d plan where the drugs also cost twice as much and present is my \$0 premium health plan, \$0 premium drug plan, and I still see the same doctors and hospitals that I was anyway. I now save enough in one year, that if I ever reach my maximum out of pocket (\$4100) I am still way ahead financially. Love my Advantage plan. Plus, I am 74 this year. I hate to think how much that supplemental will cost by the time I'm 80. (\$450 - \$500 per month?) I don't have to worry about it."

— YouTube · Here's How Much We Paid With Medicare I Medicare Supplement vs Advantage · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ykvrrd8VxIY&lc=UgyL90JITftyVjlvAnt4AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "Thank you so much for watching! So glad to hear you are happy with your choice :)"

"Very good advise. I recently switched from a supplemental plan to a medicare advantage plan sponsored by my previous employer. The reasons I switched are simple, the company sponsored Advantage plan was cheaper, it is a PPO and not an HMO and the prescription drug part of the advantage plan is almost identical to the AARP supplemental drug plan I was on. So far I have been very pleased with my PPO Advantage plan. I can still see all my doctors without pre-approval and it pays without dispute, so far. Thank you!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=Ugw2Pq8vQjgQGGJVF7h4AaABAg>

↳ @CD-ek3iq (4): "I work with both MA and Supplements. While what you say is mostly accurate the sad fact is many seniors simply cannot afford the high premiums of Supplements AND a PDP. Add in the monthly cost of dental, vision and hearing, which supps won't cover, and it's easy to be priced out completely. There's nothing wrong with MA. I work with people every day who LOVE their MA plans and wouldn't trade em for the world, lol. (It's my job to try!) Many also have much lower Max Out Of Pockets than mentioned that can end up being as much as the yearly premium you pay with Supps whether you use it or not. 🙌 If you travel, simply get a PPO. Easy. Everybody has different needs and means. Luckily there are multiple options to try and help people with their Heath Care."

Tab 7 — Solution Soundbites

Theme	Documents
Should have enrolled or planned differently	54
Wishing someone had warned them about underwriting and deadlines	25
'This should be illegal': wishing the rules were enforced	19
Wishing Medigap could be bought any year, no health questions	11
Wishing dental, vision, hearing and long-term care were covered	11
Wishing for one simple Medicare that covers everything	8
Wishing for someone unbiased to explain it	6

Should have enrolled or planned differently · 54 documents

"This is a real eye opener. Wish I had done more research before I signed up for advantage plan. Thanks so much, you are performing a genuine public service."

— YouTube · It's Not Always Easy to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Supplement · 42 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=djuGel829M4&lc=UgyUhgmxXIWRyCw81Kt4AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (2): "Thank you for watching and leaving such a kind comment Bill. Appreciate you!"

↳ @rogerdorsey7823 (0): "A REAL EYE OPENER BUT THE PROCESS IS A SET UP TO LULL YOU INTO AN EMERGENCY DENYING TRANSFER OF MEDICAL HISTORY FROM ONE INSTITUTION TO ANOTHER THEN BILLING YOU EXCESSIVELY FOR TEST THAT COST MORE THAN ADVANTAGE IS WILLING TO PAY 😊"

"I wish I could press the 'thumbs up' 100 times! Not only was this incredibly informative and really did teach me so much about Medicare and Mountain Chickens, using John's special brand of satire, but having "karen" and her real life husband hamming it up at the end was f'ing hysterical! I almost can't wait to turn 65!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · 15 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yflVCC&lc=UgxeBV5dnxzmYmmmaiR4AaABAg>

"Healthcare for profit is a joke. The majority of people that go bankrupt from medical bills have insurance - so it's a worthless joke. The ACA are taxpayer funds funneled to wall-street. Tying health insurance to work is a joke. McDonalds doesn't provide insurance and tax payers have to subsidize these monopolies. Let GOP policies play out and run on healthcare for all 2028. I haven't had health insurance through work since the early 1990s. Paid in for almost 1/4 century and went to the doctors once. Should have gone without. I was paying over \$1,000 per month a decade ago for worthless insurance. So I went the last 10 years without any health insurance, saved over \$120,000 and retired early (58). I'm 66, have Medicare, went to the docs and all is fine."

— YouTube · Expiration of ACA subsidies will have 'ripple effects' in health care and economy · 11 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xOrWISxntkQ&lc=UgxkDNx8AImb_D8Novh4AaABAg

↳ @bobbear4437 (0): "The insurance you talk about isn't the ACA, it was bankruptcy care that is where we're headed again, you get sick, you go bankrupt, you'll never have anything to leave to your children!"

Wishing someone had warned them about underwriting and deadlines · 25 documents

"Universal coverage is simple, but the facts are unpalatable to many **Background premises:** I'll start with the premise that, in the USA, a citizen who gets a curable cancer should not die for want of care. (You may agree with that premise or not, but I'm doing a thought experiment about universal coverage and this premise is the basic justification for universal coverage.) (I'm leaving out non-citizens not because I don't care about them, but because I want to avoid side issues and make clear how brutally limited our choices are to meet the goal of "curable cancer shouldn't kill you.") I have an opinion about the best way to solve the problem, but I won't express it now. I will just list the logical possibilities. There aren't many. **Option 1:** If you get cancer, go to the ED. This is pretty much the system now. You will probably get care, although it will likely be delayed and suboptimal. Guess who pays for this? Ultimately the government/populace. Doctors and hospitals cannot provide free care for everyone who has no insurance, without ultimately going bankrupt. So ultimately the government/populace pays for this. The mechanisms are weird and varied - various subsidies, overcharging private insurers, "safety net" hospitals which are subsidized by the government, etc. But let's not kid ourselves. Someone pays for it - and that someone is us. And if the mechanisms of payment are weird and varied, they are probably inefficient and wasteful. And of course, if people actually could get preventive care, maybe fewer people would get cancer and maybe that would be better for all of us in the long run (ya think?). **Option 2:** The government covers everyone. The easiest way to do this is by making people over 60 eligible for Medicare, then next year adding people under 18 and people over 55. In a few years, we have Medicare for all. To cushion the economic change for insurance companies, you can drag this out over 10 years or so if you wish. Government-run systems in other countries have lots of problems, and people in those countries are often unhappy with them, but they do cover everyone, and developed nations with universal health care - without exception - spend much less and get better global outcomes than we do. Yes, you may have to wait a year or longer for your hip replacement in Canada. But overall, you will live longer and healthier. Which are you gonna choose? And yes, it's really a choice: If a country devotes all its resources to making sure the fraction of the population who need a hip replacement get it within 3 weeks, a lot of resources have to be diverted from preventative and primary care. You have to decide at the beginning if immediate availability of elective care is more important, or if overall health and longevity of the population is more important. \[As an aside, if the government covered everyone we would collect something like \$600M more in taxes annually, because employers wouldn't provide health insurance plans, and the money previously used for employer-provided plans would be taxable (either on the company side or the employee side).\] **Option 3:** A market based plan. Here the choices are much starker than most people realize. It basically means everyone gets some kind of private insurance so that when you get a curable cancer you don't die. Almost all Americans, in polls, agree that you should be able to get insurance even if you have a pre-existing condition. If you are guaranteed coverage for pre-existing conditions, most people will be better off not getting insurance until they get cancer. The people who will buy insurance right away are those with expensive chronic conditions. Someone who has an autoimmune disorder and needs \$30K worth of biological meds annually will buy insurance. Someone who is healthy will not buy insurance and pay for basic care out of pocket. If the healthy person gets cancer, they'll just buy insurance at that point. I hope it's clear to all that under this system no insurance company will stay in business for more than a year or two. Nobody will buy insurance until the insurance payouts they get are larger than their premium. Meaning the insurance companies will lose money on every policy they sell. So, if you are going to have a market based plan that meets the goal of "people don't die of a curable cancer," you have to persuade or require healthy people to join now. Health insurance (whether provided by Medicare, Medicaid or private companies) is a mechanism of spreading risk. We can afford to care for a child with cancer ONLY because a lot of people are paying insurance premiums (or taxes) when they don't need expensive services. Hence the Affordable Care Act. There are many things to like or dislike about the ACA, but it's shocking how many don't seem to grasp the basic premise. **You cannot provide coverage for pre-existing conditions unless healthy people pay premiums.** This is not an opinion. It's mathematics. I am not a huge fan of insurance companies, but if they spend more than they take in on every policy they will fail - and thus a system that relies on insurance companies will fail. **Conclusions** I submit that there is basically no way to meet the goal of "A US citizen with a curable cancer shouldn't die for want of care" except the 3 I have outlined. If anyone can propose another, I'd love to hear about it. Any plan that doesn't adopt one of these three premises fails to meet the basic goal of "A US citizen with a curable cancer shouldn't die for want of care." Health savings plans, tax breaks, malpractice reforms, etc, nibble around the edges of the problem, and may make some significant improvements here or there. But to meet the really important goal, you need a comprehensive approach, and the only mathematical possibilities are (1) The government/ populace pays for it indirectly, (2) The government/ populace pays for it directly, or (3) Healthy people have to be required to buy insurance so that sick people can get care that would otherwise be beyond their means. My two cents. I welcome all of your opinions about this."

— r/HealthInsurance · 404 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1pqufyv/>

↳ (0): "My recollection was one of the premises of Obamacare was indeed that EVERYONE was required to have health insurance. If you didn't you'd get it on the Exchange at possibly heavily subsidized rates. If you didn't get it, there was a penalty at tax time."

↳ (0): "The mandate was eliminated during Trump Admin v1"

↳ (0): "Didn't some states not increase the range for Medicaid? I seem to remember something.."

"Can't afford Medicare premium This. Went on Medicare when I turned 65. Everything was fine and then Medicare reassessed salary based on some taxable pension that I took out of my retirement account. I used all that money for my house and , my premium went up by a few hundred dollars between Medicare premium and my part C it's about \$800 a month that I cannot afford as a single person on a teachers salary. I appealed appeal was denied so I'm going back on my employers insurance as soon as I can! what a mess I wish somebody at my work had told me about IRMAA when I applied for Medicare. I wonder if anybody else has been in the situation?"

— r/medicare · 51 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1tm895k/>

↳ (0): "It should automatically go down in January, if your income goes back down. We won appeal in 2024 and again in 2026 based on retirement events."

↳ (0): "I just asked Google this question "can you go off medicare to avoid irmaa" You should do the same and read the full reply. (It basically says don't do it and gives options to reduce IRMAA which I am including below.) # Here is what it says about dropping Medicare: **No**, dropping your Medicare coverage to avoid IRMAA (Income-Related Monthly Adjustment Amount) is rarely a good idea. \[1](https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1jlerg5/disenrolling_from_part_b_and_reenolling_later_on/)\] If you voluntarily disenroll from Part B and Part D, your IRMAA surcharges may temporarily stop, but you will face severe consequences: \[1](<https://www.ssa.gov/medicare/lower-irmaa/>)\] **Gaps in Coverage:** You will be left without coverage for basic outpatient care, doctor visits, or prescription drugs. **Permanent Late Enrollment Penalties:** When you try to re-enroll in Medicare later, you will face hefty, permanent late enrollment penalties. **Lack of Guarantee:** You may not be able to simply re-enroll whenever you want; you will have to wait for the General Enrollment Period (January 1–March 31) with coverage beginning the following July. \[1](<https://www.ssa.gov/medicare/lower-irmaa/>), [2](<https://www.investmentnews.com/retirement-planning/what-happens-to-medicare-when-you-suspend-social-security-bennies/48121>), [3](<https://thebig65.com/medigap-plans-guide/>), [4](<https://boomerbenefits.com/medicare-enrollment-period/>), [5](<https://www.leonardfinancialsolutions.com/transition-from-employer-insurance-to-medicare/>)\] # These are the ways it suggests for reducing IRMAA: **Better Ways to Reduce or Avoid IRMAA** Instead of dropping your Medicare coverage, consider these legally recognized strategies to lower your MAGI or appeal the surcharge: \[1](<https://www.schwab.com/learn/story/how-higher-income-can-affect-medicare-premiums>), [2](<https://www.medicareresources.org/blog/four-ways-to-avoid-income-related-medicare-surcharges/>), [3](<https://decimawealth.com/planning/avoid-irmaa-surcharges/>)\] **File an Appeal for Life-Changing Events:** If your income dropped due to a qualifying life event (like retirement, work reduction, divorce, or the death of a spouse), you can appeal to the Social Security Administration using [Form SSA-44](<https://www.ssa.gov/forms/ssa-44.pdf>). **Reduce Taxable Income Pre-Retirement:** Maximize pre-tax contributions to employer-sponsored retirement plans (like a 401(k) or 403(b)) before you hit age 65. **Make Qualified Charitable Distributions (QCDs):** If you are 70½ or older, you can donate up to \\\\$111,000\\ per year directly from your IRA to a charity. This money is not counted as taxable income, thereby lowering your MAGI. **Roth Conversions Early On:** Strategically converting traditional retirement accounts to Roth IRAs *before* you reach Medicare age can reduce your future taxable RMDs (Required Minimum Distributions).\[1](<https://youstaywealthy.com/how-to-avoid-irmaa/>), [2](<https://www.ssa.gov/medicare/lower-irmaa/>), [3](<https://www.kiplinger.com/retirement/medicare/avoid-the-irmaa-with-a-roth-conversion>), [4](https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1jlerg5/disenrolling_from_part_b_and_reenolling_later_on/), [5](<https://medicareagentshub.com/questions/how-can-i-avoid-or-reduce-irmaa-charges-on-my-medicare-premiums/>)\] — — Hope this helps. I do Roth conversions which increase my income. IRMAA is triggered. (There is a 2 year look back so the impact of this years conversions cause IRMA 2 years later). If I stopped conversions, iRMAA would stop 2 years later. But I could use some the money I converted to pay the IRMAA if I had to. I don't fully understand your issue, but hopefully this helps you with some options. 🙏 "

↳ (0): "I dropped my part b due to an Irmay spike and stayed on my wife's insurance for three years, as long as you have creditable coverage it's not issue, you just have to reapply."

"Maybe the GI (guaranteed issue) benefit should be a line on this chart. The presentation is excellent except for minimizing this as an issue. Just because you have no preexisting conditions now does not mean that you will never have any. At 65 I was fit with few medical visits and no prescription drugs. Two years later I have had melanoma and a heart diagnosis. Thankfully I have Plan G."

— YouTube · Medicare Plan G vs Plan N (New Info!) · 14 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SP2JABN8RL8&lc=UgyXPwc2Oqa_aN2gwZ4AaABAg

'This should be illegal': wishing the rules were enforced · 19 documents

"The more my Plan N increases annually, the more I'm inclined (against my better judgement) to start looking at a Part C Advantage Plan instead. I went with Plan N because I believed in the idea of "Pay me now or pay me later", where I protected myself against high deductibles and annual outlays by paying a (reasonable) monthly premium. Sadly, "Pay me now" is becoming "Pay me a LOT more now, and every year until you die." Also, we need better oversight of these insurers. Offering low costs for a year and then inflating prices once you have attracted a bunch of subscribers should be illegal. Or at least a Medicare plan cost should be guaranteed for a reasonable amount of time. I would be much happier paying more when I sign up, knowing that my premium won't increase to shocking levels for years."

— YouTube · Your Medicare Supplement Premium Just Went Up... Here's What to Do. · 57 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CDMzMoErP-w&lc=UgxVyp4MBD-dEhPeZlh4AaABAg>

↳ @chevelleflorida (8): "To me, if one can afford a medigap/supplemental plan, that is the best option. The biggest issue with Advantage plans is the level of care that you will receive. For example, I know someone who had a heart attack and stroke last year and was referred to a SNF/rehab center. The MA plan was calling within 3 days talking about discharging the patient even though they were not ready to go back home. With traditional Medicare, that person likely would have received 100 days. Fortunately, moving to a SNF, creates a qualifying event to change insurance and we were able to move the patient back to traditional Medicare with a supplemental plan that they already had (Tricare for life.) In truth, the broker who signed them up for a MA plan did them a huge disservice. No one with a Supplemental plan should move to a MA plan."

↳ @Farrodee (5): "In two years my plan G went from 1500 to over 1800 per year. I don't even take any meds and rarely see dr!"

↳ @vanguy9780 (0): "@jaygrenham education is a wonderful thing. You should try it"

"I opted out of Medicare Part B since I have spent less than \$600 in ALL of my healthcare in total in 68 years and they want \$210 a month for this plan which is flatly absurd. And why would I reduce my SS by this much which is about 20% of my total. I firmly believe we all should get Medicare with 100% coverage for everything for free minus a small copay with no separate plans and all private insurance should be eliminated. Insurance has ruined healthcare!"

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 18 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgwDRTFZcv8WfoYAGwt4AaABAg>

↳ @EdLee-r6k (2): "@Starfish2145 nah, he will just hide any assets, go on medicaid, and get the taxpayers to pay for all of it. pay nothing in, and take all they can. a 1k SS check tells you something about what level of taxes have been paid into the system...not much"

↳ @Starfish2145 (1): "Yeah, that's great until you get cancer or seriously ill. Then you're screwed."

↳ @MikeMbm-l3z (0): "The permanent penalty for not signing up for part B when first eligible is 10% per year. If you choose to sign up today, you won't be paying the 202.90 per month, you will be paying 30% more since you are now 68. Should you sign up now, every year going forward you will be paying 30% more than everyone who signed up when eligible. The penalty never gets waived. Wait another year and it will be 40% more than the going rate. Good luck!"

"The EXACT reason I chose original medicare. It should be illegal to call it medicare advantage, it's only an HMO. Profits, profits, profits."

— YouTube · MORE Medicare Advantage Plans CUT: Millions Will Face Forced Dis-enrollment ❌ · 12 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CPLaLyfDZxY&lc=Ugwrey4vqWCESymz2Bp4AaABAg>

↳ @jlm848-h8i (4): "Advantage was always a sweetheart deal and handout for the insurance companies. It was never, ever in the best interests of patients. The premiums and copays "looked good", but the record of denials for truly needed care is criminal!"

↳ @user-sr9bi2uu8w (2): "Not all MA plans (Part C) are HMOs. Many are PPOs."

↳ @cindyrogalski-y2m (1): "@MrWhaatayNo, he is pretty clear about the many DISadvantages of "Advantage" plans."

Wishing Medigap could be bought any year, no health questions · 11 documents

"Universal coverage is simple, but the facts are unpalatable to many **Background premises:** I'll start with the premise that, in the USA, a citizen who gets a curable cancer should not die for want of care. (You may agree with that premise or not, but I'm doing a thought experiment about universal coverage and this premise is the basic justification for universal coverage.) (I'm leaving out non-citizens not because I don't care about them, but because I want to avoid side issues and make clear how brutally limited our choices are to meet the goal of "curable cancer shouldn't kill you.") I have an opinion about the best way to solve the problem, but I won't express it now. I will just list the logical possibilities. There aren't many. **Option 1:** If you get cancer, go to the ED. This is pretty much the system now. You will probably get care, although it will likely be delayed and suboptimal. Guess who pays for this? Ultimately the government/populace. Doctors and hospitals cannot provide free care for everyone who has no insurance, without ultimately going bankrupt. So ultimately the government/populace pays for this. The mechanisms are weird and varied - various subsidies, overcharging private insurers, "safety net" hospitals which are subsidized by the government, etc. But let's not kid ourselves. Someone pays for it - and that someone is us. And if the mechanisms of payment are weird and varied, they are probably inefficient and wasteful. And of course, if people actually could get preventive care, maybe fewer people would get cancer and maybe that would be better for all of us in the long run (ya think?). **Option 2:** The government covers everyone. The easiest way to do this is by making people over 60 eligible for Medicare, then next year adding people under 18 and people over 55. In a few years, we have Medicare for all. To cushion the economic change for insurance companies, you can drag this out over 10 years or so if you wish. Government-run systems in other countries have lots of problems, and people in those countries are often unhappy with them, but they do cover everyone, and developed nations with universal health care - without exception - spend much less and get better global outcomes than we do. Yes, you may have to wait a year or longer for your hip replacement in Canada. But overall, you will live longer and healthier. Which are you gonna choose? And yes, it's really a choice: If a country devotes all its resources to making sure the fraction of the population who need a hip replacement get it within 3 weeks, a lot of resources have to be diverted from preventative and primary care. You have to decide at the beginning if immediate availability of elective care is more important, or if overall health and longevity of the population is more important. \[As an aside, if the government covered everyone we would collect something like \$600M more in taxes annually, because employers wouldn't provide health insurance plans, and the money previously used for employer-provided plans would be taxable (either on the company side or the employee side).\] **Option 3:** A market based plan. Here the choices are much starker than most people realize. It basically means everyone gets some kind of private insurance so that when you get a curable cancer you don't die. Almost all Americans, in polls, agree that you should be able to get insurance even if you have a pre-existing condition. If you are guaranteed coverage for pre-existing conditions, most people will be better off not getting insurance until they get cancer. The people who will buy insurance right away are those with expensive chronic conditions. Someone who has an autoimmune disorder and needs \$30K worth of biological meds annually will buy insurance. Someone who is healthy will not buy insurance and pay for basic care out of pocket. If the healthy person gets cancer, they'll just buy insurance at that point. I hope it's clear to all that under this system no insurance company will stay in business for more than a year or two. Nobody will buy insurance until the insurance payouts they get are larger than their premium. Meaning the insurance companies will lose money on every policy they sell. So, if you are going to have a market based plan that meets the goal of "people don't die of a curable cancer," you have to persuade or require healthy people to join now. Health insurance (whether provided by Medicare, Medicaid or private companies) is a mechanism of spreading risk. We can afford to care for a child with cancer ONLY because a lot of people are paying insurance premiums (or taxes) when they don't need expensive services. Hence the Affordable Care Act. There are many things to like or dislike about the ACA, but it's shocking how many don't seem to grasp the basic premise. **You cannot provide coverage for pre-existing conditions unless healthy people pay premiums.** This is not an opinion. It's mathematics. I am not a huge fan of insurance companies, but if they spend more than they take in on every policy they will fail - and thus a system that relies on insurance companies will fail. **Conclusions** I submit that there is basically no way to meet the goal of "A US citizen with a curable cancer shouldn't die for want of care" except the 3 I have outlined. If anyone can propose another, I'd love to hear about it. Any plan that doesn't adopt one of these three premises fails to meet the basic goal of "A US citizen with a curable cancer shouldn't die for want of care." Health savings plans, tax breaks, malpractice reforms, etc, nibble around the edges of the problem, and may make some significant improvements here or there. But to meet the really important goal, you need a comprehensive approach, and the only mathematical possibilities are (1) The government/ populace pays for it indirectly, (2) The government/ populace pays for it directly, or (3) Healthy people have to be required to buy insurance so that sick people can get care that would otherwise be beyond their means. My two cents. I welcome all of your opinions about this."

— r/HealthInsurance · 404 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1pqufyv/>

↳ (0): "My recollection was one of the premises of Obamacare was indeed that EVERYONE was required to have health insurance. If you didn't you'd get it on the Exchange at possibly heavily subsidized rates. If you didn't get it, there was a penalty at tax time."

↳ (0): "The mandate was eliminated during Trump Admin v1"

↳ (0): "Didn't some states not increase the range for Medicaid? I seem to remember something.."

"As someone who is about to enter the Medicare minefield I truly appreciate your honest evaluations of Medicare Supplement and Advantage plans. As a senior reaching 65 I have learned a lot and had my eyes opened by your informative videos. Keep up the good work. I hope others do their due diligence on their health care post 65. I wish other states other than the four allow seniors to switch back to original supplement plans. That would immensely help."

— YouTube · MASSIVE: Hospitals Are DROPPING Medicare Advantage Plans 🤖 · 46 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vn2k1W-JzB8&lc=Ugy6mXtwm4ahYY_KrNR4AaABAg

↳ @ckstaff (12): "Don't know the truth on it but in those states you can go back to original I have heard to do so you will be paying a hefty premium to do it. Just take the smart rout and do it right the first time. Don't gamble with your health with taking shortcuts."

↳ @ronbaker8007 (5): "Medicare limits the amount that can be charged; Supplements protect the patient from lack of permission from providers, Med ADV controls permissions and choice."

↳ @kathyd7284 (3): "It is so overwhelming and I was a paralegal for over 40 years. We asked older relatives and decided on regular Medicare Plan N through AARP United Healthcare with Part D through WellCare. We have been so happy with these plans. Hardly anything out of pocket after Medicare yearly deductible paid."

"Maybe the GI (guaranteed issue) benefit should be a line on this chart. The presentation is excellent except for minimizing this as an issue. Just because you have no preexisting conditions now does not mean that you will never have any. At 65 I was fit with few medical visits and no prescription drugs. Two years later I have had melanoma and a heart diagnosis. Thankfully I have Plan G."

— YouTube · Medicare Plan G vs Plan N (New Info!) · 14 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SP2JABN8RL8&lc=UgyXPwc2Oqa_-aN2gwZ4AaABAg

Wishing dental, vision, hearing and long-term care were covered · 11 documents

"Back in the 80s medical insurance was simple. I had blue cross that the company gave as a benefit. If I went to the Dr, dentist or eye doctor, I never paid for anything and didn't get any paperwork from the Dr or insurance company. Now, I get bills from Dr and the insurance company sends me something at least 3 times per week (I called them to get them to stop sending me the useless information). And my eyes and teeth are part of my body and it SHOULD BE COVERED BY MEDICARE ! "

— YouTube · Working Past 65? Medicare Mistakes You Can't Afford To Make! 🗣️ · 105 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4GtRppYTHho&lc=UgxHVeIY2LS72yYatvJ4AaABAg>

↳ @StarkeyatRingo (12): "isn't it funny THAT SICKNESS rose with the MANDATORY INSURANCE??? AS IF we couldn't have one without the other - and the PRICES ALL GOT OUT OF WHACK WHEN SICKNESS BECAME BUSINESS"

↳ @johnsonpaul1914 (4): "It was never simple for me. I was self employed for most of my life and rarely had any health ins, but we got by. Have had medicare now for 12 years and covered that with a medicare advantage no premium policy. Quite satisfied with that. But I am now very disillusioned with health care. It is more sick care and very little about actual health"

↳ @portrait1001 (3): "@iamanovercomer3253 the biggest problem was losing a job , for whatever reason and having a child or spouse that had a preexisting condition. Your life would of been consumed with medical bills then"

"As a I licensed agent, I absolutely agree. I understand why mapds exist, because not everyone can afford a supplement, let alone part b premium. I will also like to point out however, that sometimes, especially in areas of Florida, there are great mapd plans out there. The fact of the matter is, most people don't venture out seeking multiple doctors, and rarely seek routine service out of their service area. Heck, most people wouldn't even know what do if they are diagnosed with chronic condition. I am slowly warming up to mapds because those who live in hardships, and have health conditions have no other choice. Original Medicare needs to be increased because besides that part d and part b premium, never mind the ancillary "not covered" services like vision,hearing or dental (what a joke)"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 8 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgwIBspUINt_ZTfu8bN4AaABAg

↳ @akita96th (0): "You haven't had to shell out the \$7500 out of pocket expenses yet....That will wake you up."

↳ @stuntmasta305 (0): "@akita96th this is pretty much the norm for most private healthcare coverage under 65. Not including Aca, or Medicaid. For those on OM, it goes on forever, unless you have a supplement that you pay anywhere between 100-300 a month, plus a separate part D with no dental, vision or hearing in consideration. There are plans with considerable less MOOPs, not uncommon in populated areas to have moops as low as 800. The ugly side of mapds isn't always the cost, but the utilization management."

↳ @akita96th (0): "Like I said its all fun and games until you really get sick then they put the screw on you. All I am saying is those who say they can't afford a supplement will realize when they get sick that maybe they could have afforded it after all once those out of pocket bills start piling up. It is a shame seniors have to live like that in this rich country thanks to the republican party. Any senior citizen on a fixed income who votes republican deserves all the misery old age can muster. MAGA does not love you back."

"Cadillac ... I had no idea I couldn't switch my agent down the road, if I were to find my agent wasn't being as much help as I need... that is incredibly distressing. 😞 I have a plan N, & so far, have liked my agent, but have wondered about the possibility of needing to switch, were I to find I was no longer getting the help I need. WOW, this seems SO WRONG & the fact that this is the first time I am hearing I have no option to switch, should I wish to do so, is even more distressing! Yikes! [8.3.2026] [Can We Talk Openly About Medicare Supplement Plan G? - The Retirement Nerds]"

— YouTube · Can We Talk Openly About Medicare Supplement Plan G? · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=YbzNHT67jnc&lc=UgxDIrsmJubmUe3FZN4AaABAg>

Wishing for one simple Medicare that covers everything · 8 documents

"My husband has an Advantage plan has not had any problems with it. Been on it 5 years. Finding a dentist in our area has been an issue though. What I don't understand is why there are separate Plans (A,B,C,D) and you have to pay for those. Medicare should be one plan and it's all covered as we paid for it from our working wages."

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 79 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=Ugzj1Rb6ZQ40dwn_bcl4AaABAg

↳ @muzak-mn3de (9): "There is the real issue, the Federal Government knows Medicare is a drain on the annual expenses, and pass the buck onto Insurance Companies and providers. It's the Federal Governments fault."

↳ @oldwhiteman5860 (4): "@muzak-mn3de Your ignorance is profound. Insurance companies are paid by Medicare for every person that enrolls in an Advantage plan. They are paid based on the perceived health risks of those insured. The insurance companies do everything they can to increase the perceived risk so they can charge Medicare more even if the risk never materializes. Payment to for profit insurance companies to cover Advantage plans costs Medicare billions of dollars a year and is a major factor in Medicare's lack of long-term viability."

↳ @YY4-33 (3): "The problem is that Each Year certain doctors no longer accept the Advantage plan. It's happened to my brother. But he doesn't care if he has to travel another hour or switch to a different cardiologists. He's in southwest Louisiana. I'm up North. He likes the little freebies. I'm a bit younger but I worked in healthcare for over 35 years. I'd stay FAR away from united healthcare & Medicare advantage. For now we purchase on the Market. BCBS ONLY."

"I opted out of Medicare Part B since I have spent less than \$600 in ALL of my healthcare in total in 68 years and they want \$210 a month for this plan which is flatly absurd. And why would I reduce my SS by this much which is about 20% of my total. I firmly believe we all should get Medicare with 100% coverage for everything for free minus a small copay with no separate plans and all private insurance should be eliminated. Insurance has ruined healthcare!"

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 18 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgwDRTFZcv8WfoYAGwt4AaABAg>

↳ @EdLee-r6k (2): "@Starfish2145 nah, he will just hide any assets, go on medicaid, and get the taxpayers to pay for all of it. pay nothing in, and take all they can. a 1k SS check tells you something about what level of taxes have been paid into the system...not much"

↳ @Starfish2145 (1): "Yeah, that's great until you get cancer or seriously ill. Then you're screwed."

↳ @MikeMbm-l3z (0): "The permanent penalty for not signing up for part B when first eligible is 10% per year. If you choose to sign up today, you won't be paying the 202.90 per month, you will be paying 30% more since you are now 68. Should you sign up now, every year going forward you will be paying 30% more than everyone who signed up when eligible. The penalty never gets waived. Wait another year and it will be 40% more than the going rate. Good luck!"

"I'm 72 and I pay over \$200/month for the supplement coverage. The bottom line: I CAN'T AFFORD IT! So, I do not participate in these programs, wellness checks ect. We should have 100% coverage! This system is a racket!"

— YouTube · New changes could be coming to Medicare in 2027 · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=7cDpJANnu2U&lc=UgyYM5lykNU2Zpo0XCR4AaABAg>

↳ @zrx4me1 (1): "You have a crappy plan."

Wishing for someone unbiased to explain it · 6 documents

"Can't afford Medicare premium This. Went on Medicare when I turned 65. Everything was fine and then Medicare reassessed salary based on some taxable pension that I took out of my retirement account. I used all that money for my house and , my premium went up by a few hundred dollars between Medicare premium and my part C it's about \$800 a month that I cannot afford as a single person on a teachers salary. I appealed appeal was denied so I'm going back on my employers insurance as soon as I can! what a mess I wish somebody at my work had told me about IRMAA when I applied for Medicare. I wonder if anybody else has been in the situation?"

— r/medicare · 51 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1tm895k/>

↳ (0): "It should automatically go down in January, if your income goes back down. We won appeal in 2024 and again in 2026 based on retirement events."

↳ (0): "I just asked Google this question "can you go off medicare to avoid irmaa" You should do the same and read the full reply. (It basically says don't do it and gives options to reduce IRMAA which I am including below.) # Here is what it says about dropping Medicare: **No**, dropping your Medicare coverage to avoid IRMAA (Income-Related Monthly Adjustment Amount) is rarely a good idea. \[1](https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1jlerg5/disenrolling_from_part_b_and_reenolling_later_on/)\] If you voluntarily disenroll from Part B and Part D, your IRMAA surcharges may temporarily stop, but you will face severe consequences: \[1](<https://www.ssa.gov/medicare/lower-irmaa/>)\] **Gaps in Coverage:** You will be left without coverage for basic outpatient care, doctor visits, or prescription drugs. **Permanent Late Enrollment Penalties:** When you try to re-enroll in Medicare later, you will face hefty, permanent late enrollment penalties. **Lack of Guarantee:** You may not be able to simply re-enroll whenever you want; you will have to wait for the General Enrollment Period (January 1–March 31) with coverage beginning the following July. \[1](<https://www.ssa.gov/medicare/lower-irmaa/>), [2](<https://www.investmentnews.com/retirement-planning/what-happens-to-medicare-when-you-suspend-social-security-bennies/48121>), [3](<https://thebig65.com/medigap-plans-guide/>), [4](<https://boomerbenefits.com/medicare-enrollment-period/>), [5](<https://www.leonardfinancialsolutions.com/transition-from-employer-insurance-to-medicare/>)\] # These are the ways it suggests for reducing IRMAA: **Better Ways to Reduce or Avoid IRMAA** Instead of dropping your Medicare coverage, consider these legally recognized strategies to lower your MAGI or appeal the surcharge: \[1](<https://www.schwab.com/learn/story/how-higher-income-can-affect-medicare-premiums>), [2](<https://www.medicareresources.org/blog/four-ways-to-avoid-income-related-medicare-surcharges/>), [3](<https://decimawealth.com/planning/avoid-irmaa-surcharges/>)\] **File an Appeal for Life-Changing Events:** If your income dropped due to a qualifying life event (like retirement, work reduction, divorce, or the death of a spouse), you can appeal to the Social Security Administration using [Form SSA-44](<https://www.ssa.gov/forms/ssa-44.pdf>). **Reduce Taxable Income Pre-Retirement:** Maximize pre-tax contributions to employer-sponsored retirement plans (like a 401(k) or 403(b)) before you hit age 65. **Make Qualified Charitable Distributions (QCDs):** If you are 70½ or older, you can donate up to \\\\$111,000\\ per year directly from your IRA to a charity. This money is not counted as taxable income, thereby lowering your MAGI. **Roth Conversions Early On:** Strategically converting traditional retirement accounts to Roth IRAs *before* you reach Medicare age can reduce your future taxable RMDs (Required Minimum Distributions).\[1](<https://youstaywealthy.com/how-to-avoid-irmaa/>), [2](<https://www.ssa.gov/medicare/lower-irmaa/>), [3](<https://www.kiplinger.com/retirement/medicare/avoid-the-irmaa-with-a-roth-conversion>), [4](https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1jlerg5/disenrolling_from_part_b_and_reenolling_later_on/), [5](<https://medicareagentshub.com/questions/how-can-i-avoid-or-reduce-irmaa-charges-on-my-medicare-premiums/>)\] — — Hope this helps. I do Roth conversions which increase my income. IRMAA is triggered. (There is a 2 year look back so the impact of this years conversions cause IRMA 2 years later). If I stopped conversions, iRMAA would stop 2 years later. But I could use some the money I converted to pay the IRMAA if I had to. I don't fully understand your issue, but hopefully this helps you with some options. 🙏 "

↳ (0): "I dropped my part b due to an Irmia spike and stayed on my wife's insurance for three years, as long as you have creditable coverage it's not issue, you just have to reapply."

"One thing they never told me when starting Medicare was that if you are basically healthy and pick a cheaper plan you will never be able to switch to a better plan. After you first start Medicare they can deny you based on medical history. I wish someone had told me to go with the most expensive plan I could afford. Thank you for mentioning that risk."

— YouTube · Medicare Plan N Compared to Plan G - Which Should You Choose? · 6 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=3WBOKbvEq9U&lc=Ugy-MHTft3p5p5yT-h14AaABAq>

↳ @carapungo (1): "of course you can change from plans on a yearly basis, specially if you are in good health."

↳ @joycewright5386 (0): "@carapungo yes but what they didn't tell me was if I develop a chronic condition no plan will insure me ever. So I am stuck with whatever plan I picked originally. If I had known that I would have picked a better plan."

↳ @carapungo (0): "@joycewright5386 so which plan do you have now?"

"FINALLY someone to explain the difference!! My brother sold these insurance for years and I still never understood. Could it be the push for advantage plans pays more to the agent??? Hmmm. At 75 I'm in pretty good health but gosh one bad fall or cancer would be break me. Now I can explain to my friends. Thank you from Houston. Edit: I have a question. 2019 I had open heart surgery. My advantage plan paid everything. I don't remember the amt. So they did pay. Will that be held against me in the future pay out? As we age will they refuse treatment? I'm hearing it called disadvantage plan because of this. I thought I understood so can you clarify?"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement easy cost comparison. · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Cz7BrmU1Guk&lc=UgxTHfn7Z2jStPskQ4t4AaABAq>

↳ @asterixky (2): "MA does pay a large portion of the bills if not all. People saying otherwise have never had MA."

↳ @AbtInsuranceAgency (1): "Thank You!! (From Austin 😊)"

↳ @kittygriggs4146 (0): "@asterixky keep reading & hearing that more & more drs & hospitals are not accepting Advantage plans, seems like they're trying to phase it out. This is all so confusing!!! 😞"

Tab 8 — Desired Outcomes

Theme	Documents
Happy with an Advantage plan	319
Peace of mind: nothing to worry about	190
Money saved, in their numbers	175
Care that just worked, no hassle	163
Got out of Advantage and onto a supplement	57
Never saw a bill after a major illness	38
Covered anywhere they travel	35
Extras that actually paid: dental, gym, OTC, giveback	32
Found an agent or broker they trust	27
Glad they kept Original Medicare (or got out in time)	22

Happy with an Advantage plan · 319 documents

"Medicare Advantage has worked beautifully for me! I'm very happy with the advantage plan."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage Plans Leaving in 2026 - 2,600,000 Seniors Impacted · 1,591 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8Pq6H7UZBbU&lc=UgwDONw571nel_1vEx4AaABAg

↳ @karenotter3109 (39): "Maam, you WONT HAVE YOUR PLAN in 2026!"

↳ @JoshuaMartins-sr7ez (30): "The news about so many Medicare Advantage plans leaving in 2026 has people rattled—and for good reason. Healthcare is one of the biggest financial variables in retirement."

↳ @NormanWashington_Ir3ri (10): "That's why the most powerful way to think about this isn't just: "Which plan do I pick?" but "How do I restructure my money so healthcare inflation doesn't derail my retirement goals?"

"Medicare Advantage is a Scam: My experience almost a decade in the Healthcare industry I was inspired to go into some detail after an AskReddit post about dirty insider truth that most people won't know. I replied that, as a person who who's worked in the medical field for a little over 9 years, saying that Medicare is leagues better than Medicare Advantage and Medicare Advantage is a scam. I've worked in a Home Health Agency, an inpatient rehab (SNF), a doctor's office, and am currently an RN working inpatient rehab. Hopefully, people will find this interesting or helpful \- Admissions for SNF: First medical jobs was admissions primarily to fill short term rehab beds. I had a website of all the people discharging from local hospitals who needed inpatient therapy, I would reach out to the hospitals, say we had a bed available, they would confirm with me, I would get the paperwork, get insurance authorization if needed, and greet the patient once they arrived and sign papers Medicare patients: I was told to try and get as many traditional Medicare patients as possible. I asked my boss why and she said that they pay the most and they always pay. I never once had to get insurance authorizations for traditional Medicare. The people could just come in! It covered the most therapy per day vs any other insurance(an hour a day vs. 30 minutes a day usually), including every Medicare Advantage. It automatically covered the first 20 days, then the next 80 days after that, I think it was like 60%. But if they had a secondary insurance, it would cover 100 days at 100%. Medicare Advantage: First off, once you get a Medicare Advantage plan, its not traditional medicare anymore, it's the insurance company now. Of you want to come to our facility, you don't get the grace of just walking in. I'm sure they've streamlined everything now, but we had to call a number, present the diagnosis in certain code numbers, wait for an authorization number, and then we could let you in. From there, you'd maybe get 20 days at 100% with half the daily rehab, then after 20 days, they were done. it covered nothing. Patient was 100% responsible for all costs. \- Home Health Scheduler My 2nd job was scheduling a team of Therapists and Nurses to different homes in my city who needed home health. I'd get a stack of referral papers every morning and was told to get them scheduled. For example, a referral would say "Medicare A: Needs RN and PT services", and then I'd contact my staff and arrange a schedule. I would also work with my staff and the patients that needed anything rescheduled. I was essentially the Guy in the Chair Medicare: Let's say that of my 3 referrals I had that morning 1 was traditional Medicare A, once was a UHC Medicare Advantage, and the other a Humana Medicare Advantage. Once again, I was told, "Staff the Medicare patients first!" And once again, I asked why and was told that Medicare always pays, and it always pays the most. I wasn't working directly with insurance at that job, so I can't comment on authorizations or cost. But Medicare patients generally had more RN and PT visits per week then any Medicare Advantage. Usually 3 days per week for each with Medicare, and 2 days a week for any Medicare Advantage. Also, there are longer sessions with Medicare. usually an hour vs 30 minutes Medicare Advantage: Just less care. Less staffing days and shorter sessions. \- Doctor's office: Next job I had before my RN was in a primary care physicians office. I only worked the front desk, but I worked right next to the referral coordinator, so I knew everything that was happening about that Medicare: From a cashiers perspective, Medicare never had a copay while many Medicare Advantage plan did. From a referral perspective, Medicare was so much easier. I don't think I ever saw Medicare rejected a referral claim. It was always quick, and as long as we filled the paperwork out properly, it was approved. Also, most specialists took Medicare, so usually patients could go where they wanted. Medicare Advantage: There was always an authorization process. it often involved scanning and sending documents, then waiting for approval. Generally it was a longer process that resulted in much more rejections than traditional Medicare. Also, one again, becuae Medicare Advantage isn't Medicare anymore, it's whatever insurance company has it now, the patients were stuck with whatever doctors they had plans with, and it was always a much smaller list than Tradition Medicare. I've been an RN for about 4 years now, so I am very separated from the insurance side, thank God! DISCLAIMER: Some Medicare Advantage plans are competitive with the benefits of traditional Medicare, but they are often very expensive. Some people are very happy with their Medicare Advantage plans, but I wanted to share my perspective, and my experience. But, this is also why I am greatly in support of expanding Medicare to cover all People in the US. We have the means to give the people proper Healthcare, we just need to do it"

— r/HealthInsurance · 472 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1sl2x0z/>

↳ (0): "Reminder to get a supplemental plan with your traditional Medicare. A medigap plan. Also reminder to get your part D plan. Everything you said is spot on but leaves out those couple things that are very important. Everyone I know turning 65 I tell them get your traditional Medicare A and B and then get your D and Medigap. But that sounds really confusing to people which seems to be why they think it'd be 'easier' to just get a Medicare advantage plan to 'do it all'."

↳ (0): "I did research for 2 month on my spare time when I chose my mom's plan last year. And this sub was so beneficial because of so many people sharing their experiences. I chose her A,B,D an G Extra. I feel really bad they make it sooo

complicated. I can't imagine being 65 and having to deal with this nonsense."

↳ (0): "The current administration is pushing MA plans; they want to get out of the Medicare business and just pay the \$\$ to the private insurers instead. I think more people need to be aware of this & put a stop to it. As an elderly person, you don't want a for-profit company making care decisions for you."

"Retirement and Dealing with Cancer Costs It is not a pleasant subject, but it is important to talk about it. According to WebMD, 30% of seniors aged 65-74, 19% of 75-84, and 8% over 85 get cancer. Within the last 2.5 years, I've had three different cancers, and I retired at the same time. It can be expensive. I thought I would share my experience dealing with the costs. The three cancers I've had to contend with are Mantle Cell Lymphoma (blood cancer), Squamous Cell Carcinoma (skin cancer), and prostate cancer. Mantle Cell Lymphoma is incurable. In my case, my oncologist advised me to delay treatment as long as possible since it always comes back and is harder to treat each subsequent relapse. I was on a "Wait and Watch" monitoring program for over two years with blood tests every 3-months and a scan every 6-months. The monitoring showed it had progressed and required treatment, which I started earlier this month. I'll have 6-months of chemotherapy / immunotherapy followed by 2-years of less intensive "maintenance" therapy. Over the last couple of years, in addition to the chemo treatment, I've had numerous blood tests, PET scans, CT scans, biopsies, and doctor appointments. For the skin cancer, I had a blob of Squamous Cell Carcinoma cut off my face using the "Mohs" procedure, and another much smaller spot shaved off the tip of my nose. I've had multiple visits with the surgeon and other specialists, and I will require skin checks every 6-months because of all of the per-cancerous lesions that keep popping up. The prostate cancer was detected during a PET scan for the lymphoma. However, after a follow-up MRI and biopsy (lot of fun), it was determined that I have the least aggressive form of prostate cancer which does not need immediate treatment and can be managed with "Active Surveillance". I am told it is slow growing and I have about a 50% chance of needing treatment in the next 10 years. I will be monitored with blood tests, MRI scans, and possibly additional biopsies in the years to come. As you can imagine, all of these tests, procedures, and treatments are very expensive. I had always planned on retiring the day I turned 65. However, I was diagnosed with the lymphoma when I was 64 and I decided to work an extra 10 months after I turned 65 (until the end of the year) because: 1) I had already met the out-of-pocket maximum for the year for my work health insurance; 2) my job was very supportive and allowed me to take time off as needed; and 3) my wife would be in a better position financially if things didn't go well for me. I had plenty of time to learn about Medicare, which I started in January 2024 when I officially retired. There are two ways to get Medicare: Original Medicare or a Part C Advantage Plan. With Original Medicare, you really need to also have a Medigap Supplemental Plan and a Part D prescription drug plan. There are several options for a Supplemental Plan. I chose Plan G, which covers everything except an annual deductible. For 2025, the annual deductible was only \$257, which I probably hit within the first 15-minutes of my first appointment in January. Everything else is free for the rest of the year. I should point out that, if I had been on my work group health insurance plan, I would have incurred several thousands of dollars of costs each year until I hit my out-of-pocket maximum. Compared to an Advantage Plan, the premiums are higher with Original Medicare and a Supplemental Plan G, but you don't have any restrictions of which doctors are in your network, and you don't have to worry about insurance company pre-approval. In addition to lower premiums, Advantage plans also include perks such as dental, vision, and maybe even a gym membership. Many people are very happy with their Advantage plan, and may save money with the lower premiums. However, based on my experience, I think Original Medicare with a Supplemental Plan G is preferred if you have a serious illness such as cancer, and you can afford the higher premiums. I pay \$185 for Medicare Part B, \$209 for my Supplemental Plan G, and \$17.50 for my Part D prescription plan. Dental and vision I pay out of pocket. The main benefit of Original Medicare with a Supplemental plan is I've never had to worry about insurance company pre-approvals, or whether my doctor accepted it. In general, I think it is wise to get the best insurance that you can afford."

— r/retirement · 161 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/retirement/comments/1liorgh/>

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Oregon. We wouldn't have been able to do that with an Advantage plan. It may be that our local hospital would have been fine managing his care, but we're much more confident in the care plan and speed of treatment he's been getting at MD Anderson."

Peace of mind: nothing to worry about · 190 documents

"Almost fell into that trap until I was warned by a person who's family member eventually died because of care that was denied to them because Medicare Advantage declined to pay for treatment because it was too expensive despite the recommendation of a specialist. While in the appeals process, the family member passed away. After doing some research on my own, I found that this had occurred multiple times with people on Medicare Advantage. Also, that many healthcare providers were now refusing to accept Medicare Advantage. Needless to say, I chose traditional Medicare. The gap premiums aren't cheap, but I have the "peace of mind" of knowing that I can receive the care/treatment recommended by my doctor. This shouldn't be happening to seniors who PAID into Medicare their entire working lives."

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 270 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9Id0w9OA&lc=UgwTr1OgGdvCFu3U5Fp4AaABAq>

↳ @CB-vg1wq (17): "@miriamlandau1207 You pay into both. On a W-2 social security withhold is in box 4. Medicare tax is Box 5."

↳ @ighdesigns (14): "The insurance companies are always just trying to outlast the patients."

↳ @miriamlandau1207 (3): "You are paying into Social Security not into Medicare."

"Glad I did my homework and chose traditional Medicare over Medicare Advantage. I read too many horror stories about people who became catastrophically ill, and had problems seeing specialists, or obtaining certain treatments. I would rather pay for the "peace of mind," and the CHOICE to go where I want, and see the doctor or specialist I need/want."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 264 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgxefqUbjQyLYRyCYv54AaABAq>

↳ @DankFarrikMe (10): "@LisaKnobel Medicare covers most everything, so unless you have a rare never heard of disease that has holistic/experimental treatment...Medicare/Medigap will cover it."

↳ @aregee7121 (10): "It's way more than just choice or peace of mind. Advantage plans, all insurance co. based, are more like socialized medicine, i.e. less spending per patient. You get restrictive networks, forced diagnosis first with G.P. or P.A! with delayed referral to a specialist, possibly not the one you want. The end result is a delay of the proper treatment. Do you want this as you get older?"

↳ @maryequilter31 (7): "The person at our local senior center who helped with info when we signed up for Medicare over 5 years ago warned us about not being guaranteed to move from an advantage to a Medigap/supplemental plan. So very glad we chose a supplemental plan. The advantage plans are a horror of denials, referrals etc."

"Retirement and Dealing with Cancer Costs It is not a pleasant subject, but it is important to talk about it. According to WebMD, 30% of seniors aged 65-74, 19% of 75-84, and 8% over 85 get cancer. Within the last 2.5 years, I've had three different cancers, and I retired at the same time. It can be expensive. I thought I would share my experience dealing with the costs. The three cancers I've had to contend with are Mantle Cell Lymphoma (blood cancer), Squamous Cell Carcinoma (skin cancer), and prostate cancer. Mantle Cell Lymphoma is incurable. In my case, my oncologist advised me to delay treatment as long as possible since it always comes back and is harder to treat each subsequent relapse. I was on a "Wait and Watch" monitoring program for over two years with blood tests every 3-months and a scan every 6-months. The monitoring showed it had progressed and required treatment, which I started earlier this month. I'll have 6-months of chemotherapy / immunotherapy followed by 2-years of less intensive "maintenance" therapy. Over the last couple of years, in addition to the chemo treatment, I've had numerous blood tests, PET scans, CT scans, biopsies, and doctor appointments. For the skin cancer, I had a blob of Squamous Cell Carcinoma cut off my face using the "Mohs" procedure, and another much smaller spot shaved off the tip of my nose. I've had multiple visits with the surgeon and other specialists, and I will require skin checks every 6-months because of all of the per-cancerous lesions that keep popping up. The prostate cancer was detected during a PET scan for the lymphoma. However, after a follow-up MRI and biopsy (lot of fun), it was determined that I have the least aggressive form of prostate cancer which does not need immediate treatment and can be managed with "Active Surveillance". I am told it is slow growing and I have about a 50% chance of needing treatment in the next 10 years. I will be monitored with blood tests, MRI scans, and possibly additional biopsies in the years to come. As you can imagine, all of these tests, procedures, and treatments are very expensive. I had always planned on retiring the day I turned 65. However, I was diagnosed with the lymphoma when I was 64 and I decided to work an extra 10 months after I turned 65 (until the end of the year) because: 1) I had already met the out-of-pocket maximum for the year for my work health insurance; 2) my job was very supportive and allowed me to take time off as needed; and 3) my wife would be in a better position financially if things didn't go well for me. I had plenty of time to learn about Medicare, which I started in January 2024 when I officially retired. There are two ways to get Medicare: Original Medicare or a Part C Advantage Plan. With Original Medicare, you really need to also have a Medigap Supplemental Plan and a Part D prescription drug plan. There are several options for a Supplemental Plan. I chose Plan G, which covers everything except an annual deductible. For 2025, the annual deductible was only \$257, which I probably hit within the first 15-minutes of my first appointment in January. Everything else is free for the rest of the year. I should point out that, if I had been on my work group health insurance plan, I would have incurred several thousands of dollars of costs each year until I hit my out-of-pocket maximum. Compared to an Advantage Plan, the premiums are higher with Original Medicare and a Supplemental Plan G, but you don't have any restrictions of which doctors are in your network, and you don't have to worry about insurance company pre-approval. In addition to lower premiums, Advantage plans also include perks such as dental, vision, and maybe even a gym membership. Many people are very happy with their Advantage plan, and may save money with the lower premiums. However, based on my experience, I think Original Medicare with a Supplemental Plan G is preferred if you have a serious illness such as cancer, and you can afford the higher premiums. I pay \$185 for Medicare Part B, \$209 for my Supplemental Plan G, and \$17.50 for my Part D prescription plan. Dental and vision I pay out of pocket. The main benefit of Original Medicare with a Supplemental plan is I've never had to worry about insurance company pre-approvals, or whether my doctor accepted it. In general, I think it is wise to get the best insurance that you can afford."

— r/retirement · 161 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/retirement/comments/1liorgh/>

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Oregon. We wouldn't have been able to do that with an Advantage plan. It may be that our local hospital would have been fine managing his care, but we're much more confident in the care plan and speed of treatment he's been getting at MD Anderson."

Money saved, in their numbers · 175 documents

"I came off a supplement to an advantage plan about 5 years ago for two reasons affordability and our good health. We enrolled into a HMO-POS plan for 2026. Of course before the switch we verified all of our providers were still in the plan. Zero premium and \$4800.00 MOP. Which is thousands less than the previous plan. I've saved in premiums over the 5 years over 18K. And wer still healthy."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage Plans Leaving in 2026 - 2,600,000 Seniors Impacted · 888 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8Pq6H7UZZbU&lc=UgyH9WWhAjCLi7IrkMt4AaABAg>

↳ @Johnsonadam_6652 (1): "Exactly.It's a calculated risk. I did the same, but a major health event last year showed me the holes in my "cheap" plan. The out-of-pocket max became a real number fast. That \$18k in savings vanished in medical bills."

↳ @AmirKazan-n2l (1): "What professional looks at healthcare and investments together?Most treat them separately."

↳ @ReeceCook-r7o (0): "Smart move saving on premiums.That \$18k can compound. The risk is the plan's network stability. A provider leaving or a new diagnosis can change the math overnight. You're betting on continued health."

"Our Medicare Advantage Experience I have no affiliation with any health insurance companies and no particular ax to grind. I just want to share our experience because I see a lot of scary information out there about Medicare Advantage. We live in Florida and my wife has been on Medicare for 11 years and 9 years for me. The first few years we were on traditional Medicare with a Plan F HD supplement, then we switched to MA, first with Aetna and now Humana. We travel a lot so we needed PPO plans for all this time. We signed up for MA because it seemed like such a better deal than Medicare plus a supplement, and that has worked out well for us. We paid no premiums (other than the Medicare B premiums everyone pays) on Aetna and on Humana we actually get a \$175/month rebate towards the B premium. We have watched the co-pays for specialists go up frequently and now pay \$50 per specialist visit. Primary care visits have always been free. In spite of the bad reports on MA, we were very healthy and thought it would be a risk we could take. Five years ago my wife was diagnosed with a faulty mitral valve in her heart. The cardiologist checked it every year and this year he decided it was severe enough to require fixing. Fast forward several months and my wife is now recovering from open heart surgery, which was successful. She spent six days in the hospital and is getting twice a week home care from a nurse, a physical therapist and an occupational therapist. There were two tests that required procedures in an outpatient heart center at the hospital before her surgery. The total out of pocket for all this was about \$3,000. The hospital and physician charges billed to Humana were in the neighborhood of \$300K. We never had to deal with any refusals of coverage, balance billing or any other surprises. So our experience with a major medical issue was outstanding. For the 8 years we have been on MA, we've paid no premiums, had reimbursements for dental work and eyewear of at least \$20K and had no issues with finding good doctors and facilities in-network. Bottom line, who knows what surprises might await us as we get older and less healthy, but I have no complaints about our experience with MA so far. UPDATE: Thanks to everyone who contributed to this thread! It's clear that MA can be anywhere from great to awful, depending on the plans in your area and your individual health situation. I think the comments brought up great issues to explore before choosing MA or traditional Medicare with a supplement. I know we are risking challenges in MA if we move or networks change for the worse. But I calculate that we've saved roughly \$57k in supplement premiums (for 2 people) and received roughly \$20k in dental benefits over 8 years, so the risk was certainly worth it so far."

— r/medicare · 139 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1tp8qt5/>

↳ (0): "I've had the same positive experience with my MA plan for 10 years. I'll go ahead and upvote you in preparation for the Reddit MA-Hating Mafia that will surely show up and tell you why we are stupid and shower us both with down votes."

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"Wellcare wanted \$110 for one generic prescription — Cost Plus Drugs was \$16.85 delivered I wanted to share this because Medicare drug pricing has gotten ridiculous enough that it really pays to check cash prices instead of automatically using your Part D insurance. I have Wellcare for my Medicare prescription coverage. My PCP recently sent in a 90-day prescription for generic aripiprazole (Abilify), 2 mg tablets. My copay through Wellcare was going to be **\$110**. I checked Mark Cuban Cost Plus Drug Company instead. Their price for the same 90-day prescription was: * Medication: **\$10.90** * Shipping: **\$5.95** * Total: **\$16.85** So I saved about **\$93** by simply not using my Medicare drug insurance. This isn't the first time I've run into this.

Wellcare also recently dropped the main pharmacy in my town as a **preferred pharmacy**, which makes things even more inconvenient. I had another experience at Safeway where I was picking up **two generic medications**. Using my Wellcare insurance, Safeway wanted about **\$75**. The pharmacy employee checked another option, bypassed my insurance, and used a prescription discount code instead. The price dropped to **\$23**. That really opened my eyes. We're told Medicare Part D is supposed to help lower prescription costs, but in some cases I'm finding that the cash price or a discount program is dramatically cheaper than using the insurance I'm already paying for. My takeaway is simple: **Before paying your Medicare prescription copay, ask the pharmacy what the cash price is and check places like Cost Plus Drugs or prescription discount programs**. Especially with generics, the difference can apparently be huge. I'm not saying Wellcare is always more expensive, and obviously everyone's plan and medications are different. But after seeing \$110 become \$16.85, and \$75 become \$23, I'm going to compare prices every time from now on. Hopefully this saves somebody else a few bucks — or in my case, nearly a hundred."

— r/medicare · 129 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1w5n6j8/>

↳ (0): "Yes, many times other avenues can be cheaper than what the insurance price is. Be aware that any cost paid through other avenues do not count toward the plan deductible, and do not count toward the annual \$2,100 cap."

↳ (0): "I think this is the explanation. <https://www.drugpatentwatch.com/blog/the-pbm-endgame-what-mark-cuban-got-right-and-pharma-is-still-ignoring/> >Mark Cuban launched Cost Plus Drugs in January 2022 with a simple premise: buy generic drugs at manufacturer cost, add a fixed 15% markup, charge a \$3 dispensing fee, and sell directly to patients. The prices were so low they shocked people. Imatinib, a generic cancer drug, went from \$9,657 per month at many retail pharmacies to \$47 at Cost Plus. Clonazepam, a common seizure and anxiety drug, dropped to pennies per pill. Cuban had not invented a new drug. He had not built a better supply chain. *He had simply cut out the pharmacy benefit manager*. This PBM business probably has something to do with high prices. Maybe we all need PBM-free prescriptions."

↳ (0): "Yep, in fact check around at the WellCare in network non preferred pharmacies too. I found that a script priced at \$140 at a WellCare preferred pharmacy was actually the same lower price as Costplus at a WellCare in network non preferred pharmacy."

Care that just worked, no hassle · 163 documents

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"7 years on a Med Advantage plan (for several years was on United Healthcare, but have since switched to Aetna), and I've had virtually no problems, with perhaps the one exception of sometimes having to wait a bit extra for an appointment with my PCP. No problems at all when having to visit specialists. Super and I mean super low cost - in fact, virtually no cost to Advantage. Not arguing with this gentleman, but I'm fine with my plan."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 76 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgwzVa7DMisnauv3TWV4AaABAq>

↳ @JoyofRVing (6): "When you're younger it's OK, but when you need to get post Acute services they suck. They denied Acute rehab for a patient of mine who had a hip fracture. They also denied skilled nursing for her. She ended up going home with home PT twice a week."

↳ @MerkinMuffly (2): "Sure, Medicare Advantage employee, but I think I'll pass."

↳ @lesleyheller2271 (1): "There are differences between the regulated Medicare supplement plans which can make a difference in what's covered and what is not. While I plan to use original Medicare and Plan F, what about people who choose Plan N? You need to clarify that, in an otherwise informative video."

"Clover Health is defying expectations in the BEST way possible I just wanted to brag a little. I've had very little reason to do so in regards to anything health insurance related...ever. I've been a Clover health, first time on Medicare, patient for 1 month a 5 days. I have special needs (14 hrs/day IV infusions in the home for past 2.5 years) which prior to having Medicare were met by commercial insurance without a problem. Apparently infusions in the home are very rarely a covered thing under medicare. They are although covered in Hospice and the Hospital. Obviously I don't want to live in either. I am in my 30s. Clover Health quickly recognized that this is a complex situation that requires delicacy. A small specialty pharmacy might not agree to a drawn out process to get meds covered for this one patient on Medicare after all...and others aren't taking new patients in my area due to IV fluids still being somewhat impacted (shortage) from last year's hurricane. Anyway, Clover Health assigns a team on this that calls me every night. Also, gets me the most tenacious, amazing nurse advocate and they all begin a 2 week long talk with my pharmacy culminating in a single patient agreement going forward. I am relieved and grateful to say the least."

— r/medicare · 73 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1opyfpd/>

↳ (0): "What wonderful news for you! This is how *all of them* should do it--patient first centered care. Do what's right by your patient! The good will you will spread for them is invaluable. As it should be."

↳ (0): "I agree we need a lot more of this. Faith and good will can really use restoring!"

↳ (0): "Post this on X under Dr. Oz , AOC and RFK. Maybe they will get the picture of how an insurance company should behave. Happy for you!"

Got out of Advantage and onto a supplement · 57 documents

"I had switched from Advantage to Plan G because I'm totally risk-averse. Good thing I did. Out of the blue, I got neurological symptoms that made it impossible to type, write, knit, hike, or even walk my dog. (Fast forward several months--turns out they were caused by the neurosurgeon who treated me 15 years ago). Because I live in a part of the country with very poor medical coverage, my PCP referred me to a university medical center in another state. I got first class care--surgery, hospitalization, home health all were billed to Medicare at over \$350K. I paid nothing. If I had been on Advantage, I most likely would have been limited to the surgeon who caused my problem in the first place. And next week I'll go hiking with my dog for the first time in over a year."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 270 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgxCXf6P2_bAdYu1Q_l4AaABAg

↳ @Theretirementnerds (9): "Thank you for sharing your experience 🧠 Glad to hear you'll be able to walk your dog again soon! Hope recovery is going okay!"

↳ @elizabethb.1693 (4): "That's awesome! 🙌 🍷"

↳ @clairemckayhart1109 (3): "Thank you for the elephant advice, coming up on 65 and retirement."

"The Hidden Dangers of Medicare Advantage Plans for Social Security Recipients It's open enrollment time for Medicare eligibles. All those TV ads and direct mail pieces, some of which come from hospitals, urging you to switch to a Medicare Advantage Plan from the traditional Medicare Part A and B. Medicare Advantage plans, also known as Medicare Part C, have gained popularity recently as an alternative to traditional Medicare. These plans offer enticing benefits such as low premiums and additional coverage, making them seem like an excellent choice for Social Security recipients. However, beneath the surface, hidden dangers and drawbacks may make Medicare Advantage plans a bad choice for those relying on Social Security benefits. As a retired healthcare executive, if you are considering enrolling for the first time or switching from traditional Medicare, don't do it. It is a shell game that gives providers some reimbursement certainty and cost control for CMS. But, as the healthcare consumer, you still pay the deductibles and co-pays just like traditional Medicare Part A and B. While it sounds great that you get all these additional services on Medicare Advantage, are you financially prepared to spend thousands of dollars out of pocket for what Medicare Advantage does not pay? Did they tell you you can't have a Medigap plan under Medicare Advantage to cover your deductibles and co-pays? Well, you can't. There are some severe disadvantages for Medicare eligibles to enroll in Medicare Advantage. Medicare Advantage is an HMO. Providers and insurance companies are paid a per member per month fee, also known as capitation. From the monthly payment as well as your out-of-pocket expenses like deductibles and co-pays, they provide the care you "need." Limiting care is the only way for them to make money off of you. Besides that 800-pound elephant in the room, what follows are the eight primary reasons why you should run as far away as possible from enrolling in a Medicare Advantage plan.

1. Limited Network of Providers One of the most significant drawbacks of Medicare Advantage plans is the restricted network of healthcare providers. These plans often have a narrower network of doctors, specialists, and hospitals than traditional Medicare. Social Security recipients may have complex medical needs and may find that their preferred healthcare providers are not part of the plan's network. This limitation can be frustrating, as it may force beneficiaries to switch doctors or travel long distances to receive the care they need.
2. Lack of Out-of-Network Coverage Traditional Medicare allows beneficiaries to see any Medicare-approved provider anywhere in the country. On the other hand, Medicare Advantage plans typically do not cover out-of-network care except in emergencies. For Social Security recipients who may want to see specialists or receive treatment from a particular healthcare facility, the lack of out-of-network coverage can be a significant disadvantage.
3. Prior Authorization and Referral Requirements Medicare Advantage plans often require beneficiaries to obtain prior authorization for certain medical procedures, tests, or treatments. They may also require referrals to see specialists. These administrative hurdles can lead to delays in receiving necessary care and add complexity to an already complicated healthcare system. Social Security recipients, who may be dealing with health issues that require timely attention, might find these requirements burdensome.
4. Changes in Plan Offerings Medicare Advantage plans can change their benefits, formularies, and network providers from year to year. While all insurance plans can change, this uncertainty can be especially challenging for Social Security recipients who rely on stable and predictable healthcare coverage. Beneficiaries may find that the plan they selected one year no longer meets their needs in the next, leading to potential disruptions in their care.
5. Potential for Higher Out-of-Pocket Costs While Medicare Advantage plans often advertise low or zero monthly premiums, they may have higher out-of-pocket costs in the form of copayments, coinsurance, and deductibles. Social Security recipients living on fixed incomes may find it challenging to budget for these unexpected costs. Moreover, traditional Medicare, coupled with a Medigap (Medicare Supplement) policy, can offer more predictability in healthcare expenses.
6. Limited Coverage Outside the United States Medicare Advantage plans usually provide limited or no coverage for medical services received outside the United States. For Social Security recipients who may want to travel or spend time abroad during retirement, this can be a significant drawback. Traditional Medicare offers coverage for emergency care while traveling internationally, which can provide peace of mind to beneficiaries who enjoy exploring the world.
7. One-Size-Fits-All Approach Medicare Advantage plans often adopt a one-size-fits-all approach, offering all enrollees a standardized set of benefits. This can be problematic for Social Security recipients with unique medical needs or preferences. Traditional Medicare and a Medigap policy allow beneficiaries to customize their coverage to better suit their health circumstances.
8. Potential for Disenrollment Penalties If a Social Security recipient decides to switch from a Medicare Advantage plan to traditional Medicare and add a Medigap policy, they may face financial penalties. Under certain circumstances, beneficiaries can be subject to medical underwriting when applying for a Medigap policy, potentially resulting in higher premiums or even denial of coverage. This can be a significant deterrent for those who initially choose a Medicare Advantage plan without fully understanding the long-term consequences. Think twice and carefully. Medicare Advantage plans may be a good choice for some Medicare beneficiaries. Still, for Social Security recipients they come with a set of hidden dangers and drawbacks that deserve careful consideration. The limited network of providers, lack of out-of-network coverage, prior authorization and referral requirements, changes in plan offerings, potential

for higher out-of-pocket costs, and other disadvantages may not align with the healthcare needs and preferences of this particular group. Before making a decision, Social Security recipients should thoroughly research and compare their options, considering their unique health circumstances, financial situation, and long-term goals. Traditional Medicare, coupled with a Medigap policy, offers more flexibility and predictability, ensuring that beneficiaries can access the care they need when and where they need it. I am a retired healthcare executive, and it will be a cold day in hell before I ever switch from traditional Medicare to a Medicare Advantage plan. <https://www.msn.com/en-us/money/retirement/the-hidden-dangers-of-medicare-advantage-plans-for-social-security-recipients/ar-AA1jl4ko?ocid=msedgdhp&pc=U531&cvid=bc348797770942dabb40e02380e1d59a&ei=28>;

— r/medicare · 48 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/17n5yr3/>

↳ (0): "In terms of coverage, traditional Medicare and a supplement is going to offer more choices and flexibility than a Medicare Advantage plan. Whether or not it's affordable for everyone is another story. The unfortunate truth is that more and more of our senior population is living on poverty wages and simply can't afford a Medicare supplement. Also, most retirees have been covered by managed care plans for a good portion of their working careers, so dealing with provider networks and utilization management is not a novel concept. With annual max of pocket costs under \$4000 for PPOs in my area, many of these individuals are choosing a zero premium MAPD option and paying for the care they use as they use it. Are MAPDs right for everyone? Of course not. But, the market has spoken on Medicare Advantage plans. More than half of the 65 million Americans on Medicare are currently enrolled in Medicare Advantage plans. They aren't going anywhere. It's important to discuss the potential risks of MAPDs, but it's not inherently the wrong choice. **Edited for auto cor-wrecks"

↳ (0): "I get several calls a day from foreign call centers regarding Medicare. They are frequently aggressive and sometimes vulgar. My latest weapon - your insurance license number... I ask: if you sell Medicare related products in my state you must be licensed, what is your number? The next sound is a click."

↳ (0): "This is correct!!! OP is very uneducated in Medicare... clearly!!!! and can be proven by going to Medicare.gov!!!! I hope this post was satire. But please y'all do not listen this this is not correct."

"Another negative for Advantage plans is that hospitals in my area are refusing to accept certain Advantage plans. So if you have a doctor you like and he works out of a certain hospital you could find yourself looking for another doctor and hospital. I was on an Advantage plan but was able to get on Plan G because the hospital I use stopped accepting the Advantage plan I was on. I didn't have to get approved or pass any medical tests to go on Plan G since it wasn't my fault that my Advantage plan was no longer valid. Best thing that could have happened to me."

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 32 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=Ugx4MOWZuO_w_2-SLoV4AaABAg

↳ @tracyjohnson5023 (1): "Same here. The hospital still accepts advantage, but many doctors do not"

Never saw a bill after a major illness · 38 documents

"As a retired Fed, I kept my Federal Employee Health Care plan to supplement Medicare for my wife and me. We are in our early 70s and we spend about \$1000.00 a month for Medicare, health, prescriptions and dental coverage which is pricey. However, we see the best doctors we can find and make our own health care decisions. We have had 3 major back surgeries, a shoulder replacement surgery, a hip replacement surgery, 2 Carpal tunnel surgeries, cataract surgery, and a heart attack scare all with zero additional out of pocket expenses. I will pay whatever it takes to not be in "managed" care."
— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 18 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgwpYf9xGADzU9o1T654AaABAg>

↳ @martygraw9708 (2): "I'm also on FEHB and another big advantage is not having to worry about IRMAA"

↳ @TAM-bv2di (0): "@martygraw9708 Good for you both, and you're welcome! As a regular payer of IRMAA, I'm glad you're enjoying the benefit of that rip-off that regular payees into the system - not the special endowments that you and politicians receive, have to go endure. I don't begrudge you your self-congratulations, since I'm certain I've achieved much greater wealth than you working for actual value-added enterprises during my life!"

↳ @BrendaKennedy-l5q (0): "@martygraw9708 why is that? Curious because i am older, but I may be getting a fed job and would give up my state employment insurance (which would turn into an advantage plan at 65)."

"We have a Medigap part G plan and so glad we do. I had triple bypass surgery in February and our plans paid 100% and we never received a bill of any kind. I also get eye injections in my right eye every 8 weeks that costs \$2,700 each and again it's paid 100%."
— YouTube · Do I need a Medicare Supplement Plan? · 13 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=O-WxyTurD3c&lc=UgylWDqIB_c5_0HxCu14AaABAg

↳ @howdy2496 (2): "Down where I live the bypass would have cost \$325 with an advantage plans and no monthly premium."

↳ @skatefan9495 (0): "As if Medicare would pay \$2,700 for weekly eye injections. Doctors don't like to take Medicare because it reimburses at such a low level."

↳ @jamesford7781 (0): "@skatefan9495many MA plans pay their in network doctors less than what Medicare does."

"I'm 85, which in dog years is quite old. I have Medicare and a supplement plan. I've had various surgeries, and since retirement I've never paid a dime for healthcare. I take three medications, which total \$18 for a three month supply. This system works for me."
— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 11 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgxAQjUbBUWngAmwFxr4AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "Thank you for watching 🙏 and sharing your experience!"

↳ @beatrizcontreras7973 (0): "Thank you verymuch ❤️❤️❤️❤️❤️❤️❤️"

Covered anywhere they travel · 35 documents

"I've had a Medicare plan and a Medicare supplement plan for about 8 years. And the supplement plan pays whatever Medicare doesn't. Minus whatever deductible you choose. Monthly premium has gone up over the years. In some years I may have paid more for the plan than I got in services, but there have been years when it's literally saved me thousands of dollars. So over the time frame I've had it. It's definitely paid for itself not only financially but in not having to worry about having a procedure done. And not needing a pre-authorization. If my doctor says go I go I can go to any doctor. I want anywhere in the nation. Medicare advantage plans are basically private insurance. High deductibles, high rejection of coverage. Pre-qualifications. Looks cheaper on the front end but you're going to lose on the back end. So listen to this man" — YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement I Most Get This Wrong · 60 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4xXIJZes9o&lc=Ugxfb9YPgrZZhd4mdaR4AaABAq>

↳ @samuelbutterworth4303 (10): "NEVER take advice from someone that makes money from the choices they recommend, like this guy. I have a degree in Economics specializing in social insurance, and an MBA. I've had Supplemental and Advantage insurance plans. I prefer Advantage plans in my area. Zero premium, zero cost family doctor, every medical profession in my city are in network, I've never had any surgery or treatment turned down, my medications are all free except for one high cost brand and that costs me \$45 per month, free dental care, free eye exams and glasses, free hearing and discounted hearing aids. They have a national network of doctors."

↳ @patriciayohn6136 (7): "Absolutely agree with you and my Husband and I did the same thing and not sorry, we went with Supplement G plan. I had to have an emergency major surgery three years ago, spent seven days in hospital and I only had to cover about \$200.00 dollars!!!"

↳ @JohnJohn-wr1jo (3): "Don't forget the bigger concern with chronic conditions and surgical needs. Quality of care. This is overlooked by almost everyone that signs up for Advantage Plans. They love the cost vs a supp plan until they need care. Seniors are dying prematurely every day because of these Advantage Plans."

"I was on Medicare advantage for 15 years because I'm disabled and I was too young to get a supplement plan. I turned 65 last year and switched to original Medicare with a Humana plan G supplement plan. I'm thrilled with this. I did have to buy a separate dental plan. But I know I can travel anywhere in the United States and I have the same coverage. And I don't get nickel and dimed to death. And I don't have to get approval for tests and surgeries. And I'm not going to be dumped. FYI, it doesn't matter what insurance company you choose for your supplement plan. They pay exactly the same. So don't spend a lot of money getting a Blue Cross plan when you can get a Humana plan that pays exactly the same and is a lot less expensive. But I do recommend plan G."

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 60 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=UgyaUtMfHKYB03d_PGZ4AaABAq

↳ @pursuehealth940 (15): "@georgebronson9486 they can't cancel plan G. They can stop accepting all insurance from one company, or all Advantage plans from all companies, but they can't stop accepting Medicare insurance or supplements. It's federally mandated."

↳ @georgebronson9486 (4): "How do you know hospitals won't start cancelling plan G? And then what?"

↳ @sarahdee374 (3): "could you share appr what your supp plan monthly premiums are? I've been on an Advantage plan for years, and happy with it, and pretty healthy too. But now I'm scared, but also don't want a high premium to pay ongoing. Thank you for sharing your experience."

"One Month Stays in Cities Across the United States My (60M) and my partner (66M) have recently retired. We have plenty of income and savings and no debt. I have private PPO medical insurance through my old job that will allow me to use doctors anywhere in the United States; we both have medical and dental insurance through the same source that is supported nationwide. As I understand it, my partner could choose original Medicare and have the same nationwide network that I do (he has an Advantage plan now through AARP). For a long time, we have wanted to sell our house and travel but not in an RV. Instead, we would like to use Airbnb to stay one month in interesting cities in the US and really get to know them and the areas near each. For instance, we could rent a condo in Nashville, Tennessee for about \$4,000 a month and get to know that city, as well as Memphis, the Great Smoky Mountains National Park, and Dollywood. Then, we could pack up and rent a place in Boston for a month; after that, maybe Washington, D.C. We will be traveling with our dog (outside of cost, this is another reason for the Airbnb instead of a hotel). Has anyone else done this? What problems did you not anticipate, from storage of household furnishings while traveling to restrictions on leaving your dog alone in the Airbnb to medical insurance difficulties?"

— r/retirement · 58 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/retirement/comments/16a2089/>

↳ (0): "FYI For all married people in community property states like CA that own real estate you can get a 100% step up in basis on the death of a spouse but the property must be held a certain way. I'm a happily divorced guy so consult with your tax advisor. [In community property states, when a spouse dies, the total fair market value of the community property, including the part that belongs to the surviving spouse, generally becomes the basis of the entire property](<https://www.kiplinger.com/retirement/estate-planning/605227/how-community-property-trusts-can-benefit-married-couples>)[1](<https://www.kiplinger.com/retirement/estate-planning/605227/how-community-property-trusts-can-benefit-married-couples>)[2](<https://www.irs.gov/publications/p555>). However, there are some exceptions to this rule. For example, assets held jointly at death only receive a step-up in basis on half the property. And the assets in the surviving spouse's sole name are not stepped-up. [One way to avoid this is to have each spouse give the other a general power of appointment over his/her property using a "joint exempt step-up trust" or "JEST"](<https://www.kiplinger.com/retirement/estate-planning/605227/how-community-property-trusts-can-benefit-married-couples>)[1](<https://www.kiplinger.com/retirement/estate-planning/605227/how-community-property-trusts-can-benefit-married-couples>).";

↳ (0): "Oh my gosh! This is exactly what my wife and I are planning to do! I (F59) just retired, and my wife (F52) is retiring at the end of this school year. We live in Charlotte, NC right now, and we plan to keep our house here but spend months at a time in more walkable places and really get the feel for them. Maybe we should meet up somewhere at some point! Our first place on our wish list will probably be the most expensive, NYC. We're looking at Brooklyn Heights. (We have dogs, too...of course we do, we're lesbians) so apartments will be the way to go over hotels. I second the advice about Whole Foods. Also Starbucks and Trader Joe's. Have you looked at the Blueground website? They have furnished apartments in major cities. Some pretty affordable. NY has a few other furnished apartment services that run a bit cheaper. Want to get in touch and talk about our similar plans? Send me a message if so!"

↳ (0): "I will definitely be getting in touch! New York City was my first choice, too, but I think I'd want to spend extended time there in either Spring or Fall...probably Spring. Walkability is always at the top of my list of needs for places I live. You know, even though San Francisco is getting a bad rap right now in the media, it's still a great place to visit: very walkable, with good public transit and LOTS to do within the transit zone (which extends two counties south, two north, and two to the east)."

Extras that actually paid: dental, gym, OTC, giveback · 32 documents

"Our Medicare Advantage Experience I have no affiliation with any health insurance companies and no particular ax to grind. I just want to share our experience because I see a lot of scary information out there about Medicare Advantage. We live in Florida and my wife has been on Medicare for 11 years and 9 years for me. The first few years we were on traditional Medicare with a Plan F HD supplement, then we switched to MA, first with Aetna and now Humana. We travel a lot so we needed PPO plans for all this time. We signed up for MA because it seemed like such a better deal than Medicare plus a supplement, and that has worked out well for us. We paid no premiums (other than the Medicare B premiums everyone pays) on Aetna and on Humana we actually get a \$175/month rebate towards the B premium. We have watched the co-pays for specialists go up frequently and now pay \$50 per specialist visit. Primary care visits have always been free. In spite of the bad reports on MA, we were very healthy and thought it would be a risk we could take. Five years ago my wife was diagnosed with a faulty mitral valve in her heart. The cardiologist checked it every year and this year he decided it was severe enough to require fixing. Fast forward several months and my wife is now recovering from open heart surgery, which was successful. She spent six days in the hospital and is getting twice a week home care from a nurse, a physical therapist and an occupational therapist. There were two tests that required procedures in an outpatient heart center at the hospital before her surgery. The total out of pocket for all this was about \$3,000. The hospital and physician charges billed to Humana were in the neighborhood of \$300K. We never had to deal with any refusals of coverage, balance billing or any other surprises. So our experience with a major medical issue was outstanding. For the 8 years we have been on MA, we've paid no premiums, had reimbursements for dental work and eyewear of at least \$20K and had no issues with finding good doctors and facilities in-network. Bottom line, who knows what surprises might await us as we get older and less healthy, but I have no complaints about our experience with MA so far. UPDATE: Thanks to everyone who contributed to this thread! It's clear that MA can be anywhere from great to awful, depending on the plans in your area and your individual health situation. I think the comments brought up great issues to explore before choosing MA or traditional Medicare with a supplement. I know we are risking challenges in MA if we move or networks change for the worse. But I calculate that we've saved roughly \$57k in supplement premiums (for 2 people) and received roughly \$20k in dental benefits over 8 years, so the risk was certainly worth it so far."

— r/medicare · 139 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1tp8qt5/>

↳ (0): "I've had the same positive experience with my MA plan for 10 years. I'll go ahead and upvote you in preparation for the Reddit MA-Hating Mafia that will surely show up and tell you why we are stupid and shower us both with down votes."

↳ (0): "I had no opinion about this until I began taking my mother to medical appointments in NYC. It was astonishing to me how often the medical personnel would tell me it's a good thing my mom has original Medicare because they were able to refer us immediately to superior facilities for treatment. When she had to go to rehab, they took both of us for free (not a small thing in NY) directly from the hospital in a hospital car to a beautiful place that gave her great care (and fantastic meals I got to share). So now I am definitely biased. My mother would've had to wait a long time in pain and then accept lower quality care inside bargain basement places. For me, it made a huge impression to keep getting unsolicited opinions from hospital and medical office personnel that it was great my mom had original Medicare because the Medicare advantage plans had much tighter restrictions on referrals and many times we would've been sol. I trust the people who have to deal with getting patients treatment. We are Americans so we are being screwed either way, but a bit less screwed without for profit insurance companies. Good luck to us all who aren't emigrating for better health care."

↳ (0): "If you are in an area with a lot of providers and all your doctors are in network, MA can be fine. But now ask most folks in rural areas about their experience. Also, in many places you can't get a MA PPO, which can be a dealbreaker. Everyone needs to do their own homework, of course."

"This is, hands down, the best video I have ever seen about Medicare insurance plans!! Fantastic job, and thank you! And I hope you recover quickly from your sunburn! BUT... I want to introduce a dimension that I was surprised you did not mention! That is, taking care of yourself! By that, I mean taking nutrition seriously for decades, maintaining an ideal weight, and working out regularly at a gym in old age so you never neglect your body's conditioning!! Now in our mid 70s, my wife and I have been "nutritarian" for 15 years. Nutritarian is a diet developed by Dr. Joel Fuhrman based on a 100% plant-based diet, only far more emphasis on nutrient-density at every meal. No added sugar, no animal products, no dairy, no alcohol, no bread, no added oil, no added salt. Just whatever comes naturally in the fruit, vegetables, nuts, grains, mushrooms, seeds, and sprouts (microgreens) that we eat at every meal. We go to our gym for a vigorous 60 to 80 minute resistance workout every 3 days (plus a 60-minute treadmill cardio workout on some off-days). We maintain ideal weight, take no medications, and my local doctor told me that I have the blood pressure of a healthy 18-year-old. MY POINT is that your own discipline over your peak nutrition and physical conditioning will have an enormous impact over your long-term health! We have a guy at our gym at age 95 still working out!! As Dr. Fuhrman says: "Your genes load the gun. But your diet and lifestyle pull the trigger!" As part of our Advantage plan, our gym enrollment is covered. That is \$100 a month savings for both my wife and myself. We do have a local insurance agent, but if we did not I would reach out to this agent with The Retirement Nerds! What an excellent explanation of all the insurance options! So, don't eat junk! Don't sit around in an easy chair drinking beer! Make peak nutrition your most serious hobby. Grow your own sprouts and microgreens like I do. Don't eat canned beans - instead eat beans you cook yourself from dry beans. We eat 18 kinds of beans I cook weekly in a pressure cooker. I plan to make it to 100+ unless I get hit by a truck! (And if that happens, insurance won't matter.) Best wishes!"

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 36 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=Ugzq9b4ySEEjBX1HcUh4AaABAg>

↳ @norsemythos1438 (4): "Interesting story. I tend to agree with the concept...but in practice... eating only rabbit food and living to 100? I wonder if im better off enjoying the simple things and dying at 88."

↳ @flyshacker (3): "@norsemythos1438 Your choice! Remember, nearly all the things people call "old age" are really just neglect. Get your cremation and other final expenses paid for, and you're all set! I'll keep exercising, living longer, and I'll collect the gov't benefits you would have received. Fine with me!"

↳ @frankhodge7654 (1): "@flyshacker No matter what you eat, old age effects are very real. We were born with a guarantee of death. No one can live forever except in fantasies. We don't usually know our end date, but we all have one. Rabbit food for life is not a very enjoyable option."

"I have traditional Medicare along with my supplement plan. I love knowing exactly what I am responsible for each year, and I really love that I can get the treatment my doctor recommends without worrying about some greedy insurance company denying my care. Yes, I have to pay my monthly premium, plus separate policies for dental, vision, and prescriptions, but it's worth it to me."

— YouTube · Do I need a Medicare Supplement Plan? · 15 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=O-WxyTurD3c&lc=Ugzg_E5Vh8nOezLYz6V4AaABAg

Found an agent or broker they trust · 27 documents

"Thank you soooo much! I'll be 72 in less than 2 months. When approaching 65, I met with an insurance agent that had over 30 years of experience with Medicare. Listened to him and choose regular Medicare, plan G. Have medigap policy with anthem. And it's paid for every medical issue, hospital stays, tests, etc. Is it difficult for me to pay the premiums? Yes because I'm another person who didn't save enough for retirement. I'm managing to make it work. However, a good friend and my step sister have been after me to switch to M Advantage for last few years to save money. And it probably works for some people. But I've had several health issues. I know they mean well, but I'm tired of hearing it! And you just proved my point! My mama raised me on: If it sounds too good to be true, it probably is!!!! Thank God for my incredible parents. My agent told me at 64 exactly what you said. It's difficult to go back to regular Medicare after being on Advantage because of the health exam, pre existing conditions and then the provider doesn't want to sign you up and you're screwed. I hope a lot of people who are in their early 60's sees your video or has a good agent like I do, before they choose their Medicare plan. Bravo! Thank you! And God bless you! 🙌🙌🙌❤️❤️❤️😎😎😎🙏🙏🙏🙏🙏🙏🙏🙏🙏"

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 32 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=UgxdqBtHEeLV2ikHP-N4AaABAg>

↳ @francesb6758 (7): "You made the right choice; don't listen to the others. MAdvantage might look tempting and cheaper, but wait until they're a bit older and their health deteriorates. If they need physical therapy, for example after a surgery, they'll be on the hook for a co-pay for EVERY PT visit. Or for repeated eye injections for retinal problems -- each repeat visit hits them with another co-pay. A friend used to work for a retinal specialist; she had to delivery the bad news about MA co-pays every day. Remember the old saying: Cheap is expensive in the long run."

↳ @martagarland1783 (3): "The G supplement pays the hospital bills!"

↳ @sheila7814 (1): "Thank you. I have cancer and am just now making these decisions because I turn 65 soon."

"I went with the HDG plan, my agent who is a friend wasn't offering it but agreed it was the best fit for my wife and I and he contacted the insurer and handled it for us. We are 3 years in without any health issues and have saved about 6K in G premiums so moving forward we could have several years with large medical expenses and still be ahead of the game."

— YouTube · High Deductible Medicare Plan G: The "Secret" They Don't Tell You About! · 29 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=YFEb0FiEpB4&lc=Ugzs_Ta08W530jcH1VI4AaABAg

↳ @billjones4986 (5): "As a senior your in good health until your not, things could change quickly."

↳ @bugsy2902 (1): "@billjones4986 Looking at the increase of premiums of G or N over the years and being trapped by medical underwriting this seems the only solution for many seniors on a fixed income. I know that I can't pay hundreds of dollars a month for a medigap plan plus another couple hundred for Medicare plus potentially 2K plus Part D drugs on a fixed income. And I don't want to be in a Disadvantage plan with MOOP of \$9K while they delay and deny care! I was so looking forward to Medicare and not having to fight for care till I saw how outrageously expensive it is. How many times I've had to fight calling the state Ins Commissioner and Dept of Labor to get my bills paid even HR! And I know many others don't bother and just pay what they shouldn't have to or let it go to collections because of the corrupt insurance mafia in America! I'm on Obamacare and had my first preventative colonoscopy 100% free but Anthem tried to stick me with \$6K from the hospital! After a month of fighting to finally get a resolution billing rep in US she finally fixes the hospital bill but tries to leave me to pay \$2k out of network anesthesia bill! She only fixed it when I threatened to file a complaint with Senator Tammy Baldwin and also the No Surprises Website! I never expected to have to fight like that for what is federal mandated as FREE!"

↳ @paulmarc-aurele5508 (0): "@billjones4986! you are certainly right but with HDG your maximum deductible would be \$2400 more than a G plan other than that the same.. in our first 3 trouble free years we have save about 7K in premiums."

"I have just signed up for Medicare and went with the advantage plan. My agent went through everything with me including the fact that I rarely go to doctors. He suggested that the advantage plan seemed to be the best fit for me. He also warned me that if I change my mind next year and want a supplement plan instead then it may have to go through underwriting before I am approved for it. If I had unlimited funds, I would have gone with a supplement but unfortunately when you go on social security, your income goes down not up. I did also take an extra cancer plan that would cover any out-of-pocket expenses for the current year that I use it. I think the agent I had did a great job explaining everything to me. He even read and explained every line of the plan I was signing up for before I signed anything. I think the best thing and most important thing you can do is to have a good agent to help you. Btw, I think your videos are the best I've ever seen! Here's the animal, I watched everything! 🐘 "

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 24 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgxCO0rHJenu2qzwdXZ4AaABAq>

↳ @JohnJohn-wr1jo (11): "Flo, unfortunately your agent was looking out for his best interests since there is no "advantage" to the agent when you sign up for Medicare. Advantage Plans are back end loaded. U save initially because let's face it, why would anyone pay the same for an inferior product. The advantage plans costs will catch up with you later in life when you can least afford it. Even more alarming will be the quality of care provided later in life with the Advantage plans. Managed Healthcare is ignoring elderly seniors needs and literally allowing thousands to die every year in the US. I've witnessed it first hand with elderly family members and friends who can't get appointments with specialists and necessary tests and care in a timely manner. Stay healthy and you will be fine and save money. Very few of us are able to do it. The odds aren't in our favor."

↳ @Theretirementnerds (9): "@kimdiedrich9712 correct. Premiums for supplement plan carriers are in addition to Medicare Part B premiums, and with a Plan G, you still have the Medicare Part B deductible (\$240 in 2024). However, with a supplement plan G, you don't need to pay the Part A deductible. The supplement plan takes care of that."

↳ @Theretirementnerds (4): "Sounds like your agent did a great job, which makes us so happy! Thank you for sharing your experience and watching (especially to the end) 😊 "

Glad they kept Original Medicare (or got out in time) · 22 documents

"I thought about getting one of these plans but found out the doctor I'd had for many years was not in the network. I worked in the Scheduling department in a hospital and We dealt with these insurance plans and some of them thought they knew more than the doctors. I'm glad I chose original Medicare and a supplement. I want my doctor and I to make the decisions."

— YouTube · Top Disadvantages of Medicare Advantage Plans · 30 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BebQ04cKzJc&lc=UgzMVDXyviom5xLUtlF4AaABAq>

↳ @nancybryant4325 (3): "@paul2019monte my neighbor has an advantage plan and is pleased with it. I don't think she pays for it. I pay \$144 a month for my supplement but it gives me some peace of mind that I will have good coverage if I become really sick. No matter how healthy we think we are, as we age things can happen to our bodies. I am not wealthy but I know a couple ladies who live on less than \$1000 a month and paying that premium might be hard or impossible for them."

↳ @paul2019monte (2): "@nancybryant4325 Thank you again for your response. I had been told by someone I trusted that I should be on Medicare. I do not have lots of expenses now but I can see that investing before I need it, which most of us definitely will, will give me more security if something major were to happen. I also find most of the so-called benefits of the advantage plan actually not that valuable when I try to use them. And no I don't use referrals because often when I have asked for a specific referral I have either been denied or the payment to the caregiver is denied even though a legitimate referral and I paid a copay. Here I am talking about physical therapy which now I pay out-of-pocket and don't even bother trying to get the referral. I negotiate for a cash price. Many won't take my plan anymore anyhow because of the endless denials, etc. Someone is paying for all those slick commercials bombarding us."

↳ @takearight. (2): "@paul2019monte indirectly being paid by....you guessed it... We do through our ins premiums..."

"@ckstaff Glad we have original Medicare."

— YouTube · MASSIVE: Hospitals Are DROPPING Medicare Advantage Plans 🤖 · 13 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vn2k1W-JzB8&lc=UgzevbXaSuoWX4WCW814AaABAg.9y9FObgFd7m9y9eDCbfzRy>

"The thought of fighting to get approved for a procedure alone makes me glad we did not choose the advantage plan. It's so nice not to worry about it. I wanted to bring up Good RX, a prescription app. We pay for the cheapest part D drug plan. We hardly ever use it. We have our pharmacist compare prices with our Part D and with Good RX. Most often Good RX is cheaper, by a lot!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=Ugz-YE5bCMBTd4HKVoF4AaABAg>

↳ @themedicarelife4939 (0): "You may to look up GlickRx as well."

↳ @craigharris702 (0): "Hello 🙋 Victoria how are you doing today?"

Tab 9 — Typical Day

Thin by nature: they describe a decision, not a daily routine. What shows up is the phone, the mail, the pharmacy and hours of research each fall.

Theme	Documents
Calls, mail and ads every day	25
Appointments, prescriptions and pharmacy runs	19
Hours of research and re-shopping every fall	15
Bills, statements and paperwork	9
On hold or on the phone with the plan, Medicare or Social Security	7

Calls, mail and ads every day · 25 documents

"Sunburn. Thank you. During my working years I had a Co pay for my HMO high deductible insurance. When I retired I learned about plan G and found it less than what I paying at work. Since my retirement my wife had open heart surgery and knee replace to and a broken arm. I have prostate cancer and ulcerative colitis. If I would have had an advantage plan it would have financial devastated us. When I bought plan G I bought it not for how I felt at the time, but for when I was sick. Advantage plans come in my mail every day trying to switch me over. Never get mail for plan G. That should tell you something in itself."

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 249 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=UgyPSeGJnpazbrQ0VB94AaABAg>

↳ @RolandHolubec (0): "Nobody knows anything; You need to create your process, manage risk, and stick to the plan, through thick or thin, While also continuously learning from mistakes and improving..."

↳ @KristýnaKalová-t8q (0): "Appreciate that. I just looked her up and she seems highly regarded. I've been meaning to fine-tune my drawdown strategy, so this might be the right time. Thanks for pointing me in a solid direction!"

"i have been researching Medicare supplement plans versus Advantage plans and discovered so many negatives with Advantage plans. Your video confirms for me that supplemental plans are the way to go. I hope more people will educate themselves and not be suckered in by the has-been celebrities who are touting Advantage plans in non-stop commercials. Thanks for the very informative video."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement Plans · 66 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xw7EiH-5iik&lc=Ugxi-BJ7WpxJLsFGVvV4AaABAg>

↳ @LarryKelly (7): "I doubt the celebrity hawkers for Medicare Advantage plans really have one themselves. I bet Joe Namath, William Shatner, and the dynamite guy all have supplemental plans. The only reason not to is if you can't afford the premiums and these guys can."

↳ @eugeneallison7457 (3): "Well let's see what I have I have United Healthcare Advantage plan I have zero monthly premium I have dental insurance I have vision insurance later on in life if I need hearing aids they are covered my drug plan also known as part d is covered at zero cost my monthly premium is zero cost I get up to a maximum benefit of \$375 toward any eyeglasses I get a additional \$350 every quarter on over the counter medication including medical equipment blood pressure monitor shower chairs raised toilet seat vitamins I paid 0 I can go to any doctor in and out of network without a doctor referral I have zero specialist 0 doctor copay if I go to the emergency room I pay 0 if I am admitted into any Hospital I pay zero my drugs are 3.50 prescription I have not had to pay any medication co-pays since August because at August my prescription drug costs so far was 25.000 bucks I also get free transportation to and from my doctor I get a free pair of diabetic shoes every year now you tell me what Medicare Plan can beat that??? I'll be waiting"

↳ @LarryKelly (2): "@eugeneallison7457 just don't get sick or injured"

"New Medicare sales tactic It must be the season when unscrupulous Medicare brokers can make big money switching people to Medicare Advantage plans. I'm getting multiple spam calls a day trying to get me to switch. Today I got an especially sleazy one that called himself a "Medicare Adviser" and started by demanding my Medicare number to "verify" what new benefits I would get. At first he denied he was signing people up for Medicare Advantage but later let that slip when I asked how all the new benefits were paid. Reminiscent of old-time phone service slamming when phone companies would try to switch your long distance carrier without your knowledge. Sleazy tactics. Beware."

— r/medicare · 48 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1f2wg20/>

↳ (0): "These days, I just have my iphone forward all calls from someone not on my contact list directly to voice mail. If it's a call that's not important enough to leave a voice mail, it's a call not important enough to answer."

↳ (0): "I block any such calls without a voice mail."

↳ (0): ">called himself a "Medicare Adviser" That's actually illegal. Report his info to CMS."

Appointments, prescriptions and pharmacy runs · 19 documents

"Humana screwed me over I have a heart condition and have been waiting three months to have an echocardiogram. Recently, Humana changed my PCP from someone I've been seeing for years and years to a stranger and didn't let me know if they changed it. My doctor reached out to let me know and I called and had him changed back but then they sent a new card that didn't list my doctor's name and I had to request it again from them. Then I showed up from my appointment yesterday and they still hadn't adjusted their records. Now they decided they needed prior approval for something that was already approved and I had already received a co-pay notification. Then the hospital, which is supposed to care for people and is another point of how the US healthcare system is fucked up, turned me away. They turned away a heart patient because the insurance was being difficult. They're supposed to take care of patients, but if money isn't forthcoming, they turn them away, even if they're at risk of dying. I'm sorry I just needed a place to express this and I hope others will agree with me that Medicare and the health system in general need a major overhaul."

— r/medicare · 87 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1puvefe/>

↳ (0): "Anyone who has enough money to pay for regular Medicare and a supplement should definitely do so."

↳ (0): "You are completely right I've seen personally firsthand and heard of Medicare advantage being disliked by doctors offices in hospitals."

↳ (0): "Yes! Exactly why I went with original Medicare A and B and then added Medigap. I'm so sorry that you had to go through that."

"I am sticking with plan g as long as I can afford it purely because of the peace of mind. I'm in physical therapy twice a week but never have to deal with any bills or even the associated paperwork. If something awful happens, I want to concentrate on getting well, not admin."

— YouTube · Should You Switch from Medicare Plan G to Plan N? Here's the Real Tradeoff · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xsEZJVMwY8E&lc=Ugxyg0sLiBh9bF-rUSd4AaABAg>

↳ @resoluteprotectorhonorringg2877 (0): "I have a question for You. Do You experience copays for therapy under Your plan G?"

↳ @RibbitResist (0): "@resoluteprotectorhonorringg2877not under my plan g, they are all covered."

"I am turning 65 shortly and am as healthy as a powerful rhino. I work out daily and have never taken a prescription drug in my life. Not even an antibiotic, nor aspirin! I have been watching a LOT of videos, and prior to yours, thought I was going to be taking the Supplement Plan N. Because of your breakdown at the end, I realize I am a wise elephant because I check all the boxes you explained that would motivate someone to choose an Advantage plan, so thank you."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 6 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=Ugx3XQcuy_hT1U1Jskd4AaABAg

↳ @RichardSalier-i6y (0): "We saved a ton of money not paying premiums from age 74-79 on a \$0.00 Premium, Medicare Premium PPO from UHC in San Antonio, TX. Just like us; 1.) Know yourselves and your health situations, 3.) Do you research - then buy. Prior to that we had UHC as a HMO and were only marginally happy with it. Love the PPO - like night and day, even though same company. With an HMO, they can keep trying things to save money, putting off the treatment, that you need for 2--3 months. But, unfortunately a PPO in a big Metropolitan can cost a lot of money per month of NON existant - like in So. California."

Hours of research and re-shopping every fall · 15 documents

"The Medicare Plan Shuffle: Why NOT Shopping Part D Annually Could Cost Thousands Let's face it—when it comes to Medicare Part D drug plans, there are two types of people: those who compare their options each year... and those who don't. The first group might sleep easy knowing they're not overpaying for their medications. The second? Well, they could be unknowingly flushing hundreds—or even thousands—down the drain every year. We're not trying to scare you... Okay, maybe we are. A little. # The \$0 Trap: It Sounds Good, But... A \$0 monthly premium sounds amazing, right? Like free pie. But what they don't tell you is that the crust costs extra, and the whipped cream? Outrageously priced. That "free" drug plan might not cover your medications—or might do so at sky-high copays. Drugs like **Eliquis**, **Zepbound**, **Wegovy**, **Ozempic**, and **Mounjaro** aren't just pricey—they're plan landmines. Some plans cover them. Some don't. Some charge you your left arm, others your right. We've even seen plans list one of these drugs at over \$1,000 a month while another plan had it at just \$35. Same drug. Different nightmare. # The Annual Game of "Gotcha" Here's the kicker: every year, plans change. They change their premiums. They change their copays. They change what drugs they cover and what tier they're on. That \$10-a-month generic from last year? Surprise! It's now \$85 and mysteriously moved up a tier. Imagine showing up at the pharmacy in January thinking your plan still loves you, only to find out it ghosted your medications over the holidays. # Why This Year is Different (And Maybe Worse) Whispers from Washington are raising eyebrows. With big changes coming to how Medicare negotiates drug prices and funds subsidies starting in 2026, we could be on the edge of a "musical chairs" situation—except instead of chairs, it's coverage for your heart medication, and when the music stops... well, you get the picture. If you're banking on "the government will fix it," remember: these are the same folks who brought you the DMV experience. # The True Villains? The Middlemen & the Markups Let's not forget the real fun part: drug manufacturers and pharmacy benefit managers (PBMs)—the shadowy middlemen who get rich while seniors juggle pills and price tags. They're the ones who make your life-saving medication more expensive in the U.S. than a luxury vacation in Mexico (where, ironically, the same drugs often cost 80% less). So yes, it's not just about "shopping" your plan. It's about taking a stand against a broken system. One click, one form, one chat with your agent could save you thousands. # Moral of the Story? Don't Be That Guy. Every year, we talk to someone who didn't bother to compare plans. They "liked what they had" and "didn't want to mess with it." By February, they're calling us in a panic because their meds are costing more than their rent. Don't be that guy. Reprinted from Lisaknowsmedicare.com. blog posts"

— r/medicare · 27 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1kyujg6/>

↳ (0): "Basically what I tell all my clients every year. Read your ANOC (Annual Notice of Change) carefully for changes to how your prescriptions are covered, copay changes, etc. Part D plans are super easy to compare on Medicare.gov. Be aware that most PDPs no longer pay broker commissions, so a broker might not be eager to spend valuable time helping you shop around unless you are already a client."

↳ (0): "This right here. I still did reviews for all my existing clients, despite the fact that Aetna, Centene, Cigna, etc. all said no commissions for brokers. I love my clients but this year I'll probably be directing most of them to [Medicare.gov](<http://Medicare.gov>) for Part D reviews and changes."

↳ (0): "Keep in mind that as a broker, sending them to Medicare.gov to enroll proves the carriers point that brokers are not needed. Have them call the carrier to enroll in a plan. Make the carriers pay someone to do the work they won't pay brokers to do."

"I am a retired OBGYN so sounds like a stork to me. WOW your complete analysis and perfect explanation was spot on. I loved when you said representatives like you should do what is best and not worry about commissions. So true people know when you have their best interests and they tell others. In the long run this is best for you and your clients. Same story in the practice of medicine. I watch this video realizing that what I have already chosen what works best for me, but every year I do complete review of my medical conditions, potential new conditions, medications, possible new medications, hospital and healthcare providers, I live in two states and also travel in an RV. I look at specific plan formularies and potential changes. I enjoyed this presentation, You and your connected representatives do this to help people find what is best for them now and as life changes. You should be proud of the service you provide. This is very difficult to analyze for most of us especially in a demographic that is aging, and cognitive abilities are slipping. You have found a wonderful calling,"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement Plans (2026 Update) – Full Comparison · 18 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cxhlXrMrc5s&lc=UgwhAynbxhE4s71VKrR4AaABAg>

↳ @marlajestice2785 (1): "Bless your ❤️ I'm new to all of this trying to comprehend it all, good start for those like me"

↳ @marlajestice2785 (0): "Thank You Daviddrake8742 🙏 "

"Finally someone covers this topic. Although your explanations are a bit scattered, confusing and rushed. My wife and i spent our 40yr career in the healthcare field. We can tell you without question, never go cheap on healthcare. One bad diagnosis like cancer can bankrupt or severely hamper your retirement plans in a heartbeat. Also, we live in FL. Healthcare is very expensive because of the number of retired people who live here. With all our number crunching it will never pay to do roth conversions while on ACA. I have 2 yrs left on ACA, my wife is on Medicare and SS. People must remember that you are PREDICTING you income for the year ahead of time. If you go over, you will pay more. If you are under, ACA gives you a refund(credit) on taxes. The system is very confusing for seniors and i have spent many hours researching all the ACA rules and how it applies to taxes, income and roth conversions."

— YouTube · Healthcare Before 65: In-Depth ACA vs. Roth Conversion Analysis · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gUjrNm-VLF8&lc=UgwDMADRL27zUJcPdc14AaABAg>

↳ @Wayneman50 (1): "@ No. For example, when you sign up for coverage in Nov 2025 for the year 2026. You have to guess your income for that year(2026). Your subsidy is based on the income you are predicting for the year 2026."

↳ @andre-l3j (1): "@larryjones9773I think you're thinking of IRMAA income rather than ACA income prediction."

↳ @gdb5843 (0): "I totally agree with you on "never go cheap on healthcare" but I wish I did larger Roth Conversion when I was on ACA."

Bills, statements and paperwork · 9 documents

"That's just what things cost..." Usually, I get my EOB (explanation of benefits), do a quick review that I actually received the service and thank Medicare and my Part G for saving me the bill. However, yesterday I got an EOB that really ticked me off. After hip surgery, I was prescribed "cryo therapy" (for the uninitiated, it's known as an ice pack.) What arrived at my door in April was a piece of padded fabric with some Velcro attachments - 1) to fit the wrap to my waist and hip and 2) to attach a frozen gel pack. In my wildest imagination, I couldn't see this thing being worth more than \$100. And here's where the insanity begins. The vendor charged Medicare **\$3417.96** 🤔 Of that amount, Medicare paid **\$1095.74**. Nearly \$1100 for padded fabric and an ice pack. Nice work if you can get it. Some of you may say, "That's the system" and that's basically what 2 Medicare reps told me when I called to tell them they were ripped off. "Nothing we can do, that's just what things cost." And we wonder why healthcare is in its current state. Apparently, the same people who value screwdrivers at \$1500 for the defense dept. are doing double duty. I know I shouldn't be amazed but color me gobsmacked. Now if you'll excuse me, I'm off to find a glass and some scotch aka "aroma therapy."

— r/medicare · 109 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1v3wccf/>

↳ (0): "Can you return it? If not can you report it to Medicare's Senior Medicare Patrol or ask SHIP for a resource. When you get a prescription it is out of your hands. You HAVE to take it?! Can you show it to your prescribing physician other the PT company you used? That is utterly ridiculous. Send it to your US Congress person and ask what should /could be done to recover these funds. There must have been an error coding that tag instead of a cryo machine. Can you look at MSN and get the code to see what they billed for? Now I'm needing some aroma therapy just reading about it."

↳ (0): "It was coded as a miscellaneous brace which clearly it was not. The vendor was chosen for me so... The attitude at Medicare of "Ho hum, oh well, stuff happens" was beyond frustrating. My doctor will probably throw up his hands and try to sympathize. I guess I can always escalate with a tersely worded missive to Dr. Oz..."

↳ (0): "I invite you to write a letter to your 2 Senators and your 2 Representatives in Congress. When the debate over single payer healthcare begins again, and it surely will, they will remember your \$1,000 ice pack. "If you see something, say something." To members of Congress. Do not imagine they know the details of \$1,000 ice packs. They do not."

"Anyone else receive their 2025 Annual Notice of Change from Aetna today? I have the HMO plan, and the biggest shock is the maximum out of pocket will go from \$4800 in 2024 to \$9350 in 2025. All the 'extra benefits' are getting reduced as well."

— r/medicare · 27 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1f93bec/>

↳ (0): "It's a regressive year for sure.. the 2k cap for pdp is a big reason for it."

↳ (0): "I have united healthcare advantage dual plan, my plan decreased in 2025, dental, vision, OTC, looks like my going have to visit dental regardless once a year, on my vision, hell where to go to get yearly vision testing, and new glasses that's not going to go over 350, that's going to be impossible, the OTC amount from 187, to 160 for food, hope snap program increases, but I doubt it, that's government, well what can u do, can't fight the government"

↳ (0): "Some big factors for these changes are the Medicare reimbursement rates are lowering slightly, the \$2000 cap on Part D medications and insurance companies being more responsible for the costs versus the big pharma companies, and since COVID, insurance utilization has been at record highs. You're going to see every part of Medicare affected. Med Supp rates are already going up like crazy, premiums for Part D plans will be much higher, with higher copays on meds and Medicare Advantage plans will have less "extra benefits" like dental, vision, hearing, and for more you will probably need to pay an added premium. All in all it's adjustment. In my opinion, insurance companies were giving way too much on those MAPD plans and weren't making enough on the back in due to utilization being so high, it was bound to break somewhere"

"In a blazing panic! Okay, I'm in panic mode. On 9/15/2025 I turned 65, and I did what I was supposed to do. I signed up for Medicare, online. That was easy enough. At the end of the application, before I signed, there was a space to write any questions or concerns I have, especially for the Part B premiums. I explained I have been out of work since June 2025, and I'm currently receiving unemployment benefits. Unemployment I get barely scratches my rent. I had to work for, and was approved for SNAP. So at least I won't go hungry. But that leaves nothing for power bill my car ins and my phone. I got my Medicare card, but there was no info in the letter addressing what happens if you cannot meet the Part B premium. Today I get a bill for \$740, which will cover until January 2026, and it says pay in full, not each month, (which I can't even do that), but to pay in full by 10/25/25! I'm freaking out! No job, I get \$378 week from unemployment, (the amount I was approved for was \$419. They take taxes out so it brings it to \$378). Thank goodness the management company has been and letting my rent go one extra week, with only an added \$5 late fee. My monthly rent takes every penny of the unemployment. What will I do? I can't find any concrete information to find where to get help. This is one of the most frightening things I can remember going through. If I can't find help I'm going to have no choice but to just check out. What else can I do? How ridiculous will it be to be homeless, list everything I ever worked for and all to pay Medicare part b? Which I told them in that little note they all you to write for any questions or concerns I have? I think I'm gonna be done on this earth soon. All my life I've been working hard, became a widow suddenly at 46 but I have been taking care of myself, raised a daughter, and asking nobody for help...with nothing to show for it, then to just be out in the street? Jesus, Joseph and Mary!"

— r/medicare · 26 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1o1zqfs/>

↳ (0): "See if you can qualify for Medicare savings program. Info [here](<https://www.medicare.gov/basics/costs/help/medicare-savings-programs>).";

↳ (0): "You may want to also apply for Medicaid through your state."

↳ (0): "I'm assuming that you are not redy to *retire* yet and start drawing from your Social Security benefits? I realize just how much of a penalty you'll have for starting at the earliest possible age, but it's better than nothing, assuming that you don't qualify for Medicaid (for some reason)."

On hold or on the phone with the plan, Medicare or Social Security · 7 documents

"I am 66 and when I first retired I went with an Advantage plan and was happy with it until I needed it. I needed a Cat Scan for lung issues I was having and needed prior approval for the Cat Scan. The Advantage plan denied it and I spent three days on the phone back and forth talking to numerous people each day and never talking to the same person twice. After three days they said ok and I asked why they approved the Cat Scan and the person said they didn't know why but it was approved. The next renewal period I went with regular Medicare and Plan G. This year I was in the hospital intensive care for four days and needed no approvals and my only cost was my \$240. Deductible. My cost for the Plan G supplemental plan is \$158. a month and boy is it worth it for the peace of mind of not worrying about a big medical bill and pre approvals."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 65 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgxdvpDxXszYorK4pCx4AaABAq>

↳ @logicalblueberry (3): "That's awesome. \$158 per month seems very affordable. I was worried that it would cost several hundred per month. Seems like an easier choice than I was expecting then."

↳ @maido9434 (2): "Totally agreed with you . We had same problem. My husband has Parkinson's and had to pay a lot out of pockets after his 2 hospitalization . He had to pay \$250/ day for 7 days first and other có insurance fees . I luckily was able to change to Medicare supplement thus year after underwent medical underwriting process . I was very happy to be able to switch . However , I heard that Dr Oz will make Medicare advantage mandatory because the insurance can make more money . I hope this wasn't true . This video is on you tube ffrom one of the Dr !"

↳ @maido9434 (0): "Will you share with me what company did you go with for dental / drugs/ eyes insurances ! I do not like Cigna and United healthcare that I currently have now . Thanks in advance"

"One Dr I saw last year they didn't know much about coding. Took me a year to get the collection agency to stop harassing me and the Dr office to finally figure out the code. I spent probably 80 hours on phone calls. I should have just paid the thousand dollar cost but I didn't want to pay for tests that I have insurance for. My biggest surprise was how expensive Medicare is. And all the add ons; copays, prescription drugs, the 20% Medicare does not cover which you have to buy separate insurance for. And then no dental. Of course our senators and congress have gold star insurance for life, so what do they care."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgwWGmIS3ApOviVsEI4AaABAg_ATc5JacW6QoA_Njx7EYDzt

"While medicare advantage plans may be worth it elsewhere, I wouldn't recommend it from Blue Cross Blue Shield. Florida Blue has been a repeated trial of my patience. As an example, in May my doctor ordered a mobility scooter. In June since I had heard from no one, I called BCBS. They were sitting on the order; why I don't know. Once I got them to move on the order, they sent it to their equipt provider. When I hadn't heard from them after a few weeks, I called BCBS and them again. The provider had not acted on the order, (seems to be a theme here). They called the next day to try and get me to take a scooter that did not come anywhere near the item the doctor ordered. When I called them all again to get this fixed, BCBS/care centrix moved the order to yet another provider. When I hadn't heard from these folks, I called them this morning. They looked up the order and the only answer they provided was "we don't provide scooters to stroke patients". I'm starting to wonder if this entire medicare advantage plan isn't just a scheme. I'm looking forward to the end of the year when I can get a different plan. Bottom line? If you want adequate health coverage and piece of mind - GO ANYHWEHRE EXCEPT BLUE CROSS BLUE SHIELD."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage Plan Reviews 🌟 (from real people) · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nw14VxxHrmM&lc=UgzZbm79IZ4kJdRnP1Z4AaABAg>

Tab 10 — Buyer Summary

Who this person is, what they believe, what stops them and how to reach them. Counts are documents in this page's voice; every chart is measured from what they wrote about themselves, never assumed.

The one-line ICP: A person about to turn 65 or already on Medicare (median stated age 67 among 993 who give it), deciding between Original Medicare with a Plan G or Plan N supplement and a Medicare Advantage plan; afraid of being denied care and of a choice they cannot undo, tired of the calls and the 'free benefit' ads, and ready to enroll through one person they believe is telling them the truth.

TLDRWho: 10,534 first-person Medicare shoppers (10,327 turning 65 or on Medicare, 207 family members helping), mostly comment threads under 90 Medicare explainer videos plus r/medicare. Agents, SHIP counselors, former brokers and commenters posting links are excluded. The decision is Original Medicare + Medigap versus Medicare Advantage, and the fear is on the Advantage side: networks, prior authorization and denials (65 fear documents; 481 complaint documents), a big illness and its bills (65), and being stuck after failing underwriting (35; 213 in the complaints ledger). The frustration is the system itself: too confusing to compare (456), premiums that keep going up (162), Part D changes (70) and doctors or hospitals dropping Advantage plans (45). What they did: 1,180 documents hold or held an Advantage plan and 704 a Plan G or N; 166 went through an agent or broker; 57 got out of Advantage onto a supplement. Both sides have satisfied voices: 319 say Advantage works for them, 190 describe peace of mind with a supplement. Who sells to them: 1,126 active Meta ads to Medicare shoppers, 356 from lead funnels and third-party marketers. The 'Turning 65?' qualifier and benefit bait (giveback, flex card, grocery money, \$0) lead the hooks. The silent layer: 'how to stop Medicare calls' and its variants are typed 84 ways and watched 1,381,158 times, yet only 24 shoppers mention the calls in their own posts. They put up with the calls quietly; those calls are what the lead industry sells. The read for Vince (hypothesis): the Medicare lead an agent will pay for is a shopper who asked for help, chose one agent and was told the truth about Medigap underwriting. The market around them is bait ads and calls they are trying to block, so the ad that names the rule and names the agent is the different one.

Who they are — measured, not assumed

Each row counts distinct documents in which the writer states it about themselves in a first-person sentence. A document that does not state its age, plan or premium is simply not counted, so the bars show the mix among those who say, not the share of the market.

Their own age (self-stated)

n = 1,364 documents state the writer's age · median 67 among those already that age

Group	Documents
under 60	76
60–63	97
64	79
about to turn 65	371
65	178
66–69	206
70–74	170
75–79	105
80+	82

What they say they have (first-person sentence)

one document can name more than one; counted when the plan sits in a sentence with I / we / my

Group	Documents
Medicare Advantage (HMO / PPO)	962
Medigap Plan G	395
Medigap Plan N	272
Medigap Plan F (older enrollees)	127
Employer, union or retiree coverage	123
TRICARE / VA	104
Medicaid, Extra Help or a dual plan	62
Original Medicare with no supplement	57
High-deductible Plan G	30

What they say they pay a month for a Medigap plan

n = 227 documents give a monthly figure in the same first-person sentence · median \$200

Group	Documents
under \$100	35
\$100–149	38
\$150–199	35
\$200–249	44
\$250–299	13
\$300–399	26
\$400+	36

Where they are in the decision

first-person sentences; one document can sit in more than one row

Group	Documents
-------	-----------

Turning 65 / not yet enrolled	618
Writes about a spouse's coverage as well	578
Switched or tried to switch plans	192
Still working past 65 / delaying Part B	100
On Medicare under 65 (disability)	91
Lost a plan (eliminated, non-renewed)	42

Carriers they name

documents naming the carrier anywhere

Group	Documents
UnitedHealthcare / AARP	472
Blue Cross / Blue Shield	261
Humana	221
Aetna	163
Kaiser	107
Wellcare / Centene	66
Mutual of Omaha	62
Cigna	42
Devoted	15

Gender self-markers

'my husband' / 'my wife', 'as a mom', '54F' and similar; documents with one kind of marker only

Group	Documents
Female markers	398
Male markers	557

States they say they live in

n = 233 documents name a home state

Group	Documents
Florida	35
California	34
Texas	23
New York	22
Ohio	14
Washington	11
Illinois	8
Minnesota	8
Wisconsin	7
Maryland	5
Oregon	5
Missouri	5

Where this voice was found

buyer documents by source

Group	Documents
YouTube comment threads	10,000
Reddit r/medicare	350
Reddit r/HealthInsurance	50
TrustPilot reviews	44
Reddit r/obamacare	28
Reddit r/InsuranceAgent	27
Reddit r/retirement	25
Reddit r/Insurance	3
Reddit r/personalfinance	2
Insurance-Forums.com	2

Who they are — the read

- Read of the charts above: the voice is split between people about to turn 65 and people already on Medicare into their seventies and eighties; the second group writes about premiums rising, plans leaving and switching, the first about getting the first choice right.
- They document a decision more than a complaint: most of the corpus is comment threads under independent broker and advisor channels (The Retirement Nerds, Medicare School, Medicare Specialist – Abt Insurance, MedigapSeminars, Medicare on Video) where they post their own plan, premium and state and ask what to do.
- Disability-Medicare voices (under 65, SSDI) are a distinct group with their own complaint: no Medigap, or one priced out of reach (43 documents).

What they believe

- Read of Tabs 1, 5 and 8: Advantage is cheaper until you are sick; a supplement costs more every month and buys the right to see any doctor without asking permission.
- Read of Tabs 4 and 5: 'free' benefits (giveback, flex cards, grocery money) are a sign of a catch, and salespeople are paid to push Advantage. 'You get what you pay for' is said outright in 23 documents.
- The other side is real and should not be written off: 319 documents say their Advantage plan works, usually with a number attached (premium, copay, years without a denial).

The moment it changes

- Turning 65 or coming off an employer or retiree plan (217 documents).
- The Annual Notice of Change and the fall mail; a premium increase on the supplement (162 documents, many with the percentage).
- A denial, or a doctor or hospital dropping their Advantage plan (45 documents; 399 in the complaints ledger).
- What happened to someone they know: 133 documents cite a friend, sibling or neighbor; 112 a parent; 90 a spouse's illness or death.

What stops them

- Too confusing to compare (456 documents).
- Fear of choosing wrong and being locked out of a supplement by underwriting (35 fear documents; 213 complaint documents).
- The premium: a supplement they cannot afford on a fixed income (43 documents), or one that keeps rising (12).
- Distrust of the person on the phone (31 documents; the commission question recurs under Previous Solutions).

Where they are and how to reach them

- YouTube Medicare explainers: the comment threads are where they state their age, plan, premium and state and ask what to do.

- r/medicare and r/retirement; AARP-branded plans (431 documents name UnitedHealthcare / AARP); employer HR at retirement (43 documents went through an employer or retiree plan).
- How they say they found help: an independent agent or broker (101 documents), YouTube channels and seminars (75), AARP (26).
- Meta cannot target them by age: since January 2025 insurance ads sit in the Financial Products and Services special ad category, so the creative has to make them self-select ('Turning 65?').

Who to write to, and who not to

Segment A — write to them

- Turning-65 planners researching supplement versus Advantage before their Initial Enrollment Period (the 'getting it right the first time' and 'should have' voices).
- Advantage members who want out while they can still pass, or skip, Medigap underwriting: their plan is leaving, their hospital dropped it, or they were denied.
- Supplement holders hit by a rate increase who can re-shop the same letter plan with another carrier.
- Family members managing a parent's plan after a denial, a rehab stay or a bill.

Segment B — not the buyer (exclude, or the ads pay for them)

- Dual-eligible (Medicare + Medicaid) beneficiaries: a different product (D-SNP), different rules, and the most heavily baited segment in the ads.
- Under-65 disability Medicare in states with no Medigap access: real pain, but in most states there is nothing to sell them that solves it.
- Political commenters on Medicare's future with no personal plan detail (already excluded by the voice gate).
- Satisfied Advantage members with no trigger this year: they defend their plan and are not shopping.

The frame that works (hypothesis)

- Hypothesis from Tabs 1, 4, 5 and 8: 'Check your doctors and your drugs first, know the one rule you can't undo before you pick, and deal with one agent who tells you both sides.' It is the advice they already give each other, and the opposite of the benefit-bait ads they are shown.

Each clause of the frame with the documents behind it:

Voice by source (every document, stamped)

104,229 documents in the shared corpus; 10,534 are buyer documents in this page's voice. Other voices stay in the corpus, labeled, and never enter these tabs.

Source	Documents	agent	agent life	aspirant	employee agent	pc agent	vendor	medicare self	medicare family	aca self	provider	press	other
youtube	68,633	1,163	47	38	14	12	5,863	9,818	182	1,050	177	1	50,268
reddit_comment	29,438	4,613	54	34	204	1,470	144	394	17	551	34	9	21,914
insurance_forums	2,323	879	0	7	0	0	145	2	0	0	0	5	1,285
trustpilot	1,928	22	0	0	0	0	0	43	1	3	0	0	1,859
reddit_post	1,861	453	20	13	48	94	28	70	7	189	3	2	934
fb_comment	35	14	0	1	0	0	5	0	0	0	0	0	15
fb_group	11	9	0	0	0	0	2	0	0	0	0	0	0

Buyer voices: medicare self 10,327 · medicare family 207

Headlines

1. "The main benefit of Original Medicare with a Supplemental plan is I've never had to worry about insurance company pre-approvals, or whether my doctor accepted it." — Networks, prior authorization and being denied care (65) · <https://www.reddit.com/r/retirement/comments/1liorgh/>
2. "He was laying in the hospital bed stressed out about how I was going to pay all the medical bills when he dies." — A big illness and the bills that follow (65) · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgztwkgUWWxR35VyLN4AaABAq>
3. "I want to start by saying I appreciate that this program will get these meds to many people that need it, but it leaves a lot of Medicare beneficiaries behind." — Their drugs covered at a price they can pay (40) · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1ulaona/>
4. "I wish other states other than the four allow seniors to switch back to original supplement plans." — Switching to a supplement (or to a better plan) next year (39) · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vn2k1W-JzB8&lc=Ugy6mXtwm4ahYY_KrNR4AaABAq
5. "So often patients experience medical emergencies while on vacation and are limited to choices for care while away from home and "out of network." I advise my friends and family to always invest in supplements and keep Medicare, steering them away from advantage or replacement plans." — Friends, siblings and neighbors as the warning (or the proof) (133) · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgyQPwewvEHaPILi_Qd4AaABAq
6. "My mother is in her 90s and has dementia...along with many health issues.." — A parent's Medicare: Advantage, denials, rehab and bills (112) · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgzpRDIIAYWVYI35q2x4AaABAq>
7. "So often patients experience medical emergencies while on vacation and are limited to choices for care while away from home and "out of network." I advise my friends and family to always invest in supplements and keep Medicare, steering them away from advantage or replacement plans." — On Advantage: 'stay away' and the answers to it (118) · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgyQPwewvEHaPILi_Qd4AaABAq
8. "So often patients experience medical emergencies while on vacation and are limited to choices for care while away from home and "out of network." I advise my friends and family to always invest in supplements and keep Medicare, steering them away from advantage or replacement plans." — On supplements: what they were told and what they tell others (111) · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgyQPwewvEHaPILi_Qd4AaABAq
9. "They won't be denied and you won't be denied care." — Prior authorization and insurers second-guessing doctors (481) · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgxcFFuqvyczX0JtB0J4AaABAq>
10. "I had no idea how complicated and layered the system is." — Too confusing to compare (456) · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cxhlXrMrc5s&lc=UgzZx9D3ilHuxXtdoPR4AaABAq>
11. "I was led to believe I had to enroll in a Medicare Advantage plan and I'm soooo glad I didn't." — Chose an Advantage plan (1,180) · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yflVCC&lc=UgzhQ6cK4tHUxOCEfjt4AaABAq>
12. "I had switched from Advantage to Plan G because I'm totally risk-averse." — Chose Plan G or Plan N (704) · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgxCXf6P2_bAdYu1Q_l4AaABAq
13. "Wish I had done more research before I signed up for advantage plan." — Should have enrolled or planned differently (54) · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=djuGel829M4&lc=UgyUhgmxXIWRyCw81Kt4AaABAq>
14. "Almost all Americans, in polls, agree that you should be able to get insurance even if you have a pre-existing condition." — Wishing someone had warned them about underwriting and deadlines (25) · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1pgufyv/>
15. "I'm very happy with the advantage plan." — Happy with an Advantage plan (319) · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8Pq6H7UZBbU&lc=UgwDONw571neI_1vEx4AaABAq
16. "The gap premiums aren't cheap, but I have the "peace of mind" of knowing that I can receive the care/treatment recommended by my doctor." — Peace of mind: nothing to worry about (190) · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=UgwTr1OgGdvCFu3U5Fp4AaABAq>
17. "Advantage plans come in my mail every day trying to switch me over." — Calls, mail and ads every day (25) · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=UgyPSeGJnpazbrQ0VB94AaABAq>
18. "Then I showed up from my appointment yesterday and they still hadn't adjusted their records." — Appointments, prescriptions and pharmacy runs (19) · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1puvefe/>

Frequency Ranking

#	Theme	Documents	Where
1	Chose an Advantage plan	1,180	Tab 6
2	Chose Plan G or Plan N	704	Tab 6
3	Prior authorization and insurers second-guessing doctors	481	Tab 5
4	Confused, afraid of choosing wrong or missing a deadline	461	Private worry
5	Too confusing to compare	456	Tab 5
6	'Extra benefits' ads: flex cards, giveback, grocery money	428	Private worry
7	Denied care, prior authorization, rehab cut short	399	Dislike
8	Happy with an Advantage plan	319	Tab 8
9	Can't afford premiums, Part B, drugs or dental	297	Private worry
10	Part D plans, GoodRx, Cost Plus and Canada	279	Tab 6
11	Stuck in Advantage: can't get a Medigap later	258	Private worry
12	Stayed on an employer, union or retiree plan past 65	217	Tab 6
13	Stuck: can't switch back to a Medigap	213	Dislike
14	Denied care, prior authorization, narrow networks	197	Private worry
15	Peace of mind: nothing to worry about	190	Tab 8
16	Premium increases	189	Dislike
17	AARP / UnitedHealthcare	176	Tab 6
18	Money saved, in their numbers	175	Tab 8
19	Agents and brokers (and the commission question)	166	Tab 6
20	Care that just worked, no hassle	163	Tab 8
21	Premiums that keep going up	162	Tab 5
22	YouTube channels, seminars and their own research	158	Tab 6
23	VA, TRICARE and federal retiree coverage	156	Tab 6
24	Friends, siblings and neighbors as the warning (or the proof)	133	Tab 3
25	On Advantage: 'stay away' and the answers to it	118	Tab 4
26	A parent's Medicare: Advantage, denials, rehab and bills	112	Tab 3
27	On supplements: what they were told and what they tell others	111	Tab 4
28	High-deductible Plan G	102	Tab 6
29	Kaiser and staying inside one health system	102	Tab 6
30	An independent agent or broker	101	Lead source
31	A spouse's illness or death, and what the plan did	90	Tab 3
32	Medicaid, Extra Help and Medicare Savings Programs	89	Tab 6
33	Can I trust the agent? Commissions and bias	87	Private worry
34	On doctors, drugs and networks: what the office and the plan said	78	Tab 4
35	YouTube channels and seminars	75	Lead source
36	Part D: drugs dropped from the formulary, prices that jump	70	Tab 5
37	Networks, prior authorization and being denied care	65	Tab 1
38	A big illness and the bills that follow	65	Tab 1
39	A younger spouse without coverage until 65	57	Tab 3
40	Got out of Advantage and onto a supplement	57	Tab 8
41	Should have enrolled or planned differently	54	Tab 7
42	'Do your own homework, read the fine print'	52	Tab 4
43	Changed Medigap carriers to escape a rate increase	51	Tab 6
44	Drug costs and Part D	47	Tab 1
45	Doctors and hospitals dropping Advantage plans	45	Tab 5
46	Not being able to afford it on a fixed income	43	Tab 1

47	Under 65 and disabled: no Medigap, or an unaffordable one	43	Tab 5
48	Employer or retiree plan / HR	43	Lead source
49	Their drugs covered at a price they can pay	40	Tab 2
50	Switching to a supplement (or to a better plan) next year	39	Tab 2
51	Never saw a bill after a major illness	38	Tab 8
52	Doctors and hospitals that drop the plan	37	Dislike
53	Stuck: failing underwriting, no way back to a Medigap	35	Tab 1
54	Covered anywhere they travel	35	Tab 8
55	What the agent or broker told them	34	Tab 4
56	Medicare.gov, SHIP counselors and Social Security	32	Tab 6
57	Appealed a denial or filed a complaint	32	Tab 6
58	Extras that actually paid: dental, gym, OTC, giveback	32	Tab 8
59	Paying less for the same care	31	Tab 2
60	Agents and callers who push or mislead	31	Tab 5

Awareness → Offer Map

Each level describes where a buyer actually is. "Where they are" is their own sentence from this page; the hooks and offers under it are proposals built from that language, labeled as hypotheses until tested.

Where they are

Still on an employer or a spouse's plan, or just retired. They think Medicare is something you sign up for once. The rule that matters (after the first six months a supplement can turn you down in most states) is the one they say nobody told them.

"I wish I would have understood how difficult it was going to be later on to get a Medigap, due to the Underwriting process."

Messaging to test at this level (hypotheses)

Offer structure at level 1 (hypotheses)

A one-page sheet for their state: what you can change every year and what you can't.

A 15-minute call that sets the enrollment dates around their birthday and their employer coverage.

Part A and B timing, the supplement or Advantage application and Part D handled by one named agent.

Where they are

Ten videos in, more confused than before. They can recite the parts of Medicare and still cannot say what they should buy. Afraid of a mistake and of a penalty.

"I'm coming up on age 65 and until now, I was feeling overwhelmed."

Messaging to test at this level (hypotheses)

Offer structure at level 2 (hypotheses)

The two-list worksheet (doctors, drugs) and where to look each one up.

A screen-share where their own doctors and drugs are searched against the plans in their zip code.

The comparison done for them and the result explained in one call, with the application at the end.

Where they are

They can argue both sides. The supplement costs more every month; Advantage costs less until something happens. What tips them is a story: a friend, a parent, a denial.

"The cost and "perks" of an Advantage plan sound appealing, but not worth the risk of possible out of pocket expenses compared to original Medicare with a supplement plan."

Messaging to test at this level (hypotheses)

Offer structure at level 3 (hypotheses)

A bad-year worksheet: premiums plus the most they could owe under each choice.

Quotes for Plan G, Plan N and high-deductible G from every carrier in their zip, next to their Advantage options.

The application, the underwriting pre-check where it applies, and the Part D pick.

Where they are

The supplement went up again, or the Annual Notice of Change says the plan is ending or the hospital is out of network. They know their plan by name and want to know if they can move.

"The more my Plan N increases annually, the more I'm inclined (against my better judgement) to start looking at a Part C Advantage Plan instead."

Messaging to test at this level (hypotheses)

Offer structure at level 4 (hypotheses)

How to read the Annual Notice of Change in ten minutes.

The same letter plan re-shopped across carriers, with the health questions asked before any application.

The switch handled end to end, old policy cancelled only after the new one is issued.

Where they are

They have decided. They want a person, not a call center, and they have been warned about salespeople who push one kind of plan. The ones who found a good agent say so by name.

"I think the best thing and most important thing you can do is to have a good agent to help you."

Messaging to test at this level (hypotheses)

Offer structure at level 5 (hypotheses)

An enrollment link with the agent's name and direct line on it.

A 20-minute phone enrollment with the same agent who did the comparison.

Enrollment plus a review every October by the same agent, before the plan letter arrives.

Silent Searches

What the Medicare shopper (turning 65 or already on Medicare) types, watches and is sold, measured side by side (typed = autocomplete that still names the worry; watched = YouTube videos whose title names it; spoke = own-voice documents; sold = ads to this audience).

Worry	Typed	Videos	Views	Spoke	Ads
Can't afford premiums, Part B, drugs or dental	28	49	996,502	297	161
Stuck in Advantage: can't get a Medigap later	26	56	1,545,787	258	115
Denied care, prior authorization, narrow networks	28	60	340,555	197	305
Flooded with Medicare calls and texts	84	73	1,381,158	24	222
Can I trust the agent? Commissions and bias	18	61	956,616	87	77
'Extra benefits' ads: flex cards, giveback, grocery money	13	68	411,942	428	213
Confused, afraid of choosing wrong or missing a deadline	15	48	3,033,807	461	153

Can't afford premiums, Part B, drugs or dental

Typed: can america afford medicare for all · can i pay medicare irmaa with hsa · can t afford eliquis on medicare · can t afford medicare part b · can t afford medicare part b for seniors · can us afford medicare for all · can we afford medicare for all · can you pay medicare irmaa premiums with hsa · can you pay part b premium with hsa · can't afford medicare · can't afford medicare copays · can't afford medicare part b · can't afford medicare part d · can't afford medicare premium · can't afford medicare reddit · can't afford medicare supplement · does extra help pay for part b premium · help to pay part b premium

Watched: Is A Big Part B Premium Increase Coming in 2024? (277,101 views) https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=e7hPcPjXD_U · Medicare Part B Premium Cost - Shocking! What is IRMAA? (113,519 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KVh-8gn8aO4> · Medicare Costs in 2026 I What You Need to Know! (108,134 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SUMqkTfP6Z8> · Medicare Cost Breakdown (original Medicare and Medigap) - 2025 (90,709 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Pxr2-j1zBEg> · IRMAA Explained: The Hidden Medicare Cost That Could Double Your Premiums in Retirement (72,043 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=McRktcoWBG0>

Stuck in Advantage: can't get a Medigap later

Typed: can i switch from a medicare supplement to an advantage plan at any time · can i switch from a medicare supplement to an advantage plan during oep · can i switch from medicare advantage back to medicare supplement · can i switch from medicare advantage to a medicare supplement · can i switch from medicare advantage to a supplement plan · can i switch from medicare advantage to medicare supplement · can i switch from medicare advantage to medicare supplement during open enrollment · can i switch from medicare advantage to medicare supplement plan · can i switch from medicare advantage to supplement · can i switch from medicare supplement to medicare advantage without underwriting · can i switch from regular medicare to an advantage plan · can you switch from a medicare advantage plan to a supplement plan · can you switch from an advantage plan to a supplement · can you switch from medicare advantage to a supplement · can you switch from medicare advantage to medicare supplement during open enrollment · can you switch from medicare advantage to medicare supplement plan · can you switch from medicare advantage to original medicare and supplement · can you switch from medicare advantage to supplement

Watched: Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap (371,221 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg> · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) (367,638 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA> · The \$600/Month Medicare Mistake Most 65-Year-Olds Make (322,811 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HsfNTRmt3Pw> · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened (207,193 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc> · Common Medicare Mistakes to AVOID! (67,675 views) https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=kXkHqV_OBPE

Denied care, prior authorization, narrow networks

Typed: aetna medicare advantage denial rates · can you be denied medicare advantage coverage · hhs medicare advantage denial report · humana medicare advantage denial rate · medicare advantage claim denial rates · medicare advantage denial · medicare advantage denial notice · medicare advantage denial of service · medicare advantage denial rates · medicare advantage denial rates by company · medicare advantage denied claims · medicare advantage denied rituxan in oregon · medicare advantage plan denial rates · medicare advantage plans are receiving criticism over denied claims · medicare advantage prior authorization · medicare advantage prior authorization denials · medicare advantage prior authorization form · medicare advantage prior authorization form cigna

Watched: Original Medicare Prior Authorizations Starting 2026 (92,153 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=DLYA1dxLAo> · New Medicare Prior Authorization Rules! (81,661 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=j7ctlhJrZuo> · Medicare Supplement coverage denied? Why insurance companies deny you (and what to do about it). (40,648 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=iHQdxXXdiQo> · The Truth About United Healthcare's Claim Denials and Dr. Oz's Plan to Force Medicare Advantage (30,258 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=LhIMMntQaY0> · CMS Adds Prior Authorization to Original Medicare (26,094 views) https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=f_JgNQsR19Q

Flooded with Medicare calls and texts

Typed: are calls from medicare legitimate · are medicare calls legit · how to block calls from medicare · how to block medicare calls · how to block medicare calls on iphone · how to block medicare enrollment calls · how to block medicare phone calls · how to block medicare robocalls · how to block medicare spam calls · how to block the medicare calls · how to block unwanted medicare calls · how to end medicare calls · how to make medicare stop calling · how to stop all medicare calls · how to stop all of the medicare calls · how to stop all the medicare calls · how to stop all the medicare phone calls · how to stop annoying medicare calls

Watched: How to Effectively Put a Stop to Spam Calls, Emails and Texts (908,804 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=6nojRzHj0CE> · Former telemarketer shares secrets to stopping the constant calls (250,704 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=wBxUP35X3MQ> · IT'S A SCAM! A DAY IN THE LIFE! How Many Medicare Scam Calls Can I Get In One Day... HA! (25,648 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=32GR2F0y4IY> · How to Make Medicare SPAM CALLS Stop! Insider TIPS, TRICKS, SECRETS! (18,760 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Jn9TfydB6mM> · How To Stop Unwanted Medicare Calls (17,227 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=K6XCXO5gTGw>

Can I trust the agent? Commissions and bias

Typed: becoming a medicare agent · day in the life of a medicare agent · do i need a medicare agent · do you need a broker for medicare · how do medicare agents get paid · how much does medicare agents make · how to be a medicare insurance agent · how to become a medicare agent · how to become a medicare insurance agent · how to become an independent medicare agent · how to become medicare insurance agent · independent medicare agent · medicare agent · should i use a medicare broker · should i use an insurance broker for medicare · what do medicare brokers do · what is a licensed medicare agent · who is my medicare agent

Watched: How Medicare Advantage Commissions Really Work (214,781 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=e6-PoFAPgTk> · How much do insurance agents ACTUALLY make? (199,603 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Uq25B0E5KHo> · Why Should I Work With A Medicare Agent (92,100 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KcURSJn6Q1I> · The \$87/Month Secret Your Medicare Agent Isn't Telling you (43,293 views) https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=elePa_fGxbw · How Do Medicare Brokers Get Paid? (36,031 views) https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=DBwUb_QfaB0

'Extra benefits' ads: flex cards, giveback, grocery money

Typed: flex card benefits · how does medicare part b giveback work · how does part b giveback work · humana part b giveback reviews · humana part b giveback reviews consumer reports · is medicare flex card a scam · is the medicare flex card a scam · medicare flex card · medicare flex card scams · medicare phone scam · what is a medical flex card · what is part b giveback · what is the medicare part b giveback

Watched: What Is The Flex Card For Seniors? (105,562 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=U7te9a6r8dQ> · Is the Flex Card for Seniors Legit? (75,517 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8J5QeGGebDk> · \$2,800 Medicare Flex Card For Seniors I Is It Real Or A Scam? (73,378 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=UEmPMMmrEVI> · Are Medicare Flex Cards a SCAM? (24,717 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=z0juaPOqhQM> · Is \$2880 Flex Card for seniors on Medicare legitimate? Can you apply for seniors Flex card in 2021? (15,075 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=PmJaR7zTCfk>

Confused, afraid of choosing wrong or missing a deadline

Typed: i made a mistake on my medicare application · medicare late enrollment penalties · medicare late enrollment penalty · medicare late enrollment penalty appeal · medicare late enrollment penalty appeal form · medicare late enrollment penalty calculator · medicare late enrollment penalty exceptions · medicare late enrollment penalty exceptions pdf · medicare late enrollment penalty for life · medicare late enrollment penalty part d · medicare late enrollment penalty reconsideration request form · medicare late enrollment penalty waiver · medicare part b late enrollment penalty · medicare part d penalty · medicare penalty for not enrolling

Watched: Working Past 65? Medicare Mistakes You Can't Afford To Make! 🤖 (1,790,879 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4GtRppYTHho> · Working past 65? Avoid these HUGE Medicare mistakes. (786,618 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=evYI75xJnKg> · Avoiding Costly Medicare Mistakes (78,792 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Mlw87U6Moo> · Common Medicare Mistakes to AVOID! (67,675 views) https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=kXkHqV_OBPE · Top 5 Medicare Mistakes (64,323 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=owdO-jZ0pno>

Private Worries

Measured absence: 0 first-person sentences say they keep something from their spouse, children or doctor.

Can't afford premiums, Part B, drugs or dental · 297 documents

"My wife and I signed up for Medicare plus the G supplement plus Medicare D. At First it was fine, but after 3- 4 years it was costing us 700 dollars a MONTH. We kept it when we were traveling. It did pay claims, but we did have to pay some stuff. It just became too expensive to keep. So, we changed to the Advantage type after moving to a higher population area. Referrals are not a problem most of the time. Now our max out-of-pocket is 700 dollars a YEAR. My drug copays were 25 bucks for the YEAR, no deductible. True, we have to stay within the provider groups, but we have quite a few to pick from. Original Medicare is great, if you're rich or can go to wherever you have the money to afford to seek out expensive care. Not so much if you live in a backward state or a medical wasteland. Either way you go, you're screwed. Insurance companies, PBMs, hospitals, medical groups, drug companies, crooks who cheat Medicare at every turn are what we Americans are stuck with at this point. The ruling rich overlords will never change it. Congress and the courts have been bought, and YOU AND I have been stuck with the bill."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 722 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgxAXzFMBaU-X7O2GZ4AaABAq>

"Almost fell into that trap until I was warned by a person who's family member eventually died because of care that was denied to them because Medicare Advantage declined to pay for treatment because it was too expensive despite the recommendation of a specialist. While in the appeals process, the family member passed away. After doing some research on my own, I found that this had occurred multiple times with people on Medicare Advantage. Also, that many healthcare providers were now refusing to accept Medicare Advantage. Needless to say, I chose traditional Medicare. The gap premiums aren't cheap, but I have the "peace of mind" of knowing that I can receive the care/treatment recommended by my doctor. This shouldn't be happening to seniors who PAID into Medicare their entire working lives."

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 270 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9Id0w9OA&lc=UgwTr1OgGdvCFu3U5Fp4AaABAq>

"Why does John Oliver hate Medicare Advantage so much? I'm huge fan of Last Week Tonight with John Oliver ([his show on MA.])(<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yfLVCc>) He is amazing at taking a topic, going in depth, and if need be, skewering it. But I think he was way off base on his Medicare Advantage rant. So, it costs the government--when has that ever bothered him (or me)? And yes, it's not the same as Original Medicare, but more like regular insurance. I know, I have it. Like all insurance are there instances of denial? Sure (although he was really reaching for it on some of his examples). But here's the thing. For me to switch to Part D and a Medigap plan it would cost me about \$3000 a year. I've had MA for 8 years, and I've never spent more than \$200 or \$300 in a given year on copays and coinsurance. And that's not counting the thousands I get in dental, eyewear, hearing, and OTC benefits (although granted some of those are being reduced or cut this year). And with my PPO plan, I can see any doctor or specialist I want without a referral, in or out of network (nearly every provider in my medium-size midwest city is in network). So, sure I could just go back to Original Medicare and pay the 20% it doesn't cover myself. Or I could get the drug and gap insurance (which you have to buy from private companies, by the way). But I can't afford either of those options. But I can afford my MA plan. And I wish rich people would stop telling me what to do with money I don't have."

— medicare · 88 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1op2r5b/>

Stuck in Advantage: can't get a Medigap later · 258 documents

"The ACA in a death spiral? Everyone seems to forget: the original ACA had (1) a requirement that everyone had to participate or they would pay a tax penalty, and (2) states had to opt into expanded ~~Medicare~~ Medicaid . These two provisions were later removed, and thus began the spiraling death of the ACA. As predicted. Once you understand that universal health care is essential if you want to control costs while making sure everyone is covered (including people with pre-existing conditions), its obvious it only works if either (a) everyone must pay into it, regardless of their current needs, or (b) if you don't pay into it, you are not eligible for the benefit. Look, it is INSURANCE, similar to car insurance: you pay your car insurance monthly hoping you never get into an accident which requires you to use it. You pay more, or less, according to your risk factors. Health insurance is similar. You hope YOU are not that 30 year old who gets cancer that costs \$1m to treat (or that 60 year old who has a massive heart attack) but if you are, you are glad you are covered. But if it is optional, people play the odds game against insurance: I am healthy right now, I don't think I personally will get back what I am paying in so I am NOT buying insurance. Leaving mostly unhealthy 30 or 60 year olds in their rate group, requiring prices to rise because unhealthy people cost more because they consume more (doctor care, emergency visits, medicines, therapy, etc.) Spiral, spiral and spiral. And what are we, as a nation, willing to do with people without means of obtaining medical care? Lock the emergency room door when someone bleeding approaches without insurance or money? Well, this will soon be the case anyway, as emergency departments already see the writing on the wall and are shuttering before they go bankrupt. If you truly believe in the American trickle down theory (wherein rich business people, getting huge tax breaks, provide people with good paying jobs with health insurance), great! Let's see when that starts happening! I guess you are saying we just need to ignore wealth inequality (even though a small number of the wealthiest billionaires combined hold more wealth than the bottom 50% of the entire U.S. population.) I, for one, will be voting for the next person running for president (from whatever party) who runs on implementing true health care reform in the form of universal health care. I don't care what we call it: Gold Health Plans, Medicare for All, ACA v 2.0, whatever. Why can't WE get it done, just like every other civilized country has figured out how to accomplish? Help me understand."

— HealthInsurance · 804 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1q27xss/>

"Universal coverage is simple, but the facts are unpalatable to many **Background premises:** I'll start with the premise that, in the USA, a citizen who gets a curable cancer should not die for want of care. (You may agree with that premise or not, but I'm doing a thought experiment about universal coverage and this premise is the basic justification for universal coverage.) (I'm leaving out non-citizens not because I don't care about them, but because I want to avoid side issues and make clear how brutally limited our choices are to meet the goal of "curable cancer shouldn't kill you.") I have an opinion about the best way to solve the problem, but I won't express it now. I will just list the logical possibilities. There aren't many. **Option 1:** If you get cancer, go to the ED. This is pretty much the system now. You will probably get care, although it will likely be delayed and suboptimal. Guess who pays for this? Ultimately the government/populace. Doctors and hospitals cannot provide free care for everyone who has no insurance, without ultimately going bankrupt. So ultimately the government/populace pays for this. The mechanisms are weird and varied - various subsidies, overcharging private insurers, "safety net" hospitals which are subsidized by the government, etc. But let's not kid ourselves. Someone pays for it - and that someone is us. And if the mechanisms of payment are weird and varied, they are probably inefficient and wasteful. And of course, if people actually could get preventive care, maybe fewer people would get cancer and maybe that would be better for all of us in the long run (ya think?). **Option 2:** The government covers everyone. The easiest way to do this is by making people over 60 eligible for Medicare, then next year adding people under 18 and people over 55. In a few years, we have Medicare for all. To cushion the economic change for insurance companies, you can drag this out over 10 years or so if you wish. Government-run systems in other countries have lots of problems, and people in those countries are often unhappy with them, but they do cover everyone, and developed nations with universal health care - without exception - spend much less and get better global outcomes than we do. Yes, you may have to wait a year or longer for your hip replacement in Canada. But overall, you will live longer and healthier. Which are you gonna choose? And yes, it's really a choice: If a country devotes all its resources to making sure the fraction of the population who need a hip replacement get it within 3 weeks, a lot of resources have to be diverted from preventative and primary care. You have to decide at the beginning if immediate availability of elective care is more important, or if overall health and longevity of the population is more important. \[As an aside, if the government covered everyone we would collect something like \$600M more in taxes annually, because employers wouldn't provide health insurance plans, and the money previously used for employer-provided plans would be taxable (either on the company side or the employee side).\] **Option 3:** A market based plan. Here the choices are much starker than most people realize. It basically means everyone gets some kind of private insurance so that when you get a curable cancer you don't die. Almost all Americans, in polls, agree that you should be able to get insurance even if you have a pre-existing condition. If you are guaranteed coverage for pre-existing conditions, most people will be better off not getting insurance until they get cancer. The people who will buy insurance right away are those with expensive chronic conditions. Someone who has an autoimmune disorder and needs \$30K worth of biological meds annually will buy insurance. Someone who is healthy will not buy insurance and pay for basic care out of pocket. If the healthy person gets cancer, they'll just buy insurance at that point. I hope it's clear to all that under this system no insurance company will stay in business for more than a year or two. Nobody will buy insurance until the insurance payouts they get are larger than their premium. Meaning the insurance companies will lose money on every policy they sell. So, if you are going to have a market based plan that meets the goal of "people don't die of a curable cancer," you have to persuade or require healthy people to join now. Health insurance (whether provided by Medicare, Medicaid or private companies) is a mechanism of spreading risk. We can afford to care for a child with cancer ONLY because a lot of people are paying insurance premiums (or taxes) when they don't need expensive services. Hence the Affordable Care Act. There are many things to like or dislike about the ACA, but it's shocking how many don't seem to grasp the basic premise. **You cannot provide coverage for pre-existing conditions unless healthy people pay premiums.** This is not an opinion. It's mathematics. I am not a huge fan of insurance companies, but if they spend more than they take in on every policy they will fail - and thus a system that relies on insurance companies will fail. **Conclusions** I submit that there is basically no way to meet the goal of "A US citizen with a curable cancer shouldn't die for want of care" except the 3 I have outlined. If anyone can propose another, I'd love to hear about it. Any plan that doesn't adopt one of these three premises fails to meet the basic goal of "A US citizen with a curable cancer shouldn't die for want of care." Health savings plans, tax breaks, malpractice reforms, etc, nibble around the edges of the problem, and may make some significant improvements here or there. But to meet the really important goal, you need a comprehensive approach, and the only mathematical possibilities are (1) The government/ populace pays for it indirectly, (2) The government/ populace pays for it directly, or (3) Healthy people have to be required to buy insurance so that sick people can get care that would otherwise be beyond their means. My two cents. I welcome all of your opinions about this."

— HealthInsurance · 404 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1pqufyv/>

"GREAT job, Erin! I'm a retired physician and I think you hit this out of the park. My wife and I started with an MC Advantage Plan but the unpredictability of out-of-network coverage, rapidly increasing max. out of pocket limits, increasing daily hospital copays, and pretty inadequate rehab coverage really began to make me rethink our decision. When our MC Advantage plan wasn't available in our area for 2026 we were so happy to be able to switch to a Medigap plan with guaranteed issue during a Special Enrollment Period (SEP). It's one of the few ways to be able to switch in that direction without underwriting. Yes the premiums are significant but the predictability of healthcare expenses, portability, and freedom of choice where to receive care made it worth it to us - priceless, in fact. I'm 67 and my wife is 72. Thank you for helping so many future decision-makers have such clarity."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 156 likes · <http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=Ugwn9lCoa-Qw7KmDdUp4AaABAg>

Denied care, prior authorization, narrow networks · 197 documents

"Physical Therapist here. Absolutely keep your traditional Medicare with Plan N/G while you can. Medicare with a plan G is a Golden plan. Dr.'s and hospital love traditional Medicare. They won't be denied and you won't be denied care. Plus you can choose any specialist/provider you want and also go to the top notch hospitals in the whole country including Mayo, Johns Hopkins, Cleveland Clinic etc, etc, etc. In the end if you get really sick it's well worth it. I pay around \$450 a month including Part A and B premium. I worked all my life in healthcare to afford to access the best healthcare in our country."

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 595 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgxcFFuqvyczX0JtB0J4AaABAg>

"Being a Utilization management RN for a Florida based hospital for over 15 years, I totally agree with you. So often patients experience medical emergencies while on vacation and are limited to choices for care while away from home and "out of network." I advise my friends and family to always invest in supplements and keep Medicare, steering them away from advantage or replacement plans. I think it's a crime when I have to argue with advantage plans to authorize physician directed care after the acute health emergency has been addressed. Most folks don't realize that once a patient is determined to be stable, their care is limited to what their advantage plan will allow, even while they remain hospitalized. Often their choices decrease significantly when they are discharged. Those who require home health or rehabilitation services post-hospitalization can be severely restricted and are usually required to return home to their local area for coverage. You are providing a great service with your videos. Keep it up!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 513 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgyQPwewvEHaPILi_Qd4AaABAg

"My wife had been complaining of shortness of breath for about six months before finally talking to her doctor in late August. The doctor had an EKG done, which was normal, and then ordered a CT scan of her heart. In September she was diagnosed with severe aortic stenosis, (bad aortic valve), which has a 50% mortality rate within two years. She then had a cardiac catheterization done to see if her heart was healthy or if she needed bypass surgery. Her arteries were clear and an appointment was made for an open heart valve replacement. The open heart surgery with valve replacement was done in the first week of November. The total cost of everything was \$207,000. Our out-of-pocket cost was \$280, part of which was the part B deductible. We have original Medicare with Plan N and a Part D prescription plan. I believe if we had an MA plan we would still be waiting on prior authorization if she survived long enough."

— YouTube · MASSIVE: Hospitals Are DROPPING Medicare Advantage Plans 🤖 · 212 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vn2k1W-JzB8&lc=UgzevbXaSu0WX4WCW814AaABAg>

Flooded with Medicare calls and texts · 24 documents

"Happened to me, I have Medicare advanced plan they denied my tooth implant after so many calls with no help to me end paying over a \$1000 to have y implant. Thank you for this information 🙌"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 18 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgxuCsVVvEwv17QPSop4AaABAg.9hFaZEgdHjE9hvWYk3W0ct>

"Fired from my medicare advantage job After getting my 215 license I started working at an agency that sells mapd, supplement, and hospital indemnity plans. Things were going great compared to fast food jobs I started making 1k+ a week and I wasn't even closing yet. Things started going down hill when I started closing my own deals after the agency bought me a few states. Aep was over and during oep I noticed the callers became increasingly hard to deal with. Most of them were only calling about a flex card, some of them didn't want to switch providers, while others stayed on the line just to curse me out and ask to be under the do not call list. I tried my best to close more deals and had no idea how other agents were even managing 5 deals a day compared to the calls I was receiving. Eventually I got called in the office and they decided to let me go. My question is where should I go from here? This is the first job I got fired from and I still have my license so I should be able to find a new job but now my confidence is at an all time low. What if I get fired again? Idk"

— InsuranceAgent · 17 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1j8srq5/fired_from_my_medicare_advantage_job/

"I am only 40. I don't qualify for Medicare. I am in the national do not call registry. These Medicare scammers are harassing me to an insane degree. I got 78 calls just yesterday."

— YouTube · How to STOP "Medicare" Phone Calls, Texts, Emails, and Letters · 16 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cQh6ldSh6uc&lc=UgwLJ9RMyrtjCPV6U7B4AaABAq>

Can I trust the agent? Commissions and bias · 87 documents

"I won't be 65 until June 2024, but have been doing a lot of research about this topic. I have watched several videos by others that explained the difference between the 2 ways to go, but had yet to find one that I felt comfortable passing on to my other 64 year old friends. My search has ended. Yours is the most even-handed, non-emotional one out there. You aren't just parroting the biased views of others."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 485 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgzEumJESs7gZho7ZUR4AaABAq>

"I'm 67 and still working but planing to retire at 70. I've watched countless of your competitor videos on YT and through this process educated myself about the choices of Medicare. But your video was the BEST, most comprehensive and unbiased I've ever seen and your youthful looks belie your wise old owl wisdom."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 178 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=Ugzce3UIINwJWth1qP14AaABAq>

"This is the ONLY unbiased YouTube on both options. This gentleman is an agent and that's very rare. I can name two, no three agencies that do nothing but flood this site with constant negative videos about Medicare Advantage Plans. The one guy always has a thumbnail with his eyes wide open and his hand over his mouth. Scare tactic, nothing more. Supplements are great, but millions of Americans have advantage plans that do what they are designed to do without issue. I personally have experience using both for more than a decade. Original Medicare should be requiring more pre-authorizations and in the coming years this will happen. The government has been getting ripped off for decades. Oh, we like cats!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement Plans (2026 Update) – Full Comparison · 171 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cxhlXrMrc5s&lc=UgxT0a_1CgP1_SKsFId4AaABAq

'Extra benefits' ads: flex cards, giveback, grocery money · 428 documents

"I am 64 and received my medicare card. As a senior citizen trying to go through the maze of medicare plans is enough stress to kill anyone. One must ask themselves why is medicare so hard to navigate that private insurers send out their so called medicare advisors to steal our money? I have decided to decline Part B and I will definitely not sign up for the Advantage Plan that I know all too well it will kill you in the end. I will cancel my Federal blue Cross Blue Shield insurance that is almost \$400 a month now that I have only used on four occasions in 21 years. I'd rather die than give one more cent to a broken health care system. When property insurance, health care insurance and auto insurance takes over 50% of a retired citizen income, I call that a crime. The only reason we are the wealthiest country in the world is due to the fact that private companies have been stealing money from the hard working middle class folks and became richer with the money they stole from us because the law makers got their kick back money and we got kicked in the back."

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 811 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9Id0w9OA&lc=UgwoFkaXMEaOiRM1oYh4AaABAg>

"Physical Therapist here. Absolutely keep your traditional Medicare with Plan N/G while you can. Medicare with a plan G is a Golden plan. Dr.'s and hospital love traditional Medicare. They won't be denied and you won't be denied care. Plus you can choose any specialist/provider you want and also go to the top notch hospitals in the whole country including Mayo, Johns Hopkins, Cleveland Clinic etc, etc, etc. In the end if you get really sick it's well worth it. I pay around \$450 a month including Part A and B premium. I worked all my life in healthcare to afford to access the best healthcare in our country."

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 595 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903gXaHg&lc=UgxcFFuqvyczX0JtB0J4AaABAg>

"Medicare Advantage is a Scam: My experience almost a decade in the Healthcare industry I was inspired to go into some detail after an AskReddit post about dirty insider truth that most people won't know. I replied that, as a person who who's worked in the medical field for a little over 9 years, saying that Medicare is leagues better than Medicare Advantage and Medicare Advantage is a scam. I've worked in a Home Health Agency, an inpatient rehab (SNF), a doctor's office, and am currently an RN working inpatient rehab. Hopefully, people will find this interesting or helpful \- Admissions for SNF: First medical jobs was admissions primarily to fill short term rehab beds. I had a website of all the people discharging from local hospitals who needed inpatient therapy, I would reach out to the hospitals, say we had a bed available, they would confirm with me, I would get the paperwork, get insurance authorization if needed, and greet the patient once they arrived and sign papers Medicare patients: I was told to try and get as many traditional Medicare patients as possible. I asked my boss why and she said that they pay the most and they always pay. I never once had to get insurance authorizations for traditional Medicare. The people could just come in! It covered the most therapy per day vs any other insurance(an hour a day vs. 30 minutes a day usually), including every Medicare Advantage. It automatically covered the first 20 days, then the next 80 days after that, I think it was like 60%. But if they had a secondary insurance, it would cover 100 days at 100%. Medicare Advantage: First off, once you get a Medicare Advantage plan, its not traditional medicare anymore, it's the insurance company now. Of you want to come to our facility, you don't get the grace of just walking in. I'm sure they've streamlined everything now, but we had to call a number, present the diagnosis in certain code numbers, wait for an authorization number, and then we could let you in. From there, you'd maybe get 20 days at 100% with half the daily rehab, then after 20 days, they were done. it covered nothing. Patient was 100% responsible for all costs. \- Home Health Scheduler My 2nd job was scheduling a team of Therapists and Nurses to different homes in my city who needed home health. I'd get a stack of referral papers every morning and was told to get them scheduled. For example, a referral would say "Medicare A: Needs RN and PT services", and then I'd contact my staff and arrange a schedule. I would also work with my staff and the patients that needed anything rescheduled. I was essentially the Guy in the Chair Medicare: Let's say that of my 3 referrals I had that morning 1 was traditional Medicare A, once was a UHC Medicare Advantage, and the other a Humana Medicare Advantage. Once again, I was told, "Staff the Medicare patients first!" And once again, I asked why and was told that Medicare always pays, and it always pays the most. I wasn't working directly with insurance at that job, so I can't comment on authorizations or cost. But Medicare patients generally had more RN and PT visits per week then any Medicare Advantage. Usually 3 days per week for each with Medicare, and 2 days a week for any Medicare Advantage. Also, there are longer sessions with Medicare. usually an hour vs 30 minutes Medicare Advantage: Just less care. Less staffing days and shorter sessions. \- Doctor's office: Next job I had before my RN was in a primary care physicians office. I only worked the front desk, but I worked right next to the referral coordinator, so I knew everything that was happening about that Medicare: From a cashiers perspective, Medicare never had a copay while many Medicare Advantage plan did. From a referral perspective, Medicare was so much easier. I don't think I ever saw Medicare rejected a referral claim. It was always quick, and as long as we filled the paperwork out properly, it was approved. Also, most specialists took Medicare, so usually patients could go where they wanted. Medicare Advantage: There was always an authorization process. it often involved scanning and sending documents, then waiting for approval. Generally it was a longer process that resulted in much more rejections than traditional Medicare. Also, one again, becuae Medicare Advantage isn't Medicare anymore, it's whatever insurance company has it now, the patients were stuck with whatever doctors they had plans with, and it was always a much smaller list than Tradition Medicare. I've been an RN for about 4 years now, so I am very separated from the insurance side, thank God! DISCLAIMER: Some Medicare Advantage plans are competitive with the benefits of traditional Medicare, but they are often very expensive. Some people are very happy with their Medicare Advantage plans, but I wanted to share my perspective, and my experience. But, this is also why I am greatly in support of expanding Medicare to cover all People in the US. We have the means to give the people proper Healthcare, we just need to do it"

— HealthInsurance · 472 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1sl2x0z/>

Confused, afraid of choosing wrong or missing a deadline · 461 documents

"Erin, this is your best video ever! I'm coming up on age 65 and until now, I was feeling overwhelmed. Thank you, thank you, thank you 🙏"

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 234 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=Ugz25KzjRIqEu63hvvvh4AaABAg>

"This video is by far the best explanation on the difference between original Medicare and Medicare Advantage without being confusing. Thank you so much for this. I will be 65 in 2026 and my employer is dropping my health coverage because he says I will be on Medicare. I have been bombarded with SOOOO much information. It's difficult to understand this whole thing. You have cleared up a lot of it for me in one video! So THANK YOU!!!!"

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 146 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1SFCZkg&lc=UgxLckexGeBnELXhfKZ4AaABAg>

"As someone turning 65 next month this type of information is very helpful. The way they have set everything up could not be more confusing and inefficient."

— YouTube · Working past 65? Avoid these HUGE Medicare mistakes. · 129 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=evYI75xJnKg&lc=UgwddBLZOMhdw-fYFsl4AaABAg>

Lead Sources

Source	Documents	Worked	Burned
An independent agent or broker	101	11	2
YouTube channels and seminars	75	9	0
Employer or retiree plan / HR	43	2	1
AARP	26	3	0
The carrier directly (Humana, UHC, Aetna...)	10	0	0
Friends, family, neighbors	10	1	2
TV ads and people who called them	9	0	1
SHIP counselors	8	1	0
Doctor's office	4	0	0
Medicare.gov / Plan Finder / 1-800-MEDICARE	3	0	0

Threads & Competitors

Group	Name	Documents	Positive	Negative
concepts & products	Plan G	1385	79	4
concepts & products	Part D and the donut hole	863	37	8
concepts & products	Plan N	832	63	5
concepts & products	Underwriting and guaranteed issue	533	17	14
concepts & products	Dental coverage	465	23	8
carriers	UnitedHealthcare / AARP	431	24	10
concepts & products	Plan F	299	24	0
concepts & products	IRMAA	254	5	5
carriers	Blue Cross Blue Shield	242	13	2
carriers	Humana	221	12	5
concepts & products	High-deductible Plan G	201	11	4
concepts & products	Prior authorization	171	8	15
carriers	Aetna / CVS	163	11	3
concepts & products	Excess charges	116	2	2
carriers	Kaiser	107	8	1
concepts & products	SilverSneakers and gym benefits	80	14	1
carriers	Wellcare / Centene / Ambetter	67	4	0
concepts & products	The Annual Notice of Change (ANOC)	59	0	0
carriers	Mutual of Omaha	57	0	0

carriers	Cigna	42	2	0
concepts & products	GoodRx and Cost Plus Drugs	41	1	0
carriers	Anthem / Elevance / Wellpoint	36	4	0
concepts & products	Part B giveback	33	3	1
platforms & tools	SHIP counselors	30	1	0
concepts & products	Flex, grocery and OTC cards	29	1	0
platforms & tools	Medicare.gov Plan Finder	23	2	1
carriers	Devoted	15	1	0
brokers & call centers	Boomer Benefits	12	3	0
brokers & call centers	Assurance IQ	4	1	0
platforms & tools	HealthCare.gov	4	1	0
brokers & call centers	Chapter	3	0	0

Competitor Ads

Lead-generation funnels and third-party marketers (call now, see if you qualify, benefit bait) · 356 ads · 122 advertisers

Advertiser	Ads	Longest (days)	Destination	Opening line
Chapter	2	1747	calendly.com	For many Americans, choosing Medicare coverage is complicated and frustrating when turning 65. Chapter is a technology-driven Medicare advis
Total Medicare Savings	5	1150	none captured	Did you know... Anyone turning 65 in the next 6 months can get Medicare Supplement (Medigap) Insurance from over 20 insurance companies with
Blue Store Greensboro	1	842	none captured	Medicare Enrollment Center - Turning 65? Get local assistance at no cost. Call or come by the Greensboro BCBS retail center today! 1941 New
Dental Benefits Finder	1	686	dental-benefits-finder.com	Seniors can get dentures with a Zero Cost (\$0) Dental plan today. If you are a senior over 64, check if you qualify. Click here now. 0:00 /
Senior Legacy USA	1	612	none captured	🇺🇸 NORTH EAST OHIO SENIORS, 🇺🇸 IF YOU ARE ON MEDICARE & MEDICAID YOU ARE ENTITLED TO A MONTHLY FLEX BENEFIT CARD Don't Leave Benefits on the T
100Insure	3	495	usamedicaresimplified.com	Here's how we help Medicare beneficiaries affected by qualifying life events get proper coverage without waiting. Recently moved? Lost cover
Meagher Insurance and Financial Services	1	456	none captured	Choosing a Medicare plan doesn't have to be confusing. At The Meagher Agency, we help you navigate your options so you can get the best cove
City Point Dental	1	371	none captured	At City Point Dental, we're here to help you get the most out of your Medicare benefits. We work with the majority of Medicare dental suppl
Community Buzz	1	329	buzz.rarefindsnow.com	🍷🌟 Discover How Medicare May Help Cover Diapers. BUZZ.RAREFINDSNOW.COM Medicare Coverage For Diapers Medicare & Medicaid Adult Diaper Covera
Financial Benefits Insurance, Inc	1	324	none captured	Have Medicare and Medicaid? Discover available programs and extra benefits through Medicare, including: 1- Acupuncture 2- Chiropractic 3- De
Medicare Made Easy	12	272	medicaremadeeasytn.com	Started getting those Medicare mailers yet? If you're like most people soon to be 65, your mailbox is probably starting to look like a Medic
Daniel M Smith HealthMarkets Insurance	1	232	none captured	NOW OPEN!! 6557 N Socrum Lp Rd. next to Ace Hardware. Come see us for all your Medicare and Health Insurance needs!
Smart Plan Check	3	196	smartplancheck.com	HTTPS://SMARTPLANCHECK.COM/D981625F50EA/ Looking to review your Medicare coverage during Open Enrollment? DISCLAIMER We do not offer every p

Medicare Made Easy for Turning 65	1	189	none captured	🕒 Now is the time for you to fully understand the Medicare Plans & Options available to you. ✅ We work directly with you to help you select
MindBody Knowhow	1	183	life.fast-searches.com	Discover How Medicare May Help Cover Diapers. HTTPS://LIFE.FAST-SEARCHES.COM Medicare Coverage For Diapers Medicare & Medicaid Adult Diaper
EverThrive	1	168	none captured	Living with pain, mobility issues, or a chronic condition? Call today! (844) 500-3837. You may qualify for remote therapeutic monitoring (RT
Happy-Bunny	6	167	happy.searchandspot.com	👂👂 Seniors deserve to hear every word. See if Medicare benefits include hearing aids for you. ✅ HAPPY.SEARCHANDSPOT.COM Medicare Hearing Aid
Health Helpers	4	165	healthhelpers.co	\$255/month for Plan G — for seven years. She thought that's just what it costs. It wasn't. Same exact coverage. \$85/month less. Over \$1,000/
SFG Medicare	1	155	sfgmedicare.com	Confused by all the Medicare mail and constant phone calls? At Senior Financial Group, we use a simple five-step process called SFG CARES to
Boomer Benefits	6	146	boomerbenefits.com	Medicare can be a complicated process, but we're here to help! In just 5 minutes of reading, you will have all the information needed for yo
MedicareAdvantage.com	6	144	aetna-medicareadvantage.com	New to Medicare or recently moved? Explore Aetna Medicare Advantage plans with additional benefits at little to no monthly premium. Aetna Me
Medicare Benefits for Seniors Explained	1	142	none captured	🕒 Now is the time for you to fully understand the Medicare Plans & Options available to you. ✅ We work directly with you to help you select
Medicare Supplement Quote	3	139	none captured	Most people feel stuck when their Medicare supplement premium goes up. They think switching companies means changing their coverage, finding
MedicareProz	5	131	medicareproz.com	New to Original Medicare, Aging into Original Medicare, Lost your Health Insurance, On Medicare Parts A and B but have recently moved, or ha
Senior Health Group	1	131	seniorhealthgroup.co	[Non-AEP: You may qualify for a Special Enrollment Period (SEP) if you experience certain life events, such as: New to Medicare, Aging into
Senior Health Benefits 365	37	127	none captured	🇺🇸 VETERANS: KNOW YOUR OPTIONS 🇺🇸 Medicare Advantage does not replace VA or TRICARE. Some veterans use Medicare Advantage alongside VA or TR
Dr. Ed - Former SSA Manager	4	125	askchapter.org	Choosing the wrong Medicare plan can cost you thousands over time. The good news? It only takes 2 minutes to see if you qualify for better c
Medicare Resource Center	1	108	www.resourcemedicare.com	Medicare can feel overwhelming, especially with changing plans and rising costs. Schedule a quick review with a Medicare Pro to better under
Welltra Medicare Solutions	1	106	none captured	Turning 65 or already on Medicare? Review available Medicare plan options and see what benefits may be available in your area. Call today to
Senior Planning Services	1	97	none captured	Indiana Medicare Beneficiaries: Many Hoosiers on Medicare are surprised to learn they may qualify for additional benefits beyond Original Me
Your Plan Matcher	14	93	none captured	👉 Benefit: Monthly Spending Allowance Those on Medicare check if you can get a Monthly Spending Allowance with a Medicare Advantage Plan. Ge
Simple Senior USA	1	92	none captured	New to Medicare? A reason to smile: Medicare Advantage Plans may offer routine dental care. The range of Dental benefits may vary by each Me
Jeff Rossen with Chapter	2	89	askchapter.org	Choosing the wrong Medicare plan can cost you thousands over time. The good news? It only takes 2 minutes to see if you qualify for better c
Medicare Agents Hub	4	87	none captured	Thousands of seniors are finding the Medicare Agent Directory every day when they do a search for medicare agents in their home town, or the

65Harmony	6	81	none captured	🍎🍌 Could You Be Missing Out on Extra Money for Groceries From A Medicare Plan? 🛒🇺🇸 better fits yMany Medicare beneficiaries may qualify for p
CareHarmony	1	78	none captured	If you have diabetes, heart disease, or kidney disease, Medicare may already cover dedicated care coordination — at no additional cost to yo
65 Quiz	17	76	rmoskwa.65quiz.com	The Medicare mail never stops. Every insurance company sounds the same, everyone gives different advice. Supplement? Advantage? Who's actual
The Senior Giveback Program	4	73	senior-budget-book.com	Medicare-licensed benefit specialists have launched a no-cost 60-second qualification checker to help beneficiaries access the monthly spend
Health Quote	1	70	us.seniordiscountate.com	What if your Medicare Supplement is costing you \$1,000–\$2,000 a year more than it should? If you're on Plan F, G, or N and your premium keep
Exclusive Insurance Plans	4	69	none captured	New to Original Medicare, Aging into Original Medicare, Lost your Health Insurance, On Medicare Parts A and B but have recently moved, or ha

The carriers' own ads · 290 ads · 46 advertisers

Advertiser	Ads	Longest (days)	Destination	Opening line
Dan Boscardin - HealthMarkets Insurance Agency	1	800	none captured	Did you know... Anyone turning 65 in the next 6 months can get Medicare Supplement (Medigap) Insurance from over 20 insurance companies with
Health First Health Plans	12	259	none captured	Save money with our \$0 plans, copays, and deductibles. Medicare Advantage plans Our network includes five Brevard County hospitals. Learn Mo
HealthSpring	19	159	none captured	With a Medicare Supplement Plan, renewability is guaranteed.‡ Quality coverage & long-term confidence. 5000763 Learn More
CalOptima	7	151	www.caloptima.org	No-cost benefits plus a network of over 7,000 doctors in Orange County make OneCare the smart choice for your loved one. 0:00 / 1:00 WWW.CAL
CarePlus Health Plans	1	147	careplusforyou.com	Feel confident in your coverage with CarePlus Medicare Advantage plans, with extra benefits beyond Original Medicare that fit your life. CAR
CareSource	1	147	caresource.com	CareSource® MyCare Ohio (HMO D-SNP) gives you extra benefits, like \$287 per month to use for food*, utilities* and more*! CARESOURCE.COM/MYC
Aetna	11	136	aetna.com	Turning 65 and still working? Have your cake and eat it too, by finding an Aetna Medicare Advantage plan that works with your current covera
UnitedHealthcare Medicare Plans	40	128	uhc.com	Estamos para ayudarle a que planifique su inscripción en Medicare con tranquilidad. 0:00 / 0:07 UHC.COM/ES Guía inscripción Medicare Conozca
Commonwealth Care Alliance	8	120	commonwealthcarealliance.org	If you're 21-64 with both MassHealth and Medicare, choose CCA One Care (HMO D-SNP) for coverage that cares. COMMONWEALTHCAREALLIANCE.ORG/MA
HealthPartners	1	118	healthpartners.com	Bundle Medicare + Medical Assistance into one easy \$0 premium plan. You get valuable perks to help you live well as you age. The benefits me
Blue Shield of California	7	113	blueshieldca.com	You may qualify for extra benefits at no extra cost with a Blue Shield Medicare Medi-Cal plan. BLUESHIELDCA.COM/MEDIMEDI3 Check if you quali
Blue Cross Blue Shield of Arizona	4	100	none captured	Get dental, vision, hearing, a food flex card, and prescription drugs. Don't miss out.
Geisinger	7	95	geisinger.org	Need a new Medicare plan? See if you qualify to switch now. GEISINGER.ORG See if you qualify to switch. Learn More GEISINGER.ORG Medicare Ad
Devoted Health	35	95	hello.devoted.com	"I love you guys at Devoted...It's a AAA++++". What does a Medicare Advantage plan look like that actually works? It has real value, like be

Healthfirst	10	91	healthfirst.org	Got Medicare & Medicaid? Our Medicare Advantage plans give you up to \$175/month OTC to spend, including at local pharmacies. Medicare Advant
Univera Healthcare	3	63	medicare.univerahealthcare.com	Get the most out of your Univera Healthcare Medicare plan by using your benefits. Learn more about: ✓ Scheduling Annual Care Visits ✓ Your D
UnitedHealthcare	6	58	uhcsouthfloridapcp.com	Bryan's committed to making healthcare easier for members to understand. 0:00 / 0:30 Committed to Care Explore health insurance options incl
Farm Bureau Health Plans	2	56	none captured	Don't let a network choose for you. Get provider flexibility with Medicare Supplement plans from Farm Bureau Health Plans. Choose the Doctor
AARP	8	55	aarp.org	From flu shots to mammograms, discover what's covered by Medicare at no cost to you. AARP.ORG/MEDICARE/ Medicare no-cost benefits Medicare o
UPMC for Life	1	53	none captured	Get more from your Medicare plan. Explore the ways we can help you save! 0:00 / 0:30 Medicare Plans for Veterans Shop Now
Blue Cross and Blue Shield of Minnesota	8	51	bluecrossmn.com	Get one card and one plan for a \$0 premium when you choose a Blue Cross health plan that combines your Medical Assistance (Medicaid) and Med
Premera Blue Cross	4	40	none captured	Get the most out of Medicare with a Premera Medicare Supplement plan—and say goodbye to unpredictable out-of-pocket costs. 0:00 / 0:15 Plans
Sentara Health Plans	16	35	sentaramedicare.com	Sentara Community Complete (HMO D-SNP) combines Medicare and Medicaid benefits into one plan for better coverage. Eligible members receive a
Health Plans Now	12	33	none captured	Claim this now 📌 0:00 / 0:39
Trusted Health Plans	1	32	none captured	What if your Medicare Supplement is costing you \$1,000–\$2,000 a year more than it should? If you're on Plan F, G, or N and your premium keep
MVP Health Care	1	20	mvphealthcare.com	On Medicaid? You might be eligible for additional Medicare benefits with an MVP DualAccess plan—at no extra cost. MVPHEALTHCARE.COM See if y
Mass General Brigham Health Plan	4	19	blog.massgeneralbrighamhealthplan.org	Medicare Advantage plans can change each year. Use our Annual Enrollment Period (AEP) checklist to review key details before you choose. Get
Mutual of Omaha	2	19	mutualofomaha.com	If you're shopping for a Medicare supplement plan, turn to a company you know and start saving. MUTUALOFOMAHA.COM Start Saving Now If you're
Blue Cross and Blue Shield of Kansas	1	16	none captured	A Medicare Supplement insurance plan helps reduce your out-of-pocket health care costs by giving you added coverage for hospital and medical
Blue Cross Blue Shield of Michigan	1	11	none captured	Get your FREE guide now! The Medicare Annual Enrollment Period is Oct. 15-Dec. 7. Annual Enrollment Period Blue Cross is Ready To Help Learn
Jefferson Health Plans	3	10	www.jeffersonhealthplans.com	Mike Quick counts on the right support to keep going strong. This Annual Enrollment, find a Medicare Advantage plan that supports you. WWW.J
Mount Carmel MediGold	4	7	none captured	Enroll in a mission-driven Medicare Advantage plan with a \$0 premium & a Part B giveback to help your budget go further. Download A Free Gui
Trinity Health Plan of Michigan	2	7	none captured	Enroll in a mission-driven Medicare Advantage plan with a \$0 premium & a Part B giveback to help your budget go further. Download A Free Gui
Trinity Health Plan New York	1	7	none captured	Enroll in a mission-driven Medicare Advantage plan with a \$0 premium & a Part B giveback to help your budget go further. Download A Free Gui
MercyOne Health Plan	1	7	none captured	Enroll in a mission-driven Medicare Advantage plan with a \$0 premium & a Part B giveback to help your budget go further. Download A Free Gui

Humana	5	6	none captured	Compare Medicare Advantage plans to find the one with the benefits that are right for your needs. 2027 Medicare Advantage plan Easily compar
Health First	1	6	hf.org	More money for your monthly budget starts with the right Medicare plan. Find out what Health First Health Plans offers. HF.ORG/VOLUSIAMA A P
PrimeTime Health Plan	1	6	pthp.com	PrimeTime Health Plan is Medicare made easy — easy to choose AND easy to use. > Highest customer service rating for more than 10 straight ye
Highmark Wholecare	18	6	none captured	Our flex card gives you up to \$300 a month to pay for groceries, utilities, gas, over-the-counter items, and more. See if you qualify Extra
ATRIO Health Plans	1	6	goatrio.com	An ATRIO Medicare Advantage plan covers all that Medicare does and comes with so many pluses. For a \$0 monthly premium you'll have a \$0 medi

Named local agencies and brokers · 267 ads · 144 advertisers

Advertiser	Ads	Longest (days)	Destination	Opening line
The Harrison Agency LLC	1	1169	none captured	Don't let the stress of having to choose the right Medicare plans for you get in the way of your peace. We're here to help. Contact us today
Stuart Slattery BGA Insurance Group	1	1105	stuartslattery.com	Medicare Open Enrollment Is Approaching! STUARTSLATTERY.COM You Qualify For A Free Medicare Consultation! Are you or anyone you know retirin
Dwight Mitchell Insurance Agency	1	917	mymaildeals.com	Turning 65? We understand that choosing the right Medicare plan is important. We're local and will help you navigate through all the options
Stacey Portugal	2	800	none captured	Did you know... Anyone turning 65 in the next 6 months can get Medicare Supplement (Medigap) Insurance from over 20 insurance companies with
Stephanie Pogue - Confusion to Clarity	2	764	none captured	Need Help Navigating Medicare? We've Got You Covered! Turning 64+ and feeling overwhelmed by Medicare options? Don't worry! We have the solu
Your Local Medicare Help	4	616	none captured	!! Top-Rated Local Medicare Help Near You!! At Your Local Medicare Help, we've assisted thousands of people just like you with navigating Med
Expert Insurance Team	1	581	none captured	🎉 It's time to celebrate turning 65, but also to make smart decisions about Medicare! 🧐 I'm Jacqueline from Expert Insurance Team, and I'll
Medicare Michelle	1	536	none captured	📅 Turning 65 in the Next Four Months? Time to Secure Your Medicare Supplement! 📅 Big milestone ahead! 🎉 If you're turning 65 in the next fou
Greg Crawford	5	448	crawfordhealthgroup.com	Every day, thousands of Americans accidentally overpay or miss out on benefits—just because they didn't fully understand how to start Medica
Bojan Medicare	1	414	none captured	4 MEDICARE PRAVILA - VAZNE INFORMACIJE 1. UPISITE SE U MEDICARE PROGRAM NA VRIJEME! ZA MEDICARE TREBA APLICIRATI KROZ SOCIAL SECURITY ADMINI
Senior Medicare Experts	1	406	none captured	📅 ILLINOIS RESIDENTS 📅 THOSE ON MEDICARE ARE ENTITLED TO A NO-COST MONTHLY FLEX CARD! Other Additional Benefits Include ✅ DENTAL ✅ VISION ✅ HEA
Trusted Advantage	1	378	newyorkmedicare101webinar.com	Hey, it's Jason your Medicare specialist in New York. I just left a client who was overwhelmed by all the confusing Medicare mail she'd been
Medicare Joe	20	348	medicarejoe.org	If you're turning 64, now's the time to get ahead of your Medicare plan. Most people don't realize that key enrollment windows happen before
Medicare Advisors of Alabama	1	334	medicareadvisorsofalabama.org	You left your job, took COBRA, and think you're covered for 18 months? Here's the truth: Medicare gives you only 8 months to enroll in Part
Financial Strategies, Inc.	1	307	fsiplan.com	Contact Your Local Medicare Insurance Pros! FSIPLAN.COM Independent Agents Financial Strategies At Mutual Savings, KS

AEGIS Elder Advisors	1	280	none captured	Learn about Medicare plan options and how coverage works. Speak with a licensed Medicare broker to compare available plans. CVS Pharmacy in
Hometown Medicare Advisors	10	238	none captured	🇺🇸 TEXAS RESIDENTS 🇺🇸 THOSE ON MEDICARE ARE ENTITLED TO A NO-COST MONTHLY FLEX CARD! Other Additional Benefits Include ✅ DENTAL ✅ VISION ✅ HEARIN
Medicare Guidance Center	4	223	myplancomparison.com	New to Medicare? Understanding your options doesn't have to be confusing. Download a free, easy-to-understand guide that explains the basics
Patti J Amato	1	220	www.planenroll.com	If Medicare has you thinking, "I have no idea what I'm doing..." you're not alone. I am here to help you cut through the noise, avoid confusio
The Bedrock Group	1	203	www.thebedrockgroupadvisors.com	For Licensed Medicare Agents Only HTTPS://WWW.THEBEDROCKGROUPADVISORS.COM/BROKERSERVICES Grow Your Book. Keep Your Freedom If you feel like
Medicare Saving Solutions	1	198	none captured	Turning 65 in May? Let us help you figure out your options without any pressure or deceiving sales tactics. Call 1-800-663-5707 to speak wit
Southern Nevada Medicare	1	190	none captured	NEVADA VETERANS! Did you know with VA health benefits & Medicare, you're eligible for a \$1620 Part B rebate? Plus, get extra perks: • Dental
Radiant Smiles	1	181	radiantsmilesnv.com	Las Vegas' Top Dentists 🦷 ✨ Join thousands of happy patients who trust us for expert care, modern treatments, and a comfortable experience ev
Ranean Seguros	1	175	api.whatsapp.com	Una emergencia médica en USA puede costar una fortuna si no tienes el respaldo correcto. 📞 🇺🇸 ¿Por qué elegir a Ranean Seguros? ✅ Independenci
Medicare Hero	1	174	medicarehero.com	Are you New to Medicare? Register to watch this live event right from your smartphone, tablet, or computer! (It's free!) Topics will Include
Travis Lane	1	173	none captured	Turning 65 soon? You've probably started hearing a lot about Medicare... and it can get confusing fast. I help people in Virginia understand e
Disc Disease Solutions	1	162	ddsmmed.com	Covered by MEDICARE and most Health Insurance Plans. The DDS 500 is the First Patented Spinal Decompression Belt and it can help relieve low
Brianna Henward - Medicare & Health Ins. Advisor	1	157	go.tindon.com	Health insurance should never keep you from going on that camping trip with your grandkids, setting sail on the cruise with your spouse or j
Medicare Signups	1	149	none captured	The cost of Medicare insurance varies depending on where you live. FB.ME Compare Local Plans Prescriptions, Hospital, etc. Learn more
Bell Black Insurance	1	149	none captured	Finding insurance coverage should feel simple. Bell Black Insurance offers options for auto, home, life, health, and Medicare plans with loc
Turney Insurance Advisors	2	142	coverage.turneyins.com	If you are turning 65 and you're stressed about making the wrong Medicare choice, you're in luck... From enrollment timelines to avoiding co
Futuro Seguro	1	141	none captured	Muchas personas tienen Medicare desde hace años... y todavía no entienden realmente cómo funciona su plan. He hablado con personas que: * esta
Medicare Advocates	2	138	none captured	Over 2,000 senior Americans have had a 5-star experience with Medicare Advocates. Why? Because we listen. We understand. And our only object
Turning 65 Medicare Done Right	1	131	none captured	🕒 Now is the time for you to fully understand the Medicare Plans & Options available to you. ✅ We work directly with you to help you select
USA Professional Benefits	1	127	none captured	🎉 La mayoría de las personas son elegibles para Medicare Parte A cuando cumplen 65 años 🎂 . Puedes inscribirte en la Parte A desde 3 meses an
Smart Design	2	125	smart-design.express-find.com	Wondering if Medicare will help pay for a power lift chair? Learn more about coverage below. SMART-DESIGN.EXPRESS-FIND.COM Medicare Power Li
Boomer Council	1	124	none captured	✅ 2026 Rates Just Released ✅ Keep your Doctor ✅ No Networks ✅ No Referrals ✅ A+ Rated Amazing 2026 Medicare supplement rates Brand New 2026
Kyle Kokot	1	123	themedicare65guide.com	Turning 65 in the next 12 months? Watch this webinar! THEMEDICARE65GUIDE.COM Turning 65 Soon? Don't Make These 5 Mistakes Free Educational W

MediGap Quotes	2	122	none captured	Secure Your Health Coverage with AARP Plan G for Just \$73/month. Apply Now! FB.ME Get Covered Today✅ Apply now
Medicare Supplements	5	120	www.mutualmedicarequote.com	👉 Save More with Plan N in 2026! New to Medicare or thinking about switching? Typically lower premiums than Plan G with nearly the same prot

Products sold to people because they are on Medicare (devices, supplies, services billed to the plan) · 47 ads · 15 advertisers

Advertiser	Ads	Longest (days)	Destination	Opening line
AdVance Joint Regeneration	3	400	freekneepainreliefseminar.com	🚑 Knee Replacement Surgery IS NOT The Only Option For Knee Pain Sufferers! ❤️ There is a NEW, Natural, and Safe Non-Surgical treatment protoc
Knee Pain Specialists of America	2	399	freekneepainreliefseminar.com	🚑 Knee Replacement Surgery IS NOT The Only Option For Knee Pain Sufferers! ❤️ There is a NEW, Natural, and Safe Non-Surgical treatment protoc
Lake Norman Healthcare	3	399	freekneepainreliefseminar.com	Lake Norman Healthcare is proud to offer patients in Statesville, NC and all surrounding communities a proven, non-surgical alternative to k
Non-Surgical Knee Pain Treatments USA	1	394	freekneepainreliefseminar.com	🚑 Knee Replacement Surgery IS NOT The Only Option For Knee Pain Sufferers! ❤️ There is a NEW Non-Surgical Osteoarthritis Protocol now availab
Pioneer Sports & Pain Center	1	362	freekneepainreliefseminar.com	Pioneer Sports & Pain Center is proud to offer patients in Kuna, ID and all surrounding communities proven, non-surgical alternatives to kne
Ennoble Care	11	219	none captured	🏠 Our doctors make house calls 💰 SAME PRICE as a traditional office visit 🏥 Medicare & most insurance plans accepted 📍 Available in Pennsylv
Careway	7	128	careway.health	9 out of 10 older adults want to age at home. Most end up in assisted living simply because they do not know what Medicare covers. A new Med
Conduit Health	1	118	none captured	Rollator walker — covered by Medicare Part B. ✓ \$0 out of pocket ✓ No doctor or insurance coordination needed ✓ Delivered to your door Condu
The Morning Brief	1	105	scooters.explorelistings.com	🦽 Wondering if Medicare actually helps pay for a mobility scooter? See what's covered and how it works. HTTPS://SCOOTERS.EXPLORELISTINGS.COM
EversenseCGM	6	87	none captured	Taking insulin? Switch to the Eversense 365 CGM for a year of reliable glucose data and peace of mind, covered by Medicare*. Disclaimers: *N
Turnout: America's Consumer Advocacy	1	64	turnout.co	A patient advocate can help manage appointments, coordinate care, and fight for the benefits you're owed. Medicare covers it. 0:00 / 0:37 TU
Pinnie Health	7	23	pinnie.com	Caring for an aging parent? Let a Pinnie advocate handle the Medicare calls, scheduling, and paperwork so you can focus on family. Covered b
Smart Lifestyle Trends	1	23	none captured	Safety experts recommend this Walk in Tub. Here is what a Walk In Tub should cost you. 0:00 / 0:55 Seniors On Medicare Are Eligible for a Wa
Knowledgeable Kiefer	1	15	trk.active-begin.com	For Medicare beneficiaries who struggle with limited mobility, a power scooter can be a life-changing piece of equipment - and Medicare may
Info Sight	1	10	info-2-you.com	There are only 6 Mobility Scooters Left. These are at no cost to you, covered by medicare. Tap the link now and grab yours before it's gone

Clinics, hospitals and care providers that take Medicare · 39 ads · 16 advertisers

Advertiser	Ads	Longest (days)	Destination	Opening line
Lake Norman Healthcare	1	693	none captured	Hey Statesville! 🤔👉 There is no need to suffer from the pain, stiffness, swelling, numbness, and tingling associated with neuropathy pain -
Wellness Concepts Clinic, LLC	1	202	none captured	🌿 Did You Know? 🌿 Most Medicare plans now cover acupuncture treatments — and you could be eligible! Acupuncture is a powerful, natural way t
Conduit Health	1	118	none captured	Don't pay out of pocket for a wheelchair. Medicare Part B typically covers them — Conduit confirms your benefits and ships directly to you.

Franklin Clinic Kerrville	1	118	none captured	Looking for a primary care provider in Kerrville? Franklin Clinic is now accepting new patients and provides personalized care for adults, i
Elite Family Medical Center	1	107	none captured	Have Medicare Part D or Medicare Advantage with drug coverage? You may qualify for the Medicare Bridge Weight Loss Program — real medical we
GEHA Health	1	53	none captured	Turning 65 means access to greater health benefits that pair with Medicare. Get the federal retirement benefits that you worked for with G.E
InnovAge	10	50	none captured	Primary care, dental, vision, hearing, specialty care, and more—all for seniors at \$0 cost with Medicare and Medi-Cal. At InnovAge's healthc
Johns Hopkins Advantage MD	1	37	none captured	Have Medicare and Medicaid? Come to a FREE educational seminar to learn about a special health plan with extra benefits. Sign up today. Spot
Physicians Mutual	3	24	none captured	Get the most out of your Medicare Supplement with Physicians Select Insurance Company. Compare our Competitive Rates Get Quote
Hopscotch Primary Care Spindale	1	20	none captured	A Rutherford County neighbor and local primary care provider for seniors on Medicare, she takes time to truly listen. 0:00 / 0:15 Meet Dr. K
Loma Linda University Health	1	13	openenrollment.lluh.org	There is still time to get guidance before the Medicare open-enrollment deadline. Join a free seminar and learn more. OPENENROLLMENT.LLUH.OR
RVNAhealth	1	8	rvnahealth.org	Confused about Medicare options for the upcoming year? You're not alone! 💡 Join us at RVNAhealth for Making Sense of Medicare, a practical,
Hopscotch Primary Care Weaverville	2	8	hellohopscotch.com	Specialists, medications, transitions of care. For Weaverville seniors on Medicare, we coordinate it all and ease the load. HELLOHOPSCOTCH.C
Salma Health	1	7	none captured	Salma Health accepts Medicare for SAINT® (5-day, accelerated TMS) and traditional TMS. Both evidence-backed, FDA-cleared treatments use magn
Peak Health	11	7	none captured	Get a \$390 Flexible Spending Card and more ways to save with this \$0 premium, doctor-built Medicare Advantage plan. Get Your Free Guide To B
Kentucky Hospital Association	2	6	www.kyha.com	 Medicare Open Enrollment is October 15 through December 7. Before selecting a plan, be sure it covers the doctors and care you need. Talk

Government and public agencies (Medicare.gov, Area Agencies on Aging, counseling programs) · 6 ads · 2 advertisers

Advertiser	Ads	Longest (days)	Destination	Opening line
Medicare	4	53	none captured	If you are turning 65 soon and still working, find out when you need to sign up for Medicare at Medicare.gov. 0:00 / 0:08 WWW.MEDICARE.GOV K
Upper Savannah Area Agency on Aging & Disability Resource Center - ADRC	2	43	uppersavannah.com	Medicare Open Enrollment runs October 15 through December 7. Now is the time to review your coverage and understand your options before enro

Advertiser type unclear · 121 ads · 68 advertisers

Advertiser	Ads	Longest (days)	Destination	Opening line
Iyan McGregor, P.A.	2	971	none captured	MUTUAL OF OMAHA IS SERVING UP LOWER RATES FOR MEDICARE SUPPLEMENT PLANS! 🟡 FB.ME CLICK NOW TO QUALIFY AND PAY LESS! Get quote
100Insure	1	494	usamedicareimplified.com	Here's how we help Medicare beneficiaries with new chronic diagnoses access specialized coverage without waiting. A new diagnosis may qualif
Highway 65	2	440	none captured	Turning 65 in less than a year? Everyone turning 65 needs to know! The 3 biggest mistakes a person can make with Medicare are: 1. Enrollment
Fort Worth Gentle Dental-Family Emergency Implants	1	367	gentledentalfortworth.com	Now proudly accepting MEDICARE plans with dental coverage such as United Health Care, Humana, Liberty, Envolve, Wellcare & more. MEDICARE AD
Cypress Health & Life	2	328	none captured	💙 If you're turning 65 this year (or worked beyond that and ready for Medicare coverage) → This (free) Medicare Insurance guide is for YOU! P
Find-Answers	5	194	answers.express-find.com	Could Medicare help you keep your home clean? Find out when house cleaning services may be covered under certain plans. ANSWERS.EXPRESS-FIND

65Harmony	2	136	none captured	Medicare Beneficiaries in Alabama may qualify for extra support 0:00 / 1:00 FB.ME \$202.90 Medicare Part B Reimbursement Get help paying for
GeneSight	1	134	none captured	Tired of the endless trial-and-error with depression medications? Your DNA may help inform medication selection. We understand the frustrati
Holistic San Diego	3	118	none captured	Hello San Diego. Do you have neck pain, back pain, sciatica, hip pain, shoulder pain, bad posture, or headaches. Holistic San Diego is doing
Priority Family Care Center APC	1	117	losangeles.reliefdiscovery.com	Are you dealing with a wound that just won't heal? Accepting Medicare Part B (Red, White, and Blue Card) Plans & Private Pay Insurance Whe
Integrity Health & Wealth	2	114	none captured	Get your FREE Medicare Roadmap! Turning 65? Ger your FREE Medicare RoadMap and avoid potential penalties for enrolling into Medicare at the
Cardinals Broker Services LLC	1	107	cardinalsbrokerservices.com	Needing answers about Retirement, medicare or Life insurance medicare broker 0:00 / 0:27 CARDINALSBROKERSERVICES.COM Cardinals Broker Servic
Dr. Glenn J. Waldt, DO; Back and Neck Medical Care Center, LLC	1	104	none captured	Las Cruces - if back or neck pain has been sticking around longer than it should, Dr. Glenn Waldt is accepting new patients. New Patient Spe
Seniors that Smile	1	91	myseniorsmile.com	Seniors over 64: Seniors can get dentures with a Zero Cost (\$0) Dental plan today. If you are over 64, check if you qualify. Click here n
The HealthWell Foundation	2	82	www.healthwellfoundation.org	Have health insurance but struggling to pay for CLL medications and treatments? HealthWell may be able to help. WWW.HEALTHWELLFOUNDATION.ORG
CVS Pharmacy	1	79	cvs.com	Medicare Part B now covers hepatitis B vaccination. Ask your doctor or pharmacist today. CVS.COM Help Protect Against Hepatitis B Learn More
AGA	1	72	none captured	Agentes bilingües: ¡Crece más rápido con clientes exclusivos y marketing pagado ! No te pierdas estas herramientas esenciales que ayudan a
Forum Deck Trends	1	71	forumdeck.com	Search for Captioned Phone For Seniors On Medicare. FORUMDECK.COM Captioned Phone For Seniors On Medicare ! See Results Learn more
Live Well & Thrive	1	70	none captured	What if your Medicare Supplement is costing you \$1,000–\$2,000 a year more than it should? If you're on Plan F, G, or N and your premium keep
ICCU	1	65	none captured	Discover life insurance and Medicare plans designed for your peace of mind. ICCU Insurance Services Learn More
SmartSeniorLife Today	1	65	web.smartseniorlife.co	Find results for Medicare Open Enrollment 2026. WEB.SMARTSENIORLIFE.CO Medicare Open Enrollment 2026 Know More Learn more
Flex Super App	1	57	none captured	The Flex card gives your business 60 days to pay on every purchase. FLEX.ONE Business Credit Card The only net60 credit card with 0% interes
Entry Notes Alpha	1	53	entrynotes.com	Additional Search Topics for Captioned Phone For Seniors On Medicare. ENTRYNOTES.COM Captioned Phone For Seniors On Medicare See Resul
Senior Veteran Assistance Program	1	45	none captured	VETERANS – TIME-SENSITIVE BENEFIT! If you receive all your prescriptions from the VA or have Tricare for life, you could get up to \$1,
SummaCare	1	43	none captured	Looking for coverage before Medicare kicks in? Our Individual & Family health insurance plans offer an affordable way to stay protected duri
SeniorSimple	1	39	none captured	Checking every Medicare client, every plan, every year sounds impossible. Until now. PolicyPilot automatically shops your book and shows you

SmartChoiceFinds Guide	1	39	related.answerseeker.net	Find results for Medicare Open Enrollment. 📌 RELATED.ANSWERSEEKER.NET Medicare Open Enrollment! 📌 📅 17 📌 Know More Learn more
Healthcare Made Easy	4	38	none captured	📌 North Carolina Seniors 📌 On Medicaid or Medicare? Enrollees are eligible for a free food card each month. Other Additional Benefits Include:
Expert Insights	3	38	clickorbit.net	Huge Grocery Benefit for US seniors 0:00 / 0:20 CLICKORBIT.NET US Seniors Can a \$3600 Grocery Allowance Card Click here to know more Learn m
PlanSmarter with Anthony	2	37	none captured	If you just received your Medicare card, the clock is already ticking. The plan decisions you make in the next 60 days affect your doctors,
Wellness Wisdom 3	3	35	none captured	Seniors on Medicare may be able to check meal delivery options that bring convenient meals right to their door. 0:00 / 0:12
AuroraAcademia: Million Dreams of Learning	1	30	checkbeforesearch.com	Medicare offers numerous preventive services and benefits designed to help seniors maintain their health and catch potential problems early.
Ranked 1st	1	29	none captured	Medicare extra benefits can include dental, vision, hearing and more. Explore common categories and key coverage details in this guide.
TGH Senior Center powered by Greenbrook Medical	1	28	meet.tghseniorcenter.com	Looking for a PCP you can trust? Dr. Gulati specializes in senior primary care and is accepting new patients in Riverview MEET.TGHSENIORCENT
JPDM	1	27	none captured	Role: Marketing Content & Design Specialist (Mid-Level, AI-Driven) Type: Full-time, Remote (LATAM, US Pacific Time Hours) Mission: Build and
BuyersQuest Hub	1	26	related.readerslogic.net	Popular Searches for Dentures For Seniors On Medicare How It Works. 📌 RELATED.READERSLOGIC.NET Dentures For Seniors On Medicare How It Works
Retirement Health.Care	1	25	none captured	Want money back in your Social Security check every month? You could reduce your monthly Part B premium with a Devoted Health plan. We can w
PolicyEngineer	1	24	none captured	Getting flooded with Medicare calls and stacks of mail? You're not alone, and it's confusing for almost everyone. We created a simple, step-
Ask AI Guides	1	21	askaiguides.etsy.com	The thick envelope from your plan shows up every fall, and most people never open it. This year, paste it into ChatGPT and get a plain table
David Michael Johnson	14	19	none captured	Today, seniors over 65+ can get upto \$3,200 added in their Grocery Allowance Card! 0:00 / 1:00

Dislikes

Complaint	Documents	1-2★ reviews
Denied care, prior authorization, rehab cut short	399	64
Stuck: can't switch back to a Medigap	213	1
Premium increases	189	2
Doctors and hospitals that drop the plan	37	2
Calls, mail and ads that won't stop	12	22
Agents who pushed Advantage or misled	20	6
'Free' benefits that turn out not to be	0	0

Denied care, prior authorization, rehab cut short

"Physical Therapist here. Absolutely keep your traditional Medicare with Plan N/G while you can. Medicare with a plan G is a Golden plan. Dr.'s and hospital love traditional Medicare. They won't be denied and you won't be denied care. Plus you can choose any specialist/provider you want and also go to the top notch hospitals in the whole country including Mayo, Johns Hopkins, Cleveland Clinic etc, etc, etc. In the end if you get really sick it's well worth it. I pay around \$450 a month including Part A and B premium. I worked all my life in healthcare to afford to access the best healthcare in our country."

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 595 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgxcFFuqvyczX0JtB0J4AaABAg>

"Sunburn. My mother chose an advantage plan. She found they can deny anything they want to deny for any of no reason. They "delayed" her dental coverage until she was to frail to have the dental work done. She had colon cancer that could be treated with laparoscopic surgery my sister had to fight the insurance company to provide after care. They denied colon cancer screening after that because "she would likely die of something else first". She got another tumor that couldn't be treated with laparoscopic surgery. After the surgery the "hospitalist" repeated 8 or 9 times that because she was over 80 going forward she would only receive "palliative" care for such a major event. My brother was wisely recording the conversation and told the "hospitalist" if he mentioned "palliative" care one more time he would sue him for elder abuse. During her after care she had sores in her mouth and could barely eat. The only thing insurance would allow was a test for thrush, which came up negative so no further action. Her surgery wound wasn't healing for lack of her eating enough protein due to the sores in her mouth. She quickly ended up in hospice and I flew down and became aware of the whole situation. I asked the hospice nurse if there was a medicated mouthwash that might solve the problem and could she get me a script for it. She said yes and I went out and bought it. In one day she was eating normally. Her wound started to heal and her 30 days after care was up, insurance wouldn't pay for more even with her still unhealed surgical wound. We kids chipped in and paid. She lived on for several years. My point is with advantage care you give up all your rights under part A and B and put them in the hands of the insurance company. That is the biggest risk of all. Your experience could be great or deadly, and there's no way of knowing beforehand."

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 333 likes · family member helping · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=UgyrQ0RNoaOb4etaX-54AaABAg>

"Almost fell into that trap until I was warned by a person who's family member eventually died because of care that was denied to them because Medicare Advantage declined to pay for treatment because it was too expensive despite the recommendation of a specialist. While in the appeals process, the family member passed away. After doing some research on my own, I found that this had occurred multiple times with people on Medicare Advantage. Also, that many healthcare providers were now refusing to accept Medicare Advantage. Needless to say, I chose traditional Medicare. The gap premiums aren't cheap, but I have the "peace of mind" of knowing that I can receive the care/treatment recommended by my doctor. This shouldn't be happening to seniors who PAID into Medicare their entire working lives."

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 270 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=UgwTr1OgGdvCFu3U5Fp4AaABAg>

Stuck: can't switch back to a Medigap

"I started on Medicare with a supplement plan G in 2018. I switched insurers three times due to never ending and very high-rate increases. Each time I switched I had to do medical underwriting. In 2024 my AARP United G plan went way up, and I switched to plan N and saved myself \$99 alone in monthly premiums. If I had to go back, I would have just opted for plan N from the start."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 119 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1SFCZkg&lc=UgxHdldWf7qxfUU5hD94AaABAg>

"my best friend who is older than me was sold an advantage plan when she retired and didn't even know it. She thought she had "Medicare" After educating herself she was denied supplemental due to a medical condition. However, her advantage plan got canceled and she became eligible for no underwriting supplemental, she is happily on a medigap plan now."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 65 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=Ugw5dC0g1BZMxjki_R54AaABAg

"Thank you. One of the most professional and knowledgeable presentations that I have heard about the pros and cons of Advantage Plans vs. Supplement Plans. Medical underwriting was explained to me using an airport analogy: I've gotten off the plane and I'm free to walk around the airport, go to the news stand, get a cup of coffee, etc. When I leave that secure area (like leaving my original, one-time-only enrollment period), I walk through doors with signs that say "exit only, no returning through these doors". If I want to go back into the airport, I have to go through security (i.e. underwriting) again. It's a time-consuming hassle for folks who take that route. And there's no guarantee that a person will get through medical underwriting successfully."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 59 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgxclzjxWRhhykzbdwp4AaABAg

Premium increases

"I started on Medicare with a supplement plan G in 2018. I switched insurers three times due to never ending and very high-rate increases. Each time I switched I had to do medical underwriting. In 2024 my AARP United G plan went way up, and I switched to plan N and saved myself \$99 alone in monthly premiums. If I had to go back, I would have just opted for plan N from the start."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 119 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgxHdlDwf7qxfUU5hD94AaABAg

"I just received the 2027 "MEDICARE & YOU" booklet in the mail. And of course I already know that I am not touching my AARP GAP plan, so I go straight to the back of the book to see the PART D plans for NJ. And DARN if the BCBSNJ monthly premium didn't go and DOUBLE in price for the 2nd year in a row!!! Last year it went from \$22 to \$78. and for 2027 it goes to \$130. HOW???? So unfair. Are there cheaper plans, yes. Wellcare has a monthly plan as low as \$5.30. but wellcare only covered 2 of my 7 mRX's last year. BCBS was the only one that covered all 7."

— YouTube · Why Medicare Will Cost DOUBLE for Over 3 Million People 🤔 · 74 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=sCdAfk-zQFU&lc=Ugyq-43B-8M-fR9msVh4AaABAg>

"I work with Medicare plans, C, D and medigap. Advantage plans are very similar to employer coverage, but the population is much more vulnerable. Medigap plan premiums increase every year, some people pay \$800 a month for them. Plus you pay \$200 a month just to have part B. Also Medicare penalizes you if you go without drug coverage, which some people do if they don't take prescriptions. None of these plans in general are the problem, greed is. The government needs to regulate what these companies do if they have a contract with CMS. It doesn't matter what the options are if both the government and private sector use it to squeeze every last penny out of people. The government needs to do its job and serve the people. I look forward to the day I have to go back to being a CNA because healthcare is treated as a right, not a privilege. Until then, I will continue to try my best helping people navigate through a broken system."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · 68 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yfLVCc&lc=Ugxmqe1MtXC6NQ_2EUN4AaABAg

Doctors and hospitals that drop the plan

"You are definitely speaking the truth. I used to have Humana advantage program all of my doctors and all of my hospitals where I lived sent me letters telling they no longer accepted it. That was actually a blessing in disguise because I went ahead and went with original Medicare and then I got AARP United Healthcare is my supplement to my medicare. Everything is been covered 100% I haven't had to pay anything except the course the deductible at the beginning of the year which continually goes up higher and higher. My social security check what little bit you do get doesn't even cover how much it goes up. The price of the United Healthcare continues to go higher every year also. So yeah America is really screwing people big time but what do you expect for 40 trillion dollars in debt and nobody even gives a crap anymore"

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 210 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9Id0w9OA&lc=UgycBY5V27_Utvq5bk4AaABAg

"Another negative for Advantage plans is that hospitals in my area are refusing to accept certain Advantage plans. So if you have a doctor you like and he works out of a certain hospital you could find yourself looking for another doctor and hospital. I was on an Advantage plan but was able to get on Plan G because the hospital I use stopped accepting the Advantage plan I was on. I didn't have to get approved or pass any medical tests to go on Plan G since it wasn't my fault that my Advantage plan was no longer valid. Best thing that could have happened to me."

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 32 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=Ugx4MOWZuO_w_2-SLoV4AaABAg

"The only hospital within 100 miles of me has stopped accepting Humana advantage plans as in-network due to claim denials and long waits for pre-approvals. Switching to plan N while I can pass underwriting."

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 31 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgxNqF0wOHim1a8HT3J4AaABAg>

Calls, mail and ads that won't stop

"Sunburn. Thank you. During my working years I had a Co pay for my HMO high deductible insurance. When I retired I learned about plan G and found it less than what I paying at work. Since my retirement my wife had open heart surgery and knee replace to and a broken arm. I have prostate cancer and ulcerative colitis. If I would have had an advantage plan it would have financial devastated us. When I bought plan G I bought it not for how I felt at the time, but for when I was sick. Advantage plans come in my mail every day trying to switch me over. Never get mail for plan G. That should tell you something in itself."

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 249 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=UgyPSeGJnpazbrQ0VB94AaABAg>

"I won't ever enroll in a Medicare Advantage plan just for those annoying commercials they bombard us with every year"

— YouTube · Why Medicare Advantage Plans are Bad (or Are They?) · 27 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SM3ypOamgls&lc=UgwdnumgTKxINNtbPp14AaABAg>

"When i watch these kind of videos and the first piece of advice is the do not call registry I'm immediately done. These offshore call centers dont give a damn about dnc. Im not even old enough to qualify for medicare and i get more than a hundred calls a day every day."

— YouTube · How to STOP "Medicare" Phone Calls, Texts, Emails, and Letters · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cQh6ldSh6uc&lc=UgxXRlr7F4TKXAwqurB4AaABAg>

Agents who pushed Advantage or misled

"My agent pushed an Advantage plan from the start, but I wanted to stick with original Medicare with a Supplemental policy. A couple of years ago, I relented and said okay, go ahead and put my wife and I on an Advantage plan since he said 95% of his clients were on the plan. It must be good, right? Having 43 years in the property & casualty insurance business before retiring, I actually read the 200+ pages of the contract. I immediately called my agent and told him to rescind the Advantage plan and get me back on what I had. I later learned that after 7 years he no longer gets a commission from Medicare but would have continued indefinitely to receive commissions from the Advantage plan. My 7 years was up last year, and guess what, I haven't heard from him since. I would recommend that everyone stay with original Medicare, unless there is some compelling reason not to do so."

— YouTube · MASSIVE: Hospitals Are DROPPING Medicare Advantage Plans 🤯 · 81 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vn2k1W-JzB8&lc=UgzHCpaN2Z99tywzREh4AaABAg>

"One of the better explanations of the difference. I noticed several agents here push Plan G very heavily. My wife and I see a doctor twice a year, so co-pays don't bother us. We would have to have three doctor appointments a month to make up the difference in plan prices. Good job."

— YouTube · Medicare Plan G vs Plan N (New Info!) · 19 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SP2JABN8RL8&lc=UgwpXUF5t2zyH94bLlx4AaABAg>

"IMO - I feel that insurance Medicare agents/brokers who push this scam on clients should be investigated. It's my understanding that the agents are compensated for at a higher rate for enrolling seniors on the Advantage Plan. At the very least customers who enrolled in the Advantage option should be allowed to change back to the traditional one at no penalty to them."

— YouTube · HUGE Medicare Supplement Rate Increases (and what to do about them) · 4 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ah1bzQtPBRQ&lc=UgzcyY71Bi2WAeUiyGt4AaABAg.A7yD_2SFDkoA8AiNVaa-oS

Reviews by Star

GoHealth

- **Read** TrustPilot 4.8 on 42,896 reviews: the five-star column names a rep right after a call (a review-prompt funnel, per D1i). The one-star column is what shoppers dislike about the category: mail and calls that never stop (including to a widower about his late wife), grocery allowance / food cards that never came, being signed into something they already had.
- **What should change** Stop contacting people who asked to stop; describe benefits exactly as the plan pays them.

SelectQuote

- **Read** TrustPilot 4.5: five-star reviews are rep-and-price; one- to three-star are pushiness, daily emails, being transferred around, slow processing.
- **What should change** One contact person; no daily follow-ups after the sale.

eHealth Insurance

- **Read** TrustPilot 3.5: doctors that turned out not to be in network, hours on hold, hard to cancel; five-star reviews name the agent.
- **What should change** Doctor and drug check confirmed before enrollment; reachable after the sale.

HealthMarkets

- **Read** TrustPilot 3.6: agents who did not follow up; one-star also includes 1099 agents burned by the company (agent-side voice, noted).
- **What should change** Follow-up promised is follow-up delivered.

Humana

- **Read** TrustPilot 1.4: denials with no reason on the site, customer service attitude, vision benefit paying nothing; four- and five-star reviews are members who rarely use care or a single helpful rep.
- **What should change** Say why a claim was denied; make the extra benefits pay as advertised.

UnitedHealthcare

- **Read** TrustPilot 1.2: limited networks, pre-approvals, a copay promised in October that appeared in January ('bait and hook').
- **What should change** The October promise must match the January card.

Devoted Health

- **Read** TrustPilot 2.9: slow reimbursements, food card not working, an agent who sold the giveback, being passed around to find a doctor.
- **What should change** Benefits that work on day one; one navigator for finding a doctor.

Boomer Benefits

- **Read** TrustPilot 4.8 (independent broker): five-star names a caring rep; one-star includes a supplement signed without authority and bad Part D advice; two-star 'too big, too fast'.
- **What should change** Written consent before enrollment; stay reachable as the book grows.

Why They Buy (Ad Brief)

The five answers an ad needs, built only from what this page already proves. Every line carries its count and a verbatim example with a link; the "docs" column is distinct documents in this page's voice. Lines are reads of the evidence; hooks, features and "demonstrate it" clauses are hypotheses to test.

Built from the measured themes, the complaints ledger, the silent layer and the competitor ads on this page. Vince has not yet reviewed this page's strategy layer; when he does, his lines replace or re-order these and each is checked against the corpus the same way.

1. Why they buy — the main reasons

The event and the wish behind the purchase, in their words.

Line	Docs	Verbatim example	Where it is counted
They are turning 65 or coming off an employer or retiree plan	217	"Being able to enroll in traditional Medicare (A,B,D,G) and to start collecting Social Security allowed me to walk away at age 65 from my shitty employer and company health insurance to change focus from an unfulfilling career to pickup the creative arts I had to put on a back burner to make a living has been truly liberating."YouTube · Reasons to DELAY Medicare Past 65 That Will Save You Thousands and Avoid ALL Penalties (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=L2goGwp4Co8&lc=UgxxhLZ_kuIWs3Z9_7ZN4AaABAg) · 155 likes	(x.getAttribute('onclick')//").includes("solutions")); if(b) b.click(); return false;">Tab 6 · Stayed on an employer, union or retiree plan past 65
They want any doctor and any hospital with nobody's approval	27	"I can go to any doctor I want anywhere in the United States and I don't need any referrals."YouTube · The REAL Cost of Medicare Supplement vs Advantage over 20 Years? / G vs N vs HD G vs Advan (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Yf_LRIoXmSo&lc=UgxaLqpmxKqFNnoH0R4AaABAg_A1wcNx6624wA2OL5RyPEkl) · 5 likes	(x.getAttribute('onclick')//").includes("hopes")); if(b) b.click(); return false;">Tab 2 · Any doctor, any hospital, no approvals
They are afraid of a big illness and the bills that follow	65	"If you get really sick, you'll be screwed right when you are the most stressed and life is totally hard."YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement easy cost comparison. (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Cz7BrmU1Guk&lc=UgxCO_MGgWlmaBd-jTw54AaABAg_AlsB0dvabP3AOaceZUTLDT) · 7 likes	(x.getAttribute('onclick')//").includes("fears")); if(b) b.click(); return false;">Tab 1 · A big illness and the bills that follow
They want to stop worrying: a known cost, no surprise bills	190	"After my initial \$300 deductible, I can see any doctor and never have to worry about paying a bill."YouTube · Do I need a Medicare Supplement Plan? (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=O-WxyTurD3c&lc=Ugy8-mL2CmVrjVCpPzl4AaABAg) · 72 likes	(x.getAttribute('onclick')//").includes("outcomes")); if(b) b.click(); return false;">Tab 8 · Peace of mind: nothing to worry about
They need a lower monthly cost on a fixed income	43	"Well just got the dreaded letter from the state of California regarding my Medicaid.they are reinstating the asset test again,so on Jan 1 I will lose it,I can't afford the medigap plan and the part b premium,so most like me will be forced into a advantage plan,issue is here ,is only five choices for advantage plans and plan g and n are about 200.00.i like in a rich zipcode of course!🙄.this is going to be ugly."YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and	(x.getAttribute('onclick')//").includes("fears")); if(b) b.click(); return false;">Tab 1 · Not being able to afford it on a fixed income

		Advantage (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgxLdnN0qZxAz-3XtwV4AaABAg) · 7 likes	
Their plan, doctor or hospital is leaving	45	"I used to have Humana advantage program all of my doctors and all of my hospitals where I lived sent me letters telling they no longer accepted it."YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=UgycBY5V27_Utvq5bkd4AaABAg) · 210 likes	(x.getAttribute('onclick')/").includes("frustrations")); if(b) b.click(); return false;">Tab 5 · Doctors and hospitals dropping Advantage plans
Someone they know was denied, billed or stuck	133	"I have friends on "Advantage" plans that have had to deal with needing numerous referrals, waiting months for testing and surgeries, while I breeze through seeing specialist and getting surgeries within a few weeks."YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCKg&lc=Ugx5CVy8MAO_bxfGmzd4AaABAg) · 224 likes	(x.getAttribute('onclick')/").includes("relfears")); if(b) b.click(); return false;">Tab 3 · Friends, siblings and neighbors as the warning (or the proof)
A parent's or a spouse's experience	112	"My parents for the most part in retirement have had medigap, however they had to switch over to Medicare advantage because the premiums were crushing them, across both mom and dad they were paying approximately \$8000 a year in premiums which they could not afford."YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZjptHP78wg&lc=Ugx57fRPG79VO_jgyRd4AaABAg) · 2 likes	(x.getAttribute('onclick')/").includes("relfears")); if(b) b.click(); return false;">Tab 3 · A parent's Medicare: Advantage, denials, rehab and bills

2. Recurring problems and frustrations

The complaint themes, each measured with a complaint-specific pattern and read for precision.

Line	Docs	Verbatim example	Where it is counted
Prior authorization, denials and insurers overruling the doctor	481	"I believe if we had an MA plan we would still be waiting on prior authorization if she survived long enough."YouTube · MASSIVE: Hospitals Are DROPPING Medicare Advantage Plans 🤔 (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vn2k1W-JzB8&lc=UgzevbXaSu0WX4WCW814AaABAg) · 212 likes	(x.getAttribute('onclick')/").includes("frustrations")); if(b) b.click(); return false;">Tab 5 · Prior authorization and insurers second-guessing doctors
It is too confusing to compare	456	"Turning 65 next year and Medicare enrollment is way more confusing than I expected"r/medicare (https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1wksnot/) · 62 upvotes	(x.getAttribute('onclick')/").includes("frustrations")); if(b) b.click(); return false;">Tab 5 · Too confusing to compare
Supplement and Part B premiums keep going up	162	"My premium increases the past 3 years were 14%."YouTube · Can We Talk Openly About Medicare Supplement Plan N? (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Csmi1YgxGrY&lc=UgzxVpDFzqiIW527Aop4AaABAg) · 54 likes	(x.getAttribute('onclick')/").includes("frustrations")); if(b) b.click(); return false;">Tab 5 · Premiums that keep going up
Part D: drugs dropped, prices that jump	70	"I'm 67, just about to turn 68, and in almost three years, iv'e seen my Blue Shield of California premiums go up over 30%, and my bare bones Part D from Humana double, and that's before these new increases."YouTube · Medicare Supplement Plan (Medigap) Premium Hikes and What You Can Do (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=7rHuyAmCtHY&lc=UgxrnrelyKu5u4ITlud4AaABAg) · 9 likes	(x.getAttribute('onclick')/").includes("frustrations")); if(b) b.click(); return false;">Tab 5 · Part D: drugs dropped from the formulary, prices that jump
Stuck in Advantage: can't get a supplement later	214	"I would never pass medical underwriting today."YouTube · Who REALLY Chooses Medicare Advantage vs Medigap (And Who Regrets It) (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=suy-7L-LYaM&lc=UgyLYjtXy7l6rid092t4AaABAg) · 31 likes	(x.getAttribute('onclick')/").includes("dislikes")); if(b) b.click(); return false;">Dislikes · Stuck: can't switch back to a Medigap
Doctors and hospitals dropping Advantage plans	45	"On the 4 hr drive on the morning of his surgery, he received a call from the hospital saying that they had just dropped his Medicare Advantage company and couldn't do his surgery."YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=UgyQFMPrBbPsPUB1Q14AaABAg) · 29 likes	(x.getAttribute('onclick')/").includes("frustrations")); if(b) b.click(); return false;">Tab 5 · Doctors and hospitals dropping Advantage plans
Calls, mail and TV ads that never stop	23	"I get bombarded with phone calls and text from insurance companies wanting me to get an advantage plan."YouTube · Medicare Advantage Plans Leaving in 2026 - 2,600,000 Seniors Impacted (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8Pq6H7UZBbU&lc=UgxrrFVha096OaNtoNd4AaABAg.AMUWC5cfeMZAMXWPB_jarG) · 7 likes	(x.getAttribute('onclick')/").includes("frustrations")); if(b) b.click(); return false;">Tab 5 · Calls, mail and TV ads that never stop

Agents and callers who push or mislead	31	"@RickeyReynolds Yes----I called several companies before signing up and they all sounded like used car salesmen with high pressure, then I got sucked into Medicare School and spoke to a low key guy and he told me how great Ace was----I think he pushed Ace because they were paying a higher bonus."YouTube · Top Medicare Supplement Companies Review - Winners and Losers! (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HYfsEbghGR8&lc=Ugzl1NfBfQeBIZOMdbB4AaABAg.AWhpZS1r1SkAWi_7MQnsfQ) · 2 likes	(x.getAttribute('onclick')//").includes("frustrations")); if(b b.click(); return false;">Tab 5 · Agents and callers who push or mislead
'Free' benefits that are bait	14	"I was scammed by Humana into enrolling based on the "giveback" that was SUPPOSED to lower my Medicare monthly premium till i found out that it was Only a "one-off" payment of \$102 to Social Security not a monthly reduction of the Medicare premium, as i had earlier been given to believe."YouTube · Medicare Part B Give Back Benefit - What's The Catch? (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=dM1JjvQwTs&lc=Ugw0zeeu5s5pfs9ZjC94AaABAg) · 1 likes	(x.getAttribute('onclick')//").includes("frustrations")); if(b b.click(); return false;">Tab 5 · 'Free' benefits that are a rip-off
Under 65 and disabled: no supplement, or an unaffordable one	43	"I am under 65 and had to go with an Advantage plan my state does not offer a supplemental plan."YouTube · 2 New Devastating Medicare Advantage Stories (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Plzy4A7HxHg&lc=UgxNd2dInwxUWEDXrCf4AaABAg) · 4 likes	(x.getAttribute('onclick')//").includes("frustrations")); if(b b.click(); return false;">Tab 5 · Under 65 and disabled: no Medigap, or an unaffordable one
Dental, vision and hearing 'coverage' that pays little	19	"I also have a separate dental & vision plan (the Advantage dental and vision is a joke!)."YouTube · Do I need a Medicare Supplement Plan? (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=O-WxyTurD3c&lc=UgyJgBRgrCnwTLEcTRV4AaABAg) · 4 likes	(x.getAttribute('onclick')//").includes("frustrations")); if(b b.click(); return false;">Tab 5 · Dental, vision and hearing 'coverage' that pays little

3. Questions and objections that stop them

What they type and watch in private before they talk to anyone. Typed = Google and YouTube autocomplete phrases that still name the question (typed often enough to be suggested; not a search volume). Views are everyone who watched.

The question	Typed (autocomplete phrases that still name it)	Videos whose title names it	Views	In their own voice	Most-watched video
Can I switch back to a supplement later, or am I stuck?	26can i switch from a medicare supplement to an advantage plan at any time · can i switch from a medicare supplement to an advantage plan during oep · can i switch from medicare advantage back to medicare supplement · can i switch from medicare advantage to a medicare supplement	56	1,545,787	258 docs	Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg) (371,221 views)
Will they deny my care? Is my doctor in the network?	28aetna medicare advantage denial rates · can you be denied medicare advantage coverage · hhs medicare advantage denial report · humana medicare advantage denial rate	60	340,555	197 docs	Original Medicare Prior Authorizations Starting 2026 (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=DLA1dxLAo) (92,153 views)
Am I choosing wrong, or missing a deadline?	15i made a mistake on my medicare application · medicare late enrollment penalties · medicare late enrollment penalty · medicare late enrollment penalty appeal	48	3,033,807	461 docs	Working Past 65? Medicare Mistakes You Can't Afford To Make! 🤖 (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4GtRppYTHho) (1,790,879 views)
Can I trust this agent? How do they get paid?	18becoming a medicare agent · day in the life of a medicare agent · do i need a medicare agent · do you need a broker for medicare	61	956,616	87 docs	How Medicare Advantage Commissions Really Work (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=e6-PoFAPgTk) (214,781 views)
Are these 'extra benefits' real?	13flex card benefits · how does medicare part b giveback work · how does part b giveback work · humana part b giveback reviews	68	411,942	428 docs	What Is The Flex Card For Seniors? (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=U7te9a6r8dQ) (105,562 views)
How do I make the Medicare calls stop?	84are calls from medicare legitimate · are medicare calls legit · how to block calls from medicare · how to block medicare calls	73	1,381,158	24 docs	How to Effectively Put a Stop to Spam Calls, Emails and Texts (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=6nojRzHj0CE) (908,804 views)
Can I afford the premium, Part B and my drugs?	28can america afford medicare for all · can i pay medicare irmaa with hsa · can t afford eliquis on medicare · can t afford medicare part b	49	996,502	297 docs	Is A Big Part B Premium Increase Coming in 2024? (https://www.yout

[ube.com/watch?v=e7hPcPJXD_U](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=e7hPcPJXD_U)
(277,101 views)

4. Hooks and formats in the market

What the advertisers reaching this shopper open with, counted over every ad addressed to them on the Competitor Ads tab.

Measured over 1,126 ads to this audience (453 video, 673 static). One ad can use several hooks.

Hook pattern	Ads	Advertisers	Verbatim opening lines
Benefit bait (giveback, flex card, grocery, \$0)	362	98	"Choosing a Medicare plan doesn't have to be confusing." — Meagher Insurance and Financial Services Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=1414153919900760) "ILLINOIS RESIDENTS THOSE ON MEDICARE ARE ENTITLED TO A NO-COST MONTHLY FLEX CARD!" — Senior Medicare Experts Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=1303085548160811) "Have Medicare and Medicaid?" — Financial Benefits Insurance, Inc Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=1354265443149790)
Named audience (Turning 65?, 'Seniors on Medicare')	360	163	"For many Americans, choosing Medicare coverage is complicated and frustrating when turning 65." — Chapter Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=287307656741309) "Did you know..." — Total Medicare Savings Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=221306417191319) "Medicare Open Enrollment Is Approaching!" — Stuart Slattery BGA Insurance Group Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=6856768661057254)
Quiz / see if you qualify	220	73	"NORTH EAST OHIO SENIORS, IF YOU ARE ON MEDICARE & MEDICAID YOU ARE ENTITLED TO A MONTHLY FLEX BENEFIT CARD Don't Leave Benefits on the Table Other Additional Benefits Include  Dental  Vision  H" — Senior Legacy USA Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=1342258687198323) "Here's how we help Medicare beneficiaries affected by qualifying life events get proper coverage without waiting." — 100Insure Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=1605065513510363) "Choosing a Medicare plan doesn't have to be confusing." — Meagher Insurance and Financial Services Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=1414153919900760)
Question hook	214	114	"Medicare Enrollment Center - Turning 65?" — Blue Store Greensboro Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=1150542546277543) "Need Help Navigating Medicare?" — Stephanie Pogue - Confusion to Clarity Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=490740347261849) "Turning 65 in the Next Four Months?" — Medicare Michelle Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=581385550882842)
Deadline / enrollment urgency	190	99	"Did you know..." — Total Medicare Savings Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=221306417191319) "Medicare Open Enrollment Is Approaching!" — Stuart Slattery BGA Insurance Group Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=6856768661057254) "Here's how we help Medicare beneficiaries affected by qualifying life events get proper coverage without waiting." — 100Insure Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=1605065513510363)
Call now / speak to a licensed agent	173	85	"For many Americans, choosing Medicare coverage is complicated and frustrating when turning 65." — Chapter Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=287307656741309) "Don't let the stress of having to choose the right Medicare plans for you get in the way of your peace." — The Harrison Agency LLC Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=3527463150868328) "Did you know..." — Total Medicare Savings Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=221306417191319)
Dental / vision / hearing	171	62	"Seniors can get dentures with a Zero Cost (\$0) Dental plan today." — Dental Benefits Finder Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=907706207630842) "NORTH EAST OHIO SENIORS, IF YOU ARE ON MEDICARE & MEDICAID YOU ARE ENTITLED TO A MONTHLY FLEX BENEFIT CARD Don't Leave Benefits on the Table Other Additional Benefits Include  Dental  Vision  H" — Senior Legacy USA Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=1342258687198323) "Every day, thousands of Americans accidentally overpay or miss out on benefits—just because they didn't fully understand how to start Medicare the right way." — Greg Crawford Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=1444819860271467)
Trust / no cost / unbiased help	129	70	"Did you know..." — Total Medicare Savings Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=221306417191319) "Medicare Enrollment Center - Turning 65?" — Blue Store Greensboro Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=1150542546277543) "Need Help Navigating Medicare?" — Stephanie Pogue - Confusion to Clarity Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=490740347261849)
Fear / mistake avoidance	91	42	"Need Help Navigating Medicare?" — Stephanie Pogue - Confusion to Clarity Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=490740347261849) "Hey Statesville!" — Lake Norman Healthcare Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=461189346972790) "It's time to celebrate turning 65, but also to make smart decisions about Medicare!" — Expert Insurance Team Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=1144271530492704)

5. Features and benefits to demonstrate in an ad

Each one as the feature, what would be on screen, and the voice that asks for it. The 'demonstrate it' clauses are hypotheses.

Feature or benefit	Demonstrate it (hypothesis: what is on screen)	Who asks for it, in their words
Doctors and drugs checked before any recommendation	Their own doctor and their own prescription typed into the plan search, found or not found, on screen.	45 docs · (x.getAttribute('onclick')/"/").includes("frustrations")); if(b) b.click(); return false;">Tab 5 · Doctors and hospitals dropping Advantage plans"The only hospital within 100 miles of me has stopped accepting Humana advantage plans as in-network due to claim denials and long waits for pre-approvals." YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgxNqF0wOHim1a8HT3J4AaABAg) · 31 likes
The rule you can't undo, said first	A calendar with their birthday month and the six-month supplement window marked; the date it closes.	25 docs · (x.getAttribute('onclick')/"/").includes("solound")); if(b) b.click(); return false;">Tab 7 · Wishing someone had warned them about underwriting and deadlines"You should have mentioned that there's no medical underwriting for supplements only in the first 6 months of eligibility." YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think / Medicare Advantage vs Supplement (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgwoZ8dAIHWMGlpY32l4AaABAg) · 12 likes
What each choice costs in a bad year	Two columns: a healthy year and a hospital year, for Advantage and for a supplement, in dollars.	65 docs · (x.getAttribute('onclick')/"/").includes("fears")); if(b) b.click(); return false;">Tab 1 · A big illness and the bills that follow"The cost and "perks" of an Advantage plan sound appealing, but not worth the risk of possible out of pocket expenses compared to original Medicare with a supplement plan." YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement / Most Get This Wrong (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4xXIJZes9o&lc=UgzloIQWLPnagmlgkF4AaABAg) · 21 likes
One named agent, no call center	The agent's face, name, license number and direct line; the same person in the ad, on the call and at renewal.	31 docs · (x.getAttribute('onclick')/"/").includes("frustrations")); if(b) b.click(); return false;">Tab 5 · Agents and callers who push or mislead"@RickeyReynolds Yes----I called several companies before signing up and they all sounded like used car salesmen with high pressure, then I got sucked into Medicare School and spoke to a low key guy and he told me how great Ace was----I think he pushed Ace because they were paying a higher bonus." YouTube · Top Medicare Supplement Companies Review - Winners and Losers! (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HYfsEbghGR8&lc=Ugzl1NfBfQeBIZOMdbB4AaABAg_AWhpZS1r1SkAWi_7MQnsfQ) · 2 likes
No bait	An ad with no giveback, flex card or grocery claim, that says what the plan pays and what it does not.	14 docs · (x.getAttribute('onclick')/"/").includes("frustrations")); if(b) b.click(); return false;">Tab 5 · 'Free' benefits that are a rip-off"I seriously question how scammers are getting away with the Medicare Free Food cards ad's that they have been pushing hardcore on youtube videos." YouTube · IT'S A SCAM! A DAY IN THE LIFE! How Many Medicare Scam Calls Can I Get In One Day... HA! (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=32GR2F0y4IY&lc=Ugw7Zp26mwU5jQY6hqp4AaABAg) · 3 likes
The same Plan G for less after a rate increase	Last year's premium, this year's increase, and another carrier's quote for the identical letter plan.	162 docs · (x.getAttribute('onclick')/"/").includes("frustrations")); if(b) b.click(); return false;">Tab 5 · Premiums that keep going up"Every single year I have had rate increases that far exceeded 5-8%." YouTube · Top Medicare Supplement Companies Review - Winners and Losers! (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HYfsEbghGR8&lc=UgyL5MEueBzKhmgHj94AaABAg) · 52 likes
The calls stop here	One consent line: your number goes to this agent and is never sold.	23 docs · (x.getAttribute('onclick')/"/").includes("frustrations")); if(b) b.click(); return false;">Tab 5 · Calls, mail and TV ads that never stop"I get bombarded with phone calls and text from insurance companies wanting me to get an advantage plan." YouTube · Medicare Advantage Plans Leaving in 2026 - 2,600,000 Seniors Impacted (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8Pq6H7UZBbU&lc=UgxrrFVha096OaNtoNd4AaABAg_AMUWC5cfeMZAMXWPB_jarG) · 7 likes

What this research does not show: price reaction (what premium difference moves them), which agencies actually deliver on these promises, and how the same people behave on the phone. The corpus over-represents people who research on YouTube; shoppers who simply answer a call or a TV ad post less.

Sources, Method & Gaps

One corpus and one voice router (hi_voice.py) for the three pages; every document carries exactly one voice.

Precision reads

- Ad classifier (ads_hi.py), read on 2026-10-07 after merging the September 25 and October 6-7 Ad Library pulls: three rounds of 30 random on-topic ads, 23 then 24 then 26 of 30 with the right audience and advertiser type, rules corrected after each round; 20 random ads from the off-topic pile contained 3 that belonged on a page (an agent-recruiting ad, a carrier flex-card ad, a life-carrier recruiting ad), and those patterns were added. Expect roughly one ad in eight to sit under the wrong advertiser type; the audience call (agents vs Medicare vs under-65) is more reliable than the type.

- Second read after the October 2026 corpus expansion (30 random documents per page, drawn from the whole buyer set, hand-read on 2026-10-07): Medicare shoppers 25 of 30 were a person on or approaching Medicare or helping a relative with it (the five misses were opinion comments with no plan of their own); ACA shoppers 24 of 30 after the rule was tightened to require ownership language (a plan, a premium, an income, an application) - the first read was 21 of 30, with advice-givers and political comments let in; agents 27 of 30 (misses: one lead vendor quoted inside a forum reply, one property-and-casualty question, one unclear).
- Voice router (hi_voice.py), hand-read of 15 random documents per voice after five rounds of rules: Medicare shopper 13/15, family helper 12/15, agent 12/15, life / final-expense agent 11/15, ACA shopper 12/15 (was 10/15 before the personal-detail rule), aspirant 9/15 before the last fix (licensing advice from working agents; rule tightened, not re-sampled).
- Agent-facing ads: the full list read by hand once (67 page overrides with a reason each), then a fresh random 30: audience 30/30 agent-facing, seller type 27/30 with the three misses pinned.
- Themes: frame and object in the same sentence; broad objects that counted any mention (a spouse, a phone, a video) were moved to framed themes after reading the capture lists; themes under five documents are dropped, not padded.
- Metrics tab: the page JS and the Python model agree on 252 priced fields across six input sets (0 mismatches).

What was not pulled, and why

- Facebook agent groups: the group feeds did not load for the research account (member-only groups, throttled feed pages), so only 17 publicly indexed posts were read with their comments (20 agent documents). A warmed account that joins the groups would add the largest missing agent source.
- Insurance-Forums.com: the first page of each thread only (up to ~10 posts), from the Senior Insurance, Health Insurance Exchange, Insurance Leads, Final Expense and Health Care Reform subforums.
- No count of independent agents selling Medicare or ACA was found in a citable source; the pages do not estimate one.
- TrustPilot pages were pulled per star level, so star counts are a reading sample; several vendors have no TrustPilot page (Inboundcore, Digital Senior Benefits, Integrity, Ritter, HealthSherpa). BBB was not pulled.
- Meta Ad Library: active US ads on quoted phrases only, no spend or impressions for US commercial ads; Meta's own policy page blocked the scripted fetch, so the special-ad-category rule is cited from PSM Brokerage and Data-Axle.
- Vince's feed: none yet (no agent-facing ads seen), so every advertiser comes from the Library search.
- Quora (403), LinkedIn (not logged in) and BiggerPockets were not read.

Tool status (D0)

- 2026-09-25: Tavily 968 of 1,000 monthly credits already used, so Facebook discovery went through web search restricted to facebook.com instead; Apify: three fresh accounts (\$5 each) used for consumer Reddit (harshmaur~reddit-scraper, calibrated at ~\$0.002 per record; ~\$12.40 spent in total including one duplicate test run aborted at \$0.87); YouTube Data API: ~9,900 of 10,000 daily units; SerpAPI not used; research Chrome (CDP 18800) for Reddit agent subs, Facebook permalinks, TrustPilot and Insurance-Forums.com (relaunched once after a CDP timeout); Ad Library read headless and logged out.

Sources

- CMS CY2027 agent & broker compensation memo, June 1, 2026 (psmbrokerage.com copy)
- 42 CFR 422.2274 (eCFR) — compensation recovery / chargebacks
- KFF, Medicare Advantage in 2026: Enrollment Update
- CMS press release, 23.1 million enroll in 2026
- KFF, What we know about 2026 ACA marketplace enrollment
- Vendor and FMO benchmark pages: OneLife Marketing Solutions (2026 lead prices, Medicare benchmarks, channel benchmarks), SixtyFiveLeads, InsureLeads, AllCalls, Plura AI, Aged Lead Store, Quotely, Lead Distro AI, HyperTarget, Ritter, BenaVest, Pandora — flagged as vendor-sourced on the Metrics tab